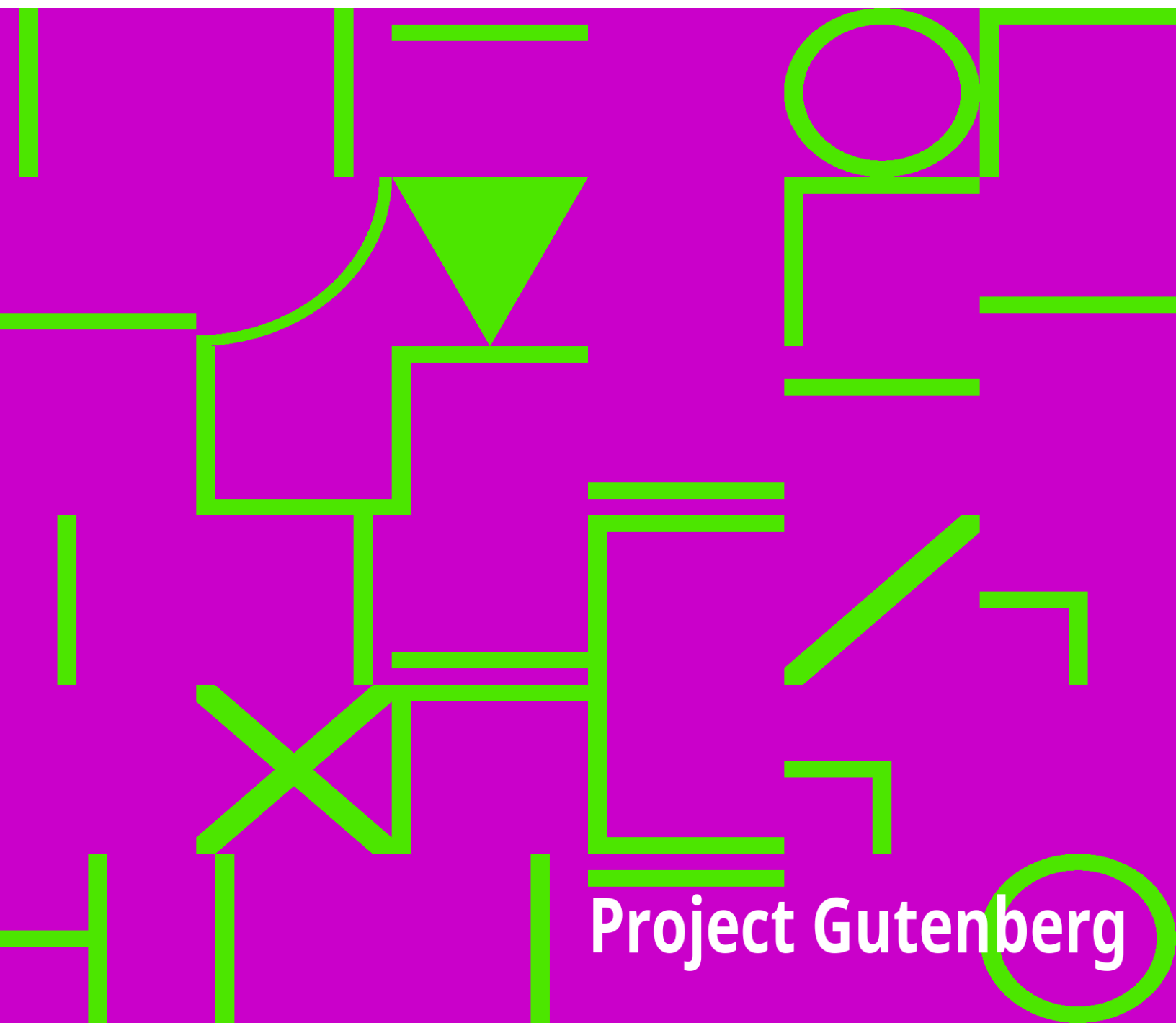


The Works of Lord Byron. Vol. 3

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LORD BYRON. VOL. 3 ***

The Works
OF
LORD BYRON.

A NEW, REVISED AND ENLARGED EDITION,
WITH ILLUSTRATIONS.
Poetry. Vol. III.

EDITED BY
ERNEST HARTLEY COLERIDGE, M.A.,

HON. F.R.S.L.

LONDON:
JOHN MURRAY, ALBEMARLE STREET.
NEW YORK: CHARLES SCRIBNER'S SONS.

1900.

TRANSCRIBER'S NOTES

The source code for this HTML page contains only Latin-1 characters, but it directs the browser to display some special characters. The original work contained a few phrases or lines of Greek text. These are represented here as Greek letters, for example Δεῦτε πῖδες, κ.τ.λ.. If the mouse is held still over such phrases, a transliteration in Beta-code pops up. Aside from Greek letters, the only unusual characters are ā (a with macron), ī (i with macron), and ć (c with accent).

An important feature of this edition is its copious footnotes. Footnotes are indicated by small raised keys in brackets; these are links to the footnote's text. Footnotes indexed with arabic numbers (e.g. [17], [221]) are informational. Any text in square brackets is the work of editor E. H. Coleridge. Unbracketed note text is by Byron himself. Footnotes indexed with letters (e.g. [c], [bf]) document variant forms of the text from manuscripts and other sources.

In the original, footnotes were printed at the foot of the page on which they were referenced, and their indices started over on each page. In this etext, footnotes have been collected at the ends of each section, and have been numbered consecutively throughout.

Navigation aids are provided as follows. Page numbers are displayed at the right edge of the window. To jump directly to page *nn*, append #Page_*nn* to the document URL. To jump directly to the text of footnote *xx*, either search for [*xx*] or append #Footnote_*xx* to the document URL.

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PREFACE TO THE THIRD VOLUME.



THE present volume contains the six metrical tales which were composed within the years 1812 and 1815, the *Hebrew Melodies*, and the minor poems of 1809-1816. With the exception of the first fifteen poems (1809-1811)—*Chansons de Voyage*, as they might be called—the volume as a whole was produced on English soil. Beginning with the *Giaour*; which followed in the wake of *Childe Harold* and shared its triumph, and ending with the ill-omened *Domestic Pieces*, or *Poems of the Separation*, the poems which Byron wrote in his own country synchronize with his popularity as a poet by the acclaim and suffrages of his own countrymen. His greatest work, by which his lasting fame has been established, and by which his relative merits as a great poet will be judged in the future, was yet to come; but the work which made his name, which is stamped with his sign-manual, and which has come to be regarded as distinctively and characteristically Byronic, preceded maturity and achievement.

No poet of his own or other times, not Walter Scott, not Tennyson, not Mr. Kipling, was ever in his own lifetime so widely, so amazingly popular. Thousands of copies of the "Tales"—of the *Bride of Abydos*, of the *Corsair*, of *Lara*—were sold in a day, and edition followed edition month in and month out. Everywhere men talked about the "noble author"—in the capitals of Europe, in literary circles in the United States, in the East Indies. He was "the glass of fashion ... the observ'd of all observers," the swayer of

sentiment, the master and creator of popular emotion. No other English poet before or since has divided men's attention with generals and sea-captains and statesmen, has attracted and fascinated and overcome the world so entirely and potently as Lord Byron.

It was *Childe Harold*, the unfinished, immature *Childe Harold*, and the Turkish and other "Tales," which raised this sudden and deafening storm of applause when the century was young, and now, at its close (I refer, of course, to the Tales, not to Byron's poetry as a whole, which, in spite of the critics, has held and still holds its own), are ignored if not forgotten, passed over if not despised—which but few know thoroughly, and "very few" are found to admire or to love. *Ubi lapsus, quid feci?* might the questioning spirit of the author exclaim with regard to his "Harrys and Larrys, Pilgrims and Pirates," who once held the field, and now seem to have gone under in the struggle for poetical existence!

To what, then, may we attribute the passing away of interest and enthusiasm? To the caprice of fashion, to an insistence on a more faultless *technique*, to a nicer taste in ethical sentiment, to a preference for a subtler treatment of loftier themes? More certainly, and more particularly, I think, to the blurring of outline and the blotting out of detail due to lapse of time and the shifting of the intellectual standpoint.

However much the charm of novelty and the contagion of enthusiasm may have contributed to the success of the Turkish and other Tales, it is in the last degree improbable that our grandfathers and great-grandfathers were enamoured, not of a reality, but of an illusion born of ignorance or of vulgar bewilderment. They were carried away because they breathed the same atmosphere as the singer; and being undistracted by ethical, or grammatical, or metrical offences, they not only read these poems with

avidity, but understood enough of what they read to be touched by their vitality, to realize their verisimilitude.

Tout comprendre c'est tout pardonner. Nay, more, the knowledge, the comprehension of essential greatness in art, in nature, or in man is not to know that there is aught to forgive. But that sufficing knowledge which the reader of average intelligence brings with him for the comprehension and appreciation of contemporary literature has to be bought at the price of close attention and patient study when the subject-matter of a poem and the modes and movements of the poet's consciousness are alike unfamiliar.

Criticism, however subtle, however suggestive, however luminous, will not bridge over the gap between the past and the present, will not supply the sufficing knowledge. It is delightful and interesting and, in a measure, instructive to know what great poets of his own time and of ours have thought of Byron, how he "strikes" them; but unless we are ourselves saturated with his thought and style, unless we learn to breathe his atmosphere by reading the books which he read, picturing to ourselves the scenes which he saw,—unless we aspire to his ideals and suffer his limitations, we are in no way entitled to judge his poems, whether they be good or bad.

Byron's metrical "Tales" come before us in the guise of light reading, and may be "easily criticized" as melo-dramatic—the heroines conventional puppets, the heroes reduplicated reflections of the author's personality, the Oriental "properties" loosely arranged, and somewhat stage-worn. A thorough and sympathetic study of these once extravagantly lauded and now belittled poems will not, perhaps, reverse the deliberate judgment of later generations, but it will display them for what they are, bold and rapid and yet exact presentations of the "gorgeous East," vivid and fresh from the

hand of the great artist who conceived them out of the abundance of memory and observation, and wrought them into shape with the "pen of a ready writer." They will be once more recognized as works of genius, an integral portion of our literary inheritance, which has its proper value, and will repay a more assiduous and a finer husbandry.

I have once more to acknowledge the generous assistance of the officials of the British Museum, and, more especially, of Mr. A. G. Ellis, of the Oriental Printed Books and MSS. Department, who has afforded me invaluable instruction in the compilation of the notes to the *Giaour* and *Bride of Abydos*.

I have also to thank Mr. R. L. Binyon, of the Department of Prints and Drawings, for advice and assistance in the selection of illustrations.

I desire to express my cordial thanks to the Registrar of the Copyright Office, Stationers' Hall; to Professor Jannaris, of the University of St. Andrews; to Miss E. Dawes, M.A., D.L., of Heathfield Lodge, Weybridge; to my cousin, Miss Edith Coleridge, of Goodrest, Torquay; and to my friend, Mr. Frank E. Taylor, of Chertsey, for information kindly supplied during the progress of the work.

For many of the "parallel passages" from the works of other poets, which are to be found in the notes, I am indebted to a series of articles by A. A. Watts, in the *Literary Gazette*, February and March, 1821; and to the notes to the late Professor E. Kolbing's *Siege of Corinth*.

On behalf of the publisher, I beg to acknowledge the kindness of Lord Glenesk, and of Sir Theodore Martin, K.C.B., who have permitted the examination and collation of MSS. of the *Siege of Corinth* and of the "Thyrza" poems, in their possession.

The original of the miniature of H.R.H. the Princess Charlotte of Wales (see p. 44) is in the Library of Windsor Castle. It has been reproduced for this volume by the gracious permission of Her Majesty the Queen.

ERNEST HARTLEY COLERIDGE.

April 18, 1900.

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INTRODUCTION TO THE OCCASIONAL *PIECES*

(*POEMS* 1809-1813; *POEMS* 1814-1816).



THE Poems afterwards entitled "Occasional Pieces," which were included in the several editions of the Collected Works issued by Murray, 1819-1831, numbered fifty-seven in all. They may be described as the aggregate of the shorter poems written between the years 1809-1818, which the author thought worthy of a permanent place among his poetical works. Of these the first twenty-nine appeared in successive editions of *Childe Harold* (Cantos I., II.) «viz. fourteen in the first edition, twenty in the second, and twenty-nine in the seventh edition», while the thirtieth, the *Ode on the Death of Sir Peter Parker*, was originally attached to *Hebrew Melodies*. The remaining twenty-seven pieces consist of six poems first published in the Second Edition of the *Corsair*, 1814; eleven which formed the collection entitled "Poems," 1816; six which were appended to the *Prisoner of Chillon*, December, 1816; the *Very Mournful Ballad*, and the *Sonnet by Vittorelli*, which accompanied the Fourth Canto of *Childe Harold*, 1818; the *Sketch*, first included by Murray in his edition of 1819; and the *Ode to Venice*, which appeared in the same volume as *Mazeppa*.

Thus matters stood till 1831, when seventy new poems (sixty had been published by Moore, in *Letters and Journals*, 1830, six were republished from Hobhouse's *Imitations and Translations*, 1809, and four derived from other sources) were included in a sixth volume of the Collected Works.

In the edition of 1832-35, twenty-four new poems were added, but four which had appeared in *Letters and Journals*, 1830, and in the sixth volume of the edition of 1831 were omitted. In the one-volume edition (first issued in 1837 and still in print), the four short pieces omitted in 1832 once more found a place, and the lines on "John Keats," first published in *Letters and Journals*, and the two stanzas to Lady Caroline Lamb, "Remember thee! remember thee," first printed by Medwin, in the *Conversations of Lord Byron*, 1824, were included in the Collection.

The third volume of the present issue includes all minor poems (with the exception of epigrams and *jeux d'esprit* reserved for the sixth volume) written after Byron's departure for the East in July, 1809, and before he left England for good in April, 1816.

The "Separation" and its consequent exile afforded a pretext and an opportunity for the publication of a crop of spurious verses. Of these *Madame Lavalette* (first published in the *Examiner*, January 21, 1816, under the signature B.B., and immediately preceding a genuine sonnet by Wordsworth, "How clear, how keen, how marvellously bright!") and *Oh Shame to thee, Land of the Gaul!* included by Hone, in *Poems on his Domestic Circumstances*, 1816; and *Farewell to England, Ode to the Isle of St. Helena, To the Lily of France, On the Morning of my Daughter's Birth*, published by J. Johnston, 1816, were repudiated by Byron, in a letter to Murray, dated July 22, 1816. A longer poem entitled *The Tempest*, which was attached to the spurious *Pilgrimage to the Holy Land*, published by

Johnston, "the Cheapside impostor," in 1817, was also denounced by Byron as a forgery in a letter to Murray, dated December 16, 1816.

The *Triumph of the Whale*, by Charles Lamb, and the *Enigma on the Letter H*, by Harriet Fanshawe, were often included in piratical editions of Byron's *Poetical Works*. Other attributed poems which found their way into newspapers and foreign editions, viz. (i.) *To my dear Mary Anne*, 1804, "Adieu to sweet Mary for ever;" and (ii.) *To Miss Chaworth*, "Oh, memory, torture me no more," 1804, published in *Works of Lord Byron*, Paris, 1828; (iii.) lines written *In the Bible*, "Within this awful volume lies," quoted in *Life, Writings, Opinions, etc.*, 1825, iii. 414; (iv.) lines addressed to (?) George Anson Byron, "And dost thou ask the reason of my sadness?" *Nicnac*, March 29, 1823; (v.) *To Lady Caroline Lamb*, "And sayst thou that I have not felt," published in *Works, etc.*, 1828; (vi.) lines *To her who can best understand them*, "Be it so, we part for ever," published in the *Works of Lord Byron, In Verse and Prose*, Hartford, 1847; (vii.) *Lines found in the Travellers' Book at Chamouni*, "How many numbered are, how few agreed!" published *Works, etc.*, 1828; and (viii.) a second copy of verses with the same title, "All hail, Mont Blanc! Mont-au-Vert, hail!" *Life, Writings, etc.*, 1825, ii. 384; (ix.) *Lines addressed by Lord Byron to Mr. Hobhouse on his Election for Westminster*, "Would you get to the house by the true gate?" *Works, etc.*, 1828; and (x.) *Enigma on the Letter I*, "I am not in youth, nor in manhood, nor age," *Works, etc.*, Paris, p. 720, together with sundry epigrams, must, failing the production of the original MSS., be accounted forgeries, or, perhaps, in one or two instances, of doubtful authenticity.

The following poems: *On the Quotation*, "And my true faith" etc.; [*Love and Gold*]; *Julian [a Fragment]*; and *On the Death of the Duke of Dorset*,

are now published for the first time from MSS. in the possession of Mr. John Murray.

POEMS 1809-1813.



THE GIRL OF CADIZ.^[1]

1.

never talk again to me
of northern climes and British ladies;
it is not been your lot to see,^[a]
like me, the lovely Girl of Cadiz.
Though her eye be not of blue,
nor fair her locks, like English lasses,
yet far its own expressive hue
the languid azure eye surpasses!

2.

Mintheus-like from heaven she stole
the fire that through those silken lashes
darkest glances seems to roll,
from eyes that cannot hide their flashes:
as along her bosom steal
lengthened flow her raven tresses,
'd swear each clustering lock could feel,
and curled to give her neck caresses.

3.

English maids are long to woo,^{[b][2]}
and frigid even in possession;
if their charms be fair to view,
their lips are slow at Love's confession;
born beneath a brighter sun,
or love ordained the Spanish maid is,
who,—when fondly, fairly won,—
enchants you like the Girl of Cadiz?

4.

Spanish maid is no coquette,
nor joys to see a lover tremble,
if she love, or if she hate,
like she knows not to dissemble.
Her heart can ne'er be bought or sold—
where'er it beats, it beats sincerely;
yet, though it will not bend to gold,
it will love you long and love you dearly.

5.

Spanish girl that meets your love
ne'er taunts you with a mock denial,
every thought is bent to prove
her passion in the hour of trial.
When thronging foemen menace Spain,
she dares the deed and shares the danger;
should her lover press the plain,
she hurls the spear, her love's avenger.

6.

when, beneath the evening star,
he mingles in the gay Bolero,^[3]
ings to her attuned guitar
f Christian knight or Moorish hero,
ounts her beads with fairy hand
eneath the twinkling rays of Hesper,^[c]
oins Devotion's choral band,
o chaunt the sweet and hallowed vesper;—

7.

ach her charms the heart must move
f all who venture to behold her;
n let not maids less fair reprove
ecause her bosom is not colder:
ough many a clime 'tis mine to roam
/here many a soft and melting maid is,
none abroad, and few at home,
lay match the dark-eyed Girl of Cadiz.^[d]

1809.
[First published, 1832.]

LINES WRITTEN IN AN ALBUM, AT MALTA.^{[e][4]}

1.

o'er the cold sepulchral stone
ome *name* arrests the passer-by;
s, when thou view'st this page alone,
lay *mine* attract thy pensive eye!

2.

when by thee that name is read,
perchance in some succeeding year,
direct on *me* as on the *dead*,
and think my *Heart* is buried *here*.

Malta, *September* 14, 1809.
[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

TO FLORENCE. ^[f]

1.

Lady! when I left the shore,
the distant shore which gave me birth,
hardly thought to grieve once more,
to quit another spot on earth:

2.

here, amidst this barren isle,
where panting Nature droops the head,
where only thou art seen to smile,
I view my parting hour with dread.

3.

though far from Albin's craggy shore,
divided by the dark-blue main;
now, brief, rolling seasons o'er,
perchance I view her cliffs again:

4.

wheresoe'er I now may roam,

hrough scorching clime, and varied sea,
ugh Time restore me to my home,
ne'er shall bend mine eyes on thee:

5.

hee, in whom at once conspire
ll charms which heedless hearts can move,
om but to see is to admire,
nd, oh! forgive the word—to love.

6.

give the word, in one who ne'er
/ith such a word can more offend;
. since thy heart I cannot share,
elieve me, what I am, thy friend.

7.

. who so cold as look on thee,
hou lovely wand'rer, and be less?
be, what man should ever be,
he friend of Beauty in distress?

8.

who would think that form had past
hrough Danger's most destructive path,^[g]
braved the death-winged tempest's blast,
nd 'scaped a Tyrant's fiercer wrath?

9.

y! when I shall view the walls

Where free Byzantium once arose,
Stamboul's Oriental halls
The Turkish tyrants now enclose;

10.

Though mightiest in the lists of fame,
That glorious city still shall be;
None 'twill hold a dearer claim,
This spot of thy nativity:

11.

Though I bid thee now farewell,
When I behold that wondrous scene—
Where thou art I may not dwell—
I will soothe to be where thou hast been.

September, 1809.
[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

STANZAS COMPOSED DURING A THUNDERSTORM. ^{[h][5]}

1.

Dark and mirk is the nightly blast,
Where Pindus' mountains rise,
The angry clouds are pouring fast
The vengeance of the skies.

2.

guides are gone, our hope is lost,
and lightnings, as they play,
show where rocks our path have crost,
nor gild the torrent's spray.

3.

On a cot I saw, though low?
When lightning broke the gloom—
How welcome were its shade!—ah, no!
'Tis but a Turkish tomb.

4.

Through sounds of foaming waterfalls,
hear a voice exclaim—
Way-worn countryman, who calls
In distant England's name.

5.

What is fired—by foe or friend?
Nother—'tis to tell
Mountain-peasants to descend,
And lead us where they dwell.

6.

Who in such a night will dare
To tempt the wilderness?
Who 'mid thunder-peals can hear
Our signal of distress?

7.

who that heard our shouts would rise
to try the dubious road?
rather deem from nightly cries
that outlaws were abroad.

8.

ids burst, skies flash, oh, dreadful hour!
fore fiercely pours the storm!
here one thought has still the power
to keep my bosom warm.

9.

le wandering through each broken path,
'er brake and craggy brow;
le elements exhaust their wrath,
weet Florence, where art thou?

10.

on the sea, not on the sea—
hy bark hath long been gone:
may the storm that pours on me,
ow down my head alone!

11.

swiftly blew the swift Siroc,
hen last I pressed thy lip;
long ere now, with foaming shock,
npelled thy gallant ship.

12.

✓ thou art safe; nay, long ere now
ast trod the shore of Spain;
ere hard if aught so fair as thou
ould linger on the main.

13.

. since I now remember thee
i darkness and in dread,
n those hours of revelry
hich Mirth and Music sped;

14.

hou, amid the fair white walls,
Cadiz yet be free,
imes from out her latticed halls
ook o'er the dark blue sea;

15.

n think upon Calypso's isles,
ndeared by days gone by;
others give a thousand smiles,
o me a single sigh.

16.

. when the admiring circle mark
he paleness of thy face,
elf-formed tear, a transient spark
f melancholy grace,

17.

in thou'lt smile, and blushing shun
ome coxcomb's raillery;
own for once thou thought'st on one,
Who ever thinks on thee.

18.

ugh smile and sigh alike are vain,
When severed hearts repine,
spirit flies o'er Mount and Main,
and mourns in search of *thine*.

October 11, 1809.

[MS. M. First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

STANZAS WRITTEN IN PASSING THE AMBRACIAN GULF.^[i]

1.

OUGH cloudless skies, in silvery sheen,
ull beams the moon on Actium's coast:
on these waves, for Egypt's queen,
he ancient world was won and lost.

2.

ow upon the scene I look,
he azure grave of many a Roman;
ere stern Ambition once forsook
is wavering crown to follow *Woman*.

3.

ence! whom I will love as well
As ever yet was said or sung,
(e Orpheus sang his spouse from Hell)
Thilst *thou* art *fair* and *I* am *young*;

4.

et Florence! those were pleasant times,
When worlds were staked for Ladies' eyes:
bards as many realms as rhymes,^[j]
hy charms might raise new Antonies.^[k]

5.

ugh Fate forbids such things to be,^[l]
et, by thine eyes and ringlets curled!
not *lose* a *world* for thee,
ut would not lose *thee* for a *World*.^[6]

November 14, 1809.

[MS. M. First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

THE SPELL IS BROKE, THE CHARM IS FLOWN!^[m]

WRITTEN AT ATHENS, JANUARY 16, 1810.

spell is broke, the charm is flown!
hus is it with Life's fitful fever:
madly smile when we should groan;
elirium is our best deceiver.
n lucid interval of thought
ecalls the woes of Nature's charter;
. *He* that acts as *wise men* ought,

ut *lives*—as Saints have died—a martyr.

[MS. M. First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

WRITTEN AFTER SWIMMING FROM SESTOS
TO ABYDOS.^[7]

1.

n the month of dark December,
eander, who was nightly wont
at maid will not the tale remember?)
o cross thy stream, broad Hellespont!

2.

hen the wintry tempest roared,
e sped to Hero, nothing loth,
thus of old thy current poured,
air Venus! how I pity both!

3.

me, degenerate modern wretch,
hough in the genial month of May,
dripping limbs I faintly stretch,
nd think I've done a feat to-day.

4.

since he crossed the rapid tide,
ccording to the doubtful story,
voo,—and—Lord knows what beside,
nd swam for Love, as I for Glory;

5.

ere hard to say who fared the best:
ad mortals! thus the Gods still plague you!
ost his labour, I my jest:
or he was drowned, and I've the ague.^[8]

May 9, 1810.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

LINES IN THE TRAVELLERS' BOOK AT ORCHOMENUS.^[9]

IN THIS BOOK A TRAVELLER HAD WRITTEN:—

Albion, smiling, sees her son depart
race the birth and nursery of art:
le his object, glorious is his aim;
comes to Athens, and he—writes his name.”

BENEATH WHICH LORD BYRON INSERTED THE FOLLOWING:—

modest bard, like many a bard unknown,
mes on our names, but wisely hides his own;
yet, whoe'er he be, to say no worse,
name would bring more credit than his verse.

1810.

[First published, *Life*, 1830.]

MAID OF ATHENS, ERE WE PART.^[n]

Ζωή μου, σᾶς ἀγαπῶ.

1.

d of Athens,^[10] ere we part,
e, oh give me back my heart!
since that has left my breast,
p it now, and take the rest!
r my vow before I go,
| μου, σᾶς ἀγαπῶ.^[11]

2.

hose tresses unconfined,
æd by each Ægean wind;
hose lids whose jetty fringe
; thy soft cheeks' blooming tinge;
hose wild eyes like the roe,
| μου, σᾶς ἀγαπῶ.

3.

hat lip I long to taste;
hat zone-encircled waist;
ill the token-flowers^[12] that tell
at words can never speak so well;
ove's alternate joy and woe,
| μου, σᾶς ἀγαπῶ.

4.

d of Athens! I am gone:
rk of me, sweet! when alone.
ugh I fly to Istambol,^[13]
ens holds my heart and soul:
I cease to love thee? No!

μου, σᾶς ἀγαπῶ.

Athens, 1810.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

FRAGMENT FROM THE "MONK OF ATHOS."^[14]

1.

IDE the confines of the Ægean main,
/here northward Macedonia bounds the flood,
views opposed the Asiatic plain,
/here once the pride of lofty Ilion stood,
e the great Father of the giant brood,
/ith lowering port majestic Athos stands,
wned with the verdure of eternal wood,
s yet unspoiled by sacrilegious hands,
throws his mighty shade o'er seas and distant lands.

2.

deep embosomed in his shady groves
ull many a convent rears its glittering spire,
scenes where Heavenly Contemplation loves
o kindle in her soul her hallowed fire,
re air and sea with rocks and woods conspire
o breathe a sweet religious calm around,
ning the thoughts from every low desire,
nd the wild waves that break with murmuring sound
ng the rocky shore proclaim it holy ground.

3.

restered shades where Piety has given

. quiet refuge from each earthly care,
once the rapt spirit may ascend to Heaven!

ye condemned the ills of life to bear!
s with advancing age your woes increase,
at bliss amidst these solitudes to share
he happy foretaste of eternal Peace,
Heaven in mercy bids your pain and sorrows cease.

[First published in the *Life of Lord Byron*,
by the Hon. Roden Noel, London, 1890, pp. 206, 207.]

LINES WRITTEN BENEATH A PICTURE. ^[15]

1.

.R object of defeated care!
hough now of Love and thee bereft,
econcile me with despair
hine image and my tears are left.

2.

said with Sorrow Time can cope;
ut this I feel can ne'er be true:
by the death-blow of my Hope
ly Memory immortal grew.

Athens, January, 1811.
[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

TRANSLATION OF THE FAMOUS GREEK WAR SONG,

"Δεῦτε παῖδες τῶν Ἑλλήνων." ^[16]

s of the Greeks, arise!
he glorious hour's gone forth,
, worthy of such ties,
isplay who gave us birth.

CHORUS.

Sons of Greeks! let us go
In arms against the foe,
Till their hated blood shall flow
In a river past our feet.

n manfully despising
he Turkish tyrant's yoke,
your country see you rising,
nd all her chains are broke.
ve shades of chiefs and sages,
ehold the coming strife!
énes of past ages,
h, start again to life!
he sound of my trumpet, breaking
our sleep, oh, join with me!
the seven-hilled city^[17] seeking,
ight, conquer, till we're free.

Sons of Greeks, etc.

ta, Sparta, why in slumbers
ethargic dost thou lie?
ike, and join thy numbers
with Athens, old ally!

nidas recalling,
hat chief of ancient song,
o saved ye once from falling,
he terrible! the strong!
o made that bold diversion
i old Thermopylæ,
warring with the Persian
o keep his country free;
i his three hundred waging
he battle, long he stood,
like a lion raging,
xpired in seas of blood.

Sons of Greeks, etc.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

TRANSLATION OF THE ROMAIC SONG,

“Μπένω μεσ' τὸ περιβόλι
Ὠραιότατη Χαηδή,” κ.τ.λ.^[18]

TER thy garden of roses,
elovéd and fair Haidée,
i morning where Flora reposes,
or surely I see her in thee.
Lovely! thus low I implore thee,
eeceive this fond truth from my tongue,
ch utters its song to adore thee,
et trembles for what it has sung;
he branch, at the bidding of Nature,
dds fragrance and fruit to the tree,
ough her eyes, through her every feature,

hines the soul of the young Haidée.

the loveliest garden grows hateful
When Love has abandoned the bowers;
Give me hemlock—since mine is ungrateful,
That herb is more fragrant than flowers.
Give poison, when poured from the chalice,
Will deeply embitter the bowl;
When drunk to escape from thy malice,
The draught shall be sweet to my soul.
O cruel! in vain I implore thee
To free my heart from these horrors to save:
Will nought to my bosom restore thee?
When open the gates of the grave.

He chief who to combat advances
Secure of his conquest before,
Gaze thou, with those eyes for thy lances,
Hast pierced through my heart to its core.
Tell me, my soul! must I perish
By pangs which a smile would dispel?
Would the hope, which thou once bad'st me cherish,
Or torture repay me too well?
O sad is the garden of roses,
Belovéd but false Haidée!
Where Flora all withered reposes,
And mourns o'er thine absence with me.

1811.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

ON PARTING.

kiss, dear maid! thy lip has left
hall never part from mine,
happier hours restore the gift
untainted back to thine.

2.

parting glance, which fondly beams,
in equal love may see:^[o]
tear that from thine eyelid streams
can weep no change in me.

3.

Can no pledge to make me blest
in gazing when alone;^[p]
one memorial for a breast,
Whose thoughts are all thine own.

4.

Need I write—to tell the tale
My pen were doubly weak:
what can idle words avail,^[q]
Unless the heart could speak?

5.

Day or night, in weal or woe,
That heart, no longer free,
Can bear the love it cannot show,
And silent ache for thee.

March, 1811.
[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812(4to).]

FAREWELL TO MALTA.^[19]

EU, ye joys of La Valette!
eu, Sirocco, sun, and sweat!
eu, thou palace rarely entered!
eu, ye mansions where—I've ventured!
eu, ye curséd streets of stairs!^[20]
w surely he who mounts them swears!)
eu, ye merchants often failing!
eu, thou mob for ever railing!
eu, ye packets—without letters!
eu, ye fools—who ape your betters! 10
eu, thou damned'st quarantine,
t gave me fever, and the spleen!
eu that stage which makes us yawn, Sirs,
eu his Excellency's dancers!^[21]
eu to Peter—whom no fault's in,
could not teach a colonel waltzing;
eu, ye females fraught with graces!
eu red coats, and redder faces!
eu the supercilious air
ll that strut *en militaire*!^[22] 20
—but God knows when, or why,
moky towns and cloudy sky,
hings (the honest truth to say)
ad—but in a different way.

well to these, but not adieu,
mphant sons of truest blue!
le either Adriatic shore,^[23]
fallen chiefs, and fleets no more,

. nightly smiles, and daily dinners,^[24]
claim you war and women's winners. 30
lon my Muse, who apt to prate is,
. take my rhyme—because 'tis "gratis."

. now I've got to Mrs. Fraser,^[25]
haps you think I mean to praise her—
. were I vain enough to think
praise was worth this drop of ink,
ne—or two—were no hard matter,
ere, indeed, I need not flatter:
she must be content to shine
etter praises than in mine, 40
n lively air, and open heart,
. fashion's ease, without its art;
hours can gaily glide along.
ask the aid of idle song.

. now, O Malta! since thou'st got us,
u little military hot-house!
not offend with words uncivil,
. wish thee rudely at the Devil,
only stare from out my casement,
. ask, "for what is such a place meant?" 50
n, in my solitary nook,
urn to scribbling, or a book,
ake my physic while I'm able
o spoonfuls hourly, by this label),
er my nightcap to my beaver,
. bless my stars I've got a fever.

May 26, 1811.^[26]
[First published, 1816.]

NEWSTEAD ABBEY.

1.

the dome of my Sires as the clear moonbeam falls
through Silence and Shade o'er its desolate walls,
shines from afar like the glories of old;
glads, but it warms not—'tis dazzling, but cold.

2.

the Sunbeam be bright for the younger of days:
the light that should shine on a race that decays,
when the Stars are on high and the dew on the ground,
the long shadow lingers the ruin around.

3.

the step that o'erechoes the gray floor of stone
is sullenly now, for 'tis only my own;
sunk are the voices that sounded in mirth,
empty the goblet, and dreary the hearth.

4.

vain was each effort to raise and recall
brightness of old to illumine our Hall;
vain was the hope to avert our decline,
the fate of my fathers had faded to mine.

5.

theirs was the wealth and the fulness of Fame,
mine to inherit too haughty a name;^[r]

theirs were the times and the triumphs of yore,
mine to regret, but renew them no more.

6.

Ruin is fixed on my tower and my wall,
hoary to fade, and too massy to fall;
ills not of Time's or the tempest's decay,^[s]
the wreck of the line that have held it in sway.

August 26, 1811.

[First published in *Memoir of Rev. F. Hodgson*, 1878, i. 187.]

EPISTLE TO A FRIEND,^[27]

IN ANSWER TO SOME LINES EXHORTING THE AUTHOR
TO BE CHEERFUL, AND TO "BANISH CARE."

! banish care"—such ever be
motto of *thy* revelry!
chance of *mine*, when wassail nights
saw those riotous delights,
swept with the children of Despair
the lone heart, and "banish care."
not in Morn's reflecting hour,
in present, past, and future lower,
in all I loved is changed or gone,
mark with such taunts the woes of one,
lose every thought—but let them pass—
you know'st I am not what I was.
above all, if thou wouldst hold
me in a heart that ne'er was cold,
all the powers that men revere,

ill unto thy bosom dear,
joys below, thy hopes above,
ak—speak of anything but Love.

were long to tell, and vain to hear,
tale of one who scorns a tear;
there is little in that tale
ch better bosoms would bewail.
mine has suffered more than well
ould suit philosophy to tell.
seen my bride another's bride,—
e seen her seated by his side,—
e seen the infant, which she bore,
r the sweet smile the mother wore,
en she and I in youth have smiled,
ond and faultless as her child;—
e seen her eyes, in cold disdain,
if I felt no secret pain;
. *I* have acted well my part,
. made my cheek belie my heart,
rned the freezing glance she gave,
felt the while that *woman's* slave;—
e kissed, as if without design,
babe which ought to have been mine,
. showed, alas! in each caress
e had not made me love the less.

ut let this pass—I'll whine no more,
seek again an eastern shore;
world befits a busy brain,—
lie me to its haunts again.
if, in some succeeding year,^[28]

en Britain's "May is in the sere,"
u hear'st of one, whose deepening crimes
with the sablest of the times,
ne, whom love nor pity sways,
hope of fame, nor good men's praise;
, who in stern Ambition's pride,
hance not blood shall turn aside;
ranked in some recording page
n the worst anarchs of the age,
t wilt thou *know*—and *knowing* pause,
with the *effect* forget the cause.

Newstead Abbey, Oct. 11, 1811.
[First published, *Life*, 1830.]

TO THYRZA. ^{[t][29]}

HOUD a stone to mark the spot, ^[30]
nd say, what Truth might well have said, ^[u]
ill, save one, perchance forgot,
h! wherefore art thou lowly laid?
nany a shore and many a sea ^[v]
ivided, yet beloved in vain;
Past, the Future fled to thee,
o bid us meet—no—ne'er again!
ld this have been—a word, a look,
hat softly said, "We part in peace,"
taught my bosom how to brook,
ith fainter sighs, thy soul's release.
didst thou not, since Death for thee
repared a light and pangless dart,
e long for him thou ne'er shalt see,

Who held, and holds thee in his heart?
Who like him had watched thee here?
Or sadly marked thy glazing eye,
That dread hour ere Death appear,
When silent Sorrow fears to sigh,
All was past? But when no more
'twas thine to reckon of human woe,
Affection's heart-drops, gushing o'er,
Had flowed as fast—as now they flow.
Did they not flow, when many a day^[w]
In these, to me, deserted towers,
Called but for a time away,
Affection's mingling tears were ours?
Was too the glance none saw beside;
His smile none else might understand;
The whispered thought of hearts allied,^[x]
The pressure of the thrilling hand;
The kiss, so guiltless and refined,
That Love each warmer wish forbore;
These eyes proclaimed so pure a mind,
Even Passion blushed to plead for more.^[y]
The tone, that taught me to rejoice,
When prone, unlike thee, to repine;
The song, celestial from thy voice,
So sweet to me from none but thine;
The pledge we wore—I wear it still,
But where is thine?—Ah! where art thou?
Have I borne the weight of ill,
But never bent beneath till now!
Didst thou leave me in Life's best bloom^[z]
The cup of Woe for me to drain.^[aa]

st alone be in the tomb,
would not wish thee here again:
if in worlds more blest than this
hy virtues seek a fitter sphere,
art some portion of thy bliss,
o wean me from mine anguish here.
th me—too early taught by thee!
o bear, forgiving and forgiven:
earth thy love was such to me;
fain would form my hope in Heaven!^[ab]

October 11, 1811.
[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

AWAY, AWAY, YE NOTES OF WOE!^{[ac][31]}

1.

AY, away, ye notes of Woe!
e silent, thou once soothing Strain,
must flee from hence—for, oh!
dare not trust those sounds again.^[ad]
ne they speak of brighter days—
ut lull the chords, for now, alas!^[ae]
ist not think, I may not gaze,^[af]
n what I *am*—on what I *was*.

2.

voice that made those sounds more sweet^[ag]
hushed, and all their charms are fled;
now their softest notes repeat
dirge, an anthem o'er the dead!

Thyrza! yes, they breathe of thee,
elovéd dust! since dust thou art;
all that once was Harmony
worse than discord to my heart!

3.

silent all!—but on my ear^[ah]
he well remembered Echoes thrill;
ar a voice I would not hear,
voice that now might well be still:
oft my doubting Soul 'twill shake;
v'n Slumber owns its gentle tone,
Consciousness will vainly wake
o listen, though the dream be flown.

4.

et Thyrza! waking as in sleep,
hou art but now a lovely dream;
ar that trembled o'er the deep,
hen turned from earth its tender beam.
he who through Life's dreary way
lust pass, when Heaven is veiled in wrath,
long lament the vanished ray
hat scattered gladness o'er his path.

December 8, 1811.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

ONE STRUGGLE MORE, AND I AM FREE.^[ai]

1.

I struggle more, and I am free
From pangs that rend my heart in twain,^[aj]
I cast long sigh to Love and thee,
Then back to busy life again.
It suits me well to mingle now
With things that never pleased before:^[ak]
Though every joy is fled below,
What future grief can touch me more?^[al]

2.

Do bring me wine, the banquet bring;
For I was not formed to live alone:
Not that light unmeaning thing
That smiles with all, and weeps with none.
As not thus in days more dear,
I never would have been, but thou^[am]
Hast fled, and left me lonely here;
Thou'rt nothing,—all are nothing now.

3.

Alas my lyre would lightly breathe!
The smile that Sorrow fain would wear
Mocks the woe that lurks beneath,
Like roses o'er a sepulchre.
Though gay companions o'er the bowl
Dispel awhile the sense of ill;
Though Pleasure fires the maddening soul,
The Heart,—the Heart is lonely still!

4.

many a lone and lovely night
soothed to gaze upon the sky;
then I deemed the heavenly light
hone sweetly on thy pensive eye:
oft I thought at Cynthia's noon,
When sailing o'er the Ægean wave,
w Thyrza gazes on that moon"—
las, it gleamed upon her grave!

5.

en stretched on Fever's sleepless bed,
nd sickness shrunk my throbbing veins,
; comfort still," I faintly said,^[an]
That Thyrza cannot know my pains:"
e freedom to the time-worn slave—^[ao]
boon 'tis idle then to give—
enting Nature vainly gave^[32]
ly life, when Thyrza ceased to live!

6.

Thyrza's pledge in better days,^[ap]
When Love and Life alike were new!
v different now thou meet'st my gaze!
ow tinged by time with Sorrow's hue!
heart that gave itself with thee
silent—ah, were mine as still!
ugh cold as e'en the dead can be,
feels, it sickens with the chill.

7.

u bitter pledge! thou mournful token!
hough painful, welcome to my breast!
, still, preserve that love unbroken,
r break the heart to which thou'rt pressed.
e tempers Love, but not removes,
lore hallowed when its Hope is fled:
what are thousand living loves
o that which cannot quit the dead?

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (4to).]

EUTHANASIA.

1.

EN Time, or soon or late, shall bring
he dreamless sleep that lulls the dead,
ivion! may thy languid wing
/ave gently o'er my dying bed!

2.

oand of friends or heirs be there,^[33]
o weep, or wish, the coming blow:
naiden, with dishevelled hair,
o feel, or feign, decorous woe.

3.

silent let me sink to Earth,
/ith no officious mourners near:
uld not mar one hour of mirth,
or startle Friendship with a fear.

4.

Love, if Love in such an hour
ould nobly check its useless sighs,
ht then exert its latest power
i her who lives, and him who dies.

5.

ere sweet, my Psyche! to the last
hy features still serene to see:
getful of its struggles past,
'en Pain itself should smile on thee.

6.

vain the wish—for Beauty still
/ill shrink, as shrinks the ebbing breath;
. Woman's tears, produced at will,
ceive in life, unman in death.

7.

n lonely be my latest hour,
/ithout regret, without a groan;
thousands Death hath ceased to lower,
nd pain been transient or unknown.

8.

e but to die, and go," alas!
/here all have gone, and all must go!
e the nothing that I was
re born to life and living woe!

9.

nt o'er the joys thine hours have seen,
ount o'er thy days from anguish free,
. know, whatever thou hast been,
is something better not to be.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (Second Edition).]

AND THOU ART DEAD, AS YOUNG AND FAIR. ^[aq]

"Heu, quanto minus est cum reliquis versari quam tui meminisse!"^[34]

1.

o thou art dead, as young and fair
s aught of mortal birth;
. form so soft, and charms so rare,
oo soon returned to Earth!^[ar]
ugh Earth received them in her bed,
. o'er the spot the crowd may tread^[as]
i carelessness or mirth,
re is an eye which could not brook
oment on that grave to look.

2.

ll not ask where thou liest low, ^[at]
or gaze upon the spot;
re flowers or weeds at will may grow,
o I behold them not: ^[au]
enough for me to prove
t what I loved, and long must love,

like common earth can rot;^[av]
ne there needs no stone to tell,
Nothing that I loved so well^[aw]

3.

did I love thee to the last
s fervently as thou,^[ax]
o didst not change through all the past,
nd canst not alter now.
love where Death has set his seal,
age can chill, nor rival steal,^[ay]
or falsehood disavow:^[az]
, what were worse, thou canst not see^[ba]
wrong, or change, or fault in me.^[bb]

4.

better days of life were ours;
he worst can be but mine:
sun that cheers, the storm that lowers,^[bc]
hall never more be thine.
silence of that dreamless sleep^[bd]
vy now too much to weep;
or need I to repine,
t all those charms have passed away
ght have watched through long decay.

5.

flower in ripened bloom unmatched
lust fall the earliest prey;^[be]

ugh by no hand untimely snatched,
he leaves must drop away:
. yet it were a greater grief
vatch it withering, leaf by leaf,
han see it plucked to-day;
e earthly eye but ill can bear
race the change to foul from fair.

6.

ow not if I could have borne^[bf]
o see thy beauties fade;
night that followed such a morn
ad worn a deeper shade:
day without a cloud hath passed,^[bg]
. thou wert lovely to the last;
xtinguished, not decayed;
stars that shoot along the sky^[bh]
ie brightest as they fall from high.

7.

once I wept, if I could weep,
ly tears might well be shed,
hink I was not near to keep
ne vigil o'er thy bed;
gaze, how fondly! on thy face,
old thee in a faint embrace,
phold thy drooping head;
. show that love, however vain,
thou nor I can feel again.

8.

how much less it were to gain,
though thou hast left me free,^[bi]
loveliest things that still remain,
hast thus remember thee!
all of thine that cannot die
though dark and dread Eternity^[bj]
returns again to me,
more thy buried love endears
naught, except its living years.

February, 1812.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (Second Edition).]

LINES TO A LADY WEeping.^{[bk][35]}

Princess, daughter of a royal line,
Sire's disgrace, a realm's decay;
happy if each tear of thine
could wash a Father's fault away!
Weep—for thy tears are Virtue's tears—
propitious to these suffering Isles;
be each drop in future years
repaid thee by thy People's smiles!

March, 1812.

[MS. M. First published, *Morning Chronicle*, March 7, 1812
(Corsair, 1814, Second Edition).]

IF SOMETIMES IN THE HAUNTS OF MEN.^[bl]

1.

Sometimes in the haunts of men

hine image from my breast may fade,
lonely hour presents again
he semblance of thy gentle shade:
now that sad and silent hour
hus much of thee can still restore,
sorrow unobserved may pour
he plaint she dare not speak before.

2.

pardon that in crowds awhile
waste one thought I owe to thee,
self-condemned, appear to smile,
nfaithful to thy memory:
deem that memory less dear,
hat then I seem not to repine;
uld not fools should overhear
ne sigh that should be wholly *thine*.

3.

ot the Goblet pass unquaffed,
is not drained to banish care;
cup must hold a deadlier draught
hat brings a Lethe for despair.
could Oblivion set my soul
rom all her troubled visions free,
lash to earth the sweetest bowl
hat drowned a single thought of thee.

4.

wert thou vanished from my mind,
/here could my vacant bosom turn?

who would then remain behind
to honour thine abandoned Urn?
no—it is my sorrow's pride
that last dear duty to fulfil;
though all the world forget beside,
'tis meet that I remember still.

5.

well I know, that such had been
thy gentle care for him, who now
journeyed shall quit this mortal scene,
where none regarded him, but thou:
oh! I feel in *that* was given
a blessing never meant for me;
thou wert too like a dream of Heaven,
or earthly Love to merit thee.

March 14, 1812.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (Second Edition).]

ON A CORNELIAN HEART WHICH WAS BROKEN. ^[36]

1.

FATED Heart! and can it be,
that thou shouldst thus be rent in twain?
The years of care for thine and thee
like been all employed in vain?

2.

precious seems each shattered part,
and every fragment dearer grown,

he who wears thee feels thou art
fitter emblem of *his own*.

March 16, 1812.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1812 (Second Edition).]

THE CHAIN I GAVE.

FROM THE TURKISH.

1.

chain I gave was fair to view,
he lute I added sweet in sound;
heart that offered both was true,
and ill deserved the fate it found.

2.

se gifts were charmed by secret spell,
hy truth in absence to divine;
they have done their duty well,—
las! they could not teach thee thine.

3.

t chain was firm in every link,
ut not to bear a stranger's touch;
t lute was sweet—till thou couldst think
other hands its notes were such.

4.

him who from thy neck unbound
he chain which shivered in his grasp,
o saw that lute refuse to sound,
estring the chords, renew the clasp.

5.

en thou wert changed, they altered too;
he chain is broke, the music mute,
past—to them and thee adieu—
alse heart, frail chain, and silent lute.

LINES WRITTEN ON A BLANK LEAF OF
THE PLEASURES OF MEMORY.^[bm]

1.

ENT or present, still to thee,
Iy friend, what magic spells belong!
ill can tell, who share, like me,
I turn thy converse,^[37] and thy song.

2.

when the dreaded hour shall come
y Friendship ever deemed too nigh,
"MEMORY" o'er her Druid's tomb^[38]
hall weep that aught of thee can die,

3.

er fondly will she then repay
hy homage offered at her shrine,
blend, while ages roll away,
er name immortally with *thine*!

April 19, 1812.
[First published, *Poems*, 1816.]

ADDRESS, SPOKEN AT THE OPENING OF
DRURY-LANE THEATRE, SATURDAY,
OCTOBER 10, 1812.^[39]

ne dread night our city saw, and sighed,
ved to the dust, the Drama's tower of pride;
ne short hour beheld the blazing fane,
llo sink, and Shakespeare cease to reign.

e who beheld, (oh! sight admired and mourned,
ose radiance mocked the ruin it adorned!)
ough clouds of fire the massy fragments riven,
e Israel's pillar, chase the night from heaven;
the long column of revolving flames
ke its red shadow o'er the startled Thames,^[40] 10
le thousands, thronged around the burning dome,
ink back appalled, and trembled for their home,
glared the volumed blaze, and ghastly shone^[bn]
skies, with lightnings awful as their own,
blackening ashes and the lonely wall^[bo]
rped the Muse's realm, and marked her fall;
—shall this new, nor less aspiring pile,
red where once rose the mightiest in our isle,
w the same favour which the former knew,
rine for Shakespeare—worthy him and *you*? 20

es—it shall be—the magic of that name
es the scythe of time, the torch of flame;^[bp]
he same spot still consecrates the scene,
bids the Drama *be* where she hath *been*:
fabric's birth attests the potent spell——
ldge our honest pride, and say, *How well!*

s soars this fane to emulate the last,
might we draw our omens from the past,
ie hour propitious to our prayers may boast

ies such as hallow still the dome we lost. 30
Drury first your Siddons' thrilling art
whelmed the gentlest, stormed the sternest heart.
Drury, Garrick's latest laurels grew;
e your last tears retiring Roscius drew,
ied his last thanks, and wept his last adieu:
still for living wit the wreaths may bloom,
t only waste their odours o'er the tomb.
n Drury claimed and claims—nor you refuse
tribute to revive his slumbering muse;
n garlands deck your own Menander's head, 40
hoard your honours idly for the dead!^[bq]
r are the days which made our annals bright,
Garrick fled, or Brinsley^[41] ceased to write^[br]
s to their labours, like all high-born heirs,
i of *our* ancestry as they of *theirs*;
le thus Remembrance borrows Banquo's glass
laim the sceptred shadows as they pass,
we the mirror hold, where imaged shine
ortal names, emblazoned on our line,
se—ere their feeblers offspring you condemn, 50
ect how hard the task to rival them!

riends of the stage! to whom both Players and Plays
it sue alike for pardon or for praise,
ose judging voice and eye alone direct
boundless power to cherish or reject;
er frivolity has led to fame,
made us blush that you forbore to blame—
er the sinking stage could condescend
oother the sickly taste it dare not mend—
past reproach may present scenes refute, 60

censure, wisely loud, be justly mute!^[42]
since your fiat stamps the Drama's laws,
near to mock us with misplaced applause;
Pride shall doubly nerve the actor's powers,
Reason's voice be echoed back by ours!

his greeting o'er—the ancient rule obeyed,^[43]
Drama's homage by her herald paid—
give *our welcome* too—whose every tone
rings from our hearts, and fain would win your own.
curtain rises—may our stage unfold
scenes not unworthy Drury's days of old!
on our judges, Nature for our guide,
may we please—long, long may *you* preside.

[First published, *Morning Chronicle*, Oct. 12, 1812.]

PARENTHETICAL ADDRESS.^[44]

BY DR. PLAGIARY.

Half stolen, with acknowledgments, to be spoken in an inarticulate voice by
Master —— at the opening of the next new theatre. [Stolen parts marked with
the inverted commas of quotation—thus “——”.]

When energising objects men pursue,"
on Lord knows what is writ by Lord knows who.
The oddest Monologue you here survey,
stolen from the theatre the "other day,"
as if Sir Fretful wrote "the slumberous" verse,
he gave his son "the rubbish" to rehearse.
But at the thing you'd never be amazed,"
was you the rumpus which the Author raised;
or even here your smiles would be repress,"

w you these lines—the badness of the best, 10
me! fire! and flame!" (words borrowed from Lucretius.^[45])
ead metaphors" which open wounds like issues!
d sleeping pangs awake—and——But away"—
found me if I know what next to say).
'Hope reviving re-expands her wings,"
. Master G—— recites what Dr. Busby sings!—
mighty things with small we may compare,"
nslated from the Grammar for the fair!)
natic "spirit drives a conquering car,"
. burn'd poor Moscow like a tub of "tar." 20
is spirit" "Wellington has shown in Spain,"
urnish Melodrames for Drury Lane.
other Marlborough points to Blenheim's story,"
. George and I will dramatise it for ye.

Arts and Sciences our Isle hath shone"
s deep discovery is mine alone).
'British poesy, whose powers inspire"
verse—or I'm a fool—and Fame's a liar,
æ we invoke, your Sister Arts implore"
n "smiles," and "lyres," and "pencils," and much more. 30
se, if we win the Graces, too, we gain
graces, too! "inseparable train!"
ree who have stolen their witching airs from Cupid"
n all know what I mean, unless you're stupid):
rmonious throng" that I have kept *in petto*
v to produce in a "divine *sestetto*"!!
nile Poesy," with these delightful doxies,
stains her part" in all the "upper" boxes!
us lifted gloriously, you'll sweep along,"
ne in the vast balloon of Busby's song; 40

ne in your farce, masque, scenery, and play"
 ' this last line George had a holiday).
 l Drury never, never soar'd so high,"
 ays the Manager, and so say I.
 t hold," you say, "this self-complacent boast;"
 is the Poem which the public lost?
 ie—true—that lowers at once our mounting pride;"
 lo;—the Papers print what you deride.
 s ours to look on *you*—*you* hold the prize,"
twenty guineas, as they advertise! 50
double blessing your rewards impart"—
 sh I had them, then, with all my heart.
 r *twofold* feeling owns its twofold cause,"
 / son and I both beg for your applause.
 en in your fostering beams you bid us live,"
 next subscription list shall say how much you give!

[First published, *Morning Chronicle*, October 23, 1812.]

VERSES FOUND IN A SUMMER-HOUSE

AT HALES-OWEN.^[46]

EN Dryden's fool, "unknowing what he sought,"
 hours in whistling spent, "for want of thought,"^[47]
 ; guiltless oaf his vacancy of sense
 plied, and amply too, by innocence:
 modern swains, possessed of Cymon's powers,
 ymon's manner waste their leisure hours,
 offended guests would not, with blushing, see
 se fair green walks disgraced by infamy.
 ere the fate of modern fools, alas!
 en vice and folly mark them as they pass.

noxious reptiles o'er the whitened wall,
filth they leave still points out where they crawl.

[First published, 1832, vol. xvii.]

REMEMBER THEE! REMEMBER THEE!^[48]

1.

REMEMBER thee! remember thee!
ill Lethe quench life's burning stream
orse and Shame shall cling to thee,
nd haunt thee like a feverish dream!

2.

remember thee! Aye, doubt it not.
hy husband too shall think of thee:
neither shalt thou be forgot,
hou *false* to him, thou *fiend* to me!^[49]

[First published, *Conversations of Lord Byron*, 1824.]

TO TIME.

E! on whose arbitrary wing
he varying hours must flag or fly,
ose tardy winter, fleeting spring,
ut drag or drive us on to die—
thou! who on my birth bestowed
hose boons to all that know thee known;
better I sustain thy load,
or now I bear the weight alone.

ould not one fond heart should share
he bitter moments thou hast given;
pardon thee—since thou couldst spare
ll that I loved, to peace or Heaven.
hem be joy or rest—on me
hy future ills shall press in vain;
thing owe but years to thee,
debt already paid in pain.
even that pain was some relief;
felt, but still forgot thy power:^[bs]
active agony of grief
etards, but never counts the hour.^[bt]
y I've sighed to think thy flight
ould soon subside from swift to slow;
cloud could overcast the light,
ut could not add a night to Woe;
then, however drear and dark,
ly soul was suited to thy sky;
star alone shot forth a spark
o prove thee—not Eternity.
t beam hath sunk—and now thou art
blank—a thing to count and curse
ough each dull tedious trifling part,
hich all regret, yet all rehearse.
scene even thou canst not deform—
he limit of thy sloth or speed
en future wanderers bear the storm
hich we shall sleep too sound to heed.
I can smile to think how weak
hine efforts shortly shall be shown,
en all the vengeance thou canst wreak
ust fall upon—a nameless stone.

TRANSLATION OF A ROMAIC LOVE SONG.

1.

Love was never yet without
pang, the agony, the doubt,
which rends my heart with ceaseless sigh,
while day and night roll darkling by.

2.

Without one friend to hear my woe,
at last, I die beneath the blow.
That Love had arrows, well I knew,
but I find them poisoned too.

3.

But I, yet in freedom, shun the net
which Love around your haunts hath set;
I am circled by his fatal fire,
and your hearts shall burn, your hopes expire.

4.

Like a bird of free and careless wing
I, through many a smiling spring;
I am caught within the subtle snare,
and I, and feebly flutter there.

5.

o ne'er have loved, and loved in vain,
neither feel nor pity pain,
cold repulse, the look askance,
lightning of Love's angry glance.

6.

attering dreams I deemed thee mine;
v hope, and he who hoped, decline;
e melting wax, or withering flower,
d my passion, and thy power.

7.

light of Life! ah, tell me why
t pouting lip, and altered eye?
bird of Love! my beauteous mate!
art thou changed, and canst thou hate?

8.

e eyes like wintry streams o'erflow:
at wretch with me would barter woe?
bird! relent: one note could give
arm to bid thy lover live.

9.

curdling blood, my madd'ning brain,
lent anguish I sustain;
still thy heart, without partaking
pang, exults—while mine is breaking.

10.

er me the poison; fear not thou!
thou canst not murder more than now:
I lived to curse my natal day,
O Love, that thus can lingering slay.

11.

O wounded soul, my bleeding breast,
Can patience preach thee into rest?
Is! too late, I dearly know
That Joy is harbinger of Woe.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).]

THOU ART NOT FALSE, BUT THOU ART FICKLE. ^[bu]

[50]

1.

Thou art not false, but thou art fickle,
O those thyself so fondly sought;
Tears that thou hast forced to trickle
Are doubly bitter from that thought:
This which breaks the heart thou grievest,
well thou lov'st—*too soon* thou leavest.

2.

Wholly false the *heart* despises,
And spurns deceiver and deceit;
She who not a thought disguises, ^[bv]
Whose love is as sincere as sweet,—

en *she* can change who loved so truly,
els what mine has *felt* so newly.

3.

lream of joy and wake to sorrow
doomed to all who love or live;
if, when conscious on the morrow,
e scarce our Fancy can forgive,
t cheated us in slumber only,
eave the waking soul more lonely,

4.

at must they feel whom no false vision
ut truest, tenderest Passion warmed?
ere, but swift in sad transition:
s if a dream alone had charmed?
sure such *grief* is *Fancy's* scheming,
all thy *Change* can be but *dreaming*!

[MS. M. First published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).]

ON BEING ASKED WHAT WAS THE "ORIGIN OF LOVE."^[bw]

"Origin of Love!"—Ah, why
hat cruel question ask of me,
en thou mayst read in many an eye
e starts to life on seeing thee?
shouldst thou seek his *end* to know:
ly heart forebodes, my fears foresee,

I linger long in silent woe;
I live until—I cease to be.

[First published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).]

ON THE QUOTATION,

"And my true faith can alter never,
Though thou art gone perhaps for ever."

1.

o "thy true faith can alter never?"—
indeed it lasted for a—week!
ow the length of Love's forever,
nd just expected such a freak.
eace we met, in peace we parted,
i peace we vowed to meet again,
though I find thee fickle-hearted
o pang of mine shall make thee vain.

2.

gone—'twas time to seek a second;
i sooth 'twere hard to blame thy haste.
whatsoever thy love be reckoned,
t least thou hast improved in taste:
ugh one was young, the next was younger,
is love was new, mine too well known—
what might make the charm still stronger,
he youth was present, I was flown.

3.

en days and nights of single sorrow!

so much for human constancy!
yesternight past, why then to-morrow,
his turn is come to follow me:
if each week you change a lover,
and so have acted heretofore,
more a year or two is over
We'll form a very pretty *corps*.

4.

How, fair thing! without upbraiding
fain would take a decent leave;
beauty still survives unfading,
and undeceived may long deceive.
I bring him unto thy bosom dearer
enjoy the moments as they flee;
I wish his love sincerer
than thy young heart has been to me.

1812.
[From a MS. in the possession of Mr. Murray, now for the first time printed.]

REMEMBER HIM, WHOM PASSION'S POWER. ^[51]

1.

REMEMBER him, whom Passion's power
everely—deeply—vainly proved:
remember thou that dangerous hour,
When neither fell, though both were loved. ^[bx]

2.

that yielding breast, that melting eye,^[by]
so much invited to be blessed:
that gentle prayer, that pleading sigh,
the wilder wish reprov'd, repress'd.

3.

let me feel that all I lost^[bz]
but saved thee all that Conscience fears;
no blush for every pang it cost
to spare the vain remorse of years.

4.

think of this when many a tongue,
whose busy accents whisper blame,
would do the heart that loved thee wrong,
and brand a nearly blighted name.^[ca]

5.

think that, whate'er to others, thou
hast seen each selfish thought subdued:
how thy purer soul even now,
even now, in midnight solitude.

6.

God! that we had met in time,
our hearts as fond, thy hand more free;
when thou hadst loved without a crime,
and I been less unworthy thee!^[cb]

7.

may thy days, as heretofore,^[cc]
from this our gaudy world be past!
that too bitter moment o'er,
h! may such trial be thy last.

8.

heart, alas! perverted long,
self destroyed might there destroy;
meet thee in the glittering throng,
ould wake Presumption's hope of joy.^[cd]

9.

n to the things whose bliss or woe,
like mine, is wild and worthless all,
t world resign—such scenes forego,
here those who feel must surely fall.

10.

youth, thy charms, thy tenderness—
hy soul from long seclusion pure;
n what even here hath passed, may guess
What there thy bosom must endure.

11.

pardon that imploring tear,
ince not by Virtue shed in vain,
frenzy drew from eyes so dear;
or me they shall not weep again.

12.

ugh long and mournful must it be,
he thought that we no more may meet;
I deserve the stern decree,
nd almost deem the sentence sweet.

13.

—had I loved thee less—my heart
ad then less sacrificed to thine;
It not half so much to part
s if its guilt had made thee mine.

1813.

[MS. M. First published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).]

IMPROMPTU, IN REPLY TO A FRIEND. ^[52]

EN, from the heart where Sorrow sits,
er dusky shadow mounts too high,
o'er the changing aspect flits,
nd clouds the brow, or fills the eye;
d not that gloom, which soon shall sink:
ly Thoughts their dungeon know too well;
k to my breast the Wanderers shrink,
nd *droop* within their silent cell. ^[ce]

September, 1813.

[MS. M. first published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).]

SONNET.

TO GENEVRA.

NE eyes' blue tenderness, thy long fair hair,
nd the warm lustre of thy features—caught
rom contemplation—where serenely wrought,
ns Sorrow's softness charmed from its despair—
e thrown such speaking sadness in thine air,
hat—but I know thy blessed bosom fraught
/ith mines of unalloyed and stainless thought—
ould have deemed thee doomed to earthly care.
n such an aspect, by his colours blent,
/hen from his beauty-breathing pencil born,
ept that *thou* hast nothing to repent)
he Magdalen of Guido saw the morn—
n seem'st thou—but how much more excellent!
/ith nought Remorse can claim—nor Virtue scorn.

December 17, 1813.^[53]

[MS. M. First published, *Corsair*, 1814 (Second Edition).]

SONNET.

TO GENEVRA.

· cheek is pale with thought, but not from woe,^[cf]
nd yet so lovely, that if Mirth could flush
s rose of whiteness with the brightest blush,
heart would wish away that ruder glow:
· dazzle not thy deep-blue eyes—but, oh!
/hile gazing on them sterner eyes will gush,
nd into mine my mother's weakness rush,
as the last drops round Heaven's airy bow.
through thy long dark lashes low depending,
he soul of melancholy Gentleness
ms like a Seraph from the sky descending,

bove all pain, yet pitying all distress;
nce such majesty with sweetness blending,
worship more, but cannot love thee less.

December 17, 1813.

[MS. M. First published, *Corsair*, 1814 (Second Edition).]

FROM THE PORTUGUESE.

"TU MI CHAMAS."

1.

oments to delight devoted,^[54]
My Life!" with tenderest tone, you cry;
r words! on which my heart had doted,
Youth could neither fade nor die.

1.

Death even hours like these must roll,
h! then repeat those accents never;
hange "my Life!" into "my Soul!"
hich, like my Love, exists for ever.

[MS. M.]

ANOTHER VERSION.

I call me still your *Life*.—Oh! change the word—
ife is as transient as the inconstant sigh:
rather I'm your Soul; more just that name,
or, like the soul, my Love can never die.

[Stanzas 1, 2 first published, *Childe Harold*, 1814 (Seventh Edition).
"Another Version," first published, 1832.]

FOOTNOTES:

[1] [These stanzas were inserted in the first draft of the First Canto of *Childe Harold*, after the eighty-sixth stanza. "The struggle 'gainst the Demon's sway" (see stanza lxxxiv.) had, apparently, resulted in victory, for the "unpremeditated lay" poured forth at the time betrays the youth and high spirits of the singer. But the inconsistency was detected in time, and the lines, *To Inez*, dated January 25, 1810, with their "touches of dreariest sadness," were substituted for the simple and cheerful strains of *The Girl of Cadiz* (see *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 75, note 1; *Life*, p. 151).]

[a] {1} *For thou hast never lived to see.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[b] {2} *The Saxon maids*——.—[MS. M.]

[2] [Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto I. stanza lviii. lines 8, 9, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 59, note 1.]

[3] {3} [For "Bolero," see *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 492, note 1.]

[c]

Or tells with light and fairy hand

Her beads beneath the rays of Hesper.—[MS. M. erased.]

[d] ——*the lovely Girl of Cadiz.*—[MS. M.]

[e] {4} *Written in an Album.*—[Editions 1812-1831.]

Written in Mrs. Spencer S.'s——.—[MS. M. erased]

Written at the request of a lady in her memorandum book.—[MS. B. M.]

"Mrs. S. S.'s request."—[Erased. MS. B.M.]

[4] [The possessor of the album was, doubtless, Mrs. Spencer Smith, the "Lady" of the lines *To Florence*, "the sweet Florence" of the *Stanzas composed during a Thunderstorm*, and of the *Stanzas written in passing through the Ambracian Gulf*, and, finally, when "The Spell is broke, the Charm is flown," the "fair Florence" of stanzas xxxii., xxxiii. of the Second Canto of *Childe Harold*. In a letter to his mother, dated September 15, 1809, Byron writes, "This letter is committed to the charge of a very extraordinary woman, whom you have doubtless heard of, Mrs. Spencer Smith, of whose escape the Marquis de Salvo published a narrative a few years ago (*Travels in the Year 1806, from Italy to England through the Tyrol, etc., containing the particulars of the liberation of Mrs. Spencer Smith from the hands of the French Police*, London: 12mo, 1807). She has since been shipwrecked, and her life has been from its commencement so fertile in remarkable

incidents, that in a romance they would appear improbable. She was born at Constantinople [*circ.* 1785], where her father, Baron Herbert, was Austrian Ambassador; married unhappily, yet has never been impeached in point of character; excited the vengeance of Buonaparte by a part in some conspiracy; several times risked her life; and is not yet twenty-five."

John Spencer Smith, the "Lady's" husband, was a younger brother of Admiral Sir Sidney Smith, the hero of the siege of Acre. He began life as a Page of Honour to Queen Charlotte, was, afterwards, attached to the Turkish Embassy, and (May 4, 1798) appointed Minister Plenipotentiary. On January 5, 1799, he concluded the treaty of defensive alliance with the Porte; and, October 30, 1799, obtained the freedom of the Black Sea for the English flag (see *Remains of the late John Tweddell*. London: 1815. See, too, for Mrs. Spencer Smith, *Letters*, 1898, i. 244, 245, note 1).]

[f] {5} *To——.*—[Editions 1812-1832.]

[g] {6} *Through giant Danger's rugged path.*—[MS. M.]

[h] {7} *Stanzas*—[1812.]

[5] Composed Oct^r. 11, 1809, during the night in a thunderstorm, when the guides had lost the road to Zitza, near the range of mountains formerly called Pindus, in Albania. [Editions 1812-1831.]

[This thunderstorm occurred during the night of the 11th October, 1809, when Lord Byron's guides had lost the road to Zitza, near the range of mountains formerly called Pindus, in Albania. Hobhouse, who had ridden on before the rest of the party, and arrived at Zitza just as the evening set in, describes the thunder as rolling "without intermission—the echoes of one peal had not ceased to roll in the mountains, before another tremendous crash burst over our heads, whilst the plains and the distant hills, visible through the cracks in the cabin, appeared in a perpetual blaze. The tempest was altogether terrific, and worthy of the Grecian Jove. Lord Byron, with the priest and the servants, did not enter our hut before three (in the morning). I now learnt from him that they had lost their way, ... and that after wandering up and down in total ignorance of their position, had, at last, stopped near some Turkish tombstones and a torrent, which they saw by the flashes of lightning. They had been thus exposed for nine hours. ... It was long before we ceased to talk of the thunderstorm in the plain of Zitza."—*Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. 70, 72; *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza xlviii., *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 129, note 1.]

[i] {11} *Stanzas.*—[1812.]

[j] {12} *Had Bards but realms along with rhymes.*—[MS. M.]

[k] *Again we'd see some Antonies.*—[MS. M.]

[l] *Though Jove*——.—[MS. M.]

[6] [Compare [A Woman's Hair] stanza 1, line 4, "I would not lose you for a world."—*Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 233.]

[m] *Written at Athens.*—[1812.]

[7] {13} On the 3rd of May, 1810, while the *Salsette* (Captain Bathurst) was lying in the Dardanelles, Lieutenant Ekenhead, of that frigate, and the writer of these rhymes, swam from the European shore to the Asiatic—by the by, from Abydos to Sestos would have been more correct. The whole distance, from the place whence we started to our landing on the other side, including the length we were carried by the current, was computed by those on board the frigate at upwards of four English miles, though the actual breadth is barely one. The rapidity of the current is such that no boat can row directly across, and it may, in some measure, be estimated from the circumstance of the whole distance being accomplished by one of the parties in an hour and five, and by the other in an hour and ten minutes. The water was extremely cold, from the melting of the mountain snows. About three weeks before, in April, we had made an attempt; but having ridden all the way from the Troad the same morning, and the water being of an icy chillness, we found it necessary to postpone the completion till the frigate anchored below the castles, when we swam the straits as just stated, entering a considerable way above the European, and landing below the Asiatic, fort. [Le] Chevalier says that a young Jew swam the same distance for his mistress; and Olivier mentions its having been done by a Neapolitan; but our consul, Tarragona, remembered neither of these circumstances, and tried to dissuade us from the attempt. A number of the *Salsette's* crew were known to have accomplished a greater distance; and the only thing that surprised me was that, as doubts had been entertained of the truth of Leander's story, no traveller had ever endeavoured to ascertain its practicability. [See letter to Drury, dated May 3; to his mother, May 24, 1810, etc. (*Letters*, 1898, i. 262, 275). Compare the well-known lines in *Don Juan*, Canto II. stanza cv.—

"A better swimmer you could scarce see ever,
He could perhaps have passed the Hellespont,
As once (a feat on which ourselves we prided)
Leander, Mr. Ekenhead, and I did."

Compare, too, *Childe Harold*, Canto IV. stanza clxxxiv. line 3, and the *Bride of Abydos*, Canto II. stanza i.: *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 461, note 2, *et post*, p. 178.]

[8] {14} [Hobhouse, who records the first attempt to cross the Hellespont, on April 16, and the successful achievement of the feat, May 3, 1810, adds the following note: "In my journal, in my friend's handwriting: 'The whole distance E. and myself swam was more than four miles—the current very strong and cold—some large fish near us when half across—we were not fatigued, but a little chilled—did it with little difficulty.—May, 6, 1810. Byron.'"—*Travels in Albania*, ii. 195.]

[9] {15} ["At Orchomenus, where stood the Temple of the Graces, I was tempted to exclaim, 'Whither have the Graces fled?' Little did I expect to find them here. Yet here comes one of them with golden cups and coffee, and another with a book. The book is a register of names.... Among these is Lord Byron's connected with some lines which I shall send you: 'Fair Albion,' etc." (See *Travels in Italy, Greece, etc.*, by H. W. Williams, ii. 290, 291; *Life*, p. 101.)]

[n] *Song*.—[1812.]

[10] [The Maid of Athens was, it is supposed, the eldest of three sisters, daughters of Theodora Macri, the widow of a former English vice-consul. Byron and Hobhouse lodged at her house. The sisters were sought out and described by the artist, Hugh W. Williams, who visited Athens in May, 1817: "Theresa, the Maid of Athens, Catinco, and Mariana, are of middle stature.... The two eldest have black, or dark hair and eyes; their visage oval, and complexion somewhat pale, with teeth of pearly whiteness. Their cheeks are rounded, their noses straight, rather inclined to aquiline. The youngest, Mariana, is very fair, her face not so finely rounded, but has a gayer expression than her sisters', whose countenances, except when the conversation has something of mirth in it, may be said to be rather pensive. Their persons are elegant, and their manners pleasing and lady-like, such as would be fascinating in any country. They possess very considerable powers of conversation, and their minds seem to be more instructed than those of the Greek women in general."—*Travels in Italy, Greece, etc.*, ii. 291, 292.

Other travellers, Hughes, who visited Athens in 1813, and Walsh (*Narrative of a Resident in Constantinople*, i. 122), who saw Theresa in 1821, found her charming and interesting, but speak of her beauty as a thing of the past. "She married an Englishman named Black, employed in H.M. Consular Service at Mesolonghi. She survived her husband and fell into great poverty.... Theresa Black died October 15, 1875, aged 80 years." (See *Letters*, 1898, i. 269, 270, note 1; and *Life*, p. 105, note.)

"Maid of Athens" is possibly the best-known of Byron's short poems, all over the English-speaking world. This is no doubt due in part to its having been set to music by about half a dozen composers—the latest of whom was Gounod.]

[11] {16} Romaic expression of tenderness. If I translate it, I shall affront the gentlemen, as it may seem that I supposed they could not; and if I do not, I may affront the ladies. For fear of any misconstruction on the part of the latter, I shall do so, begging pardon of the learned. It means, "My life, I love you!" which sounds very prettily in all languages, and is as much in fashion in Greece at this day as, Juvenal tells us, the two first words were amongst the Roman ladies, whose erotic expressions were all Hellenised. [The reference is to the Ζωή καὶ Ψυχὴ of Roman courtesans. *Vide* Juvenal, lib. ii., *Sat.* vi. line 195; Martial, *Epig.* x. 68. 5.]

[12] {17} In the East (where ladies are not taught to write, lest they should scribble assignations), flowers, cinders, pebbles, etc., convey the sentiments of the parties, by that universal deputy of Mercury—an old woman. A cinder says, "I burn for thee;" a bunch of flowers tied with hair, "Take me and fly;" but a pebble declares—what nothing else can. [Compare *The Bride of Abydos*, line 295—

"What! not receive my foolish flower?"

See, too, Medwin's story of "one of the principal incidents in *The Giaour*." "I was in despair, and could hardly contrive to get a cinder, or a token-flower sent to express it."—*Conversations of Lord Byron*, 1824, p. 122.]

[13] Constantinople. [Compare—

"Tho' I am parted, yet my mind
That's more than self still stays behind."

Poems, by Thomas Carew, ed. 1640, p. 36.]

[14] {18} [Given to the Hon. Roden Noel by S. McCalmont Hill, who inherited it from his great-grandfather, Robert Dallas. No date or occasion of the piece has been recorded. —*Life of Lord Byron*, 1890, p. 5.]

[15] {19} [These lines are copied from a leaf of the original MS. of the Second Canto of *Childe Harold*. They are headed, "Lines written beneath the Picture of J.U.D."]

In a curious work of doubtful authority, entitled, *The Life, Writings, Opinions and Times of the Right Hon. G. G. Noel Byron*, London, 1825 (iii. 123-132), there is a long and circumstantial narrative of a "defeated" attempt of Byron's to rescue a Georgian girl, whom he had bought in the slave-market for 800 piastres, from a life of shame and degradation. It is improbable that these verses suggested the story; and, on the other hand, the story, if true, does afford some clue to the verses.]

[16] {20} The song Δεῦτε παῖδες, etc., was written by Riga, who perished in the attempt to revolutionize Greece. This translation is as literal as the author could make it in verse. It is of the same measure as that of the original. [For the original, see *Poetical Works*, 1891, Appendix, p. 792. For Constantine Rhigas, see *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 199, note 2. Hobhouse (*Travels in Albania*, 1858, ii. 3) prints a version (Byron told Murray that it was "well enough," *Letters*, 1899, iii. 13) of Δεῦτε παῖδες of his own composition. He explains in a footnote that the metre is "a mixed trochaic, except the chorus." "This song," he adds, "the chorus particularly, is sung to a tune very nearly the same as the Marseillois Hymn. Strangely enough, Lord Byron, in his translation, has entirely mistaken the metre." The first stanza runs as follows:—

"Greeks arise! the day of glory
Comes at last your swords to claim.
Let us all in future story
Rival our forefathers' fame.
Underfoot the yoke of tyrants
Let us now indignant trample,
Mindful of the great example,
And avenge our country's shame."]

[17] {21} Constantinople. "Ἐπτάλοφος."

[18] {22} The song from which this is taken is a great favourite with the young girls of Athens of all classes. Their manner of singing it is by verses in rotation, the whole number present joining in the chorus. I have heard it frequently at our "χόροι" in the winter of 1810-11. The air is plaintive and pretty.

[o] {23} *Has bound my soul to thee*—[MS. M.]

[p] *When wandering forth alone*—[MS. M.]

[q] {24}

*Oh! what can tongue or pen avail
Unless my heart could speak.*—[MS. M.]

[19] [These lines, which are undoubtedly genuine, were published for the first time in the sixth edition of *Poems on his Domestic Circumstances* (W. Hone, 1816). They were first included by Murray in the collected *Poetical Works*, in vol. xvii., 1832.]

[20] ["The principal streets of the city of Valetta are flights of stairs."—*Gazetteer of the World*.]

[21] {25} [Major-General Hildebrand Oakes (1754-1822) succeeded Admiral Sir Richard Goodwin Keates as "his Majesty's commissioner for the affairs of Malta," April 27, 1810. There was an outbreak of plague during his tenure of office (1810-13).—*Annual Register*, 1810, p. 320; *Dict. Nat. Biog.*, art. "Oakes."]

[22] ["Lord Byron ... was once *rather near* fighting a duel—and that was with an officer of the staff of General Oakes at Malta" (1809).—*Westminster Review*, January, 1825, iii. 21 (by J. C. Hobhouse). (See, too, *Life* (First Edition, 1830, 4to), i. 202, 222.)]

[23] [On March 13, 1811, Captain (Sir William) Hoste (1780-1828) defeated a combined French and Italian squadron off the island of Lissa, on the Dalmatian coast. "The French commodore's ship *La Favorite* was burnt, himself (Dubourdieu) being killed." The four victorious frigates with their prizes arrived at Malta, March 31, when the garrison "ran out unarmed to receive and hail them." The *Volage*, in which Byron returned to England, took part in the engagement. Captain Hoste had taken a prize off Fiume in the preceding year.—*Annual Register*, 1811; *Memoirs and Letters of Sir W. Hoste*, ii. 79.]

[24] {26} ["We have had balls and fetes given us by all classes here, and it is impossible to convey to you the sensation our success has given rise to."—*Memoirs and Letters of Sir W. Hoste*, ii. 82.]

[25] [Mrs. (Susan) Fraser published, in 1809, "*Camilla de Florian* (the scene is laid in Valetta) *and Other Poems*. By an Officer's Wife." Byron was, no doubt, struck by her admiration for Macpherson's *Ossian*, and had read with interest her version of "The Address to the Sun," in *Carthon*, p. 31 (see *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 229). He may, too, have regarded with favour some stanzas in honour of the *Bolero* (p. 82), which begin, "When, my Love, supinely *laying*."]

[26] {27} [Byron left Malta for England June 13, 1811. (See Letter to H. Drury, July 17, 1811, *Letters*, 1898, i. 318.)]

[r] {28} *And mine was the pride and the worth of a name*—[MS. M.]

[s] *It tells not of time*——.—[MS. M.]

[27] Francis Hodgson.

[28] {30} [Hodgson stipulated that the last twelve lines should be omitted, but Moore disregarded his wishes, and included the poem as it stands in his *Life*. A marginal note ran thus: "N.B. The poor dear soul meant nothing of this. F.H."—*Memoir of Rev. Francis Hodgson*, 1878, i. 212.]

[t] *On the death of*——*Thyrza*.—[MS.]

[29] [The following note on the identity of Thyrza has been communicated to the Editor:

—
"The identity of Thyrza and the question whether the person addressed under this name really existed, or was an imaginary being, have given rise to much speculation and discussion of a more or less futile kind.

"This difficulty is now incapable of definite and authoritative solution, and the allusions in the verses in some respects disagree with things said by Lord Byron later. According to the poems, Thyrza had met him

" ... many a day
In these, to me, deserted towers.'

(Newstead, October 11, 1811.)

"When stretched on fever's sleepless bed.'

(At Patras, about September, 1810.)

"Death for thee
Prepared a light and pangless dart.'

"And oft I thought at Cynthia's noon,
When sailing o'er the Ægean wave,
"Now Thyrza gazes on that moon"—
Alas, it gleam'd upon her grave!'

(*One struggle more, and I am free.*)

"Finally, in the verses of October 11, 1811—

"The pledge we wore—I wear it still,
But where is thine?—Ah! where art thou?"

"There can be no doubt that Lord Byron referred to Thyrza in conversation with Lady Byron, and probably also with Mrs. Leigh, as a young girl who had existed, and the date of whose death almost coincided with Lord Byron's landing in England in 1811. On one occasion he showed Lady Byron a beautiful tress of hair, which she understood to be Thyrza's. He said he had never mentioned her name, and that now she was gone his breast was the sole depository of that secret. 'I took the name of Thyrza from Gesner. She was Abel's wife.'

"Thyrza is mentioned in a letter from Elizabeth, Duchess of Devonshire, to Augustus Foster (London, May 4, 1812): 'Your little friend, Caro William (Lady Caroline Lamb), as usual, is doing all sorts of imprudent things for him (Lord Byron) and with him; he admires her very much, but is supposed by some to admire our Caroline (the Hon. Mrs. George Lamb) more; he says she is like Thyrza, and her singing is enchantment to him.' From this extract it is obvious that Thyrza is alluded to in the following lines, which, with the above quotation, may be reproduced, by kind permission of Mr. Vere Foster, from his most interesting book, *The Two Duchesses* (1898, pp. 362-374).

"VERSES ADDRESSED BY LORD BYRON IN THE YEAR 1812
TO THE HON. MRS. GEORGE LAMB.

The sacred song that on my ear
Yet vibrates from that voice of thine
I heard before from one so dear,
'Tis strange it still appears divine.
But oh! so sweet that *look* and *tone*
To her and thee alike is given;
It seemed as if for me alone
That *both* had been recalled from Heaven.
And though I never can redeem
The vision thus endeared to me,
I scarcely can regret my dream
When realized again by thee."

(It may be noted that the name Thirza, or Thyrza, a variant of Theresa, had been familiar to Byron in his childhood. In the Preface to *Cain* he writes, "Gesner's *Death of Abel!* I have never read since I was eight years of age at Aberdeen. The general impression of my recollection is delight; but of the contents I remember only that Cain's wife was called Mahala, and Abel's Thirza." Another and more immediate suggestion of the name may be traced to the following translation of Meleager's Epitaphium *In Heliodoram*, which one of the "associate bards," Bland, or Merivale, or Hodgson, contributed to their *Translations chiefly from the Greek Anthology*, 1806, p. 4, a work which Byron singles out for commendation in *English Bards*, etc, (lines 881-890):—

"Tears o'er my parted Thyrza's grave I shed,
Affection's fondest tribute to the dead.

Break, break my heart, o'ercharged with bursting woe

An empty offering to the shades below!
Ah, plant regretted! Death's remorseless power,
With dust unfruitful checked thy full-blown flower.
Take, earth, the gentle inmate to thy breast,
And soft-embosomed let my Thyrza rest."

The MSS. of "To Thyrza," "Away, away, ye notes of Woe!" "One struggle more, and I am free," and, "And thou art dead, as young and fair," which belonged originally to Mrs. Leigh, are now in the possession of Sir Theodore Martin, K.C.B.—EDITOR.)]

[30] [For the substitution in the present issue of continuous lines for stanzas, Byron's own authority and mandate may be quoted. "In reading the 4th vol.... I perceive that piece 12 ('Without a Stone') is made nonsense of (that is, greater nonsense than usual) by dividing it into stanzas 1, 2, etc."—Letter to John Murray, August 26, 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 215.]

[u] *And soothe if such could soothe thy shade.*—[MS. erased.]

[v] {31} *By many a land*——.—[MS.]

[w] {33} *And shall they not*——.—[MS.]

[x] ——*the walk aside.*—[MS.]

[y]

(a) *The kiss that left no sting behind
So guiltless Passion thus forbore;
Those eyes bespoke so pure a mind,*

*That Love forgot to { plead
ask } for more.*

(b) *The kiss that left no sting behind,
So guiltless Love each wish forebore;
Those eyes proclaimed so pure a mind,
That Passion blushed to smile for more.—*

[Pencilled alternative stanzas.]

[z] {34} *Well hast thou fled*——.—[MS. erased.]

[aa]

*If judging from my present pain
That rest alone*——.—[MS. erased.]
If rest alone is in the tomb.—[MS.]

[ab] *So let it be my hope in Heaven.*—[MS. erased]

[ac] {35} *Stanzas.*—[MS. Editions 1812-1832.]

[31] ["I wrote it a day or two ago, on hearing a song of former days."—Letter to Hodgson, December 8, 1811, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 82.]

[ad] *I dare not hear*——.—[MS. erased.]

[ae] *But hush the chords*——.—[MS. erased.]

[af] ——*I dare not gaze.*—[MS. erased.]

[ag] *The voice that made that song more sweet.*—[MS.]

[ah] *'Tis silent now*——.—[MS.]

[ai] {36} *To Thyrza.*—[Editions 1812-1831.]

[aj]

From pangs that tear——.—[MS.]

Such pangs that tear——.—[MS. erased.]

[ak] *With things that moved me not before.*—[MS. erased.]

[al] *What sorrow cannot*——.—[MS.]

[am]

It would not be, so hadst not thou

Withdrawn so soon——.—[MS. erased.]

[an] {38} —*how oft I said.*—[MS. erased.]

[ao]

Like freedom to the worn-out slave.—[MS.]

But Health and life returned and gave,

A boon 'twas idle then to give,

Relenting Health in mocking gave.—[MS. B. M. erased.]

[32] [Compare *My Epitaph*: "Youth, Nature and relenting Jove."—Letter to Hodgson, October 3, 1810, *Letters*, 1898, i. 298.]

[ap] *Dear simple gift*——.—[MS. erased.]

[33] {39} Compare *A Wish*, by Matthew Arnold, stanza 3, etc.—

"Spare me the whispering, crowded room,
The friends who come and gape and go," etc.

[aq] {41} *Stanzas*.—[Editions 1812-1831.]

[34] ["The Lovers' Walk is terminated with an ornamental urn, inscribed to Miss Dolman, a beautiful and amiable relation of Mr. Shenstone's, who died of the small-pox, about twenty-one years of age, in the following words on one side:—

'Peramabili consobrinæ
M.D.'

On the other side—

'Ah! Maria!
pvellarvm elegantissima!
ah Flore venvstatis abrepta,
vale!
hev qvanto minvs est
cvm reliqvis versari
qvam tui
meminisse.'"

(From a *Description of the Leasowes*, by A. Dodsley; *Poetical Works of William Shenstone* [1798], p. xxix.)]

[ar]

Are mingled with the Earth.—[MS.]
Were never meant for Earth.—[MS. erased.]

[as] *Unhonoured with the vulgar dread*.—[MS. erased.]

[at] {42}

I will not ask where thou art laid,
Nor look upon the name.—[MS. erased.]

[au] *So I shall know it not*.—[MS. erased.]

[av] *Like common dust can rot*.—[MS.]

[aw] *I would not wish to see nor touch*.—[MS. erased.]

[ax] *As well as warm as thou*.—[MS. erased.]

[ay] MS. transposes lines 5 and 6 of stanza 3.

[az] *Nor frailty disavow.*—[MS.]

[ba] *Nor canst thou fair and faultless see.*—[MS. erased.]

[bb] *Nor wrong, nor change, nor fault in me.*—[MS.]

[bc] {43} *The cloud that cheers——.*—[MS.]

[bd] *The sweetness of that silent deep.*—[MS.]

[be]

The flower in beauty's bloom unmatched

Is still the earliest prey.—[MS.]

The rose by some rude fingers snatched,

Is earliest doomed to fade.—[MS. erased.]

[bf] *I do not deem I could have borne.*—[MS.]

[bg]

But night and day of thine are passed,

And thou wert lovely to the last;

Destroyed——.—[MS. erased.]

[bh] {44} *As stars that seem to quit the sky.*—[MS.]

[bi]

O how much less it were to gain,

All beauteous though they be.—[MS.]

[bj] *Through dark and dull Eternity.*—[MS.]

[bk] {45} *Sympathetic Address to a Young Lady.*— [Morning Chronicle, March 7, 1812.]

[35] [The scene which begat these memorable stanzas was enacted at a banquet at Carlton House, February 22, 1812. On March 6 the following quatrain, entitled, "Impromptu on a Recent Incident," appeared in the *Morning Chronicle*:—

"Blest omens of a happy reign,

In swift succession hourly rise,

Forsaken friends, vows made in vain—

A daughter's tears, a nation's sighs."

Byron's lines, headed, "Sympathetic Address to a Young Lady," were published anonymously in the *Morning Chronicle* of March 7, but it was not till March 10 that the *Courier* ventured to insert a report of "The Fracas at Carlton House on the 22nd ult.," which had already been communicated to the *Caledonian Mercury*.

"The party consisted of the Princess Charlotte, the Duchess of York, the Dukes of York and Cambridge, Lords Moira, Erskine, Lauderdale, Messrs. Adams and Sheridan.

"The Prince Regent expressed 'his surprise and mortification' at the conduct of Lords Grey and Grenville [who had replied unfavourably to a letter addressed by the P.R. to the Duke of York, suggesting an united administration]. Lord Lauderdale thereupon, with a freedom unusual in courts, asserted that the reply did not express the opinions of Lords Grey and Grenville only, but of every political friend of that way of thinking, and that he had been present at and assisted in the drawing-up, and that every sentence had his cordial assent. The Prince was suddenly and deeply affected by Lord Lauderdale's reply, so much so, that the Princess, observing his agitation, dropt her head and burst into tears—upon which the Prince turned round and begged the female part of the company to withdraw."

In the following June, at a ball at Miss Johnson's, Byron was "presented by order to our gracious Regent, who honoured me with some conversation," and for a time he ignored and perhaps regretted his anonymous *jeu d'esprit*. But early in 1814, either out of mere bravado or in an access of political rancour, he determined to republish the stanzas under his own name. The first edition of the *Corsair* was printed, if not published, but in accordance with a peremptory direction (January 22, 1814), "eight lines on the little Royalty weeping in 1812," were included among the poems printed at the end of the second edition.

The "newspapers were in hysterics and town in an uproar on the avowal and republication" of the stanzas (*Diary*, February 18), and during Byron's absence from town "Murray omitted the Tears in several of the copies"—that is, in the Third Edition—but yielding to *force majeure*, replaced them in a Fourth Edition, which was issued early in February. (See Letters of July 6, 1812, January 22, February 2, and February 10, 1814 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 134, etc.); and for "Newspaper Attacks upon Byron," see *Letters*, 1898, ii. Appendix VII. pp. 463-492.)]

[bl] Stanzas.—[1812.]

[36] {48} [For allusion to the "Cornelian" see "The Cornelian," ["Pignus Amoris"], and "The Adieu," stanza 7, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 66, 231, 240. See, too, *Letters*, 1898, i. 130, note 3.]

[bm] {50} *To Samuel Rogers, Esq.*—[*Poems*, 1816.]

[37] ["Rogers is silent,—and, it is said, severe. When he does talk, he talks well; and, on all subjects of taste, his delicacy of expression is pure as his poetry. If you enter his house—his drawing-room—his library—you of yourself say, this is not the dwelling of a common mind. There is not a gem, a coin, a book thrown aside on his chimney-piece, his sofa, his table, that does not bespeak an almost fastidious elegance in the possessor."—*Diary*, 1813; *Letters*, 1898, ii. 331.]

[38] [Compare Collins' *Ode on the Death of Mr. Thomson*—"In yonder grave a Druid lies."]

[39] {51} ["Mr. Elliston then came forward and delivered the following *Prize* address. We cannot boast of the eloquence of the delivery. It was neither gracefully nor correctly recited. The merits of the production itself we submit to the criticism of our readers. We cannot suppose that it was selected as the most poetical composition of all the scores that were submitted to the committee. But perhaps by its tenor, by its allusions to Garrick, to Siddons, and to Sheridan, it was thought most applicable to the occasion, notwithstanding its being in part unmusical, and in general tame."—*Morning Chronicle*, October 12, 1812.]

[40] ["By the by, the best view of the said fire [February 24, 1809] (which I myself saw from a house-top in Covent-garden) was at Westminster Bridge, from the reflection on the Thames."—Letter to Lord Holland, September 25, 1812, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 148.]

[bn]

As flashing far the new Volcano shone

*And swept the skies with { meteors
lightnings } not their own.*

or, *As flashed the volumed blaze, and { sadly
ghastly } shone*

The skies with lightnings awful as their own.—

[Letter to Lord Holland, Sept. 25, 1812.]

or, *As glared each rising flash, and ghastly shone*

The skies with lightnings awful as their own.—
[Letter to Lord Holland, Sept. 27, 1812.]

[bo] {52}

*Till slowly ebb'd the { lava of the
spent volcanic } wave.*

or, *Till ebb'd the lava of { the burning
that molten } wave,*

And blackening ashes mark'd the Muse's grave.—
[Letter to Lord Holland, Sept. 28, 1812]

[bp] *That scorns the scythe of Time, the torch of Flame.—*[Letter to Lord Holland, Sept, 28, 1812.]

[bq] {53}

*Far be from him that hour which asks in vain
Tears such as flow for Garrick in his strain;*
or, *Far be that hour that vainly asks in turn*

*Sad verse for him as { crowned his
wept o'er } Garrick's urn.—*
[Letter to Lord Holland, Sept. 30, 1812.]

[41] [Originally, "Ere Garrick *died*," etc. "By the by, one of my corrections in the fair copy sent yesterday has dived into the bathos some sixty fathom—

'When Garrick died, and Brinsley ceased to write.'

Ceasing to *live* is a much more serious concern, and ought not to be first; therefore I will let the old couplet stand, with its half rhymes 'sought' and 'wrote' [*vide supra*, [variant ii.](#)] Second thoughts in every thing are best, but, in rhyme, third and fourth don't come amiss.... I always scrawl in this way, and smooth as much as I can, but never sufficiently."—Letter to Lord Holland, September 26, 1812, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 150.]

[br]

*Such are the names that here your plaudits sought,
When Garrick acted, and when Brinsley wrote.—*[MS.]

[42] {54} [The following lines were omitted by the Committee:—

*"Nay, lower still, the Drama yet depletes
 That late she deigned to crawl upon all-fours.
 When Richard roars in Bosworth for a horse,
 If you command, the steed must come in course.
 If you decree, the Stage must condescend
 To soothe the sickly taste we dare not mend.
 Blame not our judgment should we acquiesce,
 And gratify you more by showing less.
 Oh, since your Fiat stamps the Drama's laws,
 Forbear to mock us with misplaced applause;
 That public praise be ne'er again disgraced,
 From { brutes to man recall
 babes and brutes redeem } a nation's taste;
 Then pride shall doubly nerve the actor's powers,
 When Reason's voice is echoed back with ours."*

The last couplet but one was altered in a later copy, thus—

*"The past reproach let present scenes refute,
 Nor shift from man to babe, from babe to brute."*

"Is Whitbread," wrote Lord Byron, "determined to castrate all my *cavalry* lines?... I do implore, for my own gratification, one lash on those accursed quadrupeds—a long shot, Sir Lucius, if you love me."—*Letter to Lord Holland*, September 28, 1812, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 156. For "animal performers," vide *ibid.*, note 1.]

[43] [Lines 66-69 were added on September 24, in a letter to Lord Holland.]

[44] {55} [The original of Dr. Busby's address, entitled "Monologue submitted to the Committee of Drury Lane Theatre," which was published in the *Morning Chronicle*, October 17, 1812, "will be found in the *Genuine Rejected Addresses*, as well as parodied in *Rejected Addresses* ('Architectural Atoms'). On October 14 young Busby forced his way on to the stage of Drury Lane, attempted to recite his father's address, and was taken into custody. On the next night, Dr. Busby, speaking from one of the boxes, obtained a hearing for his son, who could not, however, make his voice heard in the theatre.... To the failure of the younger Busby (himself a competitor and the author of an 'Unalogue'...) to make himself heard, Byron alludes in the stage direction, 'to be spoken in an inarticulate voice.'" (See *Letters*, 1898, ii. 176; and for Dr. Busby, see *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 481, 485.) Busby's "Address" ran as follows:—

*"When energising objects men pursue,
 What are the prodigies they cannot do?"*

A magic edifice you here survey,
Shot from the ruins of the other day!
As Harlequin had smote the slumberous heap,
And bade the rubbish to a fabric leap.
Yet at that speed you'd never be amazed,
Knew you the *zeal* with which the pile was raised;
Nor even here your smiles would be repress,
Knew you the rival flame that fires our breast, 10
Flame! fire and flame! sad heart-appalling sounds,
Dread metaphors that ope our healing wounds—
A sleeping pang awakes—and——But away
With all reflections that would cloud the day
That this triumphant, brilliant prospect brings,
Where Hope reviving re-expands her wings;
Where generous joy exults, where duteous ardour springs.

If mighty things with small we may compare,
This spirit drives Britannia's conquering car,
Burns in her ranks and kindles every tar.
Nelson displayed its power upon the main,
And Wellington exhibits it in Spain;
Another Marlborough points to Blenheim's story,
And with its lustre, blends his kindred glory. 40

In Arms and Science long our Isle hath shone,
And SHAKESPEARE—wondrous SHAKESPEARE—reared a throne
For British Poesy—whose powers inspire
The British pencil, and the British lyre—
Her we invoke—her Sister Arts implore:
Their smiles beseech whose charms yourselves adore,
These if we win, the Graces too we gain—
Their dear, beloved, inseparable train;
THREE who their witching arts from Cupid stole
And three acknowledged sovereigns of the soul: 50
Harmonious throng! with nature blending art!
Divine SESTETTO! warbling to the heart
For Poesy shall here sustain the upper part.
Thus lifted gloriously we'll sweep along,
Shine in our music, scenery and song;
Shine in our farce, masque, opera and play,
And prove old DRURY has not had her day,
Nay more—so stretch the wing the world shall cry,
Old DRURY never, never soared so high.

'But hold,' you'll say, 'this self-complacent boast; 60
Easy to reckon thus without your host.'
True, true—that lowers at once our mounting pride;
'Tis yours alone our merit to decide;
'Tis ours to look to you, you hold the prize
That bids our great, our best ambitions rise.
A *double* blessing *your* rewards impart,
Each good provide and elevate the heart.
Our twofold feeling owns its twofold cause,
Your bounty's *comfort*—*rapture* your applause;
When in your fostering beam you bid us live, 70
You give the means of life, and gild the means you give."

Morning Chronicle, October 17, 1812.]

[45] {57} [Busby's translation of Lucretius (*The Nature of Things*, a Didascalie Poem) was published in 1813. Byron was a subscriber, and is mentioned in the preface as "one of the most distinguished poets of the age." The passage in question is, perhaps, taken from the Second Book, lines 880, 881, which Busby renders—

"Just as she quickens fuel into fire,
And bids it, flaming, to the skies aspire."]

[46] {59} [The Leasowes, the residence of the poet Shenstone, is near the village of Halesowen, in Shropshire.]

[47] [See Dryden's *Cymon and Iphigenia*, lines 84, 85.]

[48] [The sequel of a temporary liaison formed by Lord Byron during his career in London, occasioned this impromptu. On the cessation of the connection, the fair one [Lady C. Lamb: see *Letters*, 1898, ii. 451] called one morning at her quondam lover's apartments. His Lordship was from home; but finding *Vathek* on the table, the lady wrote in the first page of the volume the words, "Remember me!" Byron immediately wrote under the ominous warning these two stanzas.—*Conversations of Lord Byron*, by Thomas Medwin, 1824, pp. 329, 330.

In Medwin's work the euphemisms *false* and *fiend* are represented by asterisks.]

[49] {60} ["To Bd., Feb. 22, 1813.

"Remember thee,' nay—doubt it not—
Thy Husband too may '*think*' of thee!
By neither canst thou be forgot,
Thou false to him—thou fiend to me!

"Remember thee? Yes—yes—till Fate
In Lethe quench the guilty dream.
Yet then—e'en then—Remorse and *Hate*
Shall vainly quaff the vanquished stream."

From a MS. (in the possession of Mr. Hallam Murray) not in Byron's handwriting.]

[bs] {61} ——*not confessed thy power.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[bt] ——*still forgets the hour.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[bu] {64} *Song.*—[*Childe Harold*, 1814.]

[50] ["I send you some lines which may as well be called 'A Song' as anything else, and will do for your new edition."—B.—(MS. M.)]

[bv] *But her who not*——.—[MS. M.]

[bw] {65} *To Ianthe.*—[MS. M. Compare "The Dedication" to *Childe Harold*.]

[51] {67} [It is possible that these lines, as well as the Sonnets "To Genevra," were addressed to Lady Frances Wedderburn Webster.—See *Letters*, 1898, ii. 2, note 1; and *Letters*, 1899, iii. 8, note 1.]

[bx] *To him who loves and her who loved.*—[MS. M.]

[by] *That trembling form*——.—[MS. M.]

[bz]

*Resigning thee, alas! I lost
Joys bought too dear, if bright with tears,
Yet ne'er regret the pangs it cost.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[ca] *And crush*——.—[MS. M.]

[cb] *And I been not unworthy thee.*—[MS. M.]

[cc] *Long may thy days*——.—[MS. M.]

[cd] *Might make my hope of guilty joy.*—[MS.]

[52] [Byron forwarded these lines to Moore in a postscript to a letter dated September 27, 1813. "Here's," he writes, "an impromptu for you by a 'person of quality,' written last week, on being reproached for low spirits."—*Letters*, 1898, ii. 268. They were written at Aston Hall, Rotherham, where he "stayed a week ... and behaved very well—though the

lady of the house [Lady F. Wedderburn Webster] is young, and religious, and pretty, and the master is my particular friend."—*Letters*, 1898, ii. 267.]

[[ce](#)] {70} *And bleed*——.—[MS. M.]

[[53](#)] ["Redde some Italian, and wrote two Sonnets.... I never wrote but one sonnet before, and that was not in earnest, and many years ago, as an exercise—and I will never write another. They are the most puling, petrifying, stupidly platonic compositions."—*Diary*, December 18, 1813; *Letters*, 1898, ii. 379.]

[[cf](#)] {71} ——*Hope whispers not from woe*.—[MS. M.]

[[54](#)]

["In moments to delight devoted
 'My Life!' is still the name you give,
Dear words! on which my heart had doted
 Had Man an endless term to live.
But, ah! so swift the seasons roll
 That name must be repeated never,
For 'Life' in future say, 'My Soul,'
 Which like my love exists for ever."]

Byron wrote these lines in 1815, in Lady Lansdowne's album, at Bowood.—Note by Mr. Richard Edgecombe, *Notes and Queries*, Sixth Series, vii. 46.]

THE GIAOUR: A FRAGMENT OF A TURKISH TALE.

“One fatal remembrance—one sorrow that throws
Its bleak shade alike o'er our joys and our woes—
To which Life nothing darker nor brighter can bring,
For which joy hath no balm—and affliction no sting.”

MOORE.

["As a beam o'er the face," etc.—*Irish Melodies*.]

INTRODUCTION TO *THE GIAOUR*



IN a letter to Murray, dated Pisa, December 12, 1821 (*Life*, p. 545), Byron avows that the "Giaour Story" had actually "some foundation on facts." Soon after the poem appeared (June 5, 1813), "a story was circulated by some gentlewomen ... a little too close to the text" (Letters to Moore, September 1, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 258), and in order to put himself right with his friends or posterity, Byron wrote to his friend Lord Sligo, who in July, 1810, was anchored off Athens in "a twelve-gun brig, with a crew of fifty men" (see *Letters*, 1898, i. 289, note 1), requesting him to put on paper not so much the narrative of an actual event, but "what he had heard at Athens about the affair of that girl who was so near being put an end to while you were there." According to the letter which Moore published (*Life*, p. 178), and which is reprinted in the present issue (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 257), Byron interposed on behalf of a girl, who "in compliance with the strict letter of the Mohammedan law," had been sewn in a sack and was about to be thrown into the sea. "I was told," adds Lord Sligo, "that you then conveyed her in safety to the convent, and despatched her off at night to Thebes." The letter, which Byron characterizes as "curious," is by no means conclusive, and to judge from the designedly mysterious references in the *Journal*, dated November 16 and December 5, and in the second postscript to a letter to Professor Clarke, dated December 15, 1813 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 321, 361, 311), "the circumstances which were the groundwork" are not

before us. "An event," says John Wright (ed. 1832, ix. 145), "in which Lord Byron was personally concerned, undoubtedly supplied the groundwork of this tale; but for the story so circumstantially set forth (see Medwin's *Conversations*, 1824, pp. 121, 124) of his having been the lover of this female slave, there is no foundation. The girl whose life the poet saved at Athens was not, we are assured by Sir John Hobhouse (*Westminster Review*, January, 1825, iii. 27), an object of his Lordship's attachment, but of that of his Turkish servant." Nevertheless, whatever Byron may have told Hobhouse (who had returned to England), and he distinctly says (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 393) that he did not tell him everything, he avowed to Clarke that he had been led "to the water's edge," and confided to his diary that to "describe the *feelings* of *that* situation was impossible—it is *icy* even to recollect them."

For the allusive and fragmentary style of the *Giaour*, *The Voyage of Columbus*, which Rogers published in 1812, is in part responsible. "It is sudden in its transitions," wrote the author, in the Preface to the first edition, "... leaving much to be imagined by the reader." The story or a part of it is told by a fellow-seaman of Columbus, who had turned "hermite" in his old age, and though the narrative itself is in heroic verse, the prologue and epilogue, as they may be termed, are in "the romance or ballad-measure of the Spanish." The resemblance between the two poems is certainly more than accidental. On the other hand, a vivid and impassioned description of Oriental scenery and customs was, as Gifford observed, new and original, and though, by his own admission, Byron was indebted to *Vathek* (or rather S. Henley's notes to *Vathek*) and to D'Herbelot's *Bibliothèque Orientale* for allusions and details, the "atmosphere" could only have been reproduced by the creative fancy of an observant and enthusiastic traveller who had lived under Eastern skies, and had come within ken of Eastern life and sentiment.

In spite, however, of his love for the subject-matter of his poem, and the facility, surprising even to himself, with which he spun his rhymes, Byron could not persuade himself that a succession of fragments would sort themselves and grow into a complete and connected whole. If his thrice-repeated depreciation of the *Giaour* is not entirely genuine, it is plain that he misdoubted himself. Writing to Murray (August 26, 1813) he says, "I have, but with some difficulty, *not* added any more to this snake of a poem, which has been lengthening its rattles every month;" to Moore (September 1), "The *Giaour* I have added to a good deal, but still in foolish fragments;" and, again, to Moore (September 8), "By the coach I send you a copy of that awful pamphlet the *Giaour*."

But while the author doubted and apologized, or deprecated "his love's excess In words of wrong and bitterness," the public read, and edition followed edition with bewildering speed.

The *Giaour* was reviewed by George Agar Ellis in the *Quarterly* (No. xxxi., January, 1813 [published February 11, 1813]) and in the *Edinburgh Review* by Jeffrey (No. 54, January, 1813 [published February 24, 1813]).

BIBLIOGRAPHICAL NOTE ON *THE* *GIAOUR*

THE bibliography of the *Giaour* is beset with difficulties, and it is doubtful if more than approximate accuracy can be secured. The composition of the entire poem in its present shape was accomplished within six months, May-November, 1813, but during that period it was expanded by successive accretions from a first draft of 407 lines (extant in MS.) to a seventh edition of 1334 lines. A proof is extant of an edition of 28 pages containing 460 lines, itself an enlargement on the MS.; but whether (as a note in the handwriting of the late Mr. Murray affirms) this was or was not published is uncertain. A portion of a second proof of 38 pages has been preserved, but of the publication of the poem in this state there is no record. On June 5 a first edition of 41 pages, containing 685 lines, was issued, and of this numerous copies are extant. At the end of June, or the beginning of July, 1813, a second edition, entitled, a "New Edition with some Additions," appeared. This consisted of 47 pages, and numbered 816 lines. Among the accretions is to be found the famous passage beginning, "He that hath bent him o'er the dead." Two MS. copies of this *pannus vere purpureus* are in Mr. Murray's possession. At the end of July, and during the first half of August, two or more issues of a third edition were set up in type. The first issue amounted to 53 pages, containing 950 lines, was certainly published

in this form, and possibly a second issue of 56 pages, containing 1004 lines, may have followed at a brief interval. A revise of this second issue, dated August 13, is extant. In the last fortnight of August a fourth edition of 58 pages, containing 1048 lines, undoubtedly saw the light. Scarcely more than a few days can have elapsed before a fifth edition of 66 pages, containing 1215 lines, was ready to supplant the fourth edition. A sixth edition, a reproduction of the fifth, may have appeared in October. A seventh edition of 75 pages, containing 1334 lines, which presented the poem in its final shape, was issued subsequently to November 27, 1813 (a seventh edition was advertised in the *Morning Chronicle*, December 22, 1813), the date of the last revise, or of an advance copy of the issue. The ninth, tenth, eleventh, and twelfth editions belong to 1814, while a fourteenth edition is known to have been issued in 1815. In that year and henceforward the *Giaour* was included in the various collected editions of Byron's works. The subjoined table assigns to their several editions the successive accretions in their order as now published:—

Lines. <i>Giaour</i> .	Edition of——
1—6. <i>MS. First edition of 28 pages.</i>	
7—20. Second edition. [47 pages, 816 lines.]	Approximate date, June 24, 1813.
21—45. Third edition. [53 pages, 950 lines.]	July 30, 1813.
46—102. Second edition.	
103—167. Fifth edition. [66 pages, 1215 lines.]	August 25, 1813.
168—199. <i>MS. First edition of 28 pages.</i>	
200—250. Third edition.	
251—252. Seventh edition. [75 pages, 1334 lines.]	November 27, 1813.

- 253—276. Third edition.
- 277—287. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
- 288—351. Third edition. (Second issue?) August 11, 1813.
[56 pages, 1004,? 1014 lines.]
- 352—503. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
- 504—518. Third edition.
- 519—619. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
- 620—654. Second edition.
- 655—688. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
- 689—722. Fourth edition. [58 pages, 1048 August 19.
lines.]
- 723—737. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
733-4 not in the MS., but in First
edition of 28 pages.
- 738—745. *First edition of 41 pages.* June 5, 1813.
- 746—786. First edition of 28 pages. Not in
the MS
- 787—831. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*
- 832—915. Seventh edition.
- 916—998. *First edition of 41 pages.* 937-
970 no MS.
- 999—1023. Second edition.
- 1024—1028. Seventh edition.
- 1029—1079. *First edition of 41 pages.*
- 1080—1098. Third edition.
- 1099—1125. *First edition of 41 pages.*
- 1126—1130. Seventh edition.
- 1131—1191. Fifth edition.

1192—1217. Seventh edition.

1218—1256. Fifth edition.

1257—1318. *First edition of 41 pages.*

1319—1334. *MS. First edition of 28 pages.*

NOTE.

The first edition is advertised in the *Morning Chronicle*, June 5; a third edition on August 11, 13, 16, 31; a fifth edition, with considerable additions, on September 11; on November 29 a "new edition;" and on December 27, 1813, a seventh edition, together with a repeated notice of the *Bride of Abydos*. These dates do not exactly correspond with Murray's contemporary memoranda of the dates of the successive issues.

TO

SAMUEL ROGERS, ESQ.

AS A SLIGHT BUT MOST SINCERE TOKEN

OF ADMIRATION OF HIS GENIUS,

RESPECT FOR HIS CHARACTER,

AND GRATITUDE FOR HIS FRIENDSHIP,

THIS PRODUCTION IS INSCRIBED

BY HIS OBLIGED
AND AFFECTIONATE SERVANT,

BYRON.

LONDON, *May*, 1813.

ADVERTISEMENT.



THE tale which these disjointed fragments present, is founded upon circumstances now less common in the East than formerly; either because the ladies are more circumspect than in the "olden time," or because the Christians have better fortune, or less enterprise. The story, when entire, contained the adventures of a female slave, who was thrown, in the Mussulman manner, into the sea for infidelity, and avenged by a young Venetian, her lover, at the time the Seven Islands were possessed by the Republic of Venice, and soon after the Arnauts were beaten back from the Morea, which they had ravaged for some time subsequent to the Russian invasion. The desertion of the Mainotes, on being refused the plunder of Misitra, led to the abandonment of that enterprise, and to the desolation of the Morea, during which the cruelty exercised on all sides was unparalleled even in the annals of the faithful.



THE GIAOUR.

No breath of air to break the wave
That rolls below the Athenian's grave,
That tomb^[55] which, gleaming o'er the cliff,
That greets the homeward-veering skiff
On o'er the land he saved in vain;
Can shall such Hero live again?

Dear clime! where every season smiles^[cg]
Magnificent o'er those blessed isles,
Which, seen from far Colonna's height,
Can glad the heart that hails the sight,¹⁰
Can lend to loneliness delight.
Can mildly dimpling, Ocean's cheek
Reflects the tints of many a peak
Bright by the laughing tides that lave
These Edens of the eastern wave:
Can if at times a transient breeze
Shake the blue crystal of the seas,
Can sweep one blossom from the trees,
Can welcome is each gentle air
That wakes and wafts the odours there!²⁰
Can there the Rose, o'er crag or vale,
Can ana of the Nightingale,^[56]

he maid for whom his melody,
is thousand songs are heard on high,
oms blushing to her lover's tale:
queen, the garden queen, his Rose,
ent by winds, unchilled by snows,
from the winters of the west,
every breeze and season blest,
urns the sweets by Nature given³⁰
oftest incense back to Heaven;
grateful yields that smiling sky
fairest hue and fragrant sigh.
many a summer flower is there,
many a shade that Love might share,
many a grotto, meant for rest,
t holds the pirate for a guest;
ose bark in sheltering cove below
ks for the passing peaceful prow,
the gay mariner's guitar^[57]₄₀
eard, and seen the Evening Star;
n stealing with the muffled oar,
shaded by the rocky shore,
h the night-prowlers on the prey,
turn to groans his roundelay.
nge—that where Nature loved to trace,
f for Gods, a dwelling place,
every charm and grace hath mixed
in the Paradise she fixed,
re man, enamoured of distress,⁵⁰
uld mar it into wilderness,^[ch]
trample, brute-like, o'er each flower
t tasks not one laborious hour;

claims the culture of his hand
loom along the fairy land,
springs as to preclude his care,
sweetly woos him—but to spare!
nge—that where all is Peace beside,
re Passion riots in her pride,
Lust and Rapine wildly reign⁶⁰
larken o'er the fair domain.
as though the Fiends prevailed
inst the Seraphs they assailed,
, fixed on heavenly thrones, should dwell
freed inheritors of Hell;
oft the scene, so formed for joy,
urst the tyrants that destroy!

ie who hath bent him o'er the dead^{[ci][58]}
the first day of Death is fled,
first dark day of Nothingness,⁷⁰
last of Danger and Distress,
fore Decay's effacing fingers
e swept the lines where Beauty lingers,)
marked the mild angelic air,
rapture of Repose that's there,^[cj]
fixed yet tender traits that streak
languor of the placid cheek,
—but for that sad shrouded eye,
hat fires not, wins not, weeps not, now,
nd but for that chill, changeless brow,⁸⁰
here cold Obstruction's apathy^[59]
ppals the gazing mourner's heart,^[ck]
s if to him it could impart

he doom he dreads, yet dwells upon;
es, but for these and these alone,
ome moments, aye, one treacherous hour,
e still might doubt the Tyrant's power;
o fair, so calm, so softly sealed,
he first, last look by Death revealed!^[60]
uch is the aspect of this shore;90
is Greece, but living Greece no more!^[61]
o coldly sweet, so deadly fair,
/e start, for Soul is wanting there.
ers is the loveliness in death,
hat parts not quite with parting breath;
ut beauty with that fearful bloom,
hat hue which haunts it to the tomb,
xpression's last receding ray,
gilded Halo hovering round decay,
he farewell beam of Feeling past away!100
rk of that flame, perchance of heavenly birth,
ch gleams, but warms no more its cherished earth!

Clime of the unforgotten brave!^[62]
/hose land from plain to mountain-cave
/as Freedom's home or Glory's grave!
hrine of the mighty! can it be,^[cl]
hat this is all remains of thee?
pproach, thou craven crouching slave:^[63]
Say, is not this Thermopylæ?^[cm]
hese waters blue that round you lave,—110
Oh servile offspring of the free—
ronounce what sea, what shore is this?
he gulf, the rock of Salamis!

these scenes, their story not unknown,
rise, and make again your own;
natch from the ashes of your Sires
he embers of their former fires;
nd he who in the strife expires^[cn]
/ill add to theirs a name of fear
hat Tyranny shall quake to hear,¹²⁰
nd leave his sons a hope, a fame,
hey too will rather die than shame:
or Freedom's battle once begun,
equeathed by bleeding Sire to Son,^[co]
hough baffled oft is ever won.
ear witness, Greece, thy living page!
ttest it many a deathless age!^[cp]
/hile Kings, in dusty darkness hid,
ave left a nameless pyramid,
hy Heroes, though the general doom¹³⁰
ath swept the column from their tomb,
mightier monument command,
he mountains of their native land!
here points thy Muse to stranger's eye^[cq]
he graves of those that cannot die!
were long to tell, and sad to trace,
ach step from Splendour to Disgrace;
nough—no foreign foe could quell
hy soul, till from itself it fell;
et! Self-abasement paved the way¹⁴⁰
o villain-bonds and despot sway.

/hat can he tell who treads thy shore?
No legend of thine olden time,

o theme on which the Muse might soar
igh as thine own in days of yore,
When man was worthy of thy clime.
he hearts within thy valleys bred,^[cr]
he fiery souls that might have led
Thy sons to deeds sublime,
ow crawl from cradle to the Grave,¹⁵⁰
laves—nay, the bondsmen of a Slave,^[64]
And callous, save to crime;
tained with each evil that pollutes
lankind, where least above the brutes;
ithout even savage virtue blest,
ithout one free or valiant breast,
till to the neighbouring ports they waft^[cs]
roverbial wiles, and ancient craft;
i this the subtle Greek is found,
or this, and this alone, renowned.¹⁶⁰
i vain might Liberty invoke
he spirit to its bondage broke
r raise the neck that courts the yoke:
o more her sorrows I bewail,
et this will be a mournful tale,
nd they who listen may believe,
/ho heard it first had cause to grieve.

Far, dark, along the blue sea glancing,
he shadows of the rocks advancing
tart on the fisher's eye like boat¹⁷⁰
f island-pirate or Mainote;
nd fearful for his light caïque,
e shuns the near but doubtful creek:^[ct]

hough worn and weary with his toil,
nd cumbered with his scaly spoil,
lowly, yet strongly, plies the oar,
ill Port Leone's safer shore
eceives him by the lovely light
hat best becomes an Eastern night.

Who thundering comes on blackest steed,^[65]180
With slackened bit and hoof of speed?
eneath the clattering iron's sound
he caverned Echoes wake around
lash for lash, and bound for bound:
he foam that streaks the courser's side
eems gathered from the Ocean-tide:
hough weary waves are sunk to rest,
here's none within his rider's breast;
nd though to-morrow's tempest lower,
is calmer than thy heart, young Giaour!^[66]190
know thee not, I loathe thy race,
ut in thy lineaments I trace
That Time shall strengthen, not efface:
hough young and pale, that sallow front
scathed by fiery Passion's brunt;
hough bent on earth thine evil eye,^[cu]
s meteor-like thou glidest by,
ight well I view and deem thee one
Whom Othman's sons should slay or shun.

On—on he hastened, and he drew²⁰⁰
ly gaze of wonder as he flew:^[cv]
hough like a Demon of the night

he passed, and vanished from my sight,
his aspect and his air impressed
his troubled memory on my breast,
and long upon my startled ear
hung his dark courser's hoofs of fear.
He spurs his steed; he nears the steep,
that, jutting, shadows o'er the deep;
he winds around; he hurries by;²¹⁰
the rock relieves him from mine eye;
or, well I ween, unwelcome he
whose glance is fixed on those that flee;
and not a star but shines too bright
on him who takes such timeless flight.^[cw]
He wound along; but ere he passed
his glance he snatched, as if his last,
his moment checked his wheeling steed,^[67]
his moment breathed him from his speed,
his moment on his stirrup stood—²²⁰
Why looks he o'er the olive wood?^[cx]
The Crescent glimmers on the hill,
the Mosque's high lamps are quivering still
though too remote for sound to wake
his echoes of the far tophaike,^[68]
the flashes of each joyous peal
are seen to prove the Moslem's zeal.
O-night, set Rhamazani's sun;
O-night, the Bairam feast's begun;
O-night—but who and what art thou²³⁰
of foreign garb and fearful brow?
and what are these to thine or thee,
that thou shouldst either pause or flee?

He stood—some dread was on his face,
soon Hatred settled in its place:
rose not with the reddening flush
of transient Anger's hasty blush,^{[cy][69]}
but pale as marble o'er the tomb,
whose ghastly whiteness aids its gloom.
His brow was bent, his eye was glazed;²⁴⁰
he raised his arm, and fiercely raised,
and sternly shook his hand on high,
as doubting to return or fly;^[cz]
impatient of his flight delayed,
where loud his raven charger neighed—
he glanced that hand, and grasped his blade;
that sound had burst his waking dream,
as Slumber starts at owl's scream.
The spur hath lanced his courser's sides;
away—away—for life he rides:²⁵⁰
swift as the hurled on high jerreed^[70]
springs to the touch his startled steed;
the rock is doubled, and the shore
shakes with the clattering tramp no more;
the crag is won, no more is seen
his Christian crest and haughty mien.
'Twas but an instant he restrained
that fiery barb so sternly reined;^[da]
'Twas but a moment that he stood,
when sped as if by Death pursued;²⁶⁰
but in that instant o'er his soul
whirlwinds of Memory seemed to roll,
and gather in that drop of time
a life of pain, an age of crime.

'er him who loves, or hates, or fears,
uch moment pours the grief of years:^[db]
hat felt *he* then, at once opprest
y all that most distracts the breast?
hat pause, which pondered o'er his fate,
h, who its dreary length shall date!²⁷⁰
hough in Time's record nearly nought,
was Eternity to Thought!^[71]
or infinite as boundless space
he thought that Conscience must embrace,
hich in itself can comprehend
oe without name, or hope, or end.^[72]

The hour is past, the Giaour is gone:
nd did he fly or fall alone?^[dc]
oe to that hour he came or went!
he curse for Hassan's sin was sent²⁸⁰
o turn a palace to a tomb;
e came, he went, like the Simoom,^[73]
hat harbinger of Fate and gloom,
eneath whose widely-wasting breath
he very cypress droops to death—
x tree, still sad when others' grief is fled,
only constant mourner o'er the dead!

The steed is vanished from the stall;
o serf is seen in Hassan's hall;
he lonely Spider's thin gray pall^[dd]²⁹⁰
aves slowly widening o'er the wall;
he Bat builds in his Haram bower,^[74]
nd in the fortress of his power

he Owl usurps the beacon-tower;
he wild-dog howls o'er the fountain's brim,
With baffled thirst, and famine, grim;
the stream has shrunk from its marble bed,
where the weeds and the desolate dust are spread.
'twas sweet of yore to see it play
and chase the sultriness of day,³⁰⁰
as springing high the silver dew^[de]
it whirls fantastically flew,
and flung luxurious coolness round
the air, and verdure o'er the ground.
'twas sweet, when cloudless stars were bright,
to view the wave of watery light,
and hear its melody by night.
and oft had Hassan's Childhood played
round the verge of that cascade;
and oft upon his mother's breast³¹⁰
that sound had harmonized his rest;
and oft had Hassan's Youth along
its bank been soothed by Beauty's song;
and softer seemed each melting tone
of Music mingled with its own.
but ne'er shall Hassan's Age repose
along the brink at Twilight's close:
the stream that filled that font is fled—
the blood that warmed his heart is shed!^[df]
and here no more shall human voice³²⁰
be heard to rage, regret, rejoice.
the last sad note that swelled the gale
was woman's wildest funeral wail:
that quenched in silence, all is still,

ut the lattice that flaps when the wind is shrill:
hough raves the gust, and floods the rain,
o hand shall close its clasp again.
n desert sands 'twere joy to scan
he rudest steps of fellow man,
o here the very voice of Grief³³⁰
light wake an Echo like relief—^[dg]
t least 'twould say, "All are not gone;
here lingers Life, though but in one"—^[dh]
or many a gilded chamber's there,
hich Solitude might well forbear;^[75]
ithin that dome as yet Decay
ath slowly worked her cankering way—
ut gloom is gathered o'er the gate,
or there the Fakir's self will wait;
or there will wandering Dervise stay,³⁴⁰
or Bounty cheers not his delay;
or there will weary stranger halt
o bless the sacred "bread and salt."^{[di][76]}
Alike must Wealth and Poverty
Pass heedless and unheeded by,
For Courtesy and Pity died
With Hassan on the mountain side.
His roof, that refuge unto men,
Is Desolation's hungry den.
guest flies the hall, and the vassal from labour,³⁵⁰
e his turban was cleft by the infidel's sabre!^{[dj][77]}

I hear the sound of coming feet,
But not a voice mine ear to greet;

More near—each turban I can scan,
And silver-sheathèd ataghan;^[78]
The foremost of the band is seen
An Emir by his garb of green:^[79]
! who art thou?"—"This low salam^[80]
lies of Moslem faith I am.^[dk]
burthen ye so gently bear,³⁶⁰
ns one that claims your utmost care,
, doubtless, holds some precious freight—
humble bark would gladly wait."^[dl]

Thou speakest sooth: thy skiff unmoor,
waft us from the silent shore;
, leave the sail still furled, and ply
nearest oar that's scattered by,
midway to those rocks where sleep
channelled waters dark and deep.
: from your task—so—bravely done,³⁷⁰
course has been right swiftly run;
'tis the longest voyage, I trow,
t one of—^[81] * * * "

ullen it plunged, and slowly sank,
calm wave rippled to the bank;
atched it as it sank, methought
ie motion from the current caught
irred it more,—'twas but the beam
t checkered o'er the living stream:
zed, till vanishing from view,³⁸⁰
e lessening pebble it withdrew;
less and less, a speck of white

It gemmed the tide, then mocked the sight;
All its hidden secrets sleep,
Known but to Genii of the deep,
Which, trembling in their coral caves,
Dare not whisper to the waves.

It rises on its purple wing
Insect-queen^[82] of Eastern spring,
Emerald meadows of Kashmeer³⁹⁰
Takes the young pursuer near,
Leads him on from flower to flower
Early chase and wasted hour,
Then leaves him, as it soars on high,
With panting heart and tearful eye:
Beauty lures the full-grown child,
With hue as bright, and wing as wild:
Rise of idle hopes and fears,
Run in folly, closed in tears.
Then, to equal ills betrayed,^[dm]⁴⁰⁰
It waits the insect and the maid;
Pain of pain, the loss of peace;
In infant's play, and man's caprice:
The lovely toy so fiercely sought
Which lost its charm by being caught,
Every touch that wooed its stay
Which brushed its brightest hues away,
Charm, and hue, and beauty gone,
Left to fly or fall alone.
The wounded wing, or bleeding breast,⁴¹⁰
Where shall either victim rest?
This with faded pinion soar

n rose to tulip as before?
Beauty, blighted in an hour,
l joy within her broken bower?
gayer insects fluttering by
r droop the wing o'er those that die,
lovelier things have mercy shown
very failing but their own,
every woe a tear can claim⁴²⁰
ept an erring Sister's shame.

Mind, that broods o'er guilty woes,
like the Scorpion girt by fire;
ircle narrowing as it glows,^[dn]
flames around their captive close,
inly searched by thousand throes,
nd maddening in her ire,
sad and sole relief she knows—
sting she nourished for her foes,
ose venom never yet was vain,⁴³⁰
es but one pang, and cures all pain,
darts into her desperate brain:
lo the dark in soul expire,
ive like Scorpion girt by fire;^[83]
vrithes the mind Remorse hath riven,^[do]
it for earth, undoomed for heaven,
kness above, despair beneath,
und it flame, within it death!

lack Hassan from the Haram flies,
bends on woman's form his eyes;⁴⁴⁰

unwonted chase each hour employs,
shares he not the hunter's joys.
thus was Hassan wont to fly
when Leila dwelt in his Serai.
When Leila there no longer dwell?
That tale can only Hassan tell:
Huge rumours in our city say
That that eve she fled away
When Rhamazan's^[84] last sun was set,
Flashing from each Minaret⁴⁵⁰
Thousands of lamps proclaimed the feast
Bairam through the boundless East.
As then she went as to the bath,
Which Hassan vainly searched in wrath;
She was flown her master's rage
Fierceness of a Georgian page,
Far beyond the Moslem's power
Who wronged him with the faithless Giaour.
How much of this had Hassan deemed;
Still so fond, so fair she seemed,⁴⁶⁰
Well he trusted to the slave
Whose treachery deserved a grave:
When that eve had gone to Mosque,
Whence to feast in his Kiosk.
That is the tale his Nubians tell,
Who did not watch their charge too well;
Others say, that on that night,
The pale Phingari's^[85] trembling light,
The Giaour upon his jet-black steed
Was seen, but seen alone to speed⁴⁷⁰
On bloody spur along the shore,

maid nor page behind him bore.

Her eye's dark charm 'twere vain to tell,
gaze on that of the Gazelle,
will assist thy fancy well;
large, as languishingly dark,
Soul beamed forth in every spark
that darted from beneath the lid,
bright as the jewel of Giamschid.^[86]
O Soul, and should our prophet say⁴⁸⁰
that form was nought but breathing clay,
Alas! I would answer nay;
though on Al-Sirat's^[87] arch I stood,
which totters o'er the fiery flood,
in Paradise within my view,
shall his Houris beckoning through.
Who young Leila's glance could read
shall keep that portion of his creed
which saith that woman is but dust,
a useless toy for tyrant's lust?^[88]⁴⁹⁰
Her might Muftis gaze, and own
that through her eye the Immortal shone;
Her fair cheek's unfading hue
as young pomegranate's^[89] blossoms strew
their bloom in blushes ever new;
Her hair in hyacinthine flow,^[90]
when left to roll its folds below,
amidst her handmaids in the hall
stood superior to them all,
in swept the marble where her feet⁵⁰⁰

amed whiter than the mountain sleet
from the cloud that gave it birth
ll, and caught one stain of earth.
cygnet nobly walks the water;
noved on earth Circassia's daughter,
loveliest bird of Franguestan!^[91]
ears her crest the ruffled Swan,
nd spurns the wave with wings of pride,
en pass the steps of stranger man
long the banks that bound her tide;⁵¹⁰
s rose fair Leila's whiter neck:—
s armed with beauty would she check
sion's glance, till Folly's gaze
nk from the charms it meant to praise.
s high and graceful was her gait;
heart as tender to her mate;
mate—stern Hassan, who was he?
s! that name was not for thee!^[92]

tern Hassan hath a journey ta'en
n twenty vassals in his train,⁵²⁰
n armed, as best becomes a man,
n arquebuss and ataghan;
chief before, as decked for war,
rs in his belt the scimitar
ned with the best of Arnaut blood,
en in the pass the rebels stood,
few returned to tell the tale
what befell in Parne's vale.
pistols which his girdle bore
e those that once a Pasha wore,⁵³⁰

ch still, though gemmed and bossed with gold,
n robbers tremble to behold.
said he goes to woo a bride
e true than her who left his side;
faithless slave that broke her bower,
—worse than faithless—for a Giaour!

he sun's last rays are on the hill,
sparkle in the fountain rill,
ose welcome waters, cool and clear,
w blessings from the mountaineer:⁵⁴⁰
e may the loitering merchant Greek
l that repose 'twere vain to seek
ities lodged too near his lord,
trembling for his secret hoard—
e may he rest where none can see,
rowds a slave, in deserts free;
with forbidden wine may stain
bowl a Moslem must not drain

he foremost Tartar's in the gap
spicuous by his yellow cap;⁵⁵⁰
rest in lengthening line the while
d slowly through the long defile:
ve, the mountain rears a peak,
ere vultures whet the thirsty beak,
theirs may be a feast to-night,
l tempt them down ere morrow's light;
eath, a river's wintry stream
shrunk before the summer beam,
left a channel bleak and bare,

the shrubs that spring to perish there:560
on side the midway path there lay
all broken crags of granite gray,
time, or mountain lightning, riven
on summits clad in mists of heaven;
where is he that hath beheld
peak of Liakura^[93] unveiled?

they reach the grove of pine at last;
millah!^[94] now the peril's past;
yonder view the opening plain,
there we'll prick our steeds amain:"570
Chiaus^[95] spake, and as he said,
illet whistled o'er his head;
foremost Tartar bites the ground!
scarce had they time to check the rein,
ft from their steeds the riders bound;
but three shall never mount again:
even the foes that gave the wound,
he dying ask revenge in vain.
on steel unsheathed, and carbine bent,
lie o'er their courser's harness leant,580
half sheltered by the steed;
lie fly beneath the nearest rock,
there await the coming shock,
or tamely stand to bleed
neath the shaft of foes unseen,
do dare not quit their craggy screen.
on Hassan only from his horse
lains to light, and keeps his course,
fiery flashes in the van

claim too sure the robber-clan⁵⁹⁰
e well secured the only way
ld now avail the promised prey;
n curled his very beard^[96] with ire,
glared his eye with fiercer fire;
ough far and near the bullets hiss,
scaped a bloodier hour than this."
now the foe their covert quit,
call his vassals to submit;
Hassan's frown and furious word
dreaded more than hostile sword,⁶⁰⁰
of his little band a man
igned carbine or ataghan,
raised the craven cry, Amaun!^[97]
iller sight, more near and near,
lately ambushed foes appear,
, issuing from the grove, advance
ie who on battle-charger prance.
o leads them on with foreign brand
flashing in his red right hand?
; he!'tis he! I know him now;⁶¹⁰
ow him by his pallid brow;
ow him by the evil eye^[98]
t aids his envious treachery;
ow him by his jet-black barb;
ugh now arrayed in Arnaut garb,
state from his own vile faith,
all not save him from the death:
he! well met in any hour,
: Leila's love—accursed Giaour!"

s rolls the river into Ocean,^[99]620
able torrent wildly streaming;
s the sea-tide's opposing motion,
zure column proudly gleaming,
ts back the current many a rood,
urling foam and mingling flood,
le eddying whirl, and breaking wave,
sed by the blast of winter, rave;
ough sparkling spray, in thundering clash,
lightnings of the waters flash
wful whiteness o'er the shore,630
t shines and shakes beneath the roar;
s—as the stream and Ocean greet,
n waves that madden as they meet—
s join the bands, whom mutual wrong,
fate, and fury, drive along.
bickering sabres' shivering jar;
nd pealing wide or ringing near
s echoes on the throbbing ear,
deathshot hissing from afar;
shock, the shout, the groan of war,640
everberate along that vale,
lore suited to the shepherd's tale:
ugh few the numbers—theirs the strife,
t neither spares nor speaks for life!^[dp]
fondly youthful hearts can press,
eize and share the dear caress;
Love itself could never pant
all that Beauty sighs to grant
n half the fervour Hate bestows
n the last embrace of foes,650

en grappling in the fight they fold
se arms that ne'er shall lose their hold:
nds meet to part; Love laughs at faith;
e foes, once met, are joined till death!

With sabre shivered to the hilt,
dripping with the blood he spilt;
strained within the severed hand
ch quivers round that faithless brand;
turban far behind him rolled,
cleft in twain its firmest fold;⁶⁶⁰
flowing robe by falchion torn,
crimson as those clouds of morn
t, streaked with dusky red, portend
day shall have a stormy end;
ain on every bush that bore
agment of his palampore;^[100]
breast with wounds unnumbered riven,
back to earth, his face to Heaven,
n Hassan lies—his unclosed eye
lowering on his enemy,⁶⁷⁰
f the hour that sealed his fate^[101]
iving left his quenchless hate;
o'er him bends that foe with brow
lark as his that bled below.

Yes, Leila sleeps beneath the wave,
his shall be a redder grave;
spirit pointed well the steel
ch taught that felon heart to feel.

called the Prophet, but his power
vain against the vengeful Giaour:⁶⁸⁰
called on Alla—but the word
se unheeded or unheard.
O Paynim fool! could Leila's prayer
pass, and thine accorded there?
I stiched my time, I leagued with these,
traitor in his turn to seize;
wrath is wreaked, the deed is done,
now I go—but go alone."

he browsing camels' bells are tinkling:^[dq]
mother looked from her lattice high—^[102]⁶⁹⁰
he saw the dews of eve besprinkling
pasture green beneath her eye,
he saw the planets faintly twinkling:
twilight—sure his train is nigh."
could not rest in the garden-bower,
gazed through the grate of his steepest tower.
Why comes he not? his steeds are fleet,
shrink they from the summer heat;
Why sends not the Bridegroom his promised gift?
Is heart more cold, or his barb less swift?⁷⁰⁰
false reproach! yon Tartar now
gained our nearest mountain's brow,
warily the steep descends,
now within the valley bends;^[dr]
he bears the gift at his saddle bow—
Why could I deem his courser slow?^[ds]
It well my largess shall repay

welcome speed, and weary way."

he Tartar lighted at the gate,
scarce upheld his fainting weight!^[dt]₇₁₀
swarthy visage spake distress,
this might be from weariness;
garb with sanguine spots was dyed,
these might be from his courser's side;
lrew the token from his vest—
el of Death! 'tis Hassan's cloven crest!
calpac^[103] rent—his caftan red—
ly, a fearful bride thy Son hath wed:
not from mercy, did they spare,
this empurpled pledge to bear.₇₂₀
e to the brave! whose blood is spilt:
e to the Giaour! for his the guilt."

. Turban^[104] carved in coarsest stone,
llar with rank weeds o'ergrown,
reon can now be scarcely read
Koran verse that mourns the dead,
it out the spot where Hassan fell
ctim in that lonely dell.
re sleeps as true an Osmanlie
'er at Mecca bent the knee;₇₃₀
ver scorned forbidden wine,
rayed with face towards the shrine,
risons resumed anew
olemn sound of "Alla Hu!"^[105]
died he by a stranger's hand,
. stranger in his native land;

died he as in arms he stood,
unavenged, at least in blood.
him the maids of Paradise
npatient to their halls invite,⁷⁴⁰
the dark heaven of Houris' eyes
n him shall glance for ever bright;
y come—their kerchiefs green they wave,^[106]
welcome with a kiss the brave!
o falls in battle 'gainst a Giaour
orthiest an immortal bower.

ut thou, false Infidel! shall writhe
eath avenging Monkir's^[107] scythe;
from its torments 'scape alone
vander round lost Eblis'^[108] throne;⁷⁵⁰
fire unquenched, unquenchable,
und, within, thy heart shall dwell;
ear can hear nor tongue can tell
tortures of that inward hell!
first, on earth as Vampire^[109] sent,
corse shall from its tomb be rent:
n ghastly haunt thy native place,
suck the blood of all thy race;
re from thy daughter, sister, wife,
midnight drain the stream of life;⁷⁶⁰
loathe the banquet which perforce
it feed thy livid living corse:
victims ere they yet expire
I know the demon for their sire,
cursing thee, thou cursing them,
flowers are withered on the stem.

one that for thy crime must fall,
youngest, most beloved of all,
I bless thee with a *father's* name—
that word shall wrap thy heart in flame!⁷⁷⁰
must thou end thy task, and mark
cheek's last tinge, her eye's last spark,
the last glassy glance must view
which freezes o'er its lifeless blue;
and with unhallowed hand shalt tear
tresses of her yellow hair,
which in life a lock when shorn
protection's fondest pledge was worn,
now is borne away by thee,
memorial of thine agony!⁷⁸⁰
with thine own best blood shall drip
gnashing tooth and haggard lip;^[110]
and stalking to thy sullen grave,
—and with Gouls and Afrits rave;
these in horror shrink away
and Spectre more accursed than they!

How name ye yon lone Caloyer?^[111]
his features I have scanned before
mine own land: 'tis many a year,
since, dashing by the lonely shore,⁷⁹⁰
I saw him urge as fleet a steed
never served a horseman's need.
once I saw that face, yet then
as so marked with inward pain,
I could not pass it by again;
I breathe the same dark spirit now,

leath were stamped upon his brow.^[du]

; twice three years at summer tide
ince first among our freres he came;
. here it soothes him to abide⁸⁰⁰
or some dark deed he will not name.
never at our Vesper prayer,
e'er before Confession chair
els he, nor recks he when arise
nse or anthem to the skies,
broods within his cell alone,
faith and race alike unknown.
sea from Paynim land he crost,
. here ascended from the coast;
seems he not of Othman race,⁸¹⁰
only Christian in his face:
udge him some stray renegade,
enantant of the change he made,
e that he shuns our holy shrine,
tastes the sacred bread and wine.
at largess to these walls he brought,
. thus our Abbot's favour bought;
were I Prior, not a day
uld brook such stranger's further stay,
ent within our penance cell⁸²⁰
uld doom him there for aye to dwell.
h in his visions mutters he
naiden whelmed beneath the sea;^[dv]
abres clashing, foemen flying,
ngs avenged, and Moslem dying.
cliff he hath been known to stand,
. rave as to some bloody hand

h severed from its parent limb,
sible to all but him,
ch beckons onward to his grave,⁸³⁰
lures to leap into the wave."

ark and unearthly is the scowl
t glares beneath his dusky cowl:
flash of that dilating eye
eals too much of times gone by;
ugh varying, indistinct its hue,
with his glance the gazer rue,
in it lurks that nameless spell,
ch speaks, itself unspeakable,
irit yet unquelled and high,⁸⁴⁰
t claims and keeps ascendancy;
like the bird whose pinions quake,
cannot fly the gazing snake,
others quail beneath his look,
'scape the glance they scarce can brook.
n him the half-affrighted Friar
en met alone would fain retire,
f that eye and bitter smile
isferred to others fear and guile:
oft to smile descendeth he,⁸⁵⁰
when he doth 'tis sad to see
t he but mocks at Misery.
v that pale lip will curl and quiver!
n fix once more as if for ever;
f his sorrow or disdain
made him e'er to smile again.

l were it so—such ghastly mirth
n joyaunce ne'er derived its birth.
sadder still it were to trace
at once were feelings in that face:860
e hath not yet the features fixed,
brighter traits with evil mixed;
there are hues not always faded,
ch speak a mind not all degraded
n by the crimes through which it waded:
common crowd but see the gloom
vayward deeds, and fitting doom;
close observer can espy
oble soul, and lineage high:
s! though both bestowed in vain,870
ch Grief could change, and Guilt could stain,
as no vulgar tenement
which such lofty gifts were lent,
still with little less than dread
such the sight is riveted.
roofless cot, decayed and rent,
ill scarce delay the passer-by;
tower by war or tempest bent,
le yet may frown one battlement,
emands and daunts the stranger's eye;880
n ivied arch, and pillar lone,
ds haughtily for glories gone!
floating robe around him folding,
low sweeps he through the columned aisle;
n dread beheld, with gloom beholding
he rites that sanctify the pile.
when the anthem shakes the choir,
kneel the monks, his steps retire;

under lone and wavering torch
aspect glares within the porch;890
re will he pause till all is done—
hear the prayer, but utter none.
—by the half-illumin'd wall^[dw]
hood fly back, his dark hair fall,
t pale brow wildly wreathing round,
f the Gorgon there had bound
sablest of the serpent-braid
t o'er her fearful forehead strayed:
he declines the convent oath,
leaves those locks unhallowed growth,900
wears our garb in all beside;
, not from piety but pride,
as wealth to walls that never heard
his one holy vow nor word.
—mark ye, as the harmony^[dx]
s louder praises to the sky,
t livid cheek, that stony air
nix'd defiance and despair!
t Francis, keep him from the shrine!^[dy]
may we dread the wrath divine910
le manifest by awful sign.
er evil angel bore
form of mortal, such he wore;
all my hope of sins forgiven,
a looks are not of earth nor heaven!"

o Love the softest hearts are prone,
such can ne'er be all his own;
timid in his woes to share,
meek to meet, or brave despair;

. sterner hearts alone may feel⁹²⁰
wound that Time can never heal.
rugged metal of the mine
it burn before its surface shine,^{[dz][112]}
plunged within the furnace-flame,
ends and melts—though still the same;
n tempered to thy want, or will,
ll serve thee to defend or kill—
east-plate for thine hour of need,
blade to bid thy foeman bleed;
if a dagger's form it bear,⁹³⁰
those who shape its edge, beware!
s Passion's fire, and Woman's art,
turn and tame the sterner heart;
n these its form and tone are ta'en,
. what they make it, must remain,
break—before it bend again.

solitude succeed to grief,
ease from pain is slight relief;
vacant bosom's wilderness
ht thank the pang that made it less.^[113]⁹⁴⁰
loathe what none are left to share:
n bliss—'twere woe alone to bear;
heart once left thus desolate
it fly at last for ease—to hate.
as if the dead could feel^[114]
icy worm around them steal,
. shudder, as the reptiles creep
evel o'er their rotting sleep,

out the power to scare away
cold consumers of their clay!⁹⁵⁰
as if the desert bird,^[115]
Whose beak unlocks her bosom's stream
to still her famished nestlings' scream,
mourns a life to them transferred,
would rend her rash devoted breast,
to find them flown her empty nest.
keenest pangs the wretched find
in rapture to the dreary void,
leafless desert of the mind,
the waste of feelings unemployed.⁹⁶⁰
who would be doomed to gaze upon
day without a cloud or sun?
hideous far the tempest's roar,
than ne'er to brave the billows more—^[ea]
down, when the war of winds is o'er,
nearly wreck on Fortune's shore,
all sullen calm, and silent bay,
soon to drop by dull decay;—
or to sink beneath the shock
and moulder piecemeal on the rock!⁹⁷⁰

Father! thy, days have passed in peace,
'Mid counted beads, and countless prayer;
to bid the sins of others cease,
Thyself without a crime or care,
have transient ills that all must bear,
has been thy lot from youth to age;
and thou wilt bless thee from the rage
of passions fierce and uncontrolled,

uch as thy penitents unfold,
hose secret sins and sorrows rest⁹⁸⁰
ithin thy pure and pitying breast.
y days, though few, have passed below
much of Joy, but more of Woe;
et still in hours of love or strife,
ve 'scaped the weariness of Life:
ow leagued with friends, now girt by foes,
loathed the languor of repose.
ow nothing left to love or hate,
o more with hope or pride elate,
d rather be the thing that crawls⁹⁹⁰
lost noxious o'er a dungeon's walls,^[116]
han pass my dull, unvarying days,
ondemned to meditate and gaze.
et, lurks a wish within my breast
or rest—but not to feel 'tis rest.
oon shall my Fate that wish fulfil;
And I shall sleep without the dream
f what I was, and would be still
Dark as to thee my deeds may seem:^[eb]
y memory now is but the tomb¹⁰⁰⁰
f joys long dead; my hope, their doom:
hough better to have died with those
han bear a life of lingering woes.
y spirit shrunk not to sustain
he searching throes of ceaseless pain;
or sought the self-accorded grave
f ancient fool and modern knave:
et death I have not feared to meet;
nd in the field it had been sweet,

ad Danger wooed me on to move¹⁰¹⁰
he slave of Glory, not of Love.
ve braved it—not for Honour's boast;
smile at laurels won or lost;
o such let others carve their way,
or high renown, or hireling pay:
ut place again before my eyes
ught that I deem a worthy prize—
he maid I love, the man I hate—
nd I will hunt the steps of fate,
o save or slay, as these require,¹⁰²⁰
hrough rending steel, and rolling fire:^[ec]
or needst thou doubt this speech from one
Who would but do—what he *hath* done.
eath is but what the haughty brave,
he weak must bear, the wretch must crave;
hen let life go to Him who gave:
have not quailed to Danger's brow
When high and happy—need I *now*?

I loved her, Friar! nay, adored—
But these are words that all can use—¹⁰³⁰
proved it more in deed than word;
here's blood upon that dinted sword,
A stain its steel can never lose:
Was shed for her, who died for me,
It warmed the heart of one abhorred:
ay, start not—no—nor bend thy knee,
Nor midst my sin such act record;
hou wilt absolve me from the deed,
or he was hostile to thy creed!

he very name of Nazarene¹⁰⁴⁰
/as wormwood to his Paynim spleen.
ngrateful fool! since but for brands
/ell wielded in some hardy hands,
nd wounds by Galileans given—
he surest pass to Turkish heaven—
or him his Houris still might wait
npatient at the Prophet's gate.
loved her—Love will find its way
hrough paths where wolves would fear to prey;
nd if it dares enough, 'twere hard¹⁰⁵⁰
Passion met not some reward—
o matter how, or where, or why,
did not vainly seek, nor sigh:
et sometimes, with remorse, in vain
wish she had not loved again.
he died—I dare not tell thee how;
ut look—'tis written on my brow!
here read of Cain the curse and crime,
i characters unworn by Time:
till, ere thou dost condemn me, pause;¹⁰⁶⁰
ot mine the act, though I the cause.
et did he but what I had done
ad she been false to more than one.
aithless to him—he gave the blow;
ut true to me—I laid him low:
owe'er deserved her doom might be,
er treachery was truth to me;
o me she gave her heart, that all
/hich Tyranny can ne'er enthrall;
nd I, alas! too late to save!¹⁰⁷⁰
et all I then could give, I gave—

'was some relief—our foe a grave.^[ed]
is death sits lightly; but her fate
as made me—what thou well mayst hate.
His doom was sealed—he knew it well,
/arned by the voice of stern Taheer,
eep in whose darkly boding ear^[117]
he deathshot pealed of murder near,
As filed the troop to where they fell!
e died too in the battle broil,¹⁰⁸⁰
time that heeds nor pain nor toil;
ne cry to Mahomet for aid,
ne prayer to Alla all he made:
e knew and crossed me in the fray—
gazed upon him where he lay,
nd watched his spirit ebb away:
hough pierced like pard by hunter's steel,
e felt not half that now I feel.
searched, but vainly searched, to find
he workings of a wounded mind;¹⁰⁹⁰
ach feature of that sullen corse
etrayed his rage, but no remorse.^[118]
h, what had Vengeance given to trace
espair upon his dying face!
he late repentance of that hour
/hen Penitence hath lost her power
o tear one terror from the grave,^[ee]
nd will not soothe, and cannot save.

The cold in clime are cold in blood,
heir love can scarce deserve the name;¹¹⁰⁰
ut mine was like the lava flood

That boils in Ætna's breast of flame.
cannot prate in puling strain
of Ladye-love, and Beauty's chain:
changing cheek, and scorching vein,^[ef]
lips taught to writhe, but not complain,
bursting heart, and maddening brain,
and daring deed, and vengeful steel,
and all that I have felt, and feel,
etoken love—that love was mine,¹¹¹⁰
and shown by many a bitter sign.
'tis true, I could not whine nor sigh,
knew but to obtain or die.
die—but first I have possessed,
and come what may, I *have been* blessed.
shall I the doom I sought upbraid?
no—reft of all, yet undismayed^[eg]
but for the thought of Leila slain,
give me the pleasure with the pain,
no would I live and love again.¹¹²⁰
grieve, but not, my holy Guide!
for him who dies, but her who died:
he sleeps beneath the wandering wave—
ah! had she but an earthly grave,
his breaking heart and throbbing head
should seek and share her narrow bed.
he was a form of Life and Light,^[119]
that, seen, became a part of sight;
and rose, where'er I turned mine eye,
the Morning-star of Memory!¹¹³⁰

Yes, Love indeed is light from heaven;^{[eh][120]}

A spark of that immortal fire
With angels shared, by Alia given,
To lift from earth our low desire.
Devotion wafts the mind above,
And Heaven itself descends in Love;
The feeling from the Godhead caught,
To wean from self each sordid thought;
The ray of Him who formed the whole;
The Glory circling round the soul!¹¹⁴⁰
Grant *my* love imperfect, all
That mortals by the name miscall;
When deem it evil, what thou wilt;
But say, oh say, *hers* was not Guilt!
He was my Life's unerring Light:
That quenched—what beam shall break my night?^[ei]
Oh! would it shone to lead me still,
Although to death or deadliest ill!
Why marvel ye, if they who lose
This present joy, this future hope,¹¹⁵⁰
No more with Sorrow meekly cope;
Imprehensy then their fate accuse;
Or madness do those fearful deeds
That seem to add but Guilt to Woe?
Alas! the breast that inly bleeds
Hath nought to dread from outward blow:
Who falls from all he knows of bliss,
Pours little into what abyss.^[ej]
Fierce as the gloomy vulture's now
To thee, old man, my deeds appear:¹¹⁶⁰
Read abhorrence on thy brow,
And this too was I born to bear!

'is true, that, like that bird of prey,
With havock have I marked my way:
But this was taught me by the dove,
To die—and know no second love.
His lesson yet hath man to learn,
Taught by the thing he dares to spurn:
The bird that sings within the brake,
The swan that swims upon the lake,¹¹⁷⁰
One mate, and one alone, will take.
And let the fool still prone to range,^[ek]
And sneer on all who cannot change,
Partake his jest with boasting boys;
Envy not his varied joys,
But deem such feeble, heartless man,
Less than yon solitary swan;
Far, far beneath the shallow maid^[el]
He left believing and betrayed.
Much shame at least was never mine—¹¹⁸⁰
Woe! each thought was only thine!
My good, my guilt, my weal, my woe,
My hope on high—my all below.
Each holds no other like to thee,
Nor, if it doth, in vain for me:
For worlds I dare not view the dame
Resembling thee, yet not the same.
The very crimes that mar my youth,
His bed of death—attest my truth!
'is all too late—thou wert, thou art¹¹⁹⁰
He cherished madness of my heart!^[em]

And she was lost—and yet I breathed,
But not the breath of human life:

. serpent round my heart was wreathed,
And stung my every thought to strife.
like all time, abhorred all place,^[en]
huddering I shrank from Nature's face,
/here every hue that charmed before
he blackness of my bosom wore.
he rest thou dost already know,¹²⁰⁰
nd all my sins, and half my woe.
ut talk no more of penitence;
hou seest I soon shall part from hence:
nd if thy holy tale were true,
he deed that's done canst *thou* undo?
hink me not thankless—but this grief
ooks not to priesthood for relief.^{[eo][121]}
ly soul's estate in secret guess:
ut wouldst thou pity more, say less.
/hen thou canst bid my Leila live,¹²¹⁰
hen will I sue thee to forgive;
hen plead my cause in that high place
/here purchased masses proffer grace.^[ep]
o, when the hunter's hand hath wrung
rom forest-cave her shrieking young,
nd calm the lonely lioness:
soothe not—mock not *my* distress!

n earlier days, and calmer hours,
When heart with heart delights to blend,
/here bloom my native valley's bowers,^{[eq] 1220}
I had—Ah! have I now?—a friend!^[er]
o him this pledge I charge thee send,^[es]
Memorial of a youthful vow;

would remind him of my end:

Though souls absorbed like mine allow
rief thought to distant Friendship's claim,
et dear to him my blighted name.

'is strange—he prophesied my doom,

And I have smiled—I then could smile—
hen Prudence would his voice assume,¹²³⁰

And warn—I recked not what—the while:
ut now Remembrance whispers o'er^[et]
hose accents scarcely marked before.

ay—that his bodings came to pass,

And he will start to hear their truth,
And wish his words had not been sooth:
ell him—unheeding as I was,

Through many a busy bitter scene
Of all our golden youth had been,
pain, my faltering tongue had tried¹²⁴⁰

o bless his memory—ere I died;
ut Heaven in wrath would turn away,

Guilt should for the guiltless pray.

do not ask him not to blame,
oo gentle he to wound my name;
nd what have I to do with Fame?

do not ask him not to mourn,
uch cold request might sound like scorn;
nd what than Friendship's manly tear
lay better grace a brother's bier?¹²⁵⁰

ut bear this ring, his own of old,
nd tell him—what thou dost behold!
he withered frame, the ruined mind,
he wrack by passion left behind,
. shrivelled scroll, a scattered leaf,

heard by the autumn blast of Grief!

"Tell me no more of Fancy's gleam,
O, father, no, 'twas not a dream;
Alas! the dreamer first must sleep,
Only watched, and wished to weep;¹²⁶⁰
But could not, for my burning brow
Hobbed to the very brain as now:
Wished but for a single tear,
As something welcome, new, and dear:
Wished it then, I wish it still;
Despair is stronger than my will.
Taste not thine orison, despair^[eu]
More mightier than thy pious prayer:
Would not, if I might, be blest;
Want no Paradise, but rest.¹²⁷⁰
'Twas then—I tell thee—father! then
Saw her; yes, she lived again;
And shining in her white symar^[122]
As through yon pale gray cloud the star
Which now I gaze on, as on her,
Who looked and looks far lovelier;
Dimly I view its trembling spark;^[ev]
To-morrow's night shall be more dark;
And I, before its rays appear,
That lifeless thing the living fear.¹²⁸⁰
Wander—father! for my soul
Is fleeting towards the final goal.
Saw her—friar! and I rose
Forgetful of our former woes;
And rushing from my couch, I dart,

nd clasp her to my desperate heart;
clasp—what is it that I clasp?
o breathing form within my grasp,
o heart that beats reply to mine—
et, Leila! yet the form is thine!1290
nd art thou, dearest, changed so much
s meet my eye, yet mock my touch?
h! were thy beauties e'er so cold,
care not—so my arms enfold
he all they ever wished to hold.
las! around a shadow prest
hey shrink upon my lonely breast;
et still 'tis there! In silence stands,
nd beckons with beseeching hands!
With braided hair, and bright-black eye—1300
knew 'twas false—she could not die!
ut *he* is dead! within the dell
saw him buried where he fell;
e comes not—for he cannot break
rom earth;—why then art *thou* awake?
hey told me wild waves rolled above
he face I view—the form I love;
hey told me—'twas a hideous tale!—
d tell it, but my tongue would fail:
true, and from thine ocean-cave1310
hou com'st to claim a calmer grave,
h! pass thy dewy fingers o'er
his brow that then will burn no more;
r place them on my hopeless heart:
ut, Shape or Shade! whate'er thou art,
i mercy ne'er again depart!
r farther with thee bear my soul

han winds can waft or waters roll!

Such is my name, and such my tale.

Confessor! to thy secret ear¹³²⁰

breathe the sorrows I bewail,

And thank thee for the generous tear
his glazing eye could never shed.

hen lay me with the humblest dead,^[ew]

nd, save the cross above my head,

e neither name nor emblem spread,

y prying stranger to be read,

r stay the passing pilgrim's tread."^[123]

passed—nor of his name and race

eft a token or a trace,¹³³⁰

e what the Father must not say

shrived him on his dying day:

broken tale was all we knew^[ex]

er he loved, or him he slew.

FOOTNOTES:

[55] {85} A tomb above the rocks on the promontory, by some supposed the sepulchre of Themistocles.

["There are," says Cumberland, in his *Observer*, "a few lines by Plato upon the tomb of Themistocles, which have a turn of elegant and pathetic simplicity in them, that deserves a better translation than I can give—

"By the sea's margin, on the watery strand,
Thy monument, Themistocles, shall stand:
By this directed to thy native shore,
The merchant shall convey his freighted store;
And when our fleets are summoned to the fight
Athens shall conquer with thy tomb in sight."

Note to Edition 1832.

The traditional site of the tomb of Themistocles, "a rock-hewn grave on the very margin of the sea generally covered with water," adjoins the lighthouse, which stands on the westernmost promontory of the Piræus, some three quarters of a mile from the entrance to the harbour. Plutarch, in his *Themistocles* (cap. xxxii.), is at pains to describe the exact site of the "altar-like tomb," and quotes the passage from Plato (the comic poet, B.C. 428-389) which Cumberland paraphrases. Byron and Hobhouse "made the complete circuit of the peninsula of Munychia," January 18, 1810.—*Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. 317, 318.]

[cg] {86}

*Fair clime! where ceaseless summer smiles
Benignant o'er those blessed isles,
Which seen from far Colonna's height,
Make glad the heart that hails the sight,
And lend to loneliness delight.
There shine the bright abodes ye seek,
Like dimples upon Occan's cheek,
So smiling round the waters lave
These Edens of the Eastern wave.
Or if, at times, the transient breeze
Break the smooth crystal of the seas,
Or brush one blossom from the trees,*

*How grateful is each gentle air
That wakes and wafts the fragrance there.*—[MS.]
—*the fragrance there.*—[Second Edition.]

[56] The attachment of the nightingale to the rose is a well-known Persian fable. If I mistake not, the "Bulbul of a thousand tales" is one of his appellations.

[Thus Mesihi, as translated by Sir William Jones—

"Come, charming maid! and hear thy poet sing,
Thyself the rose and he the bird of spring:
Love bids him sing, and Love will be obey'd.
Be gay: too soon the flowers of spring will fade."

"The full style and title of the Persian nightingale (*Pycnonotus hæmorrhous*) is 'Bulbul-i-hazár-dástán,' usually shortened to 'Hazar' (bird of a thousand tales = the thousand), generally called 'Andalib.'" (See *Arabian Nights*, by Richard F. Burton, 1887; *Supplemental Nights*, iii. 506.) For the nightingale's attachment to the rose, compare Moore's *Lalla Rookh*—

"Oh! sooner shall the rose of May
Mistake her own sweet nightingale," etc.

(Ed. "Chandos Classics," p. 423)

and Fitzgerald's translation of the *Rubáiyát* of Omar Khayyám (stanza vi.)—

"And David's lips are lockt; but in divine
High piping Pehlevi, with 'Wine! Wine! Wine!
Red Wine!'—the Nightingale cries to the Rose
That sallow cheek of hers to incarnadine."

Rubáiyát, etc., 1899, p. 29, and note, p. 62.

Byron was indebted for his information to a note on a passage in *Vathek*, by S. Henley (*Vathek*, 1893, p. 217).]

[57] {87} The guitar is the constant amusement of the Greek sailor by night; with a steady fair wind, and during a calm, it is accompanied always by the voice, and often by dancing.

[ch] {88} *Should wanton in a wilderness.*—[MS.]

[ci] The first draft of this celebrated passage differs in many particulars from the Fair Copy, which, with the exception of the passages marked as vars. i. (p. 89) and i. (p. 90), is the same as the text. It ran as follows:—

*He who hath bent him o'er the dead
 Ere the first day of death is fled—
 The first dark day of Nothingness
 The last of doom and of distress—
 Before Corruption's cankering fingers
 Hath tinged the hue where Beauty lingers
 And marked the soft and settled air
 That dwells with all but Spirit there
 The fixed yet tender lines that speak
 Of Peace along the placid cheek
 And—but for that sad shrouded eye
 That fires not—pleads not—weeps not—now—
 And but for that pale chilling brow
 Whose touch tells of Mortality
 And curdles to the Gazer's heart
 As if to him it could impart
 The doom he only looks upon—
 Yes but for these and these alone,
 A moment—yet—a little hour
 We still might doubt the Tyrant's power.*

The eleven lines following (88-98) were not emended in the Fair Copy, and are included in the text. The Fair Copy is the sole MS. authority for the four concluding lines of the paragraph.

[58] [Compare "Beyond Milan the country wore the aspect of a wider devastation; and though everything seemed more quiet, the repose was like that of death spread over features which retain the impression of the last convulsions."—*Mysteries of Udolpho*, by Mrs. Ann Radcliffe, 1794, ii. 29.]

[c] {89}

*And marked the almost dreaming air,
 Which speaks the sweet repose that's there.—*

[MS. of Fair Copy.]

[59] {90}

*"Aye, but to die, and go we know not where;
 To lie in cold obstruction?"*

Measure for Measure, act iii. sc. I, lines 115, 116.

[Compare, too, *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza iv. line 5.]

[ck]

*Whose touch thrills with mortality,
And curdles to the gazer's heart.*—[MS. of Fair Copy.]

[60] I trust that few of my readers have ever had an opportunity of witnessing what is here attempted in description; but those who have will probably retain a painful remembrance of that singular beauty which pervades, with few exceptions, the features of the dead, a few hours, and but for a few hours, after "the spirit is not there." It is to be remarked in cases of violent death by gun-shot wounds, the expression is always that of languor, whatever the natural energy of the sufferer's character; but in death from a stab the countenance preserves its traits of feeling or ferocity, and the mind its bias, to the last. [According to Medwin (1824, 4to, p. 223), an absurd charge, based on the details of this note, was brought against Byron, that he had been guilty of murder, and spoke from experience.]

[61] [In Dallaway's *Constantinople* (p. 2) [Rev. James Dallaway (1763-1834) published *Constantinople Ancient and Modern, etc.*, in 1797], a book which Lord Byron is not unlikely to have consulted, I find a passage quoted from Gillies' *History of Greece* (vol. i. p. 335), which contains, perhaps, the first seed of the thought thus expanded into full perfection by genius: "The present state of Greece, compared to the ancient, is the silent obscurity of the grave contrasted with the vivid lustre of active life."—Moore, *Note to Edition* 1832.]

[62] {91} [From hence to the conclusion of the paragraph, the MS. is written in a hurried and almost illegible hand, as if these splendid lines had been poured forth in one continuous burst of poetic feeling, which would hardly allow time for the pen to follow the imagination.—(*Note to Edition* 1837. The lines were added to the Second Edition.)]

[cl] *Fountain of Wisdom! can it be.*—[MS. erased.]

[63] [Compare—"Son of the Morning, rise! approach you here!" *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza iii. line 1.]

[cm]

*Why is not this Thermopylæ;
These waters blue that round you lave
Degenerate offspring of the free—
How name ye them what shore is this?
The wave, the rock of Salamis?*—[MS.]

[cn] {92}

*And he who in the cause expires,
Will add a name and fate to them
Well worthy of his noble stem.*—[MS.]

[co] *Commenced by Sire—renewed by Son.*—[MS.]

[cp]

*Attest it many a former age
While kings in dark oblivion hid.*—[MS.]

[cq] *There let the Muse direct thine eye.*—[MS.]

[cr] {93} *The hearts amid thy mountains bred.*—[MS.]

[64] Athens is the property of the Kislar Aga [kizlar-aghasî] (the slave of the Seraglio and guardian of the women), who appoints the Waywode. A pander and eunuch—these are not polite, yet true appellations—now *governs* the *governor* of Athens!

[Hobhouse maintains that this subordination of the waiwodes (or vaivodes = the Sclavic βοεβόδα (Turkish governors of Athens) to a higher Turkish official, was on the whole favourable to the liberties and well-being of the Athenians.—*Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. 246.]

[cs]

*Now to the neighbouring shores they waft
Their ancient and proverbial craft.*—[MS. erased.]

[ct] {94} *he silent slants the doubtful creek.*—[MS]

[65] [The reciter of the tale is a Turkish fisherman, who has been employed during the day in the gulf of Ægina, and in the evening, apprehensive of the Mainote pirates who infest the coast of Attica, lands with his boat on the harbour of Port Leone, the ancient Piræus. He becomes the eye-witness of nearly all the incidents in the story, and in one of them is a principal agent. It is to his feelings, and particularly to his religious prejudices, that we are indebted for some of the most forcible and splendid parts of the poem.—Note by George Agar Ellis, 1797-1833.]

[66] [In Dr. Clarke's *Travels* (Edward Daniel Clarke, 1769-1822, published *Travels in Europe, Asia, Africa*, 1810-24), this word, which means *infidel*, is always written according to its English pronunciation, *Djour*. Byron adopted the Italian spelling usual among the Franks of the Levant.—*Note to Edition* 1832.]

The pronunciation of the word depends on its origin. If it is associated with the Arabic *jawr*, a "deviating" or "erring," the initial consonant would be soft, but if with the Persian *gawr*, or *guebre*, "a fire-worshipper," the word should be pronounced *Gow-er*—as Gower Street has come to be pronounced. It is to be remarked that to the present day the Nestorians of Urumiah are contemned as *Gy-ours* (the *G* hard), by their Mohammedan countrymen.—(From information kindly supplied by Mr. A. G. Ellis, of the Oriental Printed Books and MSS. Department, British Museum.)]

[cu] {95} *Though scarcely marked*——.—[MS.]

[cv]

With him my wonder as he flew.—[MS.]

With him my roused and wondering view.—[MS. erased.]

[cw] {96} *For him who takes so fast a flight*.—[MS. erased.]

[67] [Compare—

"A moment now he slacked his speed,
A moment breathed his panting steed."

Scott's *Lay of the Last Minstrel*, Canto I. stanza xxvii. lines 1, 2.]

[cx] *And looked along the olive wood*.—[MS.]

[68] "Tophaike," musket. The Bairam is announced by the cannon at sunset: the illumination of the mosques, and the firing of all kinds of small arms, loaded with *ball*, proclaim it during the night. [The Bairâm, the Moslem Easter, a festival of three days, succeeded the Ramazân.]

For the illumination of the mosques during the fast of the Ramazân, see *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza lv. line 5, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 134, note 2.

[cy] {97} *Of transient Anger's Darkening blush*.—[MS.]

[69] [For "hasty," all the editions till the twelfth read "*darkening blush*." On the back of a copy of the eleventh, Lord Byron has written, "Why did not the printer attend to the solitary correction so repeatedly made? I have no copy of this, and desire to have none till my request is complied with." *Notes to Editions* 1832, 1837.]

[cz]

*As doubting if to stay or fly—
Then turned it swiftly to his blade;*

*As loud his raven charger neighed—
That sound dispelled his waking dream,
As sleepers start at owl's scream.*—[MS.]

[70] Jerreed, or Djerrid [Jarid], a blunted Turkish javelin, which is darted from horseback with great force and precision. It is a favourite exercise of the Mussulmans; but I know not if it can be called a *manly* one, since the most expert in the art are the Black Eunuchs of Constantinople. I think, next to these, a Mamlouk at Smyrna was the most skilful that came within my observation. [Lines 250, 251, together with the note, were inserted in the Third Edition.]

[da] {98}

*'Twas but an instant, though so long
When thus dilated in my song.
'Twas but an instant——.*—[MS.]

[db]

*Such moment holds a thousand years.
or, Such moment proves the grief of years.*—[MS.]

[71] ["Lord Byron told Mr. Murray that he took this idea from one of the Arabian tales—that in which the Sultan puts his head into a butt of water, and, though it remains there for only two or three minutes, he imagines that he lives many years during that time. The story had been quoted by Addison in the *Spectator*" [No. 94, June 18, 1711].—*Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 219, note.]

[72] [Lines 271-276 were added in the Third Edition. The MS. proceeds with a direction (dated July 31, 1813) to the printer—"And alter

'A life of woe—an age of crime—'

to

'A life of *pain*—an age of crime.'

Alter also the lines

'On him who loves or hates or fears
Such moment holds a thousand years,'

to

'O'er him who loves or hates or fears

Such moment pours the grief of years.""]

[dc] {99} *But neither fled nor fell alone.*—[MS.]

[73] The blast of the desert, fatal to everything living, and often alluded to in Eastern poetry.

[James Bruce, 1730-1794 (nicknamed "Abyssinian Bruce"), gives a remarkable description of the simoom: "I saw from the south-east a haze come, in colour like the purple part of the rainbow, but not so compressed or thick. It did not occupy twenty yards in breadth, and was about twelve feet high from the ground. It was a kind of blush upon the air, and it moved very rapidly.... We all lay flat on the ground ... till it was blown over. The meteor, or purple haze, which I saw was, indeed, passed, but the light air which still blew was of a heat to threaten suffocation." He goes on to say that he did not recover the effect of the sandblast on his chest for nearly two years (Bruce's *Life and Travels*, ed. 1830, p. 470).—Note to Edition 1832.]

[dd] There are two MS. versions of lines 290-298: (A) a rough copy, and (B) a fair copy—

(A) *And wide the Spider's thin grey pall
Is curtained on the splendid wall—
The Bat hath built in his mother's bower,
And in the fortress of his power
The Owl hath fixed her beacon tower,
The wild dogs howl on the fountain's brim
With baffled thirst and famine grim,
For the stream is shrunk from its marble bed
Where Desolation's dust is spread.*—[MS.]

B. ["August 5, 1813, in last of 3rd or first of 4th ed."]

*The lonely Spider's thin grey pall
Is curtained o'er the splendid wall—
The Bat builds in his mother's bower;
And in the fortress of his power
The Owl hath fixed her beacon-tower,
The wild dog howls o'er the fountain's brink,
But vainly lolls his tongue to drink.*—[MS.]

[74] {100} [Compare "The walls of Balclutha were desolated.... The stream of Clutha was removed from its place by the fall of the walls. The fox looked out from the windows" (Ossian's *Balclutha*). "The dreary night-owl screams in the solitary retreat of his mouldering ivy-covered tower" (*Larnul, or the Song of Despair: Poems of Ossian*, discovered by the Baron de Harold, 1787, p. 172). Compare, too, the well-known lines,

"The spider holds the veil in the palace of Cæsar; the owl stands sentinel on the watch-tower of Afrasyab" (*A Grammar of the Persian Language*, by Sir W. Jones, 1809, p. 106).]

[de]

*The silver dew of coldness sprinkling
In drops fantastically twinkling
As from the spring the silver dew
In whirls fantastically flew
And dashed luxurions coolness round
The air—and verdure on the ground.—[MS.]*

[df] {101}

*For thirsty Fox and Jackal gaunt
May vainly for its waters pant.—[MS.]*
or, *The famished fox the wild dog gaunt
May vainly for its waters pant.—[MS.]*

[dg] *Might strike an echo——.—[MS.]*

[dh] {102}

*And welcome Life though but in one
For many a gilded chamber's there
Unmeet for Solitude to share.— [MS.]*

[75] ["I have just recollected an alteration you may make in the proof.... Among the lines on Hassan's Serai, is this—'Unmeet for Solitude to share.' Now, to share implies more than *one*, and Solitude is a single gentlewoman: it must be thus—

'For many a gilded chamber's there,
Which Solitude might well forbear;'

and so on. Will you adopt this correction? and pray accept a cheese from me for your trouble."—Letter to John Murray, Stilton, October 3, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 274.]

[di] *To share the Master's "bread and salt."—[MS.]*

[76] [To partake of food—to break bread and taste salt with your host, ensures the safety of the guest: even though an enemy, his person from that moment becomes sacred.—(Note appended to Letter of October 3, 1813.)

"I leave this (*vide supra*, [note 1](#)) to your discretion; if anybody thinks the old line a good one or the cheese a bad one, don't accept either. But in that case the word *share* is repeated soon after in the line—

'To share the master's bread and salt;'

and must be altered to—

'To break the master's bread and salt.'

This is not so well, though—confound it!

If the old line ['Unmeet for Solitude to share'] stands, let the other run thus—

'Nor there will weary traveller halt,
To bless the sacred bread and salt.'"

(P.S. to Murray, October 3, 1813.)

The emendation of line 335 made that of line 343 unnecessary, but both emendations were accepted.

(Moore says (*Life*; p. 191, note) that the directions are written on a separate slip of paper from the letter to Murray of October 3, 1813).]

[\[dj\]](#) {103}

And cold Hospitality shrinks from the labour,

The slave fled his halter and the serf left his labour.—[MS.]

or, *Ah! there Hospitality light is thy labour,*

or, *Ah! who for the traveller's solace will labour?*—[MS.]

[\[77\]](#) I need hardly observe, that Charity and Hospitality are the first duties enjoined by Mahomet; and to say truth, very generally practised by his disciples. The first praise that can be bestowed on a chief is a panegyric on his bounty; the next, on his valour. ["Serve God ... and show kindness unto parents, and relations, and orphans, and the poor, and your neighbour who is of kin to you ... and the traveller, and the captives," etc.—*Korân*, cap. iv. Lines 350, 351 were inserted in the Fifth Edition.]

[\[78\]](#) The ataghan, a long dagger worn with pistols in the belt, in a metal scabbard, generally of silver; and, among the wealthier, gilt, or of gold.

[\[79\]](#) Green is the privileged colour of the prophet's numerous pretended descendants; with them, as here, faith (the family inheritance) is supposed to supersede the necessity of good works: they are the worst of a very indifferent brood.

[80] {104} "Salam aleikoum! aleikoum salam!" peace be with you; be with you peace—the salutation reserved for the faithful:—to a Christian, "Urlarula!" a good journey; or "saban hiresem, saban serula," good morn, good even; and sometimes, "may your end be happy!" are the usual salutes.

["After both sets of prayers, Farz and Sunnah, the Moslem looks over his right shoulder, and says, 'The Peace (of Allah) be upon you and the ruth of Allah,' and repeats the words over the left shoulder. The salutation is addressed to the Guardian Angels, or to the bystanders (Moslem), who, however, do not return it."—*Arabian Nights*, by Richard F. Burton, 1887: *Supplemental Nights*, i. 14, note.]

[dk]

*Take ye and give ye that salam,
That says of Moslem faith I am.*—[MS.]

[dl] *Which one of yonder barks may wait.*—[MS.]

[81] [In the MS. and the first five editions the broken line (373) consisted of two words only, "That one."]

[82] The blue-winged butterfly of Kashmeer, the most rare and beautiful of the species.

[The same insects (butterflies of Cachemir) are celebrated in an unpublished poem of Mesihî.... Sir Anthony Shirley relates that it was customary in Persia "to hawk after butterflies with sparrows, made to that use."—Note by S. Henley to *Vathek*, ed. 1893, p. 222. Byron, in his *Journal*, December 1, 1813, speaks of Lady Charlemont as "that blue-winged Kashmirian butterfly of book-learning."]

[dm] *If caught, to fate alike betrayed.*—[MS.]

[dn] {106} *The gathering flames around her close.*—[MS. erased.]

[83] {107} Alluding to the dubious suicide of the scorpion, so placed for experiment by gentle philosophers. Some maintain that the position of the sting, when turned towards the head, is merely a convulsive movement; but others have actually brought in the verdict "Felo de se." The scorpions are surely interested in a speedy decision of the question; as, if once fairly established as insect Catos, they will probably be allowed to live as long as they think proper, without being martyred for the sake of an hypothesis.

[Byron assured Dallas that the simile of the scorpion was imagined in his sleep.—*Recollections of the Life of Lord Byron*, by R. C. Dallas, p. 264.]

"Probably in some instances the poor scorpion has been burnt to death; and the well-known habit of these creatures to raise the tail over the back and recurve it so that the extremity touches the fore part of the cephalo-thorax, has led to the idea that it was stinging itself."—*Encycl. Brit.*, art. "Arachnida," by Rev. O. P. Cambridge, ii. 281.]

[do] *So writhes the mind by Conscience riven.*—[MS.]

[84] The cannon at sunset close the Rhamazan. [Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza Iv. line 5, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 134. note 2.]

[85] {108} Phingari, the moon. φεγγάρι is derived from φεγγάριον, dim. of φέγγος.

[86] The celebrated fabulous ruby of Sultan Giamschid, the embellisher of Istakhar; from its splendour, named Schebgerag [Schabchirāgh], "the torch of night;" also "the cup of the sun," etc. In the First Edition, "Giamschid" was written as a word of three syllables; so D'Herbelot has it; but I am told Richardson reduces it to a dissyllable, and writes "Jamshid." I have left in the text the orthography of the one with the pronunciation of the other.

[The MS. and First Edition read, "Bright as the gem of Giamschid." Byron's first intention was to change the line into "Bright as the ruby of Giamschid;" but to this Moore objected, "that as the comparison of his heroine's eye to a ruby might unluckily call up the idea of its being bloodshot, he had better change the line to 'Bright as the jewel,' etc."

For the original of Byron's note, see S. Henley's note, *Vathek*, 1893, p. 230. See, too, D'Herbelot's *Bibliothèque Orientale*, 1781, iii. 27.

Sir Richard Burton (*Arabian Nights*, S.N., iii. 440) gives the following *résumé* of the conflicting legends: "Jám-i-jámshid is a well-known commonplace in Moslem folk-lore; but commentators cannot agree whether 'Jám' be a mirror or a cup. In the latter sense it would represent the Cyathomantic cup of the Patriarch Joseph, and the symbolic bowl of Nestor. Jamshid may be translated either 'Jam the bright,' or 'the Cup of the Sun;' this ancient king is the Solomon of the grand old Guebres."

Fitzgerald, "in a very composite quatrain (stanza v.) which cannot be claimed as a translation at all" (see the *Rubáiyát* of Omar Khayyāām, by Edward Heron Allen, 1898), embodies a late version of the myth—

"Tram is gone and all his Rose,
And Jamshyd's sev'n-ringed Cup where no one knows."]

[87] {109} Al-Sirat, the bridge of breadth narrower than the thread of a famished spider, and sharper than the edge of a sword, over which the Mussulmans must *skate* into

Paradise, to which it is the only entrance; but this is not the worst, the river beneath being hell itself, into which, as may be expected, the unskilful and tender of foot contrive to tumble with a "*facilis descensus Averni*," not very pleasing in prospect to the next passenger. There is a shorter cut downwards for the Jews and Christians.

[Byron is again indebted to *Vathek*, and S. Henley on *Vathek*, p. 237, for his information. The authority for the legend of the Bridge of Paradise is not the Koran, but the Book of Mawakef, quoted by Edward Pococke, in his Commentary (*Notæ Miscellanæ*) on the *Porta Mosis* of Moses Maimonides (Oxford, 1654, p. 288)—

"Stretched across the back of Hell, it is narrower than a javelin, sharper than the edge of a sword. But all must essay the passage, believers as well as infidels, and it baffles the understanding to imagine in what manner they keep their foothold."

The legend, or rather allegory, to which there would seem to be some allusion in the words of Scripture, "Strait is the gate," etc., is of Zoroastrian origin. Compare the *Zend-Avesta*, Yasna xix. 6 (*Sacred Books of the East*, edited by F. Max Muller, 1887, xxxi. 261), "With even threefold (safety and with speed) I will bring his soul over the Bridge of Kinvat," etc.]

[88] {110} A vulgar error: the Koran allots at least a third of Paradise to well-behaved women; but by far the greater number of Mussulmans interpret the text their own way, and exclude their moieties from heaven. Being enemies to Platonics, they cannot discern "any fitness of things" in the souls of the other sex, conceiving them to be superseded by the Houris.

[Sale, in his *Preliminary Discourse* ("Chandos Classics," p. 80), in dealing with this question, notes "that there are several passages in the Koran which affirm that women, in the next life, will not only be punished for their evil actions, but will also receive the rewards of their good deeds, as well as the men, and that in this case God will make no distinction of sexes." A single quotation will suffice: "God has promised to believers, men and women, gardens beneath which rivers flow, to dwell therein for aye; and goodly places in the garden of Eden."—*The Qur'ân*, translated by E. H. Palmer, 1880, vi. 183.]

[89] An Oriental simile, which may, perhaps, though fairly stolen, be deemed "plus Arabe qu'en Arabie."

[Gulnár (the heroine of the *Corsair* is named Gulnare) is Persian for a pomegranate flower.]

[90] Hyacinthine, in Arabic "Sunbul;" as common a thought in the Eastern poets as it was among the Greeks.

[S. Henley (*Vathek*, 1893, p. 208) quotes two lines from the *Solima* (lines 5, 6) of Sir W. Jones—

"The fragrant hyacinths of Azza's hair
That wanton with the laughing summer-air;"

and refers Milton's "Hyacinthine locks" (*Paradise Lost*, iv. 301) to Lucian's *Pro Imaginibus*, cap. v.]

[91] {111} "Franguestan," Circassia. [Or Europe generally—the land of the Frank.]

[92] [Lines 504-518 were inserted in the second revise of the Third Edition, July 31, 1813.]

[93] {113} [Parnassus.]

[94] "In the name of God;" the commencement of all the chapters of the Koran but one [the ninth], and of prayer and thanksgiving. ["Bismillah" (in full, *Bismillahi 'rrahmani 'rrahiem*, i.e. "In the name of Allah the God of Mercy, the Merciful") is often used as a deprecatory formula. Sir R. Burton (*Arabian Nights*, i. 40) cites as an equivalent the "remembering Iddio e' Santí," of Boccaccio's *Decameron*, viii. 9.

The MS. reads, "Thank Alla! now the peril's past."]

[95] [A Turkish messenger, sergeant or lictor. The proper sixteen-seventeenth century pronunciation would have been *chaush*, but apparently the nearest approach to this was *chaus*, whence *chouse* and *chiaush*, and the vulgar form *chiaus* (*N. Eng. Dict.*, art. "Chiaus"). The peculations of a certain "chiaus" in the year A.D. 1000 are said to have been the origin of the word "to chouse."]

[96] {114} A phenomenon not uncommon with an angry Mussulman. In 1809 the Capitan Pacha's whiskers at a diplomatic audience were no less lively with indignation than a tiger cat's, to the horror of all the dragomans; the portentous mustachios twisted, they stood erect of their own accord, and were expected every moment to change their colour, but at last condescended to subside, which, probably, saved more heads than they contained hairs.

[97] {115} "Amaun," quarter, pardon.

[Line 603 was inserted in a proof of the Second Edition, dated July 24, 1813: "Nor raised the coward cry, Amaun!"]

[98] The "evil eye," a common superstition in the Levant, and of which the imaginary effects are yet very singular on those who conceive themselves affected.

[99] [Compare "As with a thousand waves to the rocks, so Swaran's host came on."—*Fingal*, bk. i., Ossian's *Works*, 1807, i. 19.]

[dp] {116} *That neither gives nor asks for life.*—[MS.]

[100] {117} The flowered shawls generally worn by persons of rank.

[101] [Compare "Catilina vero longè a suis, inter hostium cadavera repertus est, paululum etiam spirans ferociamque animi, quam habuerat vivus, in vultu retinens."—*Catilina*, cap. 61, *Opera*, 1820, i. 124.]

[dq] {118}

*His mother looked from the lattice high,
With throbbing heart and eager eye;
The browsing camel bells are tinkling,
And the last beam of twilight twinkling:
'Tis eve; his train should now be nigh.
She could not rest in her garden bower,
And gazed through the loop of her steepest tower.
"Why comes he not? his steeds are fleet,
And well are they train'd to the summer's heat."*—[MS.]

Another copy began—

*The browsing camel bells are tinkling,
And the first beam of evening twinkling;
His mother looked from her lattice high,
With throbbing breast and eager eye—
"'Tis twilight—sure his train is nigh."*—[MS. Aug. 11, 1813.]

*The browsing camel's bells are tinkling
The dews of eve the pasture sprinkling
And rising planets feebly twinkling:
His mother looked from the lattice high
With throbbing heart and eager eye.*—[Fourth Edition.]

[These lines were erased, and lines 689-692 were substituted. They appeared first in the Fifth Edition.]

[102] ["The mother of Sisera looked out at a window, and cried through the lattice, Why is his chariot so long in coming? why tarry the wheels of his chariot?"—Judges v. 28.]

[dr] {119} *And now his courser's pace amends.*—[MS. erased.]

[ds] *I could not deem my son was slow.*—[MS. erased.]

[dt]

*The Tartar sped beneath the gate
And flung to earth his fainting weight.*—[MS.]

[103] The calpac is the solid cap or centre part of the head-dress; the shawl is wound round it, and forms the turban.

[104] The turban, pillar, and inscriptive verse, decorate the tombs of the Osmanlies, whether in the cemetery or the wilderness. In the mountains you frequently pass similar mementos; and on inquiry you are informed that they record some victim of rebellion, plunder, or revenge.

[The following is a "Koran verse:" "Every one that is upon it (the earth) perisheth; but the person of thy Lord abideth, the possessor of glory and honour" (Sur. lv. 26, 27). (See "Kufic Tombstones in the British Museum," by Professor Wright, *Proceedings of the Biblical Archæological Society*, 1887, ix. 337, sq.)]

[105] {120} "Alla Hu!" the concluding words of the Muezzin's call to prayer from the highest gallery on the exterior of the Minaret. On a still evening, when the Muezzin has a fine voice, which is frequently the case, the effect is solemn and beautiful beyond all the bells in Christendom. [Valid, the son of Abdalmalek, was the first who erected a minaret or turret; and this he placed on the grand mosque at Damascus, for the muezzin or crier to announce from it the hour of prayer. (See D'Herbelot, *Bibliothèque Orientale*, 1783, vi. 473, art. "Valid." See, too, *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza lix. line 9, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 136, note 1.)]

[106] The following is part of a battle-song of the Turks:—"I see—I see a dark-eyed girl of Paradise, and she waves a handkerchief, a kerchief of green; and cries aloud, 'Come, kiss me, for I love thee,'" etc.

[107] {121} Monkir and Nekir are the inquisitors of the dead, before whom the corpse undergoes a slight noviciate and preparatory training for damnation. If the answers are none of the clearest, he is hauled up with a scythe and thumped down with a red-hot mace till properly seasoned, with a variety of subsidiary probations. The office of these angels is no sinecure; there are but two, and the number of orthodox deceased being in a small proportion to the remainder, their hands are always full.—See *Relig. Ceremon.*, v. 290; vii. 59, 68, 118, and Sale's *Preliminary Discourse to the Koran*, p. 101.

[Byron is again indebted to S. Henley (see *Vathek*, 1893, p. 236). According to Pococke (*Porta Mosis*, 1654, Notæ Miscellaneæ, p. 241), the angels Moncar and Nacir are black, ghastly, and of fearsome aspect. Their function is to hold inquisition on the corpse. If his replies are orthodox (*de Mohammede*), he is bidden to sleep sweetly and soundly in his tomb, but if his views are lax and unsound, he is cudgelled between the ears with iron rods. Loud are his groans, and audible to the whole wide world, save to those deaf animals, men and genii. Finally, the earth is enjoined to press him tight and keep him close till the crack of doom.]

[108] Eblis, the Oriental Prince of Darkness.

[109] The Vampire superstition is still general in the Levant. Honest Tournefort [*Relation d'un Voyage du Levant*, par Joseph Pitton de Tournefort, 1717, i. 131] tells a long story, which Mr. Southey, in the notes on *Thalaba* [book viii., notes, ed. 1838, iv. 297-300], quotes about these "Vroucolochas" ["Vroucolocasses"], as he calls them. The Romaic term is "Vardoulacha." I recollect a whole family being terrified by the scream of a child, which they imagined must proceed from such a visitation. The Greeks never mention the word without horror. I find that "Broucolokas" is an old legitimate Hellenic appellation—at least is so applied to Arsenius, who, according to the Greeks, was after his death animated by the Devil. The moderns, however, use the word I mention.

Βουρκόλακας or Βρυκόλακας (= the Bohemian and Slovak *Vrholak*) is modern Greek for a ghost or vampire. George Bentotes, in his *Λεξικόν Τρίγλωσσον*, published in Vienna in 1790 (see *Childe Harold*, Canto II. Notes, Papers, etc., No. III., *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 197), renders Βουρκόλακας "lutin," and Βρουκολιασμένος, "devenu un spectre."

Arsenius, Archbishop of Monembasia (circ. 1530), was famous for his scholarship. He prefaced his *Scholia in Septem Euripidis Tragædias* (Basileæ, 1544) by a dedicatory epistle in Greek to his friend Pope Paul III. "He submitted to the Church of Rome, which made him so odious to the Greek schismatics that the Patriarch of Constantinople excommunicated him; and the Greeks reported that Arsenius, after his death, was *Broukolakas*, that is, that the Devil hovered about his corps and re-animated him" (Bayle, *Dictionary*, 1724, i. 508, art. "Arsenius"). Martinus Crusius, in his *Turco-Græcia*, lib. ii. (Basileæ, 1584, p. 151) records the death of Arsenius while under sentence of excommunication, and adds that "his miserable corpse turned black, and swelled to the size of a drum, so that all who beheld it were horror-stricken, and trembled exceedingly." Hence, no doubt, the legend which Bayle takes *verbatim* from Guillet, "Les Grecs disent qu' Arsenius, apres la mort fust *Broukolakas*," etc. (*Lacédémone, Ancienne et Nouvelle*, par Le Sieur de la Guilletière, 1676, ii. 586. See, too, for "Arsenius," Fabricii *Script. Gr. Var.*, 1808, xi. 581, and Gesneri *Bibliotheca Univ.*, ed. 1545, fol. 96.) Byron, no doubt, got

his information from Bayle. By "old legitimate Hellenic" he must mean literary as opposed to klephtic Greek.]

[110] {123} The freshness of the face [? "*The paleness of the face*," MS.] and the wetness of the lip with blood, are the never-failing signs of a Vampire. The stories told in Hungary and Greece of these foul feeders are singular, and some of them most *incredibly* attested.

[Vampires were the reanimated corpses of persons newly buried, which were supposed to suck the blood and suck out the life of their selected victims. The marks by which a vampire corpse was recognized were the apparent non-putrefaction of the body and effusion of blood from the lips. A suspected vampire was exhumed, and if the marks were perceived or imagined to be present, a stake was driven through the heart, and the body was burned. This, if Southey's authorities (J. B. Boyer, Marquis d'Argens, in *Lettres Juives*) may be believed, "laid" the vampire, and the community might sleep in peace. (See, too, *Dissertations sur les Apparitions*, par Augustine Calmet, 1746, p. 395, *sq.*, and *Russian Folk-Tales*, by W. R. S. Ralston, 1873, pp. 318-324.)]

[111] [For "Caloyer," see *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza xlix. line 6, and note 21, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 130, 181. It is a hard matter to piece together the "fragments" which make up the rest of the poem. Apparently the question, "How name ye?" is put by the fisherman, the narrator of the first part of the *Fragment*, and answered by a monk of the fraternity, with whom the Giaour has been pleased to "abide" during the past six years, under conditions and after a fashion of which the monk disapproves. Hereupon the fisherman disappears, and a kind of dialogue between the author and the protesting monk ensues. The poem concludes with the Giaour's confession, which is addressed to the monk, or perhaps to the interested and more tolerant Prior of the community.]

[du] {124} *As Time were wasted on his brow.*—[MS.]

[dv] {125} *Of foreign maiden lost at sea.*—[MS.]

[dw] {127}

Behold—as turns he from the—wall
His cowl fly back, his dark hair fall.—[ms]

[A variant of the copy sent for insertion in the Seventh Edition differs alike from the MS. and the text—]

Behold as turns him from the wall—
His Cowl flies back—his tresses fall—
That pallid aspect wreathing round.

[dx] *Lo! mark him as the harmony.*—[MS.]

[dy] *Thank heaven—he stands without the shrine.*—[MS. erased.]

[dz] {128}

Must burn before it smite or shine.—[MS.]

Appears unfit to smite or shine.—[MS. erased]

[112] [In defence of lines 922-927, which had been attacked by a critic in the *British Review*, October, 1813, vol. v. p. 139, who compared them with some lines in Crabbe's *Resentment* (lines 11—16, *Tales*, 1812, p. 309), Byron wrote to Murray, October 12, 1813, "I have ... read the British Review. I really think the writer in most points very right. The only mortifying thing is the accusation of imitation. Crabbe's passage I never saw; and Scott I no further meant to follow than in his lyric measure, which is Gray's, Milton's, and any one's who like it." The lines, which Moore quotes (*Life*, p. 191), have only a formal and accidental resemblance to the passage in question.]

[113] {129} [Compare—

"To surfeit on the same [our pleasures]

And yawn our joys. Or thank a misery

For change, though sad?"

Night Thoughts, iii., by Edward Young; Anderson's *British Poets*, x. 72. Compare, too, *Childe Harold*, Canto I. stanza vi, line 8—"With pleasure drugged, he almost longed for woe."]

[114] [Byron was wont to let his imagination dwell on these details of the charnel-house. In a letter to Dallas, August 12, 1811, he writes, "I am already too familiar with the dead. It is strange that I look on the skulls which stand beside me (I have always had four in my study) without emotion, but I cannot strip the features of those I have known of their fleshy covering, even in idea, without a hideous sensation; but the worms are less ceremonious." See, too, his "Lines inscribed upon a Cup formed from a Skull," *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 276.]

[115] {130} The pelican is, I believe, the bird so libelled, by the imputation of feeding her chickens with her blood. [It has been suggested that the curious bloody secretion ejected from the mouth of the flamingo may have given rise to the belief, through that bird having been mistaken for the "pelican of the wilderness."—*Encycl. Brit.*, art. "Pelican" (by Professor A. Newton), xviii. 474.]

[ea] *Than feeling we must feel no more.*—[MS.]

[116] {131} [Compare—

"T'd rather be a toad,
And live upon the vapours of a dungeon."

Othello, act iii. sc. 3, lines 274, 275.]

[eb] *Though hope hath long withdrawn her beam.*—[MS.] [This line was omitted in the Third and following Editions.]

[ec] {132}

*Through ranks of steel and tracks of fire,
And all she threatens in her ire;
And these are but the words of one
Who thus would do—who thus hath done.*—[MS. erased.]

[ed] {134} *My hope a tomb, our foe a grave.*—[MS.]

[117] This superstition of a second-hearing (for I never met with downright second-sight in the East) fell once under my own observation. On my third journey to Cape Colonna, early in 1811, as we passed through the defile that leads from the hamlet between Keratia and Colonna, I observed Dervish Tahiri riding rather out of the path and leaning his head upon his hand, as if in pain. I rode up and inquired. "We are in peril," he answered. "What peril? We are not now in Albania, nor in the passes to Ephesus, Messalunghi, or Lepanto; there are plenty of us, well armed, and the Choriates have not courage to be thieves."—"True, Affendi, but nevertheless the shot is ringing in my ears."—"The shot. Not a tophaike has been fired this morning."—"I hear it notwithstanding—Bom—Bom—as plainly as I hear your voice."—"Psha!"—"As you please, Affendi; if it is written, so will it be."—I left this quick-eared predestinarian, and rode up to Basili, his Christian compatriot, whose ears, though not at all prophetic, by no means relished the intelligence. We all arrived at Colonna, remained some hours, and returned leisurely, saying a variety of brilliant things, in more languages than spoiled the building of Babel, upon the mistaken seer. Romaic, Arnaout, Turkish, Italian, and English were all exercised, in various conceits, upon the unfortunate Mussulman. While we were contemplating the beautiful prospect, Dervish was occupied about the columns. I thought he was deranged into an antiquarian, and asked him if he had become a "*Palaocastro*" man? "No," said he; "but these pillars will be useful in making a stand;" and added other remarks, which at least evinced his own belief in his troublesome faculty of *forehearing*. On our return to Athens we heard from Leoné (a prisoner set ashore some days after) of the intended attack of the Mainotes, mentioned, with the cause of its not taking place, in the notes to *Childe Harold*, Canto 2nd [*Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 169]. I was at some pains to question the

man, and he described the dresses, arms, and marks of the horses of our party so accurately, that, with other circumstances, we could not doubt of *his* having been in "villanous company" [I *Henry IV.*, act iii. sc. 3, line 11] and ourselves in a bad neighbourhood. Dervish became a soothsayer for life, and I dare say is now hearing more musketry than ever will be fired, to the great refreshment of the Arnauts of Berat, and his native mountains.—I shall mention one trait more of this singular race. In March, 1811, a remarkably stout and active Arnaut came (I believe the fiftieth on the same errand) to offer himself as an attendant, which was declined. "Well, Affendi," quoth he, "may you live!—you would have found me useful. I shall leave the town for the hills to-morrow; in the winter I return, perhaps you will then receive me."—Dervish, who was present, remarked as a thing of course, and of no consequence, "in the mean time he will join the Klephtes" (robbers), which was true to the letter. If not cut off, they come down in the winter, and pass it unmolested in some town, where they are often as well known as their exploits.

[118] {135} [*Vide ante*, p. 90, line 89, note 2, "In death from a stab the countenance preserves its traits of feeling or ferocity."]

[ee]

*Her power to soothe—her skill to save—
And doubly darken o'er the grave,—*[MS.]

[ef] {136}

*Of Ladye-love—and dart—and chain—
And fire that raged in every vein.—*[MS.]

[eg]

*Even now alone, yet undismayed,—
I know no friend, and ask no aid.—*[MS.]

[119] [Lines 1127-1130 were inserted in the Seventh Edition. They recall the first line of Plato's epitaph, Ἀστὴρ πρὶν μὲν ἔλαμπες ἐνὶ ζωῶσιν ἔϕος, which Byron prefixed to his "Epitaph on a Beloved Friend" (*Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 18), and which, long afterwards, Shelley chose as the motto to his *Adonais*.]

[eh] {137}

Yes } Love indeed { doth spring
If } descend
be born } from heaven:

A spark of that { *immortal*
eternal
celestial } fire

To human hearts in mercy given,
To lift from earth our low desire,
A feeling from the Godhead caught,

To wean from self { *each*
our } sordid thought:

Devotion sends the soul above,
But Heaven itself descends to love,
Yet marvel not, if they who love
This present joy, this future hope
Which taught them with all ill to cope,
No more with anguish bravely cope.—[MS.]

[120] [The hundred and twenty-six lines which follow, down to "Tell me no more of Fancy's gleam," first appeared in the Fifth Edition. In returning the proof to Murray, Byron writes, August 26, 1813, "The last lines Hodgson likes—it is not often he does—and when he don't, he tells me with great energy, and I fret and alter. I have thrown them in to soften the ferocity of our Infidel, and, for a dying man, have given him a good deal to say for himself."—*Letters*, 1898, ii. 252.]

[ei] {138}

That quenched, I wandered far in night,
or, 'Tis quenched, and I am lost in night.—[MS.]

[ej] Must plunge into a dark abyss.—[MS.]

[ek] {139}

And let the light, inconstant fool
That sneers his coxcomb ridicule.—[MS.]

[el] Less than the soft and shallow maid.—[MS. erased.]

[em] The joy—the madness of my heart.—[MS.]

[en]

To me alike all time and place—
Scarce could I gaze on Nature's face
For every hue——.—[MS.]
or, All, all was changed on Nature's face

To me alike all time and place.—[MS. erased.]

[eo] {140}

——*but this grief*

In truth is not for thy relief.

My state thy thought can never guess.—[MS.]

[121] The monk's sermon is omitted. It seems to have had so little effect upon the patient, that it could have no hopes from the reader. It may be sufficient to say that it was of a customary length (as may be perceived from the interruptions and uneasiness of the patient), and was delivered in the usual tone of all orthodox preachers.

[ep] *Where thou, it seems, canst offer grace.*—[MS. erased.]

[eq] *Where rise my native city's towers.*—[MS.]

[er] *I had, and though but one—a friend!*—[MS.]

[es] {141}

I have no heart to love him now

And 'tis but to declare my end.—[ms]

[et]

But now Remembrance murmurs o'er

Of all our early youth had been—

In pain, I now had turned aside

To bless his memory ere I died,

But Heaven would mark the vain essay,

If Guilt should for the guiltless fray—

I do not ask him not to blame—

Too gentle he to wound my name—

I do not ask him not to mourn,

For such request might sound like scorn—

And what like Friendship's manly tear

So well can grace a brother's bier?

But bear this ring he gave of old,

And tell him—what thou didst behold—

The withered frame—the ruined mind,

The wreck that Passion leaves behind—

The shrivelled and discoloured leaf

Seared by the Autumn blast of Grief.—[MS., First Copy.]

[eu] {142} *Nay—kneel not, father, rise—despair.*—[MS.]

[122] {143} "Symar," a shroud. [Cymar, or simar, is a long loose robe worn by women. It is, perhaps, the same word as the Spanish *camarra* (Arabic *camârra*), a sheep-skin cloak. It is equivalent to "shroud" only in the primary sense of a "covering."]

[ev] *Which now I view with trembling spark.*—[MS.]

[ew] {144} *Then lay me with the nameless dead.*—[MS.]

[123] The circumstance to which the above story relates was not very uncommon in Turkey. A few years ago the wife of Muchtar Pacha complained to his father of his son's supposed infidelity; he asked with whom, and she had the barbarity to give in a list of the twelve handsomest women in Yanina. They were seized, fastened up in sacks, and drowned in the lake the same night! One of the guards who was present informed me that not one of the victims uttered a cry, or showed a symptom of terror at so sudden a "wrench from all we know, from all we love." The fate of Phrosine, the fairest of this sacrifice, is the subject of many a Romaic and Arnaout ditty. The story in the text is one told of a young Venetian many years ago, and now nearly forgotten. I heard it by accident recited by one of the coffee-house story-tellers who abound in the Levant, and sing or recite their narratives. The additions and interpolations by the translator will be easily distinguished from the rest, by the want of Eastern imagery; and I regret that my memory has retained so few fragments of the original. For the contents of some of the notes I am indebted partly to D'Herbelot, and partly to that most Eastern, and, as Mr. Weber justly entitles it, "sublime tale," the "Caliph Vathek." I do not know from what source the author of that singular volume may have drawn his materials; some of his incidents are to be found in the *Bibliothèque Orientale*; but for correctness of costume, beauty of description, and power of imagination, it far surpasses all European imitations, and bears such marks of originality that those who have visited the East will find some difficulty in believing it to be more than a translation. As an Eastern tale, even Rasselas must bow before it; his "Happy Valley" will not bear a comparison with the "Hall of Eblis." [See *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza xxii. line 6, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 37, note 1.

"Mansour Effendi tells the story (*vide supra*, line 6) thus: Frosini was niece of the Archbishop of Joannina. Mouctar Pasha ordered her to come to his harem, and her father advised her to go; she did so. Mouctar, among other presents, gave her a ring of great value, which she wished to sell, and gave it for that purpose to a merchant, who offered it to the wife of Mouctar. That lady recognized the jewel as her own, and, discovering the intrigue, complained to Ali Pasha, who, the next night, seized her himself in his own house, and ordered her to be drowned. Mansour Effendi says he had the story from the

brother and son of Frosini. This son was a child of six years old, and was in bed in his mother's chamber when Ali came to carry away his mother to death. He had a confused recollection of the horrid scene."—*Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. Ill, note 6.

The concluding note, like the poem, was built up sentence by sentence. Lines 1-12, "forgotten," are in the MS. Line 12, "I heard," to line 17, "original," were added in the Second Edition. The next sentence, "For the contents" to "Vathek," was inserted in the Third; and the concluding paragraph, "I do not know" to the end, in the Fourth Editions.]

[\[ex\]](#) {146}

Nor whether most he mourned none knew.

For her he loved—or him he slew.—[MS.]

THE BRIDE OF ABYDOS. A TURKISH TALE.

"Had we never loved sae kindly,
Had we never loved sae blindly,
Never met—or never parted,
We had ne'er been broken-hearted."—

BURNS [*Farewell to Nancy*].

INTRODUCTION TO THE *THE BRIDE OF* *ABYDOS.*



MANY poets—Wordsworth, for instance—have been conscious in their old age that an interest attaches to the circumstances of the composition of their poems, and have furnished their friends and admirers with explanatory notes. Byron recorded the *motif* and occasion of the *Bride of Abydos* while the poem was still in the press. It was written, he says, to divert his mind, "to wring his thoughts from reality to imagination—from selfish regrets to vivid recollections" (*Diary*, December 5, 1813, *Letters*, ii. 361), "to distract his dreams from ..." (*Diary*, November 16) "for the sake of *employment*" (Letter to Moore, November 30, 1813). He had been staying during part of October and November at Aston Hall, Rotherham, with his friend James Wedderburn Webster, and had fallen in love with his friend's wife, Lady Frances. From a brief note to his sister, dated November 5, we learn that he was in a scrape, but in "no immediate peril," and from the lines, "Remember him, whom Passion's power" (*vide ante*, [p. 67](#)), we may infer that he had sought safety in flight. The *Bride of Abydos*, or *Zuleika*, as it was first entitled, was written early in November, "in four nights" (*Diary*, November 16), or in a week (Letter to Gifford, November 12)—the reckoning goes for little—as a counter-irritant to the pain and distress of *amour interrompu*.

The confession or apology is eminently characteristic. Whilst the *Giaour* was still in process of evolution, still "lengthening its rattles," another Turkish poem is offered to the public, and the natural explanation, that the author is in vein, and can score another trick, is felt to be inadequate and dishonouring—"To withdraw *myself* from *myself*," he confides to his *Diary*(November 27), "has ever been my sole, my entire, my sincere motive for scribbling at all."

It is more than probable that in his twenty-sixth year Byron had not attained to perfect self-knowledge, but there is no reason to question his sincerity. That Byron loved to surround himself with mystery, and to dissociate himself from "the general," is true enough; but it does not follow that at all times and under all circumstances he was insincere. "Once a *poseur* always a *poseur*" is a rough-and-ready formula not invariably applicable even to a poet.

But the *Bride of Abydos* was a tonic as well as a styptic. Like the *Giaour*, it embodied a personal experience, and recalled "a country replete with the *darkest* and *brightest*, but always the most *lively* colours of my memory" (*Diary*, December 5, 1813).

In a letter to Galt (December 11, 1813, Letters, 1898, ii. 304, reprinted from *Life of Byron*, pp. 181, 182) Byron maintains that the first part of the *Bride* was drawn from "observations" of his own, "from existence." He had, it would appear, intended to make the story turn on the guilty love of a brother for a sister, a tragic incident of life in a Harem, which had come under his notice during his travels in the East, but "on second thoughts" had reflected that he lived "two centuries at least too late for the subject," and that not even the authority of the "finest works of the Greeks," or of Schiller (in the *Bride of Messina*), or of Alfieri (in *Mirra*), "in modern times," would

sanction the intrusion of the μισητὸν into English literature. The early drafts and variants of the MS. do not afford any evidence of this alteration of the plot which, as Byron thought, was detrimental to the poem as a work of art, but the undoubted fact that the *Bride of Abydos*, as well as the *Giaour*, embody recollections of actual scenes and incidents which had burnt themselves into the memory of an eye-witness, accounts not only for the fervent heat at which these Turkish tales were written, but for the extraordinary glamour which they threw over contemporary readers, to whom the local colouring was new and attractive, and who were not out of conceit with "good Monsieur Melancholy."

Byron was less dissatisfied with his second Turkish tale than he had been with the *Giaour*. He apologizes for the rapidity with which it had been composed—*stans pede in uno*—but he announced to Murray (November 20) that "he was doing his best to beat the *Giaour*," and (November 29) he appraises the *Bride* as "my first entire composition of any length."

Moreover, he records (November 15), with evident gratification, the approval of his friend Hodgson, "a very sincere and by no means (at times) a flattering critic of mine," and modestly accepts the praise of such masters of letters as "Mr. Canning," Hookham Frere, Heber, Lord Holland, and of the traveller Edward Daniel Clarke.

The *Bride of Abydos* was advertised in the *Morning Chronicle*, among "Books published this day," on November 29, 1813. It was reviewed by George Agar Ellis in the *Quarterly Review* of January, 1814 (vol. x. p. 331), and, together with the *Corsair*, by Jeffrey in the *Edinburgh Review* of April, 1814 (vol. xxiii. p. 198).

NOTE TO THE MSS. OF *THE BRIDE OF ABYDOS*.



THE MSS. of the *Bride of Abydos* are contained in a bound volume, and in two packets of loose sheets, numbering thirty-two in all, of which eighteen represent additions, etc., to the First Canto; and fourteen additions, etc., to the Second Canto.

The bound volume consists of a rough copy and a fair copy of the first draft of the *Bride*; the fair copy beginning with the sixth stanza of Canto I.

The "additions" in the bound volume consist of—

1. Stanza xxviii. of Canto II.—here called "Conclusion" (fifty-eight lines). And note on "Sir Orford's Letters."
2. Eight lines beginning, "Eve saw it placed," at the end of stanza xxviii.
3. An emendation of six lines to stanza v. of Canto II., with reference to the comboloio, the Turkish rosary.
4. Forty additional lines to stanza xx. of Canto II., beginning, "For thee in those bright isles," and being the first draft of the addition as printed in the Revises of November 13, etc.
5. Stanza xxvii. of Canto II., twenty-eight lines.
6. Ten additional lines to stanza xxvii., "Ah! happy!"—"depart."

7. Affixed to the rough Copy in stanza xxviii., fifty-eight lines, here called "Continuation." This is the rough Copy of No. 1.

The eighteen loose sheets of additions to Canto I. consist of—

1. The Dedication.
2. Two revisions of "Know ye the land."
3. Seven sheets, Canto I. stanzas i.-v., being the commencement of the Fair Copy in the bound volume.
4. Two sheets of the additional twelve lines to Canto I. stanza vi., "Who hath not proved,"—"Soul."
5. Four sheets of notes to Canto I. stanza vi., dated November 20, November 22, 1813.
6. Two sheets of notes to stanza xvi.

7. Sixteen additional lines to stanza xiii.

The fourteen additional sheets to Canto II. consist of—

1. Ten lines of stanza iv., and four lines of stanza xvii.
2. Two lines and note of stanza v.
3. Sheets of additions, etc., to stanza xx. (eight sheets).
(α) Eight lines, "Or, since that hope,"—"thy command."
(β) "For thee in those bright isles" (twenty-four lines).

(γ) "For thee," etc. (thirty-six lines).

(δ) "Blest as the call" (three variants).

(ε) "For thee in those bright isles" (seven lines).

(ζ) Fourteen lines, "There ev'n thy soul,"—"Zuleika's name," "Aye—let the loud winds,"—"bars escape," additional to stanza xx.

4. Two sheets of five variants of "Ah! wherefore did he turn to look?" being six additional lines to stanza xxv.

5. Thirty-five lines of stanza xxvi.

6. Ten lines, "Ah! happy! but,"—"depart." And eleven lines, "Woe to thee, rash,"—"hast shed," being a continuous addition to stanza xxvii.

REVISES.

Endorsed—

November 13, 1813.

November 15, 1813.

November 16, 1813.

November 18, 1813.

November 19, 1813.

November 21, 1813.

November 23, 1813.

November 24, 1813. A wrong date,

November 25, 1813.

an imperfect revise = Nos. i.-v.

TO
THE RIGHT HONOURABLE
LORD HOLLAND,
THIS TALE
IS INSCRIBED, WITH
EVERY SENTIMENT OF REGARD
AND RESPECT,
BY HIS GRATEFULLY OBLIGED
AND SINCERE FRIEND,

BYRON.^[ey]

THE BRIDE OF ABYDOS.^[124]

CANTO THE FIRST.

I.

How ye the land where the cypress and myrtle^[125]
Are emblems of deeds that are done in their clime?
Are the rage of the vulture, the love of the turtle,
Now melt into sorrow, now madden to crime?
How ye the land of the cedar and vine,
Are the flowers ever blossom, the beams ever shine;
Are the light wings of Zephyr, oppressed with perfume,
As faint o'er the gardens of Gúl^[126] in her bloom;
Are the citron and olive are fairest of fruit,
The voice of the nightingale never is mute;^[127] 10
Are the tints of the earth, and the hues of the sky,
Colour though varied, in beauty may vie,
The purple of Ocean is deepest in dye;
Are the virgins are soft as the roses they twine,
All, save the spirit of man, is divine—
The clime of the East—'tis the land of the Sun—
The smile on such deeds as his children have done?^[128]
Wild as the accents of lovers' farewell^[ez]
The hearts which they bear, and the tales which they tell.

II.^[fa]

Begirt with many a gallant slave,²⁰
Apparelled as becomes the brave,
Awaiting each his Lord's behest
To guide his steps, or guard his rest,
Old Giaffir sate in his Divan:

Deep thought was in his agéd eye;
And though the face of Mussulman
Not oft betrays to standers by
he mind within, well skilled to hide
ll but unconquerable pride,
is pensive cheek and pondering brow^[fb]³⁰
id more than he was wont avow.

III.

: the chamber be cleared."—The train disappeared—
Now call me the chief of the Haram guard"—
1 Giaffir is none but his only son,
nd the Nubian awaiting the sire's award.
Haroun—when all the crowd that wait
re passed beyond the outer gate,
Voe to the head whose eye beheld
ly child Zuleika's face unveiled!)
ence, lead my daughter from her tower—^[fc]⁴⁰
er fate is fixed this very hour;
et not to her repeat my thought—
y me alone be duty taught!"

2acha! to hear is to obey."—
o more must slave to despot say—
hen to the tower had ta'en his way:

ut here young Selim silence brake,
First lowly rendering reverence meet;
nd downcast looked, and gently spake,
Still standing at the Pacha's feet:⁵⁰
or son of Moslem must expire,
re dare to sit before his sire!
Father! for fear that thou shouldst chide
ly sister, or her sable guide—
now—for the fault, if fault there be,
as mine—then fall thy frowns on me!
o lovelily the morning shone,
That—let the old and weary sleep—
could not; and to view alone
The fairest scenes of land and deep,⁶⁰
With none to listen and reply
o thoughts with which my heart beat high
ere irksome—for whate'er my mood,
I sooth I love not solitude;
on Zuleika's slumber broke,
And, as thou knowest that for me
Soon turns the Haram's grating key,
efore the guardian slaves awoke
e to the cypress groves had flown,
nd made earth, main, and heaven our own!⁷⁰
here lingered we, beguiled too long
With Mejnoun's tale, or Sadi's song;^{[fd][129]}
ill I, who heard the deep tambour^[130]
eat thy Divan's approaching hour,
o thee, and to my duty true,
arned by the sound, to greet thee flew:
ut there Zuleika wanders yet—

ay, Father, rage not—nor forget
hat none can pierce that secret bower
ut those who watch the women's tower."⁸⁰

IV.

n of a slave"—the Pacha said—
m unbelieving mother bred,
i were a father's hope to see
ht that beseems a man in thee.
u, when thine arm should bend the bow,
nd hurl the dart, and curb the steed,
hou, Greek in soul if not in creed,
t pore where babbling waters flow,^[fe]
watch unfolding roses blow.
ld that yon Orb, whose matin glow⁹⁰
listless eyes so much admire,
ld lend thee something of his fire!
u, who would'st see this battlement
Christian cannon piecemeal rent;
, tamely view old Stambol's wall
ore the dogs of Moscow fall,
strike one stroke for life and death
inst the curs of Nazareth!
—let thy less than woman's hand
me the distaff—not the brand.¹⁰⁰
Haroun!—to my daughter speed:
hark—of thine own head take heed—
us Zuleika oft takes wing—
u see'st yon bow—it hath a string!"

V.

sound from Selim's lip was heard,
at least that met old Giaffir's ear,
every frown and every word
ced keener than a Christian's sword.
Son of a slave!—reproached with fear!
whose gibes had cost another dear.¹¹⁰
"Of a slave!—and *who* my Sire?"
Thus held his thoughts their dark career;
His glances ev'n of more than ire^[ff]
Dashed forth, then faintly disappear.
Giaffir gazed upon his son
And started; for within his eye
He read how much his wrath had done;
He saw rebellion there begun:
"Come hither, boy—what, no reply?
I mark thee—and I know thee too;¹²⁰
There be deeds thou dar'st not do:
If thy beard had manlier length,
If thy hand had skill and strength,
I would have seen thee break a lance,
And fight against my own perchance."
Softly as these accents fell,
Selim's eye he fiercely gazed:
That eye returned him glance for glance,
And proudly to his Sire's was raised^[fg],
Still Giaffir's quailed and shrunk askance—¹³⁰
Why—he felt, but durst not tell.
Which I misdoubt this wayward boy
Will one day work me more annoy:
I never loved him from his birth,
—but his arm is little worth,

scarcely in the chase could cope
 A timid fawn or antelope,
 less would venture into strife
 ere man contends for fame and life—
 would not trust that look or tone:140
 —nor the blood so near my own.^[fh]
 That blood—he hath not heard—no more—
 watch him closer than before.
 As an Arab^[131] to my sight,
 Christian crouching in the fight—^[fi]
 hark!—I hear Zuleika's voice;
 Like Houris' hymn it meets mine ear:
 This is the offspring of my choice;
 Ah! more than ev'n her mother dear,
 I all to hope, and nought to fear—150
 Peri! ever welcome here!^[fj]
 Let, as the desert fountain's wave
 Drops just cooled in time to save—
 Much to my longing sight art thou;
 Can they waft to Mecca's shrine
 More thanks for life, than I for thine,
 Who blest thy birth and bless thee now."^[fk]

VI.

, as the first that fell of womankind,
 When on that dread yet lovely serpent smiling,
 Those Image then was stamped upon her mind—160
 But once beguiled—and ever more beguiling;
 Gliding, as that, oh! too transcendent vision
 Of Sorrow's phantom-peopled slumber given,
 When heart meets heart again in dreams Elysian,

nd paints the lost on Earth revived in Heaven;
, as the memory of buried love;
, as the prayer which Childhood wafts above;
she—the daughter of that rude old Chief,
met the maid with tears—but not of grief.

hath not proved how feebly words essay^[132]170
ix one spark of Beauty's heavenly ray?
doth not feel, until his failing sight^[f1]
its into dimness with its own delight,
changing cheek, his sinking heart confess
might—the majesty of Loveliness?
was Zuleika—such around her shone
nameless charms unmarked by her alone—
light of Love, the purity of Grace,^[fm]
mind, the Music^[133] breathing from her face,
heart whose softness harmonized the whole,180
oh! that eye was in itself a Soul!

graceful arms in meekness bending
cross her gently-budding breast;
ne kind word those arms extending
o clasp the neck of him who blest
is child caressing and carest,
uleika came—and Giaffir felt
is purpose half within him melt:
ot that against her fancied weal
is heart though stern could ever feel;190
ffection chained her to that heart;
mbition tore the links apart.

VII.

leika! child of Gentleness!
 ow dear this very day must tell,
 en I forget my own distress,
 i losing what I love so well,
 id thee with another dwell:
 ther! and a braver man
 never seen in battle's van.
 Moslem reck not much of blood:200
 ut yet the line of Carasman^[134]
 hanged, unchangeable hath stood
 irst of the bold Timariot bands
 t won and well can keep their lands.^[fn]
 ough that he who comes to woo^[fo]
 nsman of the Bey Oglou:^[135]
 years need scarce a thought employ;
 ould not have thee wed a boy.
 . thou shalt have a noble dower:
 . his and my united power210
 . laugh to scorn the death-firman,
 ch others tremble but to scan,
 . teach the messenger^[136] what fate
 bearer of such boon may wait.
 . now thou know'st thy father's will;
 ll that thy sex hath need to know:
 is mine to teach obedience still—
 he way to love, thy Lord may show."

VIII.

i silence bowed the virgin's head;
 And if her eye was filled with tears220
 hat stifled feeling dare not shed,

nd changed her cheek from pale to red,
And red to pale, as through her ears
hose wingéd words like arrows sped,
What could such be but maiden fears?
o bright the tear in Beauty's eye,
ove half regrets to kiss it dry;
o sweet the blush of Bashfulness,
ven Pity scarce can wish it less!

/hate'er it was the sire forgot:230
r if remembered, marked it not;
hrice clapped his hands, and called his steed,^[137]
Resigned his gem-adorned chibouque,^[138]
nd mounting featly for the mead,
With Maugrabeel^[139] and Mamaluke,
His way amid his Delis took,^[140]
o witness many an active deed
/ith sabre keen, or blunt jerreed.
he Kislar only and his Moors^[141]
atch well the Haram's massy doors.240

IX.

head was leant upon his hand,
is eye looked o'er the dark blue water
t swiftly glides and gently swells
ween the winding Dardanelles;
yet he saw nor sea nor strand,
even his Pacha's turbaned band
lix in the game of mimic slaughter,
æring cleave the folded felt^[142]
n sabre stroke right sharply dealt;

marked the javelin-darting crowd,²⁵⁰
heard their Ollahs^[143] wild and loud—
e thought but of old Giaffir's daughter!

X.

word from Selim's bosom broke;
sigh Zuleika's thought bespoke:
gazed he through the lattice grate,
, mute, and mournfully sedate.
im Zuleika's eye was turned,
little from his aspect learned:
al her grief, yet not the same;
heart confessed a gentler flame:^[fp] 260
yet that heart, alarmed or weak,
knew not why, forbade to speak.
speak she must—but when essay?
w strange he thus should turn away!
thus we e'er before have met;
thus shall be our parting yet."
ce paced she slowly through the room,
nd watched his eye—it still was fixed:
he snatched the urn wherein was mixed
Persian Atar-gul's perfume,^[144] 270
sprinkled all its odours o'er
pictured roof^[145] and marble floor:
drops, that through his glittering vest^[fq]
playful girl's appeal addressed,
eeded o'er his bosom flew,
f that breast were marble too.
iat, sullen yet? it must not be—
gentle Selim, this from thee!"

saw in curious order set
he fairest flowers of Eastern land— 280
loved them once; may touch them yet,
offered by Zuleika's hand."
childish thought was hardly breathed
ere the rose was plucked and wreathed;
next fond moment saw her seat
fairy form at Selim's feet:
his rose to calm my brother's cares
message from the Bulbul^[146] bears;
says to-night he will prolong
Selim's ear his sweetest song; 290
though his note is somewhat sad,
I try for once a strain more glad,
and some faint hope his altered lay
to sing these gloomy thoughts away.

XI.

What! not receive my foolish flower?
Nay then I am indeed unblest:
how can I thus thy forehead lower?
And know'st thou not who loves thee best?^[fr]
Oh, Selim dear! oh, more than dearest!
Say, is it me thou hast or fearest? 300
Come, lay thy head upon my breast,
and I will kiss thee into rest,
since words of mine, and songs must fail,
even from my fabled nightingale.
I knew our sire at times was stern,
but this from thee had yet to learn:
So well I know he loves thee not;

ut is Zuleika's love forgot?
 h! deem I right? the Pacha's plan—
 his kinsman Bey of Carasman³¹⁰
 erhaps may prove some foe of thine.
 so, I swear by Mecca's shrine,—^[fs]
 shrines that ne'er approach allow
 o woman's step admit her vow,—
 /ithout thy free consent—command—
 he Sultan should not have my hand!
 hink'st thou that I could bear to part
 /ith thee, and learn to halve my heart?
 h! were I severed from thy side,
 /here were thy friend—and who my guide?³²⁰
 ears have not seen, Time shall not see,
 he hour that tears my soul from thee:^[ft]
 v'n Azrael, ^[147] from his deadly quiver
 When flies that shaft, and fly it must,^[fu]
 hat parts all else, shall doom for ever
 Our hearts to undivided dust!"

XII.

ived—he breathed—he moved—he felt;
 aised the maid from where she knelt;
 trance was gone, his keen eye shone
 1 thoughts that long in darkness dwelt;³³⁰
 1 thoughts that burn—in rays that melt.
 he stream late concealed
 y the fringe of its willows,
 en it rushes reveal'd
 i the light of its billows;
 he bolt bursts on high

rom the black cloud that bound it,
hed the soul of that eye
hrough the long lashes round it.
ar-horse at the trumpet's sound,³⁴⁰
on roused by heedless hound,
rant waked to sudden strife
graze of ill-directed knife,^[fv]
ts not to more convulsive life
n he, who heard that vow, displayed,
. all, before repressed, betrayed:
w thou art mine, for ever mine,
n life to keep, and scarce with life resign;^[fw]
v thou art mine, that sacred oath,
ugh sworn by one, hath bound us both.³⁵⁰
fondly, wisely hast thou done;
t vow hath saved more heads than one:
blench not thou—thy simplest tress
ms more from me than tenderness;
ould not wrong the slenderest hair
t clusters round thy forehead fair,^[fx]
all the treasures buried far
in the caves of Istakar.^[148]
; morning clouds upon me lowered,
roaches on my head were showered,³⁶⁰
. Giaffir almost called me coward!
v I have motive to be brave;
son of his neglected slave,
, start not, 'twas the term he gave,
v show, though little apt to vaunt,
part his words nor deeds can daunt.
son, indeed!—yet, thanks to thee,

chance I am, at least shall be;
let our plighted secret vow
only known to us as now.³⁷⁰
Now the wretch who dares demand
on Giaffir thy reluctant hand;
the ill-got wealth, a meaner soul
is not a Musselim's^[149] control;
 he not bred in Egripo?^[150]
Whose race let Israel show!
let that pass—to none be told
the oath; the rest shall time unfold.
We and mine leave Osman Bey!
partisans for Peril's day:³⁸⁰
Think not I am what I appear;
arms—and friends—and vengeance near."

XIII.

Think not thou art what thou appearest!
O my Selim, thou art sadly changed:
yestern morn I saw thee gentlest—dearest—
but now thou'rt from thyself estranged.
The love thou surely knew'st before,
thou'rt less—nor can be more.
Hear thee—hear thee—near thee stay—
and hate the night—I know not why,³⁹⁰
so that we meet not but by day;
With thee to live, with thee to die,
I dare not to my hope deny:
 thy cheek—thy eyes—thy lips to kiss—
 this—and this—no more than this;^[fy]
Allah! sure thy lips are flame:

What fever in thy veins is flushing?
own have nearly caught the same,
at least I feel my cheek, too, blushing.
Too the thy sickness, watch thy health,⁴⁰⁰
Oake, but never waste thy wealth,
stand with smiles un murmuring by,
to lighten half thy poverty;
all but close thy dying eye,
that I could not live to try;
these alone my thoughts aspire:
What can I do? or thou require?

Selim, thou must answer why^[fz]
need so much of mystery?
cause I cannot dream nor tell,⁴¹⁰
be it, since thou say'st 'tis well;
what thou mean'st by 'arms' and 'friends,'
and my weaker sense extends.
Want that Giaffir should have heard
the very vow I plighted thee;
wrath would not revoke my word:
but surely he would leave me free.
Can this fond wish seem strange in me,
be what I have ever been?
What other hath Zuleika seen⁴²⁰
in simple childhood's earliest hour?
What other can she seek to see
in thee, companion of her bower,
the partner of her infancy?
These cherished thoughts with life begun,
say, why must I no more avow?
What change is wrought to make me shun
the truth—my pride, and thine till now?

meet the gaze of stranger's eyes
 law—our creed—our God denies;⁴³⁰
 shall one wandering thought of mine
 uch, our Prophet's will, repine:
 happier made by that decree,
 eft me all in leaving thee.
 p were my anguish, thus compelled^[ga]
 ved with one I ne'er beheld:
 ; wherefore should I not reveal?
 y wilt thou urge me to conceal?^[gb]
 ow the Pacha's haughty mood
 hee hath never boded good;⁴⁴⁰
 he so often storms at nought,
 h! forbid that e'er he ought!
 why I know not, but within
 heart concealment weighs like sin.^[gc]
 en such secrecy be crime,
 nd such it feels while lurking here;
 Selim! tell me yet in time,
 or leave me thus to thoughts of fear.
 yonder see the Tchocadar,^[151]
 father leaves the mimic war;⁴⁵⁰
 mble now to meet his eye—
 Selim, canst thou tell me why?"

XIV.

leika—to thy tower's retreat
 ke thee—Giaffir I can greet:
 now with him I fain must prate
 irmans, imposts, levies, state.
 re's fearful news from Danube's banks,

Vizier nobly thins his ranks
which the Giaour may give him thanks!
Sultan hath a shorter way⁴⁶⁰
A costly triumph to repay.
mark me, when the twilight drum
hath warned the troops to food and sleep,
O thy cell with Selim come;
then softly from the Haram creep
Where we may wander by the deep:
our garden battlements are steep;
these will rash intruder climb
list our words, or stint our time;
if he doth, I want not steel⁴⁷⁰
which some have felt, and more may feel.
thou shalt thou learn of Selim more
than thou hast heard or thought before:
list me, Zuleika—fear not me!
thou know'st I hold a Haram key."

For thee, my Selim! ne'er till now
words like this——"

"Delay not thou;^[gd]
Open the key—and Haroun's guard
leave *some*, and hope of *more* reward.
Tonight, Zuleika, thou shalt hear⁴⁸⁰
my tale, my purpose, and my fear:
I am not, love! what I appear."

CANTO THE SECOND.^[ge]



I.

winds are high on Helle's wave,
s on that night of stormy water
en Love, who sent, forgot to save
young—the beautiful—the brave—
he lonely hope of Sestos' daughter.
when alone along the sky
turret-torch was blazing high,
ugh rising gale, and breaking foam, 490
shrieking sea-birds warned him home;
clouds aloft and tides below,
n signs and sounds, forbade to go,
could not see, he would not hear,
ound or sign foreboding fear;
eye but saw that light of Love,
only star it hailed above;
ear but rang with Hero's song,
waves, divide not lovers long!"—
t tale is old, but Love anew^[152] 500
nerve young hearts to prove as true.

II.

winds are high and Helle's tide
olls darkly heaving to the main;
Night's descending shadows hide
hat field with blood bedewed in vain,
desert of old Priam's pride;
he tombs, sole relics of his reign,
—save immortal dreams that could beguile
blind old man of Scio's rocky isle!

III.

yet—for there my steps have been; 510
these feet have pressed the sacred shore,
these limbs that buoyant wave hath borne—
strel! with thee to muse, to mourn,
to trace again those fields of yore,
renewing every hillock green
contains no fabled hero's ashes,
that around the undoubted scene
his own "broad Hellespont"^[153] still dashes,
long my lot! and cold were he
to there could gaze denying thee! 520

IV.

Night hath closed on Helle's stream,
nor yet hath risen on Ida's hill
the Moon, which shone on his high theme:
the warrior chides her peaceful beam,
but conscious shepherds bless it still.
Their flocks are grazing on the Mound
of him who felt the Dardan's arrow:
that mighty heap of gathered ground
which Ammon's son ran proudly round,^[154]
generations raised, by monarchs crowned, 530
now a lone and nameless barrow!
Narrow—thy dwelling-place how narrow!^[155]
Shut out—can only strangers breathe
the name of him that was beneath:
that long outlasts the storied stone;
Thou—thy very dust is gone!

V.

, late to-night will Dian cheer
swain, and chase the boatman's fear;
then—no beacon on the cliff
shape the course of struggling skiff; 540
scattered lights that skirt the bay,
one by one, have died away;
only lamp of this lone hour
immering in Zuleika's tower.
there is light in that lone chamber,
and o'er her silken ottoman
thrown the fragrant beads of amber,
'er which her fairy fingers ran,^[156]
r these, with emerald rays beset,^[157]
w could she thus that gem forget?) 550
mother's sainted amulet,^[158]
ereon engraved the Koorsee text,
ld smooth this life, and win the next;
by her Comboloio^[159] lies
oran of illumined dyes;
many a bright emblazoned rhyme
Persian scribes redeemed from Time;
o'er those scrolls, not oft so mute,
lines her now neglected lute;
round her lamp of fretted gold 560
om flowers in urns of China's mould;
richest work of Iran's loom,
Sheeraz^[160] tribute of perfume;

that can eye or sense delight
re gathered in that gorgeous room:
ut yet it hath an air of gloom.

of this Peri cell the sprite,
at doth she hence, and on so rude a night?

VI.

pt in the darkest sable vest,
Which none save noblest Moslem wear,⁵⁷⁰
guard from winds of Heaven the breast
s Heaven itself to Selim dear,
n cautious steps the thicket threading,
nd starting oft, as through the glade
he gust its hollow moanings made,
on the smoother pathway treading,
e free her timid bosom beat,
he maid pursued her silent guide;
though her terror urged retreat,
ow could she quit her Selim's side?⁵⁸⁰
ow teach her tender lips to chide?

VII.

y reached at length a grotto, hewn
y nature, but enlarged by art,
ere oft her lute she wont to tune,
nd oft her Koran conned apart;
oft in youthful reverie
dreamed what Paradise might be:
ere Woman's parted soul shall go
Prophet had disdained to show;^{[gff][161]}
Selim's mansion was secure, ⁵⁹⁰
deemed she, could he long endure
bower in other worlds of bliss
out *her*, most beloved in this!

who so dear with him could dwell?
at Houri soothe him half so well?

VIII.

re last she visited the spot
ie change seemed wrought within the grot:
ight be only that the night
guised things seen by better light:
t brazen lamp but dimly threw 600
y of no celestial hue;
in a nook within the cell
eye on stranger objects fell.
re arms were piled, not such as wield
turbaned Delis in the field;
brands of foreign blade and hilt,
one was red—perchance with guilt!^[gg]
how without can blood be spilt?
up too on the board was set
t did not seem to hold sherbet. 610
at may this mean? she turned to see
Selim—"Oh! can this be he?"^[gh]

IX.

robe of pride was thrown aside,
is brow no high-crowned turban bore,
in its stead a shawl of red,
breathed lightly round, his temples wore:
t dagger, on whose hilt the gem
e worthy of a diadem,
onger glittered at his waist,
ere pistols unadorned were braced; 620

from his belt a sabre swung,
from his shoulder loosely hung
cloak of white, the thin capote
t decks the wandering Candiote;
eath—his golden plated vest
ng like a cuirass to his breast;
greaves below his knee that wound
n silvery scales were sheathed and bound.
were it not that high command
xe in his eye, and tone, and hand, 630
that a careless eye could see
him was some young Galiongée.^[162]

X.

id I was not what I seemed;
nd now thou see'st my words were true:
ve a tale thou hast not dreamed,
sooth—its truth must others rue.
story now 'twere vain to hide,
ist not see thee Osman's bride:
had not thine own lips declared
v much of that young heart I shared, 640
uld not, must not, yet have shown
darker secret of my own.
is I speak not now of love;
t—let Time—Truth—and Peril prove:
first—Oh! never wed another—
ika! I am not thy brother!"

XI.

! not my brother!—yet unsay—

od! am I left alone on earth
 nourn—I dare not curse—the day^[gi]
 hat saw my solitary birth?⁶⁵⁰
 thou wilt love me now no more!
 ly sinking heart foreboded ill;
 know *me* all I was before,
 hy sister—friend—Zuleika still.
 u led'st me here perchance to kill;
 thou hast cause for vengeance, see!
 breast is offered—take thy fill!
 ar better with the dead to be
 han live thus nothing now to thee:
 iaps far worse, for now I know⁶⁶⁰
 / Giaffir always seemed thy foe;
 . I, alas! am Giaffir's child,
 whom thou wert contemned, reviled.
 t thy sister—would'st thou save
 life—Oh! bid me be thy slave!"

XII.

r slave, Zuleika!—nay, I'm thine:
 ut, gentle love, this transport calm,
 lot shall yet be linked with mine;
 ear it by our Prophet's shrine,^[gi]
 nd be that thought thy sorrow's balm.⁶⁷⁰
 nay the Koran^[163] verse displayed
 n its steel direct my blade,
 anger's hour to guard us both,
 preserve that awful oath!
 name in which thy heart hath prided
 lust change; but, my Zuleika, know,

t tie is widened, not divided,
 lthough thy Sire's my deadliest foe.
 father was to Giaffir all
 hat Selim late was deemed to thee;⁶⁸⁰
 t brother wrought a brother's fall,
 ut spared, at least, my infancy!
 . lulled me with a vain deceit
 t yet a like return may meet.
 eared me, not with tender help,
 ut like the nephew of a Cain;^[164]
 vatched me like a lion's whelp,
 hat gnaws and yet may break his chain.
 ly father's blood in every vein
 oiling! but for thy dear sake⁶⁹⁰
 present vengeance will I take;
 hough here I must no more remain.
 first, beloved Zuleika! hear
 v Giaffir wrought this deed of fear.

XIII.

w first their strife to rancour grew,
 Love or Envy made them foes,
 atters little if I knew;
 ery spirits, slights, though few
 nd thoughtless, will disturb repose.
 ar Abdallah's arm was strong, ⁷⁰⁰
 embered yet in Bosniac song,^[165]
 . Paswan's^[166] rebel hordes attest
 v little love they bore such guest:
 death is all I need relate,
 stern effect of Giaffir's hate;

How my birth disclosed to me,^[gk]
ate'er beside it makes, hath made me free.

XIV.

Then Paswan, after years of strife,
Fought for power, but first for life,
And Iddin's walls too proudly sate, 710
Pachas rallied round the state;
Last nor least in high command,
A brother led a separate band;
They gave their Horse-tails^[167] to the wind,
And mustering in Sophia's plain
Their tents were pitched, their post assigned;
To one, alas! assigned in vain!
What need of words? the deadly bowl,
By Giaffir's order drugged and given,
A venom subtle as his soul,^[gl]
Dismissed Abdallah's hence to heaven. 720
Faded and feverish in the bath,
When the hunter's sport was up,
Little deemed a brother's wrath
To quench his thirst had such a cup:
The bowl a bribed attendant bore;
He drank one draught,^[168] nor needed more!
Fool my tale, Zuleika, doubt,
Haroun—he can tell it out.

XV.

The deed once done, and Paswan's feud 730
Was art suppressed, though ne'er subdued,

Abdallah's Pachalick was gained:—
 You know'st not what in our Divan
 Wealth procure for worse than man—
 Abdallah's honours were obtained
 When a brother's murder stained;
 True, the purchase nearly drained
 Ill-got treasure, soon replaced.
 Would'st question whence? Survey the waste,
 Ask the squalid peasant how 740
 Gains repay his broiling brow!—
 For me the stern Usurper spared,
 For thus with me his palace spared,
 How not. Shame—regret—remorse—
 A little fear from infant's force—
 Besides, adoption as a son
 When whom Heaven accorded none,
 Some unknown cabal, caprice,
 Served me thus:—but not in peace:
 Cannot curb his haughty mood, [gm] 750
 I forgive a father's blood.

XVI.

Thin thy Father's house are foes;
 Not all who break his bread are true:
 These should I my birth disclose,
 His days—his very hours were few:
 They only want a heart to lead,
 And to point them to the deed.
 Haroun only knows, or knew
 His tale, whose close is almost nigh:
 In Abdallah's palace grew, 760

nd held that post in his Serai
 /hich holds he here—he saw him die;
 what could single slavery do?
 nge his lord? alas! too late;
 ave his son from such a fate?
 hose the last, and when elate
 /ith foes subdued, or friends betrayed,
 id Giaffir in high triumph sate,
 ed me helpless to his gate,
 nd not in vain it seems essayed 770
 o save the life for which he prayed.
 knowledge of my birth secured
 rom all and each, but most from me;
 s Giaffir's safety was ensured.
 emoved he too from Roumelie
 his our Asiatic side,
 from our seats by Danube's tide,
 /ith none but Haroun, who retains
 n knowledge—and that Nubian feels
 . Tyrant's secrets are but chains, 780
 n which the captive gladly steals,
 . this and more to me reveals:
 n still to guilt just Allah sends—
 es, tools, accomplices—no friends!

XVII.

this, Zuleika, harshly sounds;
 ut harsher still my tale must be:
 ve'er my tongue thy softness wounds,
 et I must prove all truth to thee."^[gn]
 saw thee start this garb to see,

is it one I oft have worn,⁷⁹⁰
 and long must wear: this Galiongée,
 whom thy plighted vow is sworn,
 leader of those pirate hordes,
 whose laws and lives are on their swords;
 hear whose desolating tale
 would make thy waning cheek more pale:
 these arms thou see'st my band have brought,
 hands that wield are not remote;
 no cup too for the rugged knaves
 filled—once quaffed, they ne'er repine:⁸⁰⁰
 Prophet might forgive the slaves;
 they're only infidels in wine.

XVIII.

What could I be? Proscribed at home,
 taunted to a wish to roam;
 listless left—for Giaffir's fear
 tied the courser and the spear—
 enough oft—Oh, Mahomet! how oft!—
 still Divan the despot scoffed,
 of *my* weak unwilling hand
 used the bridle or the brand: ⁸¹⁰
 never went to war alone,
 dependent me here untried—unknown;
 Haroun's care with women left, ^[go]
 hope unblest, of fame bereft,
 leave thou—whose softness long endeared,
 though it unmanned me, still had cheered—
 Brusa's walls for safety sent,
 witnessed there the field's event.

sun who saw my spirit pining^[gp]
beneath inaction's sluggish yoke, 820
captive, though with dread resigning,
thy thralldom for a season broke,
promise to return before
that day when Giaffir's charge was o'er.
vain—my tongue can not impart^[gq]
almost drunkenness of heart,^[169]
when first this liberated eye
surveyed Earth—Ocean—Sun—and Sky—
thine my Spirit pierced them through,
and all their inmost wonders knew! 830
No word alone can paint to thee
more than feeling—I was Free!
For thy presence ceased to pine;
The World—nay, Heaven itself was mine!

XIX.

A shallow of a trusty Moor
swept me from this idle shore;
I longed to see the isles that gem
The Ocean's purple diadem:
Sight by turns, and saw them all,^[170]
But when and where I joined the crew, 840
In whom I'm pledged to rise or fall,
When all that we design to do
Shall one, 'twill then be time more meet
To tell thee, when the tale's complete.

XX.

is true, they are a lawless brood,
rough in form, nor mild in mood;
every creed, and every race,
in them hath found—may find a place:
open speech, and ready hand,
obedience to their Chief's command; 850
valiant for every enterprise,
that never sees with Terror's eyes;
friendship for each, and faith to all,
vengeance vowed for those who fall,
we made them fitting instruments
more than e'en my own intents.
I have some—and I have studied all
distinguished from the vulgar rank,
chiefly to my council call
the wisdom of the cautious Frank:— 860
some to higher thoughts aspire.
The last of Lambro's^[171] patriots there
anticipated freedom share;
I oft around the cavern fire
visionary schemes debate,
to snatch the Rayahs^[172] from their fate.
Let them ease their hearts with prate
of equal rights, which man ne'er knew;
I have a love for freedom too.
I! let me like the ocean-Patriarch^[173] roam, 870
I only know on land the Tartar's home!^[174]
I tent on shore, my galley on the sea,
I more than cities and Serais to me:^[175]
I ride by my steed, or wafted by my sail,
I cross the desert, or before the gale,

nd where thou wilt, my barb! or glide, my prow!
be the Star that guides the wanderer, Thou!
u, my Zuleika, share and bless my bark;
Dove of peace and promise to mine ark!^[176]
since that hope denied in worlds of strife, 880
hou the rainbow to the storms of life!
evening beam that smiles the clouds away,
. tints to-morrow with prophetic ray!^[177]
it—as the Muezzin's strain from Mecca's wall
ilgrims pure and prostrate at his call;
—as the melody of youthful days,
t steals the trembling tear of speechless praise;
r—as his native song to Exile's ears,^[gr]
l sound each tone thy long-loved voice endears.
thee in those bright isles is built a bower 890
oming as Aden^[178] in its earliest hour.
ousand swords, with Selim's heart and hand,
t—wave—defend—destroy—at thy command!^[gs]
by my band, Zuleika at my side,
spoil of nations shall bedeck my bride.
Haram's languid years of listless ease
well resigned for cares—for joys like these:
blind to Fate, I see, where'er I rove,
umbered perils,—but one only love!
well my toils shall that fond breast repay, 900
ugh Fortune frown, or falser friends betray.
r dear the dream in darkest hours of ill,
uld all be changed, to find thee faithful still!
out thy soul, like Selim's firmly shown;
hee be Selim's tender as thine own;
oother each sorrow, share in each delight,^[gt]

and every thought, do all—but disunite!
be free, 'tis mine our horde again to guide;
hands to each other, foes to aught beside:^[179]
there we follow but the bent assigned 910
fatal Nature to man's warring kind:^[gu]
hark! where his carnage and his conquests cease!
He makes a solitude, and calls it—peace!^{[gv][180]}
And the rest must use my skill or strength,
ask no land beyond my sabre's length:
Her sways but by division—her resource^[gw]
the blest alternative of fraud or force!
She shall be the last; in time Deceit may come
And in cities cage us in a social home:
For ere ev'n thy soul might err—how oft the heart 920
Corruption shakes which Peril could not part!
O Woman, more than Man, when Death or Woe,
Or even Disgrace, would lay her lover low,
Hark in the lap of Luxury will shame—
My suspicion!—*not* Zuleika's name!
For life is hazard at the best; and here
More remains to win, and much to fear:
 O fear!—the doubt, the dread of losing thee,
Osman's power, and Giaffir's stern decree.
That dread shall vanish with the favouring gale, 930
Which Love to-night hath promised to my sail:^[gx]
No danger daunts the pair his smile hath blest,
Their steps still roving, but their hearts at rest.
And in thee all toils are sweet, each clime hath charms;
Land—sea alike—our world within our arms!
—let the loud winds whistle o'er the deck,^[181]
That those arms cling closer round my neck:

deepest murmur of this lip shall be,^{[gy][182]}
sigh for safety, but a prayer for thee!
war of elements no fears impart 940
love, whose deadliest bane is human Art:
re lie the only rocks our course can check;
2 moments menace—*there* are years of wreck!
hence ye thoughts that rise in Horror's shape!
hour bestows, or ever bars escape.^[gz]
words remain of mine my tale to close;
hine but *one* to waft us from our foes;
—foes—to me will Giaffir's hate decline?
is not Osman, who would part us, thine?

XXI.

head and faith from doubt and death⁹⁵⁰
eturned in time my guard to save;
ew heard, none told, that o'er the wave
n isle to isle I roved the while:
since, though parted from my band
seldom now I leave the land,
deed they've done, nor deed shall do,
I have heard and doomed it too:
m the plan—decree the spoil—
fit I oftener share the toil.
now too long I've held thine ear;⁹⁶⁰
e presses—floats my bark—and here
leave behind but hate and fear.
narrow Osman with his train
ves—to-night must break thy chain:
would'st thou save that haughty Bey,—
erchance *his* life who gave thee thine,—

1 me this hour away—away!
ut yet, though thou art plighted mine,
ld'st thou recall thy willing vow,
alled by truths imparted now,⁹⁷⁰
e rest I—not to see thee wed:
be that peril on *my* head!"

XXII.

ika, mute and motionless,
d like that Statue of Distress,
en, her last hope for ever gone,
Mother hardened into stone;
in the maid that eye could see
but a younger Niobé.
ere her lip, or even her eye,
ried to speak, or look reply, ⁹⁸⁰
eath the garden's wicket porch
flashed on high a blazing torch!
ther—and another—and another—^[183]
! fly—no more—yet now my more than brother!"
wide, through every thicket spread
fearful lights are gleaming red;
these alone—for each right hand
ady with a sheathless brand.
y part—pursue—return, and wheel
1 searching flambeau, shining steel; ⁹⁹⁰
. last of all, his sabre waving,
n Giaffir in his fury raving:
. now almost they touch the cave—
must that grot be Selim's grave?

XXIII.

ntless he stood—"Tis come—soon past—
 kiss, Zuleika—'tis my last:
 ut yet my band not far from shore
 'hear this signal, see the flash;
 now too few—the attempt were rash:
 o matter—yet one effort more."¹⁰⁰⁰
 h to the cavern mouth he stept;
 is pistol's echo rang on high,
 ika started not, nor wept,
 despair benumbed her breast and eye!—
 ey hear me not, or if they ply
 ir oars,'tis but to see me die;
 t sound hath drawn my foes more nigh.
 n forth my father's scimitar,
 u ne'er hast seen less equal war!
 well, Zuleika!—Sweet! retire:¹⁰¹⁰
 et stay within—here linger safe,
 t thee his rage will only chafe.
 not—lest even to thee perchance
 ie erring blade or ball should glance.
 'st them for him?—may I expire
 this strife I seek thy sire!
 —though by him that poison poured;
 —though again he call me coward!
 tamely shall I meet their steel?
 —as each crest save *his* may feel!"¹⁰²⁰

XXIV.

bound he made, and gained the sand:
 lready at his feet hath sunk
 foremost of the prying band,

gasping head, a quivering trunk:
ther falls—but round him close
varming circle of his foes;
n right to left his path he cleft,
nd almost met the meeting wave:
boat appears—not five oars' length—
comrades strain with desperate strength—1030
h! are they yet in time to save?
is feet the foremost breakers lave;
band are plunging in the bay,
ir sabres glitter through the spray;
—wild—unwearied to the strand
y struggle—now they touch the land!
y come—'tis but to add to slaughter—
heart's best blood is on the water.

XXV.

aped from shot, unharmed by steel,
arcely grazed its force to feel,^[ha] 1040
Selim won, betrayed, beset,
where the strand and billows met;
re as his last step left the land,
the last death-blow dealt his hand—
wherefore did he turn to look^[hb]
or her his eye but sought in vain?
t pause, that fatal gaze he took,
ath doomed his death, or fixed his chain.
proof, in peril and in pain,
late will Lover's hope remain! 1050
back was to the dashing spray;
ind, but close, his comrades lay,

en, at the instant, hissed the ball—
may the foes of Giaffir fall!"
ose voice is heard? whose carbine rang?
ose bullet through the night-air sang,
nearly, deadly aimed to err?
thine—Abdallah's Murderer!
father slowly rued thy hate,
son hath found a quicker fate: 1060
from his breast the blood is bubbling,
whiteness of the sea-foam troubling—
ight his lips essayed to groan,
rushing billows choked the tone!

XXVI.

n slowly rolls the clouds away;
ew trophies of the fight are there:
shouts that shook the midnight-bay
silent; but some signs of fray
hat strand of strife may bear,
. fragments of each shivered brand;1070
s stamped; and dashed into the sand
print of many a struggling hand
lay there be marked; nor far remote
. broken torch, an oarless boat;
. tangled on the weeds that heap
beach where shelving to the deep
here lies a white capote!
rent in twain—one dark-red stain
wave yet ripples o'er in vain:
ut where is he who wore?1080
who would o'er his relics weep,

seek them where the surges sweep
 ir burthen round Sigæum's steep
 nd cast on Lemnos' shore:
 sea-birds shriek above the prey,
 which their hungry beaks delay,^[hc]
 haken on his restless pillow,
 head heaves with the heaving billow;
 t hand, whose motion is not life,^[hd]
 feebly seems to menace strife,¹⁰⁹⁰
 ig by the tossing tide on high,
 hen levelled with the wave—^[184]
 at reck's it, though that corse shall lie
 /ithin a living grave?
 bird that tears that prostrate form
 n only robbed the meaner worm;
 only heart, the only eye
 bled or wept to see him die,
 seen those scattered limbs composed,
 nd mourned above his turban-stone,^[185]¹¹⁰⁰
 t heart hath burst—that eye was closed—
 ea—closed before his own!

XXVII.

Helle's stream there is a voice of wail!
 . Woman's eye is wet—Man's cheek is pale:
 ika! last of Giaffir's race,
 hy destined lord is come too late:
 sees not—ne'er shall see thy face!
 Can he not hear
 loud Wul-wulleh^[186] warn his distant ear?
 hy handmaids weeping at the gate,¹¹¹⁰

he Koran-chanters of the Hymn of Fate,^{[he][187]}
 he silent slaves with folded arms that wait,
 is in the hall, and shrieks upon the gale,
 Tell him thy tale!
 u didst not view thy Selim fall!
 hat fearful moment when he left the cave
 Thy heart grew chill:
 e was thy hope—thy joy—thy love—thine all,
 nd that last thought on him thou could'st not save
 Sufficed to kill;¹¹²⁰
 st forth in one wild cry—and all was still.
 eace to thy broken heart—and virgin grave!
 happy! but of life to lose the worst!
 t grief—though deep—though fatal—was thy first!
 ce happy! ne'er to feel nor fear the force
 bsence—shame—pride—hate—revenge—remorse!
 , oh! that pang where more than Madness lies
 Worm that will not sleep—and never dies;
 ught of the gloomy day and ghastly night,
 t dreads the darkness, and yet loathes the light,¹¹³⁰
 t winds around, and tears the quivering heart!
 wherefore not consume it—and depart!
 e to thee, rash and unrelenting Chief!
 ainly thou heap'st the dust upon thy head,
 ainly the sackcloth o'er thy limbs dost spread:^[188]
 y that same hand Abdallah—Selim bled.
 7 let it tear thy beard in idle grief:
 pride of heart, thy bride for Osman's bed,
 whom thy Sultan had but seen to wed,^[hf]
 Thy Daughter's dead!¹¹⁴⁰
 ope of thine age, thy twilight's lonely beam,

he Star hath set that shone on Helle's stream.
it quenched its ray?—the blood that thou hast shed!
κ! to the hurried question of Despair:^[189]
ere is my child?"—an Echo answers—"Where?"^[190]

XXVIII.

Within the place of thousand tombs
That shine beneath, while dark above
he sad but living cypress glooms^[hg]
And withers not, though branch and leaf
re stamped with an eternal grief, 1150
Like early unrequited Love,
ne spot exists, which ever blooms,
Ev'n in that deadly grove—
single rose is shedding there
Its lonely lustre, meek and pale:
looks as planted by Despair—
So white—so faint—the slightest gale
light whirl the leaves on high;
And yet, though storms and blight assail,
nd hands more rude than wintry sky 1160
May wring it from the stem—in vain—
To-morrow sees it bloom again!
he stalk some Spirit gently rears,
nd waters with celestial tears;
For well may maids of Helle deem
hat this can be no earthly flower,
Which mocks the tempest's withering hour,
nd buds unsheltered by a bower;
or droops, though Spring refuse her shower,
Nor woos the Summer beam: 1170

o it the livelong night there sings
A Bird unseen—but not remote:
invisible his airy wings,
ut soft as harp that Houri strings
His long entrancing note!
were the Bulbul; but his throat,
Though mournful, pours not such a strain:
or they who listen cannot leave
he spot, but linger there and grieve,
As if they loved in vain! 1180
nd yet so sweet the tears they shed,
is sorrow so unmixed with dread,
hey scarce can bear the morn to break
That melancholy spell,
nd longer yet would weep and wake,
He sings so wild and well!
ut when the day-blush bursts from high^[hh]
Expires that magic melody.
nd some have been who could believe,^[hi]
so fondly youthful dreams deceive, 1190
Yet harsh be they that blame,)
hat note so piercing and profound
/ill shape and syllable^[191] its sound
Into Zuleika's name.
is from her cypress summit heard,
hat melts in air the liquid word:
is from her lowly virgin earth
hat white rose takes its tender birth.
here late was laid a marble stone;
ve saw it placed—the Morrow gone! 1200
was no mortal arm that bore

hat deep fixed pillar to the shore;
or there, as Helle's legends tell,
ext morn 'twas found where Selim fell;
ashed by the tumbling tide, whose wave
enied his bones a holier grave:
nd there by night, reclined, 'tis said.
seen a ghastly turbaned head:[192]
And hence extended by the billow,
'Tis named the "Pirate-phantom's pillow!" 1210
Where first it lay that mourning flower
Hath flourished; flourisheth this hour,
lone and dewy—coldly pure and pale;
s weeping Beauty's cheek at Sorrow's tale![hj][193]

NOTE TO *THE BRIDE OF ABYDOS*.



CANTO II. STANZA XX.

AFTER the completion of the fair copy of the MS. of the *Bride of Abydos*, seventy lines were added to stanza xx. of Canto II. In both MSS. the rough and fair copies, the stanza ends with the line, "The Dove of peace and promise to mine ark!"

Seven MS. sheets are extant, which make up the greater portion of these additional lines.

The *First Addition* amounts to eight lines, and takes the narrative from line 880 to line 893, "Wait—wave—defend— destroy—at thy command!"

Lines 884-889 do not appear in the first MS. Fragment, but are given in three variants on separate sheets. Two of these are dated December 2 and December 3, 1813.

The *Second Fragment* begins with line 890, "For thee in those bright isles is built a bower," and, numbering twenty-two lines, ends with a variant of line 907, "Blend every thought, do all—but disunite!" Two lines of this addition, "With thee all toils are sweet," find a place in the text as lines 934, 935.

The *Third Fragment* amounts to thirty-six lines, and may be taken as the first draft of the whole additions—lines 880-949.

Lines 908-925 and 936-945 of the text are still later additions, but a fourth MS. fragment supplies lines 920-925 and lines 936-945. (A fair copy of this fragment gives text for Revise of November 13.) Between November 13 and November 25 no less than ten revises of the *Bride* were submitted to Lord Byron. In the earliest of these, dated November 13, the thirty-six lines of the Third Fragment have been expanded into forty lines—four lines of the MS. being omitted, and twelve lines, 908-919, "Once free,"—"social home," being inserted. The text passed through five revises and remained unaltered till November 21, when eighteen lines were added to the forty, viz.: (4) "Mark! where his carnage,"—"sabre's length;" (6) "There ev'n thy soul,"—"Zuleika's name;" and (8) "Aye—let the loud winds,"—"bars escape." Of these the two latter additions belong to the *Fourth Fragment*. The text in this state passed through three more revises, but before the first edition was issued two more lines were added—lines 938, 939,

a deepest murmur of this lip shall be,
sigh for safety, but a prayer for thee!"

Even then the six lines, "Blest—as the Muezzin's,"—"endears," are wanting in the text; but the four lines, "Soft—as the melody,"—"endears," are inserted in MS. in the margin. The text as it stands first appears in the Seventh Edition.

[FIRST DRAFT OF 880, SQ., OF CANTO II. STANZ XX. OF THE *BRIDE OF ABYDOS*.]

thee in those bright isles is built a bower

Aden, in its earliest hour

oming as ~~Eden—guarded like a tower~~

ousand swords—thy Selim's soul and hand

t on thy voice, and bow to thy command

pair

Danger daunts—the ~~souls~~ that Love hath blest

steps still roving

~~1 feet long—wandering—~~but with hearts at rest.

~~thee my blade shall shine—my hand shall toil~~

1 thee all toils were sweet—each clime hath charms {line 934}

h—sea—alike—one World within our arms {line 935}

by my hand—Zuleika at my side—

Spoil of nations shall bedeck my bride

slumbring

Haram's ~~sluggish~~ life of listless ease

ell exchanged for cares and joys like these

~~e be the lot to know where'er I rove~~

~~ousand perils wait where'er I rove,~~

blind to fate I view where'er I rove

ousand perils—but one only love—

well my labor shall fond breast repay

en Fortune frowns or falser friends betray

7 dear the thought in darkest hours of ill

uld all be changed to find thee faithful still

out thy soul like Selim's firmly shown

~~mine in firmness~~

~~r as my own I deem thy tender heart~~

hee be Selim's tender as thine own

hange, or mingle every thought with his

. all our future days unite in this.

I may lead—but trust not—I may fall
hose now friends to me—yet foes to all—
is they follow but the bent assigned
fatal Nature
~~savage Nature~~ to our warning kind
there—oh, far be every thought of fear
is but peril at the best—and here
more remains to win and much to fear
fear—the doubt the dread of losing thee—
t dread must vanish.

FOOTNOTES:

[ey.]

*To the Right Hon^{ble}
Henry Richard Vassal
Lord Holland
This Tale
Is inscribed with
Every sentiment of the
Most affectionate respect
by his gratefully obliged serv^t.
And sincere Friend
Byron.*

[*Proof and Revise.*—See *Letters to Murray*, November 13, 17, 1813.]

[124] {157} ["Murray tells me that Croker asked him why the thing was called the *Bride* of Abydos? It is a cursed awkward question, being unanswerable. *She* is not a *bride*, only about to become one. I don't wonder at his finding out the *Bull*; but the detection ... is too late to do any good. I was a great fool to make it, and am ashamed of not being an Irishman."—*Journal*, December 6, 1813; *Letters*, 1898, ii. 365.

Byron need not have been dismayed. "The term is particularly applied on the day of marriage and during the 'honeymoon,' but is frequently used from the proclamation of the banns.... In the debate on Prince Leopold's allowance, Mr. Gladstone, being criticized for

speaking of the Princess Helena as the 'bride,' said he believed that colloquially a lady when engaged was often called a 'bride.' This was met with 'Hear! Hear!' from some, and 'No! No!' from others."—*N. Engl. Dict.*, art. "Bride."]

[125] [The opening lines were probably suggested by Goethe's—"Kennst du das Land wo die citronen blühn?"]

[126] "Gúl," the rose.

[127] {158} ["'Where the Citron,' etc. These lines are in the MS., and *omitted* by the Printer, whom I *again* request to look over it, and see that no others are *omitted*.—B." (Revise No. 1, November 13, 1813.)

"I ought and do apologise to Mr.— the Printer for charging him with an omission of the lines which I find was my own—but I also wish *he* would not print such a stupid word as *finest* for fairest." (Revise, November 15, 1813.)

The lines, "Where the Citron," etc., are absent from a fair copy dated November 11, but are inserted as an addition in an earlier draft.]

[128]

"Souls made of fire, and children of the Sun,
With whom revenge is virtue."

YOUNG'S *Revenge*, act v. sc. 2 (*British Theatre*, 1792, p. 84).

[ez] *For wild as the moment of lovers' farewell.*—[MS.]

[fa] *Canto 1st The Bride of Abydos. Nov. 1st 1813.*—[MS.]

[fb] {159} *The changing cheek and knitting brow.*—[MS. i.]

[fc]

*Hence—bid my daughter hither come
This hour decides her future doom—
Yet not to her these words express
But lead her from the tower's recess.*—[MSS. i., ii.]

[These lines must have been altered in proof, for all the revises accord with the text.]

[fd] {160} *With many a tale and mutual song.*—[ms]

[129] Mejnoun and Leila, the Romeo and Juliet of the East. Sadi, the moral poet of Persia. [For the "story of Leila and Mujnoon," see *The Gulistan, or Rose Garden* of ... Saadi,

translated by Francis Gladwin, Boston, 1865, Tale xix. pp. 288, 289; and Gulistan ... du Cheikh Sa'di ... Traduit par W. Semelet, Paris, 1834, Notes on Chapitre V. p. 304. Sa'di "moralizes" the tale, to the effect that love dwells in the eye of the beholder. See, too, Jāmī's *Medjnoun et Leila*, translated by A. L. Chezy, Paris, 1807.]

[130] Tambour. Turkish drum, which sounds at sunrise, noon, and twilight. [The "tambour" is a kind of mandoline. It is the large kettle-drum (*nagaré*) which sounds the hours.]

[fe] {161}

*Must walk forsooth where waters flow
And pore on every flower below.*—[MS. erased.]

[ff] {162} *For looks of peace and hearts of ire.*—[MS.]

[fg] *And calmly to his Sire's was raised.*—[MS.]

[fh] {163} *No—nor the blood I call my own.*—[MS.]

[131] The Turks abhor the Arabs (who return the compliment a hundredfold) even more than they hate the Christians.

[fi] *Or Christian flying from the fight.*—[MS.]

[fj] *Zuleika! ever welcome here.*—[MS.]

[fk] *Who never was more blest than now.*—[MS.]

[132] {164} [Lines 170-181 were added in the course of printing. They were received by the publisher on November 22, 1813.]

[fl]

*Who hath not felt his very power of sight
Faint with the languid dimness of delight?*—[MS.]

[fm]

*The light of life—the purity of grace
The mind of Music breathing in her face
or, Mind on her lip and music in her face.
A heart where softness harmonized the whole
And oh! her eye was in itself a Soul!*—[MS.]

[133] This expression has met with objections. I will not refer to "Him who hath not Music in his soul," but merely request the reader to recollect, for ten seconds, the features of the woman whom he believes to be the most beautiful; and, if he then does not comprehend fully what is feebly expressed in the above line, I shall be sorry for us both. For an eloquent passage in the latest work of the first female writer of this, perhaps of any, age, on the analogy (and the immediate comparison excited by that analogy) between "painting and music," see vol. iii. cap. 10, *DE L'ALLEMAGNE*. And is not this connection still stronger with the original than the copy? with the colouring of Nature than of Art? After all, this is rather to be felt than described; still I think there are some who will understand it, at least they would have done had they beheld the countenance whose speaking harmony suggested the idea; for this passage is not drawn from imagination but memory,[A] that mirror which Affliction dashes to the earth, and looking down upon the fragments, only beholds the reflection multiplied!

[A] *In this line I have not drawn from fiction but memory—that mirror of regret memory—the too faithful mirror of affliction the long vista through which we gaze. Someone has said that the perfection of Architecture is frozen music—the perfection of Beauty to my mind always presented the idea of living Music.*—[MS. erased.]

[For the simile of the broken mirror, compare *Childe Harold*, Canto III. stanza xxxiii. line 1 (*Poetical Works*, ii. 236, note 2); and for "the expression," "music breathing from her face," compare Sir Thomas Browne's *Religio Medici*, Part II. sect. ix., *Works*, 1835, ii. 106, "And sure there is musick, even in the beauty and the silent note which Cupid strikes, far sweeter than the sound of any instrument;" and Lovelace's "Song," *Orpheus to Beasts* —

"Oh could you view the melody
Of ev'ry grace,
And music of her face!"

The effect of the appeal to Madame de Staël is thus recorded in Byron's *Journal* of December 7, 1813 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 369): "This morning, a very pretty billet from the Staël," (for passage in *De L'Allemagne*, Part III. chap. x., and the "billet," see *Letters*, ii. 354, note 1) ... "She has been pleased to be pleased with my slight eulogy in the note annexed to *The Bride*."

[134] {166} Carasman Oglou, or Kara Osman Oglou, is the principal landholder in Turkey; he governs Magnesia: those who, by a kind of feudal tenure, possess land on condition of service, are called Timariots: they serve as Spahis, according to the extent of territory, and bring a certain number into the field, generally cavalry.

[The "line of Carasman" dates back to Kara Youlouk, the founder of the dynasty of the "White Sheep," at the close of the fourteenth century. Hammer-Purgstall (*Hist. de l'Emp. Ottoman*, iii. 151) gives *sang-sue*, "blood-sucker," as the equivalent of Youlouk, which should, however, be interpreted "smooth-face." Of the Magnesian Kara Osman Oglou ("Black Osman-son"), Dallaway (*Constantinople Ancient and Modern*, 1797, p. 190) writes, "He is the most powerful and opulent derè bey ('lord of the valley'), or feudal tenant, in the empire, and, though inferior to the pashas in rank, possesses more wealth and influence, and offers them an example of administration and patriotic government which they have rarely the virtue to follow." For the Timariots, who formed the third class of the feudal cavalry of the Ottoman Empire, see Finlay's *Greece under Othoman ... Domination*, 1856, pp. 50, 51.]

[fn] *Who won of yore paternal lands.*—[MS.]

[fo] *Enough if that thy bridesman true.*—[MS. erased.]

[135] [The Bey Oglou (Begzāde) is "the nobleman," "the high-born chief."]

[136] {167} When a Pacha is sufficiently strong to resist, the single messenger, who is always the first bearer of the order for his death, is strangled instead, and sometimes five or six, one after the other, on the same errand, by command of the refractory patient; if, on the contrary, he is weak or loyal, he bows, kisses the Sultan's respectable signature, and is bowstrung with great complacency. In 1810, several of these presents were exhibited in the niche of the Seraglio gate; among others, the head of the Pacha of Bagdat, a brave young man, cut off by treachery, after a desperate resistance.

[137] Clapping of the hands calls the servants. The Turks hate a superfluous expenditure of voice, and they have no bells.

[138] "Chibouque," the Turkish pipe, of which the amber mouthpiece, and sometimes the ball which contains the leaf, is adorned with precious stones, if in possession of the wealthier orders.

[139] {168} "Maugrabee" [*Maghrabī*, Moors], Moorish mercenaries.

[140] "Delis," bravos who form the forlorn hope of the cavalry, and always begin the action. [See *Childe Harold*, Canto II., *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 149, note 1.]

[141] [The Kizlar aghasi was the head of the black eunuchs; kizlar, by itself, is Turkish for "girls," "virgins."]

[142] A twisted fold of *felt* is used for scimitar practice by the Turks, and few but Mussulman arms can cut through it at a single stroke: sometimes a tough turban is used

for the same purpose. The jerreed [jarīd] is a game of blunt javelins, animated and graceful.

[143] "Ollahs," Alla il Allah [La ilāh ill 'llāh], the "Leilies," as the Spanish poets call them, the sound is Ollah: a cry of which the Turks, for a silent people, are somewhat profuse, particularly during the jerreed [jarīd], or in the chase, but mostly in battle. Their animation in the field, and gravity in the chamber, with their pipes and comboloios [*vide post*, [p. 181](#), [note 4](#)], form an amusing contrast.

[fp] {169} *Her heart confessed no cause of shame.*—[MS.]

[144] "Atar-gul," ottar of roses. The Persian is the finest.

[145] The ceiling and wainscots, or rather walls, of the Mussulman apartments are generally painted, in great houses, with one eternal and highly-coloured view of Constantinople, wherein the principal feature is a noble contempt of perspective; below, arms, scimitars, etc., are, in general, fancifully and not inelegantly disposed.

[fq]

*The drops that flow upon his vest
Unheeded fell upon his breast.*—[MS.]

[146] {170} It has been much doubted whether the notes of this "Lover of the rose" are sad or merry; and Mr. Fox's remarks on the subject have provoked some learned controversy as to the opinions of the ancients on the subject. I dare not venture a conjecture on the point, though a little inclined to the "errare mallet," etc., *if* Mr. Fox was mistaken.

[Fox, writing to Grey (see Lord Holland's Preface (p. xii.) to the *History ... of James the Second*, by ... C. J. Fox, London, 1808), remarks, "In defence of my opinion about the nightingale, I find Chaucer, who of all poets seems to have been the fondest of the singing of birds, calls it a 'merry note,'" etc. Fox's contention was attacked and disproved by Martin Davy (1763-1839, physician and Master of Caius College, Cambridge), in an interesting and scholarly pamphlet entitled, *Observations upon Mr. Fox's Letter to Mr. Grey*, 1809.]

[fr]

*Would I had never seen this hour
What knowest thou not who loves thee best.*—[MS.]

[fs] {171} *If so by Mecca's hidden shrine.*—[MS.]

[ft] *The day that teareth thee from me.*—[MS.]

[147] "Azrael," the angel of death.

[fu] *When comes that hour and come it must.*—[MS. erased.]

[fv] {172}

*Which thanks to terror and the dark
Hath missed a trifle of its mark.*—[MS.]

[The couplet was expunged in a revise dated November 19.]

[fw] *With life to keep but not with life resign.*—[MS.]

[fx] {173}

That strays along that head so fair.—[MS.]
or, *That strays along that neck so fair.*—[MS.]

[148] The treasures of the Pre-Adamite Sultans. See D'Herbelot [1781, ii. 405], article *Istakar* [Estekhar ou Istekhar].

[149] "Musselim," a governor, the next in rank after a Pacha; a Waywode is the third; and then come the Agas.

[This table of precedence applies to Ottoman officials in Greece and other dependencies. The Musselim [Mutaselline] is the governor or commander of a city (e.g. Hobhouse, *Travels in Albania*, ii. 41, speaks of the "Musselim of Smyrna"); Aghas, i.e. heads of departments in the army or civil service, or the Sultan's household, here denote mayors of small towns, or local magnates.]

[150] "Egripo," the Negropont. According to the proverb, the Turks of Egripo, the Jews of Salonica, and the Greeks of Athens, are the worst of their respective races.

[See Gibbon's *Decline and Fall*, 1855, viii. 386.]

[fy] *Like this—and more than this.*—[MS.]

[fz] {175}

*But—Selim why my heart's reply
Should need so much of mystery
Is more than I can guess or tell,
But since thou say'st 'tis so—'tis well.*—[MS.]

[The fourth line erased.]

[ga]

*He blest me more in leaving thee.
Much should I suffer thus compelled.*—[MS.]

[gb] {176}

*This vow I should no more conceal
And wherefore should I not reveal?*—[MS.]

[gc]

*My breast is consciousness of sin
But when and where and what the crime
I almost feel is lurking here.*—[MS.]

[151] "Tchocadar"—one of the attendants who precedes a man of authority.

[See D'Ohsson's *Tableau Générale, etc.*, 1787, ii. 159, and *Plates* 87, 88. The Turks seem to have used the Persian word *chawki-dār*, an officer of the guard-house, a policeman (whence our slang word "chokey"), for a "valet de pied," or, in the case of the Sultan, for an apparitor. The French spelling points to D'Ohsson as Byron's authority.]

[gd] {177} *Be silent thou.*—[MS.]

[ge] {178} *Nov. 9th 1813.*—[MS.]

[152] [Vide Ovid, *Heroides*, Ep. xix.; and the *De Herone atque Leandro* of Musæus.]

[153] {179} The wrangling about this epithet, "the broad Hellespont" or the "boundless Hellespont," whether it means one or the other, or what it means at all, has been beyond all possibility of detail. I have even heard it disputed on the spot; and not foreseeing a speedy conclusion to the controversy, amused myself with swimming across it in the mean time; and probably may again, before the point is settled. Indeed, the question as to the truth of "the tale of Troy divine" still continues, much of it resting upon the talismanic word "ἄπειρος;" probably Homer had the same notion of distance that a coquette has of time; and when he talks of boundless, means half a mile; as the latter, by a like figure, when she says *eternal* attachment, simply specifies three weeks.

[For a defence of the Homeric ἄπειρων, and for a *résumé* of the "wrangling" of the topographers, Jean Baptiste Le Chevalier (1752-1836) and Jacob Bryant (1715-1804), etc., see *Travels in Albania*, 1858, ii. 179-185.]

[154] {180} Before his Persian invasion, and crowned the altar with laurel, etc. He was afterwards imitated by Caracalla in his race. It is believed that the last also poisoned a friend, named Festus, for the sake of new Patroclan games. I have seen the sheep feeding on the tombs of Æyietes and Antilochus: the first is in the centre of the plain.

[Alexander placed a garland on the tomb of Achilles, and "went through the ceremony of anointing himself with oil, and running naked up to it."—Plut. *Vitæ*, "Alexander M.," cap. xv. line 25, Lipsiæ, 1814, vi. 187. For the tombs of Æsyetes, etc., see *Travels in Albania*, ii. 149-151.]

[155] [Compare—

"Or narrow if needs must be,
Outside are the storms and the strangers."

Never the Time, etc., lines 19, 20, by Robert Browning.]

[156] {181} When rubbed, the amber is susceptible of a perfume, which is slight, but *not* disagreeable. [Letter to Murray, December 6, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 300.]

[157] ["Coeterum castitatis hieroglyphicum gemma est."—Hoffmann, *Lexic. Univ.*, art. "Smaragdus." Compare, too, *Lalla Rookh* ("Chandos Classics," p. 406), "The emerald's virgin blaze."]

[158] The belief in amulets engraved on gems, or enclosed in gold boxes, containing scraps from the Koran, worn round the neck, wrist, or arm, is still universal in the East. The Koorsee (throne) verse in the second cap. of the Koran describes the attributes of the Most High, and is engraved in this manner, and worn by the pious, as the most esteemed and sublime of all sentences.

[The *âyatu 'l kursîy*, or verse of the throne (Sura II. "Chapter of the Heifer," v. 257), runs thus: "God, there is no God but He, the living and self-subsistent. Slumber takes Him not, nor sleep. His is what is in the heavens and what is in the earth. Who is it that intercedes with Him, save by His permission? He knows what is before them, and what behind them, and they comprehend not aught of His knowledge but of what He pleases. His throne extends over the heavens and the earth, and it tires Him not to guard them both, for He is high and grand."—The *Qur'ân*, translated by E. H. Palmer, 1880, Part I., *Sacred Books of the East*, vi. 40.]

[159] "Comboloio"—a Turkish rosary. The MSS., particularly those of the Persians, are richly adorned and illuminated. The Greek females are kept in utter ignorance; but many

of the Turkish girls are highly accomplished, though not actually qualified for a Christian coterie. Perhaps some of our own "*blues*" might not be the worse for *bleaching*.

[The comboloio consists of ninety-nine beads. Compare *Lalla Rookh* ("Chandos Classics," p. 420), "Her ruby rosary," etc., and note on "Le Tespih." *Lord Byron's Comboloio* is the title of a metrical *jeu d'esprit*, a rhymed catalogue of the *Poetical Works*, beginning with *Hours of Idleness*, and ending with *Cain, a Mystery*.—*Blackwood's Magazine*, 1822, xi. 162-165.]

[160] {182} [Shiraz, capital of the Persian province of Fars, is celebrated for the attar-gûl, or attar of roses.]

[gf] {183}

*Her Prophet did not clearly show
But Selim's place was quite secure.*—[MS.]

[161] [Compare *The Giaour*, [line 490](#), [note 1](#), *vide ante*, p. 110.]

[gg] *And one seemed red with recent guilt.*—[MS.]

[gh] {184} *Her Selim—"Alla—is it he?"*—[MS.]

[162] "Galiongée" or Galiongi [i.e. a Galleon-er], a sailor, that is, a Turkish sailor; the Greeks navigate, the Turks work the guns. Their dress is picturesque; and I have seen the Capitan Pacha, more than once, wearing it as a kind of *incog*. Their legs, however, are generally naked. The buskins described in the text as sheathed behind with silver are those of an Arnaut robber, who was my host (he had quitted the profession) at his Pyrgo, near Gastouni in the Morea; they were plated in scales one over the other, like the back of an armadillo.

[Gastuni lies some eight miles S.W. of Palæopolis, the site of the ancient Elis. The "Pyrgo" must be the Castle of Chlemutzi (Castel Tornese), built by Geoffrey II. of Villehouardin, circ. A.D. 1218.]

[gi] {185}

What—have I lived to curse the day?—[MS. M.]
To curse—if I could curse—the day.—[MS., ed. 1892.]

[gj] {186} *I swear it by Medina's shrine.*—[MS. erased.]

[163] The characters on all Turkish scimitars contain sometimes the name of the place of their manufacture, but more generally a text from the Koran, in letters of gold. Amongst

those in my possession is one with a blade of singular construction: it is very broad, and the edge notched into serpentine curves like the ripple of water, or the wavering of flame. I asked the Armenian who sold it, what possible use such a figure could add: he said, in Italian, that he did not know; but the Mussulmans had an idea that those of this form gave a severer wound; and liked it because it was "piu feroce." I did not much admire the reason, but bought it for its peculiarity.

[Compare *Lalla Rookh* ("Chandos Classics," p. 373)—"The flashing of their swords' rich marquetry."]

[164] {187} It is to be observed, that every allusion to any thing or personage in the Old Testament, such as the Ark, or Cain, is equally the privilege of Mussulman and Jew: indeed, the former profess to be much better acquainted with the lives, true and fabulous, of the patriarchs, than is warranted by our own sacred writ; and not content with Adam, they have a biography of Pre-Adamites. Solomon is the monarch of all necromancy, and Moses a prophet inferior only to Christ and Mahomet. Zuleika is the Persian name of Potiphar's wife; and her amour with Joseph constitutes one of the finest poems in their language. It is, therefore, no violation of costume to put the names of Cain, or Noah, into the mouth of a Moslem.

[À propos of this note "for the ignorant," Byron writes to Murray (November 13, 1813), "Do you suppose that no one but the Galileans are acquainted with Adam, and Eve, and Cain, and Noah?—*Zuleika* is the Persian *poetical name* for Potiphar's wife;" and, again, November 14, "I don't care one lump of sugar for my *poetry*; but for my *costume*, and my correctness on these points ... I will combat lustily."—*Letters*, 1898, ii. 282, 283.]

[165] {188} [Karajić (Vuk Stefanović, born 1787), secretary to Kara George, published *Narodne Srpske Pjesme*, at Vienna, 1814, 1815. See, too, *Languages and Literature of the Slavic Nations*, by Talvi, New York, 1850, pp. 366-382; *Volkslieder der Serben*, von Talvi, Leipzig, 1835, ii. 245, etc., and *Chants Populaires des Servics*, Recueillis par Wuk Stephanowitsch, et Traduits d'après Talvy, par Madame Élise Voïart, Paris, 1834, ii. 183, etc.]

[166] Paswan Oglou, the rebel of Widdin; who, for the last years of his life, set the whole power of the Porte at defiance.

[Passwan Oglou (1758-1807) [Passewend's, or the Watchman's son, according to Hobhouse] was born and died at Widdin. He first came into notice in 1788, in alliance with certain disbanded Turkish levies, named *Krdschalies*. "It was their pride to ride along on stately horses, with trappings of gold and silver, and bearing costly arms. In their train were female slaves, Giuvendi, in male attire, who not only served to amuse them in their

hours of ease with singing and dancing, but also followed them to battle (as Kaled followed Lara, see *Lara*, Canto II. stanza xv., etc.), for the purpose of holding their horses when they fought." On one occasion he is reported to have addressed these "rebel hordes" much in the spirit of the "Corsair," "The booty be yours, and mine the glory." "After having for some time suffered a Pacha to be associated with him, he at length expelled his superior, and demanded 'the three horse-tails' for himself." In 1798 the Porte despatched another army, but Passwan was completely victorious, and "at length the Porte resolved to make peace, and actually sent him the 'three horse-tails'" (i.e. made him commander-in-chief of the Janissaries at Widdin). (See *History of Servia*, by Leopold von Ranke, Bohn, 1853, pp. 68-71. See, too, *Voyage dans l'Empire Othoman*, par G. A. Olivier, an. 9 (1801), i. 108-125; and Madame Voïart's "Abrégé de l'histoire du royaume de Servie," prefixed to *Chants Populaires*, etc., Paris, 1834.))

[gk]

*And how that death made known to me
Hath made me what thou now shalt see.*—[MS.]

[167] {189} "Horse-tail,"—the standard of a Pacha.

[gl] *With venom blacker than his soul.*—[MS.]

[168] Giaffir, Pacha of Argyro Castro, or Scutari, I am not sure which, was actually taken off by the Albanian Ali, in the manner described in the text. Ali Pacha, while I was in the country, married the daughter of his victim, some years after the event had taken place at a bath in Sophia or Adrianople. The poison was mixed in the cup of coffee, which is presented before the sherbet by the bath keeper, after dressing.

[gm] {190}

*Nor, if his sullen spirit could,
Can I forgive a parent's blood.*—[MS.]

[gn] {191} *Yet I must be all truth to thee.*—[MS.]

[go] {192}

*To Haroun's care in idlesse left,
In spirit bound, of fame bereft.*—[MS. erased.]

[gp] {193}

*That slave who saw my spirit pining
Beneath Inaction's heavy yoke,*

Compassionate his charge resigning.—[MS.]

[gq]

Oh could my tongue to thee impart

That liberation of my heart.—[MS. erased.]

[169] I must here shelter myself with the Psalmist—is it not David that makes the "Earth reel to and fro like a Drunkard"? If the Globe can be thus lively on seeing its Creator, a liberated captive can hardly feel less on a first view of his work.—[Note, MS. erased.]

[170] The Turkish notions of almost all islands are confined to the Archipelago, the sea alluded to.

[171] {194} Lambro Canzani, a Greek, famous for his efforts, in 1789-90, for the independence of his country. Abandoned by the Russians, he became a pirate, and the Archipelago was the scene of his enterprises. He is said to be still alive at Petersburg. He and Riga are the two most celebrated of the Greek revolutionists.

[For Lambros Katzones (Hobhouse, *Travels in Albania*, ii. 5, calls him Canziani), see Finlay's *Greece under Othoman ... Domination*, 1856, pp. 330-334. Finlay dwells on his piracies rather than his patriotism.]

[172] {195} "Rayahs,"—all who pay the capitation tax, called the "Haratch."

["This tax was levied on the whole male unbelieving population," except children under ten, old men, Christian and Jewish priests.—Finlay, *Greece under Ottoman ... Domination*, 1856, p. 26. See, too, the *Qur'ân*, cap. ix., "The Declaration of Immunity."]

[173] This first of voyages is one of the few with which the Mussulmans profess much acquaintance.

[174] The wandering life of the Arabs, Tartars, and Turkomans, will be found well detailed in any book of Eastern travels. That it possesses a charm peculiar to itself, cannot be denied. A young French renegade confessed to Châteaubriand, that he never found himself alone, galloping in the desert, without a sensation approaching to rapture which was indescribable.

[175] [Inns, caravanserais. From *sarāy*, a palace or inn.]

[176] [The remaining seventy lines of stanza xx. were not included in the original MS., but were sent to the publisher in successive instalments while the poem was passing through the press.]

[177] [In the first draft of a supplementary fragment, line 883 ran thus—

"and tints tomorrow with { *a fancied*
an airy } ray."

A note was appended—

"Mr. M^Y. Choose which of the 2 epithets 'fancied' or 'airy' may be best—or if neither will do—tell me and I will dream another—

"Yours,

"Bⁿ"

The epithet ("prophetic") which stands in the text was inserted in a revise dated December 3, 1813. Two other versions were also sent, that Gifford might select that which was "best, or rather *not worst*"—

"and { *gilds*
tints } the hope of morning with its ray."

"And gilds to-morrow's hope with heavenly ray."

(*Letters*, 1898, ii. 282.)

On the same date, December 3rd, two additional lines were affixed to the quatrain (lines 886-889)—

"Soft as the Mecca Muezzin's strains invite
Him who hath journeyed far to join the rite."

And in a later revise, as "a last alteration"—

"Blest as the call which from Medina's dome
Invites devotion to her Prophet's tomb."

An erased version of this "last alteration" ran thus—

"Blest as the Muezzin's strain from Mecca's dome
Which welcomes Faith to view her Prophet's tomb." [A]

[A] [It is probable that Byron, who did not trouble himself to distinguish between "lie" and "lay," and who, as the MS. of *English Bards, and Scotch Reviewers* (see line 732, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 355) reveals, pronounced "petit maître" *anglicé* in four syllables,

regarded "dome" (*vide supra*) as a true and exact rhyme to "tomb," but, with his wonted compliance, was persuaded to make yet another alteration.]]

[gr] {196} Of lines 886-889, two, if not three, variants were sent to the publisher—

- (1) *Dear as the Melody of better days*
That steals the trembling tear of speechless praise—
Sweet as his native song to Exile's ears
Shall sound each tone thy long-loved voice endears.—
[December 2, 1813.]

- (2) { *Dear*
Soft } *as the melody of* { *better*
youthful } *days*

That steals { *a silent*
the trembling } *tear of speechless praise—*

[178] {197} "Jannat-al-Aden," the perpetual abode, the Mussulman paradise. [See Sale's *Koran*, "Preliminary Discourse," sect. i.; and *Journal*, November 17, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 326.]

[gs] *Wait on thy voice and bow at thy command.—*[MS.]

[gt]

Oh turn and mingle every thought with his,
And all our future days unite in this.—[MS.]

[179] ["You wanted some reflections, and I send you *per Selim*, eighteen lines in decent couplets, of a pensive, if not an *ethical* tendency.... Mr. Canning's approbation (*if* he did approve) I need not say makes me proud."—Letter to Murray, November 23, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 286.]

[gu]

Man I may lead but trust not—I may fall
By those now friends to me, yet foes to all—
In this they follow but the bent assigned,
By fatal Nature to our warring kind.—[MS.]

[gv] {198}

Behold a wilderness and call it peace,—[MS. erased.]
Look round our earth and lo! where battles cease,

"Behold a Solitude and call it" peace.—[MS.]
or, *Mark even where Conquest's deeds of carnage cease*
She leaves a solitude and calls it peace.—[November 21, 1813].

[For the final alteration to the present text, see letter to Murray of November 24, 1813.]

[180] [Compare Tacitus, *Agricola*, cap. 30—"Solitudinem faciunt—pacem appellant." See letter to Murray, November 24, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 287.]

[gw] *Power sways but by distrust—her sole source.—[MS. erased.]*

[gx] *Which Love to-night hath lent by swelling sail.—[MS.]*

[181] {199} [Compare—

"Quam juvat immites ventos audire cubantem,
Et dominam tenero detinuisse sinu."

Tibullus, *Eleg.*, Lib. I. i. 45, 46.]

[gy] *Then if my lip once murmurs, it must be.—[MS.]*

[182] [The omission of lines 938, 939 drew from Byron an admission (Letter to Murray, November 29, 1813) that "the passage is an imitation altogether from Medea in Ovid" (*Metamorph.*, vii. 66-69)—

"My love possess, in Jason's bosom laid,
Let seas swell high;—I cannot be dismay'd
While I infold my husband in my arms:
Or should I fear, I should but fear his harms."

Englished by Sandys, 1632.]

[gz] *This hour decides my doom or thy escape.—[MS.]*

[183] {200} [Compare—

"That thought has more of hell than had the former.
Another, and another, and another!"

The Revenge, by Edward Young, act iv.
(*Modern British Drama*, 1811, ii. 17).]

[ha] {202} *Or grazed by wounds he scorned to feel.—[MS.]*

[hb] {203} Three MS. variants of these lines were rejected in turn before the text was finally adopted—

- (1) { *Ah! wherefore did he turn to look*
I know not why he turned to look
Since fatal was the gaze he took?
So far escaped from death or chain,
To search for her and search in vain:
Sad proof in peril and in pain
How late will Lover's hope remain.
- (2) *Thus far escaped from death or chain*
Ah! wherefore did he turn to look?
For her his eye must seek in vain,
Since fatal was the gaze he took.
Sad proof, etc.—
- (3) *Ah! wherefore did he turn to look*
So far escaped from death or chain?
Since fatal was the gaze he took
For her his eye but sought in vain,
Sad proof, etc.—

A fourth variant of lines 1046, 1047 was inserted in a revise dated November 16—

That glance he paused to send again
To her for whom he dies in vain.

[[hc](#)] {204} *O'er which their talons yet delay.*—[MS. erased.]

[[hd](#)] {205}

And that changed hand whose only life
Is motion-seems to menace strife.—[MS.]

[[184](#)] ["While the *Salsette* lay off the Dardanelles, Lord Byron saw the body of a man who had been executed by being cast into the sea, floating on the stream, moving to and fro with the tumbling of the water, which gave to his arms the effect of scaring away several sea-fowl that were hovering to devour. This incident he has strikingly depicted in the *Bride of Abydos*."—*Life of Lord Byron*, by John Galt, 1830, p. 144.]

[[185](#)] A turban is carved in stone above the graves of *men* only.

[[186](#)] The death-song of the Turkish women. The "silent slaves" are the men, whose notions of decorum forbid complaint in *public*.

[[he](#)] {206} *The Koran-chapter chaunts thy fate.*—[MS.]

[187] [At a Turkish funeral, after the interment has taken place, the Imâm "assis sur les genoux à côté de la tombe," offers the prayer *Telkin*, and at the conclusion of the prayer recites the *Fathah*, or "opening chapter" of the Korân. ("In the name of the merciful and compassionate God. Praise belongs to God, the Lord of the worlds, the Merciful, the Compassionate, the Ruler of the day of judgment. Thee we serve, and Thee we ask for aid. Guide us in the right path, the path of those Thou art gracious to; not of those Thou art wroth with; nor of those who err."—*The Qur'ân*, p. 1, translated by E. H. Palmer, Oxford, 1880): *Tableau Générale de l'Empire Ottoman*, par Mouradja D'Ohsson, Paris, 1787, i. 235-248. Writing to Murray, November 14, 1813, Byron instances the funeral (in the *Bride of Abydos*) as proof of his correctness with regard to local colouring.—*Letters*, 1898, ii. 283.]

[188] {207} ["I one evening witnessed a funeral in the vast cemetery of Scutari. An old man, with a venerable beard, threw himself by the side of the narrow grave, and strewing the earth on his head, cried aloud, 'He was my son! my only son!'"—*Constantinople in 1828*, by Charles Macfarlane, 1829, p. 233, note.]

[hf] *She whom thy Sultan had been fain to wed.*—[MS.]

[189] ["The body of a Moslemin is ordered to be carried to the grave in haste, with hurried steps."—*Ibid.*, p. 233, note.]

[190] "I came to the place of my birth, and cried, 'The friends of my Youth, where are they?' and an Echo answered, 'Where are they?'"—*From an Arabic MS.* The above quotation (from which the idea in the text is taken) must be already familiar to every reader: it is given in the second annotation, p. 67, of *The Pleasures of Memory* [note to Part I. line 103]; a poem so well known as to render a reference almost superfluous: but to whose pages all will be delighted to recur [*Poems*, by Samuel Rogers, 1852, i. 48].

[hg] *There the sad cypress ever glooms.*—[MS.]

[hh] {209} *But with the day blush of the sky.*—[MS.]

[hi] *And some there be who could believe.*—[MS.]

[191]

"And airy tongues that syllable men's names."

MILTON, *Comus*, line 208.

For a belief that the souls of the dead inhabit the form of birds, we need not travel to the East. Lord Lytton's ghost story, the belief of the Duchess of Kendal, that George I. flew

into her window in the shape of a raven (see *Orford's Reminiscences*, *Lord Orford's Works*, 1798, iv. 283), and many other instances, bring this superstition nearer home. The most singular was the whim of a Worcester lady, who, believing her daughter to exist in the shape of a singing bird, literally furnished her pew in the cathedral with cages full of the kind; and as she was rich, and a benefactress in beautifying the church, no objection was made to her harmless folly. For this anecdote, see *Orford's Letters*.

["But here (at Gloucester) is a *modernity*, which beats all antiquities for curiosity. Just by the high altar is a small pew hung with green damask, with curtains of the same; a small corner-cupboard, painted, carved, and gilt, for books, in one corner, and two troughs of a bird-cage, with seeds and water. If any mayoress on earth was small enough to inclose herself in this tabernacle, or abstemious enough to feed on rape and canary, I should have sworn that it was the shrine of the queen of the aldermen. It belongs to a Mrs. Cotton, who, having lost a favourite daughter, is convinced her soul is transmigrated into a robin redbreast, for which reason she passes her life in making an aviary of the cathedral of Gloucester."—Letter to Richard Bentley, September, 1753 (*Lord Orford's Works*, 1798, v. 279).]

[192] {210} [According to J. B. Le Chevalier (*Voyage de La Propontide, etc.*, an. viii. (1800), p. 17), the Turkish name for a small bay which formed the ancient port of Sestos, is *Ak-Bachi-Liman* (Port de la Tête blanche).]

[bj]

*And in its stead that mourning flower
Hath flourished—flourisheth this hour,
Alone and coldly pure and pale
As the young cheek that saddens to the tale.
And withers not, though branch and leaf
Are stamped with an eternal grief.*—[MS.]
An earlier version of the final text reads—
As weeping Childhood's cheek at Sorrow's tale!

[193] ["*The Bride*, such as it is is my first *entire* composition of any length (except the Satire, and be damned to it), for *The Giaour* is but a string of passages, and *Childe Harold* is, and I rather think always will be, unconcluded" (Letter to Murray, November 29, 1813). It (the *Bride*) "was published on Thursday the second of December; but how it is liked or disliked, I know not. Whether it succeeds or not is no fault of the public, against whom I can have no complaint. But I am much more indebted to the tale than I can ever be to the most partial reader; as it wrung my thoughts from reality to imagination—from selfish regrets to vivid recollections—and recalled me to a country replete with the

brightest and darkest, but always most lively colours of my memory" (Journal, December 5, 1813, Letters, 1898, ii. 291, 361).]

THE CORSAIR: A TALE.

———"I suoi pensieri in lui dormir non ponno."

TASSO, *Gerusalemme Liberata*, Canto X. [stanza lxxviii. line 8].

INTRODUCTION TO *THE CORSAIR*.



A SEVENTH edition of the *Giaour*, including the final additions, and the first edition of the *Bride of Abydos*, were published on the twenty-ninth of November, 1813. In less than three weeks (December 18) Byron began the *Corsair*, and completed the fair copy of the first draft by the last day of the year. The *Corsair* in all but its final shape, together with the sixth edition of the *Bride of Abydos*, the seventh of *Childe Harold*, and the ninth of the *Giaour*, was issued on the first of February, 1814.

A letter from John Murray to Lord Byron, dated February 3, 1814 (*Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 223), presents a vivid picture of a great literary triumph—

"MY LORD,—I have been unwilling to write until I had something to say.... I am most happy to tell you that your last poem *is*—what Mr. Southey's is *called*—a *Carmen Triumphale*. Never in my recollection has any work ... excited such a ferment ... I sold on the day of publication—a thing perfectly unprecedented—10,000 copies.... Mr. Moore says it is masterly—a wonderful performance. Mr. Hammond, Mr. Heber, D'Israeli, every one who comes ... declare their unlimited approbation. Mr. Ward was here with Mr. Gifford yesterday, and mingled his admiration with the rest ... and Gifford did, what I never knew him do before—he repeated several stanzas from memory, particularly the closing stanza—

"'His death yet dubious, deeds too widely known.'

"I have the highest encomiums in letters from Croker and Mr. Hay; but I rest most upon the warm feeling it has created in Gifford's critic heart.... You have no

notion of the sensation which the publication has occasioned; and my only regret is that you were not present to witness it."

For some time before and after the poem appeared, Byron was, as he told Leigh Hunt (February 9, 1814; *Letters*, 1899, iii. 27), "snow-bound and thaw-swamped in 'the valley of the shadow' of Newstead Abbey," and it was not till he had returned to town that he resumed his journal, and bethought him of placing on record some dark sayings with regard to the story of the *Corsair* and the personality of Conrad. Under date February 18, 1814, he writes—

"The *Corsair* has been conceived, written, published, etc., since I last took up this journal [?last day but one]. They tell me it has great success; it was written *con amore* [i.e. during the reign of Lady Frances Wedderburn Webster], and much from *existence*."

And again, *Journal*, March 10 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 399),

"He [Hobhouse] told me an odd report,—that *I* am the actual Conrad, the veritable *Corsair*, and that part of my travels are supposed to have passed in privacy [*sic*?piracy]. Um! people sometimes hit near the truth; but never the whole truth. H. don't know what I was about the year after he left the Levant; nor does any one—nor—nor—nor—however, it is a lie—but, 'I doubt the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth.'"

Very little weight can be attached to these "I could an I would" pronouncements, deliberately framed to provoke curiosity, and destined, no doubt, sooner or later to see the light; but the fact remains that Conrad is not a mere presentation of Byron in a fresh disguise, or "The Pirate's Tale" altogether a "painting of the imagination."

That the *Corsair* is founded upon fact is argued at some length by the author (an "English Gentleman in the Greek Military Service") of the *Life*,

Writings, Opinions, and Times of the R. H. George Gordon Noel Byron, which was published in 1825. The point of the story (i. 197-201), which need not be repeated at length, is that Byron, on leaving Constantinople and reaching the island of Zea (July, 1810), visited ["strolled about"] the islands of the Archipelago, in company with a Venetian gentleman who had turned buccaneer *malgré lui*, and whose history and adventures, amatory and piratical, prefigured and inspired the "gestes" of Conrad. The tale must be taken for what it is worth; but it is to be remarked that it affords a clue to Byron's mysterious entries in a journal which did not see the light till 1830, five years after the "English Gentleman" published his volumes of gossiping anecdote. It may, too, be noted that, although, in his correspondence of 1810, 1811, there is no mention of any tour among the "Isles of Greece," in a letter to Moore dated February 2, 1815 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 176), Byron recalls "the interesting white squalls and short seas of Archipelago memory."

How far Byron may have drawn on personal experience for his picture of a pirate *chez lui*, it is impossible to say; but during the year 1809-11, when he was travelling in Greece, the exploits of Lambros Katzones and other Greek pirates sailing under the Russian flag must have been within the remembrance and on the lips of the islanders and the "patriots" of the mainland. The "Pirate's Island," from which "Ariadne's isle" (line 444) was visible, may be intended for Paros or Anti-Paros.

For the inception of Conrad (see Canto I. stanza ii.), the paradoxical hero, an assortment rather than an amalgam of incongruous characteristics, Byron may, perhaps, have been in some measure indebted to the description of Malefort, junior, in Massinger's *Unnatural Combat*, act i. sc. 2, line 20, sq.—

ave sat with him in his cabin a day together,

he did often, as if inward grief
melancholy at that instant would
ke up his vital spirits....

When from the maintop
il's descried, all thoughts that do concern
self laid by, no lion pinched with hunger
ses himself more fiercely from his den,
n he comes on the deck; and then how wisely
gives directions," etc.

The *Corsair*, together with the *Bride of Abydos*, was reviewed by Jeffrey in the *Edinburgh Review* of April, 1814, vol. xxiii. p. 198; and together with *Lara*, by George Agar Ellis in the *Quarterly Review* of July, 1814, vol. ii. p. 428.

BIBLIOGRAPHICAL NOTE ON *THE* *CORSAIR*.



IN comparison with the *Giaour*, the additions made to the *Corsair* whilst it was passing through the press were inconsiderable. The original MS., which numbers 1737 lines, is probably the fair copy of a number of loose sheets which have not been preserved. The erasures are few and far between, and the variations between the copy and the text are neither numerous nor important.

In one of the latest revises stanza x. was added to the First Canto. The last four lines of stanza xi. first appeared in the Seventh Edition.

The Second Canto suffered no alteration except the substitution of lines 1131-1133 for two lines which were expunged.

Larger additions were made to the Third Canto. Lines 1299-1375, or stanza v. (included in a revise dated January 6, 1814), stanzas xvii. and xxiii., numbering respectively 77, 32, and 16 lines, and the two last lines of stanza x., 127 lines in all, represent the difference between the text as it now stands and the original MS.

In a note to Byron's *Poetical Works*, 1832, ix. 257, it is stated that the *Corsair* was begun on the 18th and finished on the 31st of December, 1813.

In the Introduction to the *Corsair* prefixed to the Library Edition, the poem is said to have been composed in ten days, "at the rate of 200 lines a day." The first page of the MS. is dated "27th of December, 1813," and the last page "December 31, 1813, January 1, 1814." It is probable that the composition of the first draft was begun on the 18th and finished on the 27th of December, and that the work of transcription occupied the last five days of the month. Stanza v. of Canto III. reached the publisher on the 6th, and stanzas xvii. and xxiii. on the 11th and 12th of January, 1814.

The First Edition amounted to 1859 lines (the numeration, owing to the inclusion of broken lines, is given as 1863), and falls short of the existing text by the last four lines of stanza xi. It contains the first dedication to Moore, and numbers 100 pages. To the Second Edition, which numbers 108 pages, the following poems were appended:—

To a Lady Weeping.

From the Turkish.

Sonnet to Genevra ("Thine eyes' blue tenderness," etc.).

Sonnet to Genevra ("Thy cheek is pale with thought," etc.).

Inscription on the Monument of a Newfoundland Dog.

Farewell.

These occasional poems were not appended to the Third Edition, which only numbered 100 pages; but they reappeared in the Fourth and subsequent editions.

The Seventh Edition contained four additional lines (the last four of stanza xi.), and a note (unnumbered) to line 226, in defence of the

vraisemblance of the *Corsair's* misanthropy. The Ninth Edition numbered 112 pages. The additional matter consists of a long note to the last line of the poem ("Linked with one virtue, and a thousand crimes") on the pirates of Barataria.

Twenty-five thousand copies of the *Corsair* were sold between January and March, 1814. An Eighth Edition of fifteen hundred copies was printed in March, and sold before the end of the year. A Ninth Edition of three thousand copies was printed in the beginning of 1815.

TO THOMAS MOORE, ESQ.

MY DEAR MOORE,

I DEDICATE to you the last production with which I shall trespass on public patience, and your indulgence, for some years; and I own that I feel anxious to avail myself of this latest and only opportunity of adorning my pages with a name, consecrated by unshaken public principle, and the most undoubted and various talents. While Ireland ranks you among the firmest of her patriots; while you stand alone the first of her bards in her estimation, and Britain repeats and ratifies the decree, permit me, whose only regret, since our first acquaintance, has been the years he had lost before it commenced, to add the humble but sincere suffrage of friendship, to the voice of more than one nation. It will at least prove to you, that I have neither forgotten the gratification derived from your society, nor abandoned the prospect of its renewal, whenever your leisure or inclination allows you to atone to your friends for too long an absence. It is said among those friends, I trust truly, that you are engaged in the composition of a poem

whose scene will be laid in the East; none can do those scenes so much justice. The wrongs of your own country,^[194] the magnificent and fiery spirit of her sons, the beauty and feeling of her daughters, may there be found; and Collins, when he denominated his Oriental his Irish Eclogues, was not aware how true, at least, was a part of his parallel. Your imagination will create a warmer sun, and less clouded sky; but wildness, tenderness, and originality, are part of your national claim of oriental descent, to which you have already thus far proved your title more clearly than the most zealous of your country's antiquarians.

May I add a few words on a subject on which all men are supposed to be fluent, and none agreeable?—Self. I have written much, and published more than enough to demand a longer silence than I now meditate; but, for some years to come, it is my intention to tempt no further the award of "Gods, men, nor columns." In the present composition I have attempted not the most difficult, but, perhaps, the best adapted measure to our language, the good old and now neglected heroic couplet. The stanza of Spenser is perhaps too slow and dignified for narrative; though, I confess, it is the measure most after my own heart; Scott alone,^[195] of the present generation, has hitherto completely triumphed over the fatal facility of the octosyllabic verse; and this is not the least victory of his fertile and mighty genius: in blank verse, Milton, Thomson, and our dramatists, are the beacons that shine along the deep, but warn us from the rough and barren rock on which they are kindled. The heroic couplet is not the most popular measure certainly; but as I did not deviate into the other from a wish to flatter what is called public opinion, I shall quit it without further apology, and take my chance once more with that versification, in which I have hitherto published nothing but compositions whose former circulation is part of my present, and will be of my future regret.

With regard to my story, and stories in general, I should have been glad to have rendered my personages more perfect and amiable, if possible, inasmuch as I have been sometimes criticised, and considered no less responsible for their deeds and qualities than if all had been personal. Be it so—if I have deviated into the gloomy vanity of "drawing from self," the pictures are probably like, since they are unfavourable: and if not, those who know me are undeceived, and those who do not, I have little interest in undeceiving. I have no particular desire that any but my acquaintance should think the author better than the beings of his imagining; but I cannot help a little surprise, and perhaps amusement, at some odd critical exceptions in the present instance, when I see several bards (far more deserving, I allow) in very reputable plight, and quite exempted from all participation in the faults of those heroes, who, nevertheless, might be found with little more morality than *The Giaour*, and perhaps—but no—I must admit Childe Harold to be a very repulsive personage; and as to his identity, those who like it must give him whatever "alias" they please.^[196]

If, however, it were worth while to remove the impression, it might be of some service to me, that the man who is alike the delight of his readers and his friends, the poet of all circles, and the idol of his own, permits me here and elsewhere to subscribe myself,

Most truly,

And affectionately,

His obedient servant,

BYR

ON.

January 2, 1814.

THE CORSAIR.^[197]

CANTO THE FIRST.

"——nessun maggior dolore,
Che ricordarsi del tempo felice
Nella miseria,——"

DANTE, *Inferno*, v. 121.

I.

ER the glad waters of the dark blue sea,
thoughts as boundless, and our souls as free,
as the breeze can bear, the billows foam,
reign o'er our empire, and behold our home!^[198]
These are our realms, no limits to their sway—
We flag the sceptre all who meet obey.
Let the wild life in tumult still to range
From toil to rest, and joy in every change.
Who can tell? not thou, luxurious slave!
Thy soul would sicken o'er the heaving wave; 10
Not thou, vain lord of Wantonness and Ease!
Thy Slumber soothes not—Pleasure cannot please—
Who can tell, save he whose heart hath tried,
Who danced in triumph o'er the waters wide,

exulting sense—the pulse's maddening play,
 t thrills the wanderer of that trackless way?
 t for itself can woo the approaching fight,
 . turn what some deem danger to delight;
 t seeks what cravens shun with more than zeal,
 . where the feeble faint can only feel— 20
 —to the rising bosom's inmost core,
 ope awaken and its spirit soar?
 dread of Death—if with us die our foes—
 e that it seems even duller than repose;
 ie when it will—we snatch the life of Life—
 en lost—what reck's it by disease or strife?
 him who crawls, enamoured of decay,
 g to his couch, and sicken years away,^[hk]
 ve his thick breath, and shake his palsied head;
 s the fresh turf, and not the feverish bed,— 30
 le gasp by gasp he falters forth his soul,
 s with one pang—one bound—escapes control.
 corse may boast its urn and narrow cave,
 . they who loathed his life may gild his grave:
 s are the tears, though few, sincerely shed,
 en Ocean shrouds and sepulchres our dead.
 us, even banquets fond regret supply
 ie red cup that crowns our memory;
 . the brief epitaph in Danger's day,
 en those who win at length divide the prey, 40
 . cry, Remembrance saddening o'er each brow,
 v had the brave who fell exulted *now*!"

II.

1 were the notes that from the Pirate's isle

und the kindling watch-fire rang the while:
n were the sounds that thrilled the rocks along,
unto ears as rugged seemed a song!
attered groups upon the golden sand,
y game—carouse—converse—or whet the brand;
ct the arms—to each his blade assign,
careless eye the blood that dims its shine; 50
air the boat, replace the helm or oar,
le others straggling muse along the shore;
the wild bird the busy springes set,
pread beneath the sun the dripping net:
e where some distant sail a speck supplies,
n all the thirsting eye of Enterprise;
o'er the tales of many a night of toil,
marvel where they next shall seize a spoil:
natter where—their chief's allotment this;
irs to believe no prey nor plan amiss. 60
who that CHIEF? his name on every shore
med and feared—they ask and know no more
n these he mingles not but to command;
are his words, but keen his eye and hand.
r seasons he with mirth their jovial mess,
they forgive his silence for success.
r for his lip the purpling cup they fill,
t goblet passes him untasted still—
for his fare—the rudest of his crew
ld that, in turn, have passed untasted too; 70
h's coarsest bread, the garden's homeliest roots,
scarce the summer luxury of fruits,
short repast in humbleness supply
n all a hermit's board would scarce deny.
while he shuns the grosser joys of sense,

mind seems nourished by that abstinence.
er to that shore!"—they sail. "Do this!"—'tis done:
w form and follow me!"—the spoil is won.
s prompt his accents and his actions still,
all obey and few inquire his will; 80
uch, brief answer and contemptuous eye
vey reproof, nor further deign reply.

III.

ail!—a sail!"—a promised prize to Hope!
nation—flag—how speaks the telescope?^[hl]
prize, alas! but yet a welcome sail:
blood-red signal glitters in the gale.
—she is ours—a home-returning bark—
n fair, thou breeze!—she anchors ere the dark.
ady doubled is the cape—our bay
eives that prow which proudly spurns the spray. 90
r gloriously her gallant course she goes!
white wings flying—never from her foes—
walks the waters like a thing of Life!^[199]
seems to dare the elements to strife.
ould not brave the battle-fire, the wreck,
nove the monarch of her peopled deck!

IV.

rse o'er her side the rustling cable rings:
sails are furled; and anchoring round she swings;
gathering loiterers on the land discern
boat descending from the latticed stern. 100
manned—the oars keep concert to the strand,
grates her keel upon the shallow sand.^[hm]

to the welcome shout!—the friendly speech!
an hand grasps hand uniting on the beach;
smile, the question, and the quick reply,
the Heart's promise of festivity!

V.

tidings spread, and gathering grows the crowd:
hum of voices, and the laughter loud,
Woman's gentler anxious tone is heard—
nds'—husbands'—lovers' names in each dear word: 110
! are they safe? we ask not of success—
shall we see them? will their accents bless?
n where the battle roars, the billows chafe,
y doubtless boldly did—but who are safe?
e let them haste to gladden and surprise,
kiss the doubt from these delighted eyes!"

VI.

ere is our Chief? for him we bear report—
doubt that joy—which hails our coming—short;
thus sincere—'tis cheering, though so brief;
Juan! instant guide us to our Chief: 120
greeting paid, we'll feast on our return,
all shall hear what each may wish to learn."
ending slowly by the rock-hewn way,
where his watch-tower beetles o'er the bay,
lushy brake, the wild flowers blossoming,
freshness breathing from each silver spring,
ose scattered streams from granite basins burst,
o into life, and sparkling woo your thirst;
n crag to cliff they mount—Near yonder cave,

at lonely straggler looks along the wave? 130
ensive posture leaning on the brand,
oft a resting-staff to that red hand?
; he—'tis Conrad—here—as wont—alone;
—Juan!—on—and make our purpose known.
bark he views—and tell him we would greet
ear with tidings he must quickly meet:
dare not yet approach—thou know'st his mood,
en strange or uninvited steps intrude."

VII.

l Juan sought, and told of their intent;—
spoke not, but a sign expressed assent, 140
se Juan calls—they come—to their salute
ends him slightly, but his lips are mute.
ese letters, Chief, are from the Greek—the spy,
o still proclaims our spoil or peril nigh:
ate'er his tidings, we can well report,
h that"—"Peace, peace!"—he cuts their prating short.
idering they turn, abashed, while each to each
jecture whispers in his muttering speech:
y watch his glance with many a stealing look,
gather how that eye the tidings took; 150
this as if he guessed, with head aside,
hance from some emotion, doubt, or pride,
ead the scroll—"My tablets, Juan, hark—
ere is Gonsalvo?"

"In the anchored bark."
ere let him stay—to him this order bear—
k to your duty—for my course prepare:
elf this enterprise to-night will share."

night, Lord Conrad?"

"Aye! at set of sun:
breeze will freshen when the day is done.
corslet—cloak—one hour and we are gone. 160
g on thy bugle—see that free from rust
carbine-lock springs worthy of my trust;
he edge sharpened of my boarding-brand,
give its guard more room to fit my hand.
let the Armourer with speed dispose;
time, it more fatigued my arm than foes;
k that the signal-gun be duly fired,
ell us when the hour of stay's expired."

VIII.

y make obeisance, and retire in haste,
soon to seek again the watery waste: 170
they repine not—so that Conrad guides;
who dare question aught that he decides?
t man of loneliness and mystery,
ce seen to smile, and seldom heard to sigh;
ose name appals the fiercest of his crew,
tints each swarthy cheek with sallower hue;
sways their souls with that commanding art
t dazzles, leads, yet chills the vulgar heart.
at is that spell, that thus his lawless train
fess and envy—yet oppose in vain? 180
at should it be, that thus their faith can bind?
power of Thought—the magic of the Mind!
ced with success, assumed and kept with skill,
t moulds another's weakness to its will;
lds with their hands, but, still to these unknown,

ces even their mightiest deeds appear his own.
n hath it been—shall be—beneath the Sun
many still must labour for the one!
Nature's doom—but let the wretch who toils,
use not—hate not—*him* who wears the spoils. 190
if he knew the weight of splendid chains,
v light the balance of his humbler pains!

IX.

ke the heroes of each ancient race,
ions in act, but Gods at least in face,
onrad's form seems little to admire,
ugh his dark eyebrow shades a glance of fire:
ust but not Herculean—to the sight
giant frame sets forth his common height;
in the whole, who paused to look again,
more than marks the crowd of vulgar men; 200
y gaze and marvel how—and still confess
t thus it is, but why they cannot guess.
-burnt his cheek, his forehead high and pale
sable curls in wild profusion veil;
oft perforce his rising lip reveals
haughtier thought it curbs, but scarce conceals.^[hn]
ugh smooth his voice, and calm his general mien,
seems there something he would not have seen:
features' deepening lines and varying hue
imes attracted, yet perplexed the view, 210
f within that murkiness of mind
ked feelings fearful, and yet undefined;
n might it be—that none could truly tell—
close inquiry his stern glance would quell.

re breathe but few whose aspect might defy
full encounter of his searching eye;
had the skill, when Cunning's gaze would seek^[ho]
probe his heart and watch his changing cheek,
once the observer's purpose to espy,
on himself roll back his scrutiny, 220
he to Conrad rather should betray
the secret thought, than drag that Chief's to day.
There was a laughing Devil in his sneer,
that raised emotions both of rage and fear;
where his frown of hatred darkly fell,
he withering fled—and Mercy sighed farewell!^[200]

X.^[201]

What are the outward signs of evil thought,
within—within—'twas there the spirit wrought!
He shows all changes—Hate, Ambition, Guile,
may no further than the bitter smile; 230
Lip's least curl, the lightest paleness thrown
on the governed aspect, speak alone
of deeper passions; and to judge their mien,
who would see, must be himself unseen.
He—with the hurried tread, the upward eye,
the clenched hand, the pause of agony,
that listens, starting, lest the step too near
be soach intrusive on that mood of fear:
He—with each feature working from the heart,
his feelings, loosed to strengthen—not depart, 240
that rise—convulse—contend—that freeze or glow,^[hp]
flush in the cheek, or damp upon the brow;
He—Stranger! if thou canst, and tremblest not,

old his soul—the rest that soothes his lot!^[hq]
k how that lone and blighted bosom sears
scathing thought of execrated years!
old—but who hath seen, or e'er shall see,
as himself—the secret spirit free?

XI.

was not Conrad thus by Nature sent
lead the guilty—Guilt's worse instrument— 250
soul was changed, before his deeds had driven
forth to war with Man and forfeit Heaven.
ped by the world in Disappointment's school,
ords too wise—in conduct *there* a fool;
firm to yield, and far too proud to stoop,
med by his very virtues for a dupe,
ursed those virtues as the cause of ill,
not the traitors who betrayed him still;
deemed that gifts bestowed on better men
left him joy, and means to give again. 260
ed—shunned—belied—ere Youth had lost her force,
ated Man too much to feel remorse,
thought the voice of Wrath a sacred call,
ay the injuries of some on all.
knew himself a villain—but he deemed
rest no better than the thing he seemed;
scorned the best as hypocrites who hid
se deeds the bolder spirit plainly did.
knew himself detested, but he knew
hearts that loathed him, crouched and dreaded too. 270
e, wild, and strange, he stood alike exempt
n all affection and from all contempt:

name could sadden, and his acts surprise;
they that feared him dared not to despise:
it spurns the worm, but pauses ere he wake
slumbering venom of the folded snake:
first may turn, but not avenge the blow;
last expires, but leaves no living foe;
to the doomed offender's form it clings,
he may crush—not conquer—still it stings!^[202] 280

XII.

He are all evil—quickenings round his heart,
softer feeling would not yet depart;
could he sneer at others as beguiled
passions worthy of a fool or child;
'gainst that passion vainly still he strove,
even in him it asks the name of Love!
it was love—unchangeable—unchanged,
but for one from whom he never ranged;
though fairest captives daily met his eye,
shunned, nor sought, but coldly passed them by; 290
though many a beauty drooped in prisoned bower,
he ever soothed his most unguarded hour,
—it was Love—if thoughts of tenderness,
kind in temptation, strengthened by distress,
moved by absence, firm in every clime,
yet—Oh more than all!—untired by Time;
neither nor defeated hope, nor baffled wile,
could render sullen were She near to smile,
neither rage could fire, nor sickness fret to vent
nor one murmur of his discontent; 300
which still would meet with joy, with calmness part,

that his look of grief should reach her heart;
which nought removed, nor menaced to remove—
where be Love in mortals—this was Love!
Was a villain—aye, reproaches shower
him—but not the Passion, nor its power,
which only proved—all other virtues gone—
Guilt itself could quench this loveliest one!^[hr]

XIII.

paused a moment—till his hastening men
led the first winding downward to the glen. 310
brought tidings!—many a peril have I passed,
I know I why this next appears the last!
so my heart forebodes, but must not fear,
shall my followers find me falter here.
rash to meet—but surer death to wait
here they hunt us to undoubted fate;
yet, if my plan but hold, and Fortune smile,
I furnish mourners for our funeral pile.
let them slumber—peaceful be their dreams!
when ne'er awoke them with such brilliant beams 320
kindle high to-night (but blow, thou breeze!)
warm these slow avengers of the seas.
I to Medora—Oh! my sinking heart,^[hs]
may her own be lighter than thou art!
was I brave—mean boast where all are brave!
as insects sting for aught they seek to save.
as common courage which with brutes we share,
it owes its deadliest efforts to Despair,
all merit claims—but 'twas my nobler hope
to reach my few with numbers still to cope; 330

g have I led them—not to vainly bleed:
medium now—we perish or succeed!
et it be—it irks not me to die;
thus to urge them whence they cannot fly.
lot hath long had little of my care,
chafes my pride thus baffled in the snare:
is my skill? my craft? to set at last
e, Power and Life upon a single cast?
Fate!—accuse thy folly—not thy fate;
may redeem thee still—nor yet too late." 340

XIV.

s with himself communion held he, till
eached the summit of his tower-crowned hill:
re at the portal paused—for wild and soft
eard those accents never heard too oft!
ough the high lattice far yet sweet they rung,
these the notes his Bird of Beauty sung:

1.

ep in my soul that tender secret dwells,
onely and lost to light for evermore,
e when to thine my heart responsive swells,
hen trembles into silence as before. 350

2.

ere, in its centre, a sepulchral lamp
urns the slow flame, eternal—but unseen;
ch not the darkness of Despair can damp,
hough vain its ray as it had never been.

3.

member me—Oh! pass not thou my grave
without one thought whose relics there recline:
only pang my bosom dare not brave
must be to find forgetfulness in thine.

4.

dearest—faintest—latest accents hear—^[ht]
grief for the dead not Virtue can reprove; 360
n give me all I ever asked—a tear,^[203]
the first—last—sole reward of so much love!"

passed the portal, crossed the corridor,
reached the chamber as the strain gave o'er:
own Medora! sure thy song is sad—"

Conrad's absence would'st thou have it glad?
out thine ear to listen to my lay,
must my song my thoughts, my soul betray:
must each accent to my bosom suit,
heart unhushed—although my lips were mute! 370
many a night on this lone couch reclined,
dreaming fear with storms hath winged the wind,
deemed the breath that faintly fanned thy sail
murmuring prelude of the ruder gale;
ugh soft—it seemed the low prophetic dirge,
t mourned thee floating on the savage surge:
would I rise to rouse the beacon fire,
spies less true should let the blaze expire;
many a restless hour outwatched each star,
morning came—and still thou wert afar. 380

how the chill blast on my bosom blew,
day broke dreary on my troubled view,
still I gazed and gazed—and not a prow
granted to my tears—my truth—my vow!
length—'twas noon—I hailed and blest the mast
that met my sight—it neared—Alas! it passed!
then came—Oh God! 'twas thine at last!
I told that those days were over! wilt thou ne'er,
Conrad! learn the joys of peace to share?
For thou hast more than wealth, and many a home 390
as bright as this invites us not to roam:
I know'st it is not peril that I fear,
I only tremble when thou art not here;
I care not for mine, but that far dearer life,
which flies from love and languishes for strife—
O'er strange that heart, to me so tender still,
I would war with Nature and its better will!"

Alas, strange indeed—that heart hath long been changed;
I am like 'twas trampled—adder-like avenged—
I sought one hope on earth beyond thy love, 400
I scarce a glimpse of mercy from above.
I have the same feeling which thou dost condemn,
My very love to thee is hate to them,
I closely mingling here, that disentwined,
I cease to love thee when I love Mankind:
I dread not this—the proof of all the past
I presages the future that my love will last;
—Oh, Medora! nerve thy gentler heart;
In this hour again—but not for long—we part."

In this hour we part!—my heart foreboded this: 410

s ever fade my fairy dreams of bliss.
; hour—it cannot be—this hour away!
bark hath hardly anchored in the bay:
consort still is absent, and her crew
e need of rest before they toil anew;
Love! thou mock'st my weakness; and wouldst steel
breast before the time when it must feel;
trifle now no more with my distress,
n mirth hath less of play than bitterness.
ilent, Conrad!—dearest! come and share 420
feast these hands delighted to prepare;
it toil! to cull and dress thy frugal fare!
I have plucked the fruit that promised best,
where not sure, perplexed, but pleased, I guessed
uch as seemed the fairest; thrice the hill
steps have wound to try the coolest rill;
thy Sherbet to-night will sweetly flow,
how it sparkles in its vase of snow!
grapes' gay juice thy bosom never cheers;
u more than Moslem when the cup appears: 430
lk not I mean to chide—for I rejoice
at others deem a penance is thy choice.
come, the board is spread; our silver lamp
immed, and heeds not the Sirocco's damp:
n shall my handmaids while the time along,
join with me the dance, or wake the song;
ny guitar, which still thou lov'st to hear,
l soothe or lull—or, should it vex thine ear,
l turn the tale, by Ariosto told,
air Olympia loved and left of old.^[204] 440
7, thou wert worse than he who broke his vow
hat lost damsel, should thou leave me *now*—

even that traitor chief—I've seen thee smile,
on the clear sky showed Ariadne's Isle,
which I have pointed from these cliffs the while:
thus half sportive—half in fear—I said,
Time should raise that doubt to more than dread,
as Conrad, too, will quit me for the main:
he deceived me—for—he came again!"

again, again—and oft again—my Love! 450
ere be life below, and hope above,
will return—but now, the moments bring
time of parting with redoubled wing:
why, the where—what boots it now to tell?
we all must end in that wild word—Farewell!
would I fain—did time allow—disclose—
not—these are no formidable foes!
here shall watch a more than wonted guard,
sudden siege and long defence prepared:
be thou lonely, though thy Lord's away, 460
matrons and thy handmaids with thee stay;
this thy comfort—that, when next we meet,
merriness shall make repose more sweet.
!"—'tis the bugle!"—Juan shrilly blew—
the kiss—one more—another—Oh! Adieu!"
she rose—she sprung—she clung to his embrace,
his heart heaved beneath her hidden face:
dared not raise to his that deep-blue eye,
which downcast drooped in tearless agony.
his long fair hair lay floating o'er his arms, 470
all the wildness of dishevelled charms;
his heart beat that bosom where his image dwelt
full—*that* feeling seem'd almost unfelt!

↳—peals the thunder of the signal-gun!
ld 'twas sunset, and he cursed that sun.
in—again—that form he madly pressed,
ch mutely clasped, imploringly caressed!^[hu]
tottering to the couch his bride he bore,
moment gazed—as if to gaze no more;
that for him Earth held but her alone, 480
ed her cold forehead—turned—is Conrad gone?

XV.

d is he gone?"—on sudden solitude
oft that fearful question will intrude!
as but an instant past, and here he stood!
now"—without the portal's porch she rushed,
then at length her tears in freedom gushed;
bright, and fast, unknown to her they fell;
still her lips refused to send—"Farewell!"
in that word—that fatal word—howe'er
promise—hope—believe—there breathes Despair. 490
every feature of that still, pale face,
Sorrow fixed what Time can ne'er erase:
tender blue of that large loving eye
w frozen with its gaze on vacancy,
—Oh, how far!—it caught a glimpse of him,
then it flowed, and phrensied seemed to swim
ough those long, dark, and glistening lashes dewed
n drops of sadness oft to be renewed.
's gone!"—against her heart that hand is driven,
vulsed and quick—then gently raised to Heaven: 500
looked and saw the heaving of the main:
white sail set—she dared not look again;

turned with sickening soul within the gate—
s no dream—and I am desolate!"

XVI.

n crag to crag descending, swiftly sped
n Conrad down, nor once he turned his head;
shrunk whene'er the windings of his way
ed on his eye what he would not survey,
lone, but lovely dwelling on the steep,
t hailed him first when homeward from the deep: 510
she—the dim and melancholy Star,
ose ray of Beauty reached him from afar,
er he must not gaze, he must not think—
re he might rest—but on Destruction's brink:
once almost he stopped—and nearly gave
fate to chance, his projects to the wave:
no—it must not be—a worthy chief
r melt, but not betray to Woman's grief.
ees his bark, he notes how fair the wind,
sternly gathers all his might of mind: 520
in he hurries on—and as he hears
clang of tumult vibrate on his ears,
busy sounds, the bustle of the shore,
shout, the signal, and the dashing oar;
narks his eye the seaboy on the mast,
anchors rise, the sails unfurling fast,
waving kerchiefs of the crowd that urge
t mute Adieu to those who stem the surge;
more than all, his blood-red flag aloft,
narvelled how his heart could seem so soft. 530
in his glance, and wildness in his breast,

feels of all his former self possess;
ounds—he flies—until his footsteps reach
verge where ends the cliff, begins the beach,
re checks his speed; but pauses less to breathe
breezy freshness of the deep beneath,
n there his wonted statelier step renew;
rush, disturbed by haste, to vulgar view:
well had Conrad learned to curb the crowd,
urts that veil, and oft preserve the proud; 540
was the lofty port, the distant mien,
t seems to shun the sight—and awes if seen:
solemn aspect, and the high-born eye,
t checks low mirth, but lacks not courtesy;
these he wielded to command assent:
where he wished to win, so well unbent,
t Kindness cancelled fear in those who heard,
others' gifts showed mean beside his word,
en echoed to the heart as from his own
deep yet tender melody of tone: 550
such was foreign to his wonted mood,
ared not what he softened, but subdued;
evil passions of his youth had made
t value less who loved—than what obeyed.

XVII.

und him mustering ranged his ready guard.
ore him Juan stands—"Are all prepared?"
ey are—nay more—embarked: the latest boat
ts but my chief——"

"My sword, and my capote."

n firmly girded on, and lightly slung,

belt and cloak were o'er his shoulders flung: 560
"Hail Pedro here!" He comes—and Conrad bends,
To all the courtesy he deigned his friends;
Receive these tablets, and peruse with care,
Where words of high trust and truth are graven there;
Remember the guard, and when Anselmo's bark
Returns, let him alike these orders mark:
For three days (serve the breeze) the sun shall shine
For our return—till then all peace be thine!"
He said, his brother Pirate's hand he wrung,
And ran to his boat with haughty gesture sprung. 570
He heaved the dipt oars, and sparkling with the stroke,
And the waves' phosphoric^[205] brightness broke;
They gain the vessel—on the deck he stands,—
He heaves the shrill whistle, ply the busy hands—
He marks how well the ship her helm obeys,
And how gallant all her crew, and deigns to praise.
His eyes of pride to young Gonsalvo turn—
Why doth he start, and inly seem to mourn?
He sees! those eyes beheld his rocky tower,
He lives a moment o'er the parting hour; 580
—his Medora—did she mark the prow?
He never loved he half so much as now!
Much must yet be done ere dawn of day—
When he mans himself and turns away;
When to the cabin with Gonsalvo bends,
Where there unfolds his plan—his means, and ends;
Where he burns the lamp, and spreads the chart,
Where all that speaks and aids the naval art;
Why to the midnight watch protract debate;
Anxious eyes what hour is ever late? 590
 meantime, the steady breeze serenely blew,

. fast and falcon-like the vessel flew;
ed the high headlands of each clustering isle,
gain their port—long—long ere morning smile:
. soon the night-glass through the narrow bay
covers where the Pacha's galleys lay.
nt they each sail, and mark how there supine
lights in vain o'er heedless Moslem shine.
re, unnoted, Conrad's prow passed by,
. anchored where his ambush meant to lie; 600
ened from espial by the jutting cape,
t rears on high its rude fantastic shape.^[206]
n rose his band to duty—not from sleep—
ipped for deeds alike on land or deep;
le leaned their Leader o'er the fretting flood,
. calmly talked—and yet he talked of blood!

CANTO THE SECOND.



"Conosceste i dubbiosi desiri?"

DANTE, *Inferno*, v, 120.

I.

oron's bay floats many a galley light,
ough Coron's lattices the lamps are bright,^[207]
Seyd, the Pacha, makes a feast to-night:
ast for promised triumph yet to come, 610
en he shall drag the fettered Rovers home;
hath he sworn by Allah and his sword,
. faithful to his firman and his word,

summoned prows collect along the coast,
 great the gathering crews, and loud the boast;
 ready shared the captives and the prize,
 though far the distant foe they thus despise;
 but to sail—no doubt to-morrow's Sun
 will see the Pirates bound—their haven won!
 meantime the watch may slumber, if they will, 620
 only wake to war, but dreaming kill.
 Though all, who can, disperse on shore and seek
 to test their glowing valour on the Greek;
 how well such deed becomes the turbaned brave—
 before the sabre's edge before a slave!
 Not his dwelling—but forbear to slay,
 for his arms are strong, yet merciful to-day,
 he do not deign to smite because they may!
 Unless some gay caprice suggests the blow,
 keep in practice for the coming foe. 630
 He'll elude and rout the evening hours beguile,
 but they who wish to wear a head must smile;
 Moslem mouths produce their choicest cheer,
 and hoard their curses, till the coast is clear.

II.

And in his hall reclines the turbaned Seyd;
 and round—the bearded chiefs he came to lead.
 He loved the banquet, and the last pilaff—
 hidden draughts, 'tis said, he dared to quaff,
 though to the rest the sober berry's juice^[208]
 slaves bear round for rigid Moslems' use; 640
 the long chibouque's^[209] dissolving cloud supply,
 he'll dance the Almas^[210] to wild minstrelsy.

rising morn will view the chiefs embark;
waves are somewhat treacherous in the dark:
revellers may more securely sleep
silken couch than o'er the rugged deep:
st there who can—nor combat till they must,
less to conquest than to Korans trust;
yet the numbers crowded in his host
ht warrant more than even the Pacha's boast. 650

III.

n cautious reverence from the outer gate
v stalks the slave, whose office there to wait,
s his bent head—his hand salutes the floor,
yet his tongue the trusted tidings bore:
aptive Dervise, from the Pirate's nest
aped, is here—himself would tell the rest."^[211]
ook the sign from Seyd's assenting eye,
led the holy man in silence nigh.
arms were folded on his dark-green vest,
step was feeble, and his look deprest; 660
worn he seemed of hardship more than years,
pale his cheek with penance, not from fears.
red to his God—his sable locks he wore,
these his lofty cap rose proudly o'er:
und his form his loose long robe was thrown,
wraapt a breast bestowed on heaven alone;
missive, yet with self-possession manned,
calmly met the curious eyes that scanned;
question of his coming fain would seek,
ore the Pacha's will allowed to speak. 670

IV.

ience com'st thou, Dervise?"

"From the Outlaw's den
gitive—"

"Thy capture where and when?"
m Scalanova's port^[212] to Scio's isle,
Saick^[213] was bound; but Allah did not smile
n our course—the Moslem merchant's gains
Rovers won; our limbs have worn their chains.
d no death to fear, nor wealth to boast,
ond the wandering freedom which I lost;
ength a fisher's humble boat by night
rdded hope, and offered chance of flight; 680
zed the hour, and find my safety here—
n thee—most mighty Pacha! who can fear?"

w speed the outlaws? stand they well prepared,
ir plundered wealth, and robber's rock, to guard?
am they of this our preparation, doomed
rview with fire their scorpion nest consumed?"

cha! the fettered captive's mourning eye,
t weeps for flight, but ill can play the spy;
ly heard the reckless waters roar,
se waves that would not bear me from the shore; 690
ly marked the glorious Sun and sky,
bright—too blue—for my captivity;
felt that all which Freedom's bosom cheers
t break my chain before it dried my tears.
; mayst thou judge, at least, from my escape,
y little deem of aught in Peril's shape;
vainly had I prayed or sought the Chance
t leads me here—if eyed with vigilance:

careless guard that did not see me fly,
watch as idly when thy power is nigh. 700
Alas! my limbs are faint—and nature craves
rest for my hunger, rest from tossing waves:
Furnish my absence—peace be with thee! Peace
be all around!—now grant repose—release."

Now, Dervise! I have more to question—stay,
I command thee—sit—dost hear?—obey!
What I must ask, and food the slaves shall bring;
Thou shalt not pine where all are banqueting:
Supper done—prepare thee to reply,
Heartily and full—I love not mystery." 710
How vain to guess what shook the pious man,
How looked not lovingly on that Divan;
How showed high relish for the banquet prest,
How less respect for every fellow guest.
But a moment's peevish hectic passed
Along his cheek, and tranquillised as fast:
He sat him down in silence, and his look
Assumed the calmness which before forsook:
The feast was ushered in—but sumptuous fare
Was shunned as if some poison mingled there. 720
One so long condemned to toil and fast,
How thinks he strangely spares the rich repast.
What ails thee, Dervise? eat—dost thou suppose
This feast a Christian's? or my friends thy foes?
Why dost thou shun the salt? that sacred pledge,^[214]
Which, once partaken, blunts the sabre's edge,
And sees even contending tribes in peace unite,
How hated hosts seem brethren to the sight!"

t seasons dainties—and my food is still
humblest root, my drink the simplest rill; 730
my stern vow and Order's^[215] laws oppose
neak or mingle bread with friends or foes;
ay seem strange—if there be aught to dread
t peril rests upon my single head;
for thy sway—nay more—thy Sultan's throne,
te nor bread nor banquet—save alone;
nged our Order's rule, the Prophet's rage
Mecca's dome might bar my pilgrimage."

ll—as thou wilt—ascetic as thou art—
question answer; then in peace depart. 740
v many?—Ha! it cannot sure be day?
at Star—what Sun is bursting on the bay?
ines a lake of fire!—away—away!
treachery! my guards! my scimitar!
galleys feed the flames—and I afar!
urséd Dervise!—these thy tidings—thou
ie villain spy—seize—cleave him—slay him now!"

rose the Dervise with that burst of light,
less his change of form appalled the sight:
rose that Dervise—not in saintly garb, 750
like a warrior bounding on his barb,
hed his high cap, and tore his robe away—
ne his mailed breast, and flashed his sabre's ray!
close but glittering casque, and sable plume,
e glittering eye, and black brow's sabler gloom,
ed on the Moslems' eyes some Afrit Sprite,
se demon death-blow left no hope for fight.
wild confusion, and the swarthy glow

lames on high, and torches from below;
shriek of terror, and the mingling yell— 760
swords began to clash, and shouts to swell—
ing o'er that spot of earth the air of Hell!
racted, to and fro, the flying slaves
old but bloody shore and fiery waves;
ght heeded they the Pacha's angry cry,
/ seize that Dervise!—seize on Zatanai!^[216]
saw their terror—checked the first despair
t urged him but to stand and perish there,
e far too early and too well obeyed,
flame was kindled ere the signal made; 770
saw their terror—from his baldric drew
bugle—brief the blast—but shrilly blew;
answered—"Well ye speed, my gallant crew!
/ did I doubt their quickness of career?
deem design had left me single here?"
eps his long arm—that sabre's whirling sway
ds fast atonement for its first delay;
mpletes his fury, what their fear begun,
makes the many basely quail to one.
cloven turbans o'er the chamber spread, 780
scarce an arm dare rise to guard its head:
n Seyd, convulsed, o'erwhelmed, with rage, surprise,
eats before him, though he still defies.
craven he—and yet he dreads the blow,
nuch Confusion magnifies his foe!
blazing galleys still distract his sight,
ore his beard, and foaming fled the fight;^[217]
now the pirates passed the Haram gate,
burst within—and it were death to wait;

ere wild Amazement shrieking—kneeling—throws 790
sword aside—in vain—the blood o'erflows!
Corsairs pouring, haste to where within
ted Conrad's bugle, and the din
groaning victims, and wild cries for life,
claimed how well he did the work of strife.
y shout to find him grim and lonely there,
uttet tiger mangling in his lair!
short their greeting, shorter his reply—
s well—but Seyd escapes—and he must die—
h hath been done—but more remains to do— 800
ir galleys blaze—why not their city too?"

V.

ck at the word they seized him each a torch,
fire the dome from minaret to porch.
ern delight was fixed in Conrad's eye,
sudden sunk—for on his ear the cry
vomen struck, and like a deadly knell
cked at that heart unmoved by Battle's yell.
! burst the Haram—wrong not on your lives
female form—remember—we have wives.
hem such outrage Vengeance will repay; 810
is our foe, and such 'tis ours to slay:
still we spared—must spare the weaker prey.
I forgot—but Heaven will not forgive
my word the helpless cease to live;
ow who will—I go—we yet have time
souls to lighten of at least a crime."
climbs the crackling stair—he bursts the door,
feels his feet glow scorching with the floor;

breath choked gasping with the volumed smoke,
 still from room to room his way he broke. 820
 y search—they find—they save: with lusty arms
 n bears a prize of unregarded charms;
 n their loud fears; sustain their sinking frames
 n all the care defenceless Beauty claims:
 vell could Conrad tame their fiercest mood,
 . check the very hands with gore imbrued.
 who is she? whom Conrad's arms convey,
 n reeking pile and combat's wreck, away—
 o but the love of him he dooms to bleed?
 Haram queen—but still the slave of Seyd! 830

VI.

f time had Conrad now to greet Gulnare, ^[218]
 words to reassure the trembling Fair;
 in that pause Compassion snatched from War,
 foe before retiring, fast and far,
 n wonder saw their footsteps unpursued,
 t slower fled—then rallied—then withstood.
 ; Seyd perceives, then first perceives how few,
 pared with his, the Corsair's roving crew,
 . blushes o'er his error, as he eyes
 ruin wrought by Panic and Surprise. 840
 . il Alla! Vengeance swells the cry—
 ne mounts to rage that must atone or die!
 . flame for flame and blood for blood must tell.
 tide of triumph ebbs that flowed too well—
 n Wrath returns to renovated strife,
 . those who fought for conquest strike for life.
 rad beheld the danger—he beheld

followers faint by freshening foes repelled:
e effort—one—to break the circling host!"
y form—unite—charge—waver—all is lost! 850
in a narrower ring compressed, beset,
eless, not heartless, strive and struggle yet—
now they fight in firmest file no more,
imed in—cut off—cleft down and trampled o'er;
each strikes singly—silently—and home,
sinks outwearied rather than o'ercome—
last faint quittance rendering with his breath,
the blade glimmers in the grasp of Death!

VII.

first, ere came the rallying host to blows,
rank to rank, and hand to hand oppose, 860
nare and all her Haram handmaids freed,
in the dome of one who held their creed,
Conrad's mandate safely were bestowed,
dried those tears for life and fame that flowed:
when that dark-eyed lady, young Gulnare,
alled those thoughts late wandering in despair,
h did she marvel o'er the courtesy
t smoothed his accents, softened in his eye—
as strange—*that* robber thus with gore bedewed,
ned gentler than than Seyd in fondest mood. 870
Pacha wooed as if he deemed the slave
t seem delighted with the heart he gave;
Corsair vowed protection, soothed affright,
f his homage were a Woman's right.
e wish is wrong—nay, worse for female—vain:
much I long to view that Chief again;

it to thank for, what my fear forgot,
life—my loving Lord remembered not!"

VIII.

him she saw, where thickest carnage spread,
gathered breathing from the happier dead; 880
from his band, and battling with a host
t deem right dearly won the field he lost,
ed—bleeding—baffled of the death he sought,
snatched to expiate all the ills he wrought;
erved to linger and to live in vain,
le Vengeance pondered o'er new plans of pain,
stanch'd the blood she saves to shed again—
drop by drop, for Seyd's unglutted eye
ld doom him ever dying—ne'er to die!
this be he? triumphant late she saw, 890
en his red hand's wild gesture waved, a law!
he indeed—disarmed but undeprest,
sole regret the life he still possest;
wounds too slight, though taken with that will,
ch would have kissed the hand that then could kill.
were there none, of all the many given,
end his soul—he scarcely asked to Heaven?^[219]
it he alone of all retain his breath,
o more than all had striven and struck for death?
leaply felt—what mortal hearts must feel, 900
en thus reversed on faithless Fortune's wheel,
crimes committed, and the victor's threat
ingering tortures to repay the debt—
leaply, darkly felt; but evil Pride
t led to perpetrate—now serves to hide.

in his stern and self-collected mien
conqueror's more than captive's air is seen,
though faint with wasting toil and stiffening wound,
few that saw—so calmly gazed around:
though the far shouting of the distant crowd, 910
their tremors o'er, rose insolently loud,
better warriors who beheld him near,
lured not the foe who taught them fear;
the grim guards that to his durance led,
hence eyed him with a secret dread.

IX.

Leech was sent—but not in mercy—there,
note how much the life yet left could bear;
bound enough to load with heaviest chain,
no promise feeling for the wrench of Pain;
narrow—yea—to-morrow's evening Sun 920
is sinking, see Impalement's pangs begun,
rising with the wonted blush of morn
old how well or ill those pangs are borne.
torments this the longest and the worst,
which adds all other agony to thirst,
that day by day Death still forbears to slake,
while famished vultures flit around the stake.
"No water—water!"—smiling Hate denies
the victim's prayer, for if he drinks he dies.
that was his doom;—the Leech, the guard, were gone, 930
left proud Conrad fettered and alone.

X.

are vain to paint to what his feelings grew—

ren were doubtful if their victim knew.
re is a war, a chaos of the mind,^[220]
en all its elements convulsed, combined
dark and jarring with perturbéd force,
gnashing with impenitent Remorse—
t juggling fiend, who never spake before,
cries "I warned thee!" when the deed is o'er.
a voice! the spirit burning but unbent, 940
r writhe—rebel—the weak alone repent!
n in that lonely hour when most it feels,
, to itself, all—all that self reveals,—
single passion, and no ruling thought
t leaves the rest, as once, unseen, unsought,
the wild prospect when the Soul reviews,
ushing through their thousand avenues—
dition's dreams expiring, Love's regret,
angered Glory, Life itself beset;
joy untasted, the contempt or hate 950
nst those who fain would triumph in our fate;
hopeless past, the hasting future driven
quickly on to guess if Hell or Heaven;
ds—thoughts—and words, perhaps remembered not
eenly till that hour, but ne'er forgot;
igs light or lovely in their acted time,
now to stern Reflection each a crime;
withering sense of Evil unrevealed,
cankering less because the more concealed;
in a word, from which all eyes must start, 960
t opening sepulchre, the naked heart^[221]
es with its buried woes—till Pride awake,
natch the mirror from the soul, and break.

, Pride can veil, and Courage brave it all—
—all—before—beyond—the deadliest fall.
1 hath some fear, and he who least betrays,
only hypocrite deserving praise:
the loud recreant wretch who boasts and flies;
he who looks on Death—and silent dies:
steeled by pondering o'er his far career, 970
half-way meets Him should He menace near!

XI.

ie high chamber of his highest tower
Conrad, fettered in the Pacha's power.
palace perished in the flame—this fort
tained at once his captive and his court.
much could Conrad of his sentence blame,
foe, if vanquished, had but shared the same:—
ie he sate—in solitude had scanned
guilty bosom, but that breast he manned:
thought alone he could not—dared not meet— 980
, how these tidings will Medora greet?"
n—only then—his clanking hands he raised,
strained with rage the chain on which he gazed;
soon he found, or feigned, or dreamed relief,
smiled in self-derision of his grief,
d now come Torture when it will, or may—
e need of rest to nerve me for the day!"
said, with langour to his mat he crept,
, whatso'er his visions, quickly slept.

as hardly midnight when that fray begun, 990
Conrad's plans matured, at once were done,
Havoc loathes so much the waste of time,

scarce had left an uncommitted crime.
hour beheld him since the tide he stemmed—
guised—discovered—conquering—ta'en—condemned—
chief on land—an outlaw on the deep—
destroying—saving—prisoned—and asleep!

XII.

He slept in calmest seeming, for his breath^[222]
hushed so deep—Ah! happy if in death!
He slept—Who o'er his placid slumber bends? 1000
foes are gone—and here he hath no friends;
some Seraph sent to grant him grace?
'Tis an earthly form with heavenly face!
White arm raised a lamp—yet gently hid,
The ray flash abruptly on the lid
That closed eye, which opens but to pain,
Once unclosed—but once may close again.
That form, with eye so dark, and cheek so fair,
Auburn waves of gemmed and braided hair;
The shape of fairy lightness—naked foot, 1010
That shines like snow, and falls on earth as mute—
How guards and dunest night how came it there?
Rather ask what will not Woman dare?
From Youth and Pity lead like thee, Gulnare!
Could not sleep—and while the Pacha's rest
Uttering dreams yet saw his pirate-guest,
Left his side—his signet-ring she bore,
Which oft in sport adorned her hand before—
With it, scarcely questioned, won her way
Through drowsy guards that must that sign obey. 1020
In out with toil, and tired with changing blows,

ir eyes had envied Conrad his repose;
chill and nodding at the turret door,
y stretch their listless limbs, and watch no more;
raised their heads to hail the signet-ring,
ask or what or who the sign may bring.

XIII.

gazed in wonder, "Can he calmly sleep,
le other eyes his fall or ravage weep?
mine in restlessness are wandering here—
at sudden spell hath made this man so dear? 1030
—'tis to him my life, and more, I owe,
me and mine he spared from worse than woe:
late to think—but soft—his slumber breaks—
v heavily he sighs!—he starts—awakes!"
aised his head, and dazzled with the light,
eye seemed dubious if it saw aright:
noved his hand—the grating of his chain
harshly told him that he lived again.
iat is that form? if not a shape of air,
hinks, my jailor's face shows wondrous fair!" 1040
ate! thou know'st me not, but I am one,
eful for deeds thou hast too rarely done;
k on me—and remember her, thy hand
ched from the flames, and thy more fearful band.
me through darkness—and I scarce know why—
not to hurt—I would not see thee die."

o, kind lady! thine the only eye
t would not here in that gay hope delight:
irs is the chance—and let them use their right.
still I thank their courtesy or thine, 1050

It would confess me at so fair a shrine!"

 nげ though it seem—yet with extremest grief
 nked a mirth—it doth not bring relief—
 t playfulness of Sorrow ne'er beguiles,
 . smiles in bitterness—but still it smiles;
 . sometimes with the wisest and the best,
 even the scaffold^[223] echoes with their jest!
 not the joy to which it seems akin—
 ay deceive all hearts, save that within.
 ate'er it was that flashed on Conrad, now 1060
 ughing wildness half unbent his brow:
 . these his accents had a sound of mirth,
 f the last he could enjoy on earth;
 'gainst his nature—for through that short life,
 thoughts had he to spare from gloom and strife.

XIV.

rsair! thy doom is named—but I have power
 oother the Pacha in his weaker hour.
e would I spare—nay more—would save thee now,
this—Time—Hope—nor even thy strength allow;
all I can,—I will—at least delay 1070
 sentence that remits thee scarce a day.
e now were ruin—even thyself were loth
vain attempt should bring but doom to both."

s!—loth indeed:—my soul is nerved to all,
all'n too low to fear a further fall:
pt not thyself with peril—me with hope
light from foes with whom I could not cope:
it to vanquish—shall I meanly fly,

one of all my band that would not die?
there is one—to whom my Memory clings, 1080
to these eyes her own wild softness springs.
sole resources in the path I trod
e these—my bark—my sword—my love—my God!
last I left in youth!—He leaves me now—
. Man but works his will to lay me low.
ve no thought to mock his throne with prayer
ng from the coward crouching of Despair;
enough—I breathe—and I can bear.
sword is shaken from the worthless hand
t might have better kept so true a brand; 1090
bark is sunk or captive—but my Love—
her in sooth my voice would mount above:
she is all that still to earth can bind—
. this will break a heart so more than kind,
. blight a form—till thine appeared, Gulnare!
e eye ne'er asked if others were as fair."

ou lov'st another then?—but what to me
is—'tis nothing—nothing e'er can be:
yet—thou lov'st—and—Oh! I envy those
ose hearts on hearts as faithful can repose, 1100
o never feel the void—the wandering thought
t sighs o'er visions—such as mine hath wrought."

ly—methought thy love was his, for whom
; arm redeemed thee from a fiery tomb."

r love stern Seyd's! Oh—No—No—not my love—
much this heart, that strives no more, once strove
neet his passion—but it would not be.
t—I feel—Love dwells with—with the free.

like a slave, a favoured slave at best,
share his splendour, and seem very blest! 1110
must my soul the question undergo,
—'Dost thou love?' and burn to answer, 'No!'
hard it is that fondness to sustain,
struggle not to feel averse in vain;
harder still the heart's recoil to bear,
hide from one—perhaps another there.
makes the hand I give not—nor withhold—
pulse nor checked—nor quickened—calmly cold:
when resigned, it drops a lifeless weight
on one I never loved enough to hate. 1120
warmth these lips return by his imprest,
chilled Remembrance shudders o'er the rest.
—had I ever proved that Passion's zeal,
change to hatred were at least to feel:
still—he goes unmourned—returns unsought—
often when present—absent from my thought.
when Reflection comes—and come it must—
or that henceforth 'twill but bring disgust;
like his slave—but, in despite of pride,
were worse than bondage to become his bride. 1130
that this dotage of his breast would cease!
seek another and give mine release,
yesterday—I could have said, to peace!
if unwonted fondness now I feign,^[hvt]
remember—Captive! 'tis to break thy chain;
pay the life that to thy hand I owe;
give thee back to all endeared below,
to share such love as I can never know.
well—Morn breaks—and I must now away:
It cost me dear—but dread no death to-day!" 1140

XV.

pressed his fettered fingers to her heart,
bowed her head, and turned her to depart,
noiseless as a lovely dream is gone.
was she here? and is he now alone?
at gem hath dropped and sparkles o'er his chain?
tear most sacred, shed for others' pain,
t starts at once—bright—pure—from Pity's mine,
ady polished by the hand divine!
too convincing—dangerously dear—
oman's eye the unanswerable tear! 1150
t weapon of her weakness she can wield,
ave, subdue—at once her spear and shield:
id it—Virtue ebbs and Wisdom errs,
fondly gazing on that grief of hers!
at lost a world, and bade a hero fly?
timid tear in Cleopatra's eye.
be the soft Triumvir's fault forgiven;
his—how many lose not earth—but Heaven!
sign their souls to Man's eternal foe,
seal their own to spare some Wanton's woe! 1160

XVI.

Morn—and o'er his altered features play
beams—without the Hope of yesterday.
at shall he be ere night? perchance a thing
which the raven flaps her funeral wing,
his closed eye unheeded and unfelt;
le sets that Sun, and dews of Evening melt,
l, wet, and misty round each stiffened limb,
reshing earth—reviving all but him!

CANTO THE THIRD.



"Come vedi—ancor non m'abbandona."

DANTE, *Inferno*, v. 105.

I.

w sinks, more lovely ere his race be run,^[224]
ing Morea's hills the setting Sun; 1170
as in Northern climes, obscurely bright,
one unclouded blaze of living light!
the hushed deep the yellow beam he throws,
ls the green wave, that trembles as it glows.
old Ægina's rock, and Idra's isle,^[225]
God of gladness sheds his parting smile;
his own regions lingering, loves to shine,
ugh there his altars are no more divine.
cending fast the mountain shadows kiss
glorious gulf, unconquered Salamis! 1180
ir azure arches through the long expanse
e deeply purpled met his mellowing glance,
tenderest tints, along their summits driven,
k his gay course, and own the hues of Heaven;
darkly shaded from the land and deep,
ind his Delphian cliff he sinks to sleep.

such an eve, his palest beam he cast,
en—Athens! here thy Wisest looked his last.
v watched thy better sons his farewell ray,
t closed their murdered Sage's^[226] latest day! 1190

yet—not yet—Sol pauses on the hill—
precious hour of parting lingers still;
sad his light to agonising eyes,
dark the mountain's once delightful dyes:
om o'er the lovely land he seemed to pour,
land, where Phoebus never frowned before:
ere he sunk below Cithæron's head,
cup of woe was quaffed—the Spirit fled;
Soul of him who scorned to fear or fly—
o lived and died, as none can live or die! 1200

lo! from high Hymettus to the plain,
Queen of night asserts her silent reign.^[227]
murky vapour, herald of the storm,
as her fair face, nor girds her glowing form;
n cornice glimmering as the moon-beams play,
re the white column greets her grateful ray,
bright around with quivering beams beset,
emblem sparkles o'er the Minaret:
groves of olive scattered dark and wide
ere meek Cephissus pours his scanty tide; 1210
cypress saddening by the sacred Mosque,
gleaming turret of the gay Kiosk,^[228]
, dun and sombre 'mid the holy calm,
r Theseus' fane yon solitary palm,
tinged with varied hues arrest the eye—
dull were his that passed him heedless by.

in the Ægean, heard no more afar,
s his chafed breast from elemental war;
in his waves in milder tints unfold
ir long array of sapphire and of gold, 1220

ed with the shades of many a distant isle,
t frown—where gentler Ocean seems to smile.

II.

now my theme—why turn my thoughts to thee?
who can look along thy native sea,
dwell upon thy name, whate'er the tale,
nuch its magic must o'er all prevail?
o that beheld that Sun upon thee set,
Athens! could thine evening face forget?
he—whose heart nor time nor distance frees,
l-bound within the clustering Cyclades! 1230
seems this homage foreign to its strain,
Corsair's isle was once thine own domain—^[229]
ld that with freedom it were thine again!

III.

Sun hath sunk—and, darker than the night,
is with its beam upon the beacon height
lora's heart—the third day's come and gone—
n it he comes not—sends not—faithless one!
wind was fair though light! and storms were none.
eve Anselmo's bark returned, and yet
only tidings that they had not met! 1240
ugh wild, as now, far different were the tale
Conrad waited for that single sail.
night-breeze freshens—she that day had passed
atching all that Hope proclaimed a mast;
y she sate on high—Impatience bore
ast her footsteps to the midnight shore,
there she wandered, heedless of the spray

It dashed her garments oft, and warned away:
saw not, felt not this—nor dared depart,
deemed it cold—her chill was at her heart; 1250
grew such certainty from that suspense—
very Sight had shocked from life or sense!

me at last—a sad and shattered boat,
those inmates first beheld whom first they sought;
the bleeding—all most wretched—these the few—
each knew they how escaped—*this* all they knew.
Silence, darkling, each appeared to wait
fellow's mournful guess at Conrad's fate:
nothing they would have said; but seemed to fear
rust their accents to Medora's ear. 1260
saw at once, yet sunk not—trembled not—
death that grief, that loneliness of lot,
even in that meek fair form, were feelings high,
It deemed not till they found their energy.
The yet was Hope they softened, fluttered, wept—
lost—that Softness died not—but it slept;
And o'er its slumber rose that Strength which said,
"With nothing left to love, there's nought to dread."
More than Nature's—like the burning might
Fervour gathers from the fever's height. 1270

Would you stand—nor would I hear you tell
It—speak not—breathe not—for I know it well—
would I ask—almost my lip denies
—quick your answer—tell me where he lies."

Alas! we know not—scarce with life we fled;
here is one denies that he is dead:
saw him bound; and bleeding—but alive."

heard no further—'twas in vain to strive—
hrobbed each vein—each thought—till then withstood;
own dark soul—these words at once subdued: 1280
totters—falls—and senseless had the wave
hance but snatched her from another grave;
that with hands though rude, yet weeping eyes,
y yield such aid as Pity's haste supplies.^[hw]
h o'er her deathlike cheek the ocean dew,
ie, fan, sustain—till life returns anew;
ike her handmaids, with the matrons leave
t fainting form o'er which they gaze and grieve;
n seek Anselmo's cavern, to report
tale too tedious—when the triumph short. 1290

IV.

at wild council words waxed warm and strange,^[hx]
n thoughts of ransom, rescue, and revenge;
save repose or flight: still lingering there
athed Conrad's spirit, and forbade despair;
ate'er his fate—the breasts he formed and led
save him living, or appease him dead.
e to his foes! there yet survive a few,
ose deeds are daring, as their hearts are true.

V.

in the Haram's secret chamber sate^[230]
n Seyd, still pondering o'er his Captive's fate; 1300
thoughts on love and hate alternate dwell,
v with Gulnare, and now in Conrad's cell;
e at his feet the lovely slave reclined
veys his brow—would soothe his gloom of mind;

le many an anxious glance her large dark eye
ls in its idle search for sympathy,
only bends in seeming o'er his beads,^[231]
inly views his victim as he bleeds.

ha! the day is thine; and on thy crest
Triumph—Conrad taken—fall'n the rest! 1310
doom is fixed—he dies; and well his fate
earned—yet much too worthless for thy hate:
hinks, a short release, for ransom told^[hy]
n all his treasure, not unwisely sold;
ort speaks largely of his pirate-hoard—
ld that of this my Pacha were the lord!
le baffled, weakened by this fatal fray—
ched—followed—he were then an easier prey;
once cut off—the remnant of his band
ark their wealth, and seek a safer strand." 1320

lnare!—if for each drop of blood a gem
re offered rich as Stamboul's diadem;
r each hair of his a massy mine
rigin ore should supplicating shine;
l our Arab tales divulge or dream
wealth were here—that gold should not redeem!
id not now redeemed a single hour,
that I know him fettered, in my power;
, thirsting for revenge, I ponder still
pangs that longest rack—and latest kill." 1330

y, Seyd! I seek not to restrain thy rage,
justly moved for Mercy to assuage;
thoughts were only to secure for thee

riches—thus released, he were not free:
bled—shorn of half his might and band,
capture could but wait thy first command."

capture *could!*—and shall I then resign
day to him—the wretch already mine?
ase my foe!—at whose remonstrance?—thine!
suitor!—to thy virtuous gratitude, 1340
t thus repays this Giaour's relenting mood,
ch thee and thine alone of all could spare—
doubt, regardless—if the prize were fair—
thanks and praise alike are due—now hear!
ve a counsel for thy gentler ear:
mistrust thee, Woman! and each word
hine stamps truth on all Suspicion heard. [hz]
re in his arms through fire from yon Serai—
wert thou lingering there with him to fly?
u need'st not answer—thy confession speaks, 1350
ady reddening on thy guilty cheeks:
n—lovely Dame—bethink thee! and beware:
not *his* life alone may claim such care!
ther word and—nay—I need no more.
ursed was the moment when he bore
e from the flames, which better far—but no—
n had mourned thee with a lover's woe—
'tis thy lord that warns—deceitful thing!
w'st thou that I can clip thy wanton wing?
ords alone I am not wont to chafe: 1360
k to thyself—nor deem thy falsehood safe!"

ose—and slowly, sternly thence withdrew,
e in his eye, and threats in his adieu:

little recked that Chief of womanhood—
ch frowns ne'er quelled, nor menaces subdued;
little deemed he what thy heart, Gulnare!
en soft could feel—and when incensed could dare!
doubts appeared to wrong—nor yet she knew
v deep the root from whence Compassion grew—
was a slave—from such may captives claim 1370
llow-feeling, differing but in name;
half unconscious—heedless of his wrath,
in she ventured on the dangerous path,
in his rage repelled—until arose
t strife of thought, the source of Woman's woes!

VI.

nwhile—long—anxious—weary—still the same
ed day and night: his soul could Terror tame—
; fearful interval of doubt and dread,
en every hour might doom him worse than dead;^[ia]
en every step that echoed by the gate, 1380
ht entering lead where axe and stake await;
en every voice that grated on his ear
ht be the last that he could ever hear;
ld Terror tame—that Spirit stern and high
proved unwilling as unfit to die;
is worn—perhaps decayed—yet silent bore
t conflict, deadlier far than all before:
heat of fight, the hurry of the gale,
ve scarce one thought inert enough to quail:
bound and fixed in fettered solitude, 1390
ine, the prey of every changing mood;
gaze on thine own heart—and meditate

vocable faults, and coming fate—
late the last to shun—the first to mend—
count the hours that struggle to thine end,
I not a friend to animate and tell
other ears that Death became thee well;
and thee foes to forge the ready lie,
I blot Life's latest scene with calumny;
more thee tortures, which the Soul can dare, 1400
doubts how well the shrinking flesh may bear;
deeply feels a single cry would shame,
Valour's praise thy last and dearest claim;
life thou leav'st below, denied above
kind monopolists of heavenly love;
I more than doubtful Paradise—thy Heaven
earthly hope—thy loved one from thee riven.
I were the thoughts that outlaw must sustain,
I govern pangs surpassing mortal pain:
I those sustained he—boots it well or ill? 1410
I e not to sink beneath, is something still!

VII.

first day passed—he saw not her—Gulnare—
second, third—and still she came not there;
what her words avouched, her charms had done,
else he had not seen another Sun.
fourth day rolled along, and with the night
the storm and darkness in their mingling might.
how he listened to the rushing deep,
I t ne'er till now so broke upon his sleep;
I his wild Spirit wilder wishes sent, 1420
sed by the roar of his own element!

had he ridden on that wingéd wave,
loved its roughness for the speed it gave;
now its dashing echoed on his ear,
ng known voice—alas! too vainly near!
d sung the wind above; and, doubly loud,
ok o'er his turret cell the thunder-cloud;^[232]
flashed the lightning by the latticed bar,
im more genial than the Midnight Star:
se to the glimmering grate he dragged his chain, 1430
hoped *that* peril might not prove in vain.
ais'd his iron hand to Heaven, and prayed
pitying flash to mar the form it made:
steel and impious prayer attract alike—
storm rolled onward, and disdained to strike;
eal waxed fainter—ceased—he felt alone,
f some faithless friend had spurned his groan!

VIII.

midnight passed, and to the massy door
ght step came—it paused—it moved once more;
v turns the grating bolt and sullen key: 1440
as his heart foreboded—that fair She!
te'er her sins, to him a Guardian Saint,
beauteous still as hermit's hope can paint;
changed since last within that cell she came,
e pale her cheek, more tremulous her frame:
im she cast her dark and hurried eye,
ch spoke before her accents—"Thou must die!
thou must die—there is but one resource,
last—the worst—if torture were not worse."

ly! I look to none; my lips proclaim 1450
at last proclaimed they—Conrad still the same:
/ should'st thou seek an outlaw's life to spare,
. change the sentence I deserve to bear?
I have I earned—nor here alone—the meed
heyd's revenge, by many a lawless deed."

ly should I seek? because—Oh! did'st thou not
eem my life from worse than Slavery's lot?
/ should I seek?—hath Misery made thee blind
he fond workings of a woman's mind?
. must I say?—albeit my heart rebel 1460
n all that Woman feels, but should not tell—
ause—despite thy crimes—that heart is moved:
ared thee—thanked thee—pitied—maddened—loved.
ly not, tell not now thy tale again,
u lov'st another—and I love in vain:
ugh fond as mine her bosom, form more fair,
h through peril which she would not dare.
at thy heart to hers were truly dear,
e I thine own—thou wert not lonely here:
outlaw's spouse—and leave her Lord to roam! 1470
at hath such gentle dame to do with home?
speak not now—o'er thine and o'er my head
gs the keen sabre by a single thread;^[ib]
ou hast courage still, and would'st be free,
eive this poniard—rise and follow me!"

e—in my chains! my steps will gently tread,
n these adornments, o'er such slumbering head!
u hast forgot—is this a garb for flight?
s that instrument more fit for fight?"

sdoubting Corsair! I have gained the guard, 1480
e for revolt, and greedy for reward.
ngle word of mine removes that chain:
nout some aid how here could I remain?
l, since we met, hath sped my busy time,
aught evil, for thy sake the crime:
crime—'tis none to punish those of Seyd.
t hatred tyrant, Conrad—he must bleed!
e thee shudder, but my soul is changed—
nged—spurned—reviled—and it shall be avenged—
used of what till now my heart disdained— 1490
faithful, though to bitter bondage chained.
smile!—but he had little cause to sneer,
s not treacherous then, nor thou too dear:
he has said it—and the jealous well,—
se tyrants—teasing—tempting to rebel,—
erve the fate their fretting lips foretell.
ver loved—he bought me—somewhat high—
e with me came a heart he could not buy.
s a slave un murmuring; he hath said,
for his rescue I with thee had fled. 1500
as false thou know'st—but let such Augurs rue,
ir words are omens Insult renders true.
was thy respite granted to my prayer;
; fleeting grace was only to prepare
/ torments for thy life, and my despair.
e too he threatens; but his dotage still
ld fain reserve me for his lordly will:
en wearier of these fleeting charms and me,
re yawns the sack—and yonder rolls the sea!
at, am I then a toy for dotard's play, 1510
vear but till the gilding frets away?

✓ thee—loved thee—owe thee all—would save,
it to show how grateful is a slave.
had he not thus menaced fame and life,—
well he keeps his oaths pronounced in strife—
ll had saved thee—but the Pacha spared:
✓ I am all thine own—for all prepared:
u lov'st me not—nor know'st—or but the worst.
s! *this* love—*that* hatred—are the first—
could'st thou prove my truth, thou would'st not start, 1520
fear the fire that lights an Eastern heart;
now the beacon of thy safety—now
oints within the port a Mainote prow:
in one chamber, where our path must lead,
re sleeps—he must not wake—the oppressor Seyd!"

lnare—Gulnare—I never felt till now
abject fortune, withered fame so low:
d is mine enemy; had swept my band
n earth with ruthless but with open hand,
therefore came I, in my bark of war, 1530
mite the smiter with the scimitar;
n is my weapon—not the secret knife;
o spares a Woman's seeks not Slumber's life.
ie saved I gladly, Lady—not for this;
me not deem that mercy shown amiss.
✓ fare thee well—more peace be with thy breast!
it wears apace, my last of earthly rest!"^[ic]

st! rest! by sunrise must thy sinews shake,
thy limbs writhe around the ready stake,
ard the order—saw—I will not see— 1540
ou wilt perish, I will fall with thee.

life—my love—my hatred—all below
on this cast—Corsair! 'tis but a blow!
about it flight were idle—how evade
sure pursuit?—my wrongs too unrepaid,
youth disgraced—the long, long wasted years,
blow shall cancel with our future fears;
since the dagger suits thee less than brand,
try the firmness of a female hand.
guards are gained—one moment all were o'er— 1550
sair! we meet in safety or no more;
rs my feeble hand, the morning cloud
hover o'er thy scaffold, and my shroud."

IX.

turned, and vanished ere he could reply,
his glance followed far with eager eye;
gathering, as he could, the links that bound
form, to curl their length, and curb their sound,
the bar and bolt no more his steps preclude,
fast as fettered limbs allow, pursued.
as dark and winding, and he knew not where 1560
that passage led; nor lamp nor guard was there:
he sees a dusky glimmering—shall he seek
that sun that ray so indistinct and weak?
Nature guides his steps—a freshness seems to bear
on his brow as if from morning air;
he reached an open gallery—on his eye
beamed the last star of night, the clearing sky:
he scarcely heeded these—another light
in a lone chamber struck upon his sight.
hewards it he moved; a scarcely closing door 1570
revealed the ray within, but nothing more.
In a hasty step a figure outward passed,
he paused, and turned—and paused—'tis She at last!
No poniard in that hand, nor sign of ill—
thanks to that softening heart—she could not kill!"
When he looked, the wildness of her eye
came from the day abrupt and fearfully.
She stopped—threw back her dark far-floating hair,
that nearly veiled her face and bosom fair,
as if she late had bent her leaning head 1580
towards some object of her doubt or dread.
Why meet—upon her brow—unknown—forgot—
that hurrying hand had left—'twas but a spot—
that hue was all he saw, and scarce withstood—

slight but certain pledge of crime—'tis Blood!

X.

had seen battle—he had brooded lone
promised pangs to sentenced Guilt foreshown;
had been tempted—chastened—and the chain
on his arms might ever there remain:
ne'er from strife—captivity—remorse— 1590
n all his feelings in their inmost force—
hrilled, so shuddered every creeping vein,
ow they froze before that purple stain.
t spot of blood, that light but guilty streak,
banished all the beauty from her cheek!
od he had viewed—could view unmoved—but then
owed in combat, or was shed by men!^[id]

XI.

is done—he nearly waked—but it is done.
sair! he perished—thou art dearly won.
words would now be vain—away—away! 1600
bark is tossing—'tis already day.
few gained over, now are wholly mine,
these thy yet surviving band shall join:
n my voice shall vindicate my hand,
en once our sail forsakes this hated strand."

XII.

clapped her hands, and through the gallery pour,
ipped for flight, her vassals—Greek and Moor;
nt but quick they stoop, his chains unbind;

e more his limbs are free as mountain wind!
on his heavy heart such sadness sate, 1610
f they there transferred that iron weight.
words are uttered—at her sign, a door
eals the secret passage to the shore;
city lies behind—they speed, they reach
glad waves dancing on the yellow beach;
Conrad following, at her beck, obeyed,
cared he now if rescued or betrayed;
stance were as useless as if Seyd
lived to view the doom his ire decreed.

XIII.

arked—the sail unfurled—the light breeze blew— 1620
much had Conrad's memory to review!^[ie]
k he in contemplation, till the Cape
re last he anchored reared its giant shape.
—since that fatal night, though brief the time,
swept an age of terror, grief, and crime.
ts far shadow frowned above the mast,
veiled his face, and sorrowed as he passed;
hought of all—Gonsalvo and his band,
fleeting triumph and his failing hand;
hought on her afar, his lonely bride: 1630
urned and saw—Gulnare, the Homicide!

XIV.

watched his features till she could not bear
ir freezing aspect and averted air;
that strange fierceness foreign to her eye
quenched in tears, too late to shed or dry.^[if]

knelt beside him and his hand she pressed,
thou may'st forgive though Allah's self detest;
for that deed of darkness what wert thou?
reach me—but not yet—Oh! spare me *now!*
I not what I seem—this fearful night 1640
brain bewildered—do not madden quite!
had never loved—though less my guilt—
thou hadst not lived to—hate me—if thou wilt."

XV.

wrongs his thoughts—they more himself upbraid
in her—though undesigned—the wretch he made;
speechless all, deep, dark, and unexpressed,
yet bleed within that silent cell—his breast.
onward, fair the breeze, nor rough the surge,
blue waves sport around the stern they urge;
on the Horizon's verge appears a speck, 1650
not—a mast—a sail—an armed deck!
in little bark her men of watch descry,
the ample canvass woos the wind from high;
she bears her down majestically near,
armed on her prow, and terror in her tier,^{[fig][233]}
as she is seen—the ball beyond her bow
seems harmless, hissing to the deep below.
arose keen Conrad from his silent trance,
seeing, long absent gladness in his glance;
his mine—my blood-rag flag! again—again— 1660
I not all deserted on the main!"
they own the signal, answer to the hail,
they stave out the boat at once, and slacken sail.
his Conrad! Conrad!" shouting from the deck,

mand nor Duty could their transport check!
n light alacrity and gaze of Pride,
y view him mount once more his vessel's side;
nile relaxing in each rugged face,
ir arms can scarce forbear a rough embrace.
half forgetting danger and defeat, 1670
urns their greeting as a Chief may greet,
ngs with a cordial grasp Anselmo's hand,
feels he yet can conquer and command!

XVI.

se greetings o'er, the feelings that o'erflow,
grieve to win him back without a blow;
y sailed prepared for vengeance—had they known
oman's hand secured that deed her own,
were their Queen—less scrupulous are they
n haughty Conrad how they win their way.
n many an asking smile, and wondering stare, 1680
y whisper round, and gaze upon Gulnare;
her, at once above—beneath her sex,
om blood appalled not, their regards perplex. ^[ih]
Conrad turns her faint imploring eye,
drops her veil, and stands in silence by;
arms are meekly folded on that breast,
ch—Conrad safe—to Fate resigned the rest.
ugh worse than frenzy could that bosom fill,
eme in love or hate, in good or ill,
worst of crimes had left her Woman still! 1690

XVII.

; Conrad marked, and felt—ah! could he less?—

of that deed—but grief for her distress;
that she has done no tears can wash away,
Heaven must punish on its angry day:
—it was done: he knew, whate'er her guilt,
him that poniard smote, that blood was spilt;
he was free!—and she for him had given
all on earth, and more than all in heaven!^[234]
now he turned him to that dark-eyed slave
whose brow was bowed beneath the glance he gave, 1700
who now seemed changed and humbled, faint and meek,
varying oft the colour of her cheek
deeper shades of paleness—all its red
that fearful spot which stained it from the dead!
look that hand—it trembled—now too late—
lost in love—so wildly nerved in hate;
he clasped that hand—it trembled—and his own
lost its firmness, and his voice its tone.
Gulnare!"—but she replied not—"dear Gulnare!"^[ii]
she raised her eye—her only answer there— 1710
once she sought and sunk in his embrace:
he had driven her from that resting-place,
his heart had been more or less than mortal heart,
—good or ill—it bade her not depart.
chance, but for the bodings of his breast,
his latest virtue then had joined the rest.
even Medora might forgive the kiss^[ij]
that asked from form so fair no more than this,
first, the last that Frailty stole from Faith—
lips where Love had lavished all his breath, 1720
lips—whose broken sighs such fragrance fling,
he had fanned them freshly with his wing!^[ik]

XVIII.

y gain by twilight's hour their lonely isle.
hem the very rocks appear to smile;
haven hums with many a cheering sound,
beacons blaze their wonted stations round,
boats are darting o'er the curly bay,
sportive Dolphins bend them through the spray;
n the hoarse sea-bird's shrill, discordant shriek,
ets like the welcome of his tuneless beak! 1730
eath each lamp that through its lattice gleams,
ir fancy paints the friends that trim the beams.
what can sanctify the joys of home,
e Hope's gay glance from Ocean's troubled foam?^[1]

XIX.

lights are high on beacon and from bower,
'midst them Conrad seeks Medora's tower:
ooks in vain—'tis strange—and all remark,
d so many, hers alone is dark.
strange—of yore its welcome never failed,
now, perchance, extinguished—only veiled. 1740
n the first boat descends he for the shore,
looks impatient on the lingering oar.
for a wing beyond the falcon's flight,
ear him like an arrow to that height!
n the first pause the resting rowers gave,
waits not—looks not—leaps into the wave,
ves through the surge, bestrides the beach, and high
ends the path familiar to his eye.

eached his turret door—he paused—no sound

ke from within; and all was night around. 1750
knocked, and loudly—footstep nor reply
ounced that any heard or deemed him nigh:
knocked, but faintly—for his trembling hand
ised to aid his heavy heart's demand.
portal opens—'tis a well known face—
not the form he panted to embrace.
lips are silent—twice his own essayed,
failed to frame the question they delayed;
snatched the lamp—its light will answer all—
uits his grasp, expiring in the fall. 1760
ould not wait for that reviving ray—
oon could he have lingered there for day;
glimmering through the dusky corridor,
ther chequers o'er the shadowed floor;
steps the chamber gain—his eyes behold
that his heart believed not—yet foretold!

XX.

urned not—spoke not—sunk not—fixed his look,
set the anxious frame that lately shook:
gazed—how long we gaze despite of pain,
know, but dare not own, we gaze in vain! 1770
fe itself she was so still and fair,
t Death with gentler aspect withered there;
the cold flowers^[235] her colder hand contained,
at last grasp as tenderly were strained
f she scarcely felt, but feigned a sleep—
made it almost mockery yet to weep:
long dark lashes fringed her lids of snow,
veiled—Thought shrinks from all that lurked below—Oh!

the eye Death most exerts his might,^[236]
hurls the Spirit from her throne of light; 1780
as those blue orbs in that long last eclipse,
spares, as yet, the charm around her lips—
yet they seem as they forebore to smile,
wished repose,—but only for a while;
the white shroud, and each extended tress,
g, fair—but spread in utter lifelessness,
ch, late the sport of every summer wind,
aped the baffled wreath that strove to bind;^[im]
se—and the pale pure cheek, became the bier—
She is nothing—wherefore is he here? 1790

XXI.

asked no question—all were answered now
he first glance on that still, marble brow.^[in]
as enough—she died—what recked it how?
love of youth, the hope of better years,
source of softest wishes, tenderest fears,
only living thing he could not hate,
reft at once—and he deserved his fate,
did not feel it less;—the Good explore,
peace, those realms where Guilt can never soar:
proud, the wayward—who have fixed below 1800
ir joy, and find this earth enough for woe,
e in that one their all—perchance a mite—
who in patience parts with all delight?
many a stoic eye and aspect stern
k hearts where Grief hath little left to learn;
many a withering thought lies hid, not lost,
niles that least befit who wear them most.

XXII.

hose, that deepest feel, is ill exprest
indistinctness of the suffering breast;
ere thousand thoughts begin to end in one, 1810
ch seeks from all the refuge found in none;
words suffice the secret soul to show,
Truth denies all eloquence to Woe.
Conrad's stricken soul Exhaustion prest,
Stupor almost lulled it into rest;
eeble now—his mother's softness crept
hose wild eyes, which like an infant's wept:
as the very weakness of his brain,
ch thus confessed without relieving pain.
e saw his trickling tears—perchance, if seen, 1820
t useless flood of grief had never been:
long they flowed—he dried them to depart,
elpless—hopeless—brokenness of heart:
Sun goes forth, but Conrad's day is dim:
the night cometh—ne'er to pass from him.^[10]
re is no darkness like the cloud of mind,
Grief's vain eye—the blindest of the blind!
ch may not—dare not see—but turns aside
lackest shade—nor will endure a guide!

XXIII. ^[237]

heart was formed for softness—warped to wrong, 1830
ayed too early, and beguiled too long;
n feeling pure—as falls the dropping dew
in the grot—like that had hardened too;
s clear, perchance, its earthly trials passed,

sunk, and chilled, and petrified at last.^[238]
tempests wear, and lightning cleaves the rock;
rich his heart, so shattered it the shock.
There grew one flower beneath its rugged brow,
though dark the shade—it sheltered—saved till now.
When thunder came—that bolt hath blasted both, 1840
Granite's firmness, and the Lily's growth:
The gentle plant hath left no leaf to tell
The tale, but shrunk and withered where it fell;
The rock of its cold protector, blacken round
Shivered fragments on the barren ground!

XXIV.

The morn—to venture on his lonely hour
He dare; though now Anselmo sought his tower.
He was not there, nor seen along the shore;
At night, alarmed, their isle is traversed o'er:
The next morn—another bids them seek, 1850
He shout his name till Echo waxeth weak;
He went—grotto—cavern—valley searched in vain,
They find on shore a sea-boat's broken chain:
Their hope revives—they follow o'er the main.
He idle all—moons roll on moons away,
He Conrad comes not, came not since that day:
He trace nor tidings of his doom declare
Where lives his grief, or perished his despair!
He grieved mourned his band whom none could mourn beside;
He saw fair the monument they gave his Bride: 1860
He thought him they raise not the recording stone—
Death yet dubious, deeds too widely known;
He left a Corsair's name to other times,

ked with one virtue, and a thousand crimes.^[239]

FOOTNOTES:

^[194] {223} [This political allusion having been objected to by a friend, Byron composed a second dedication, which he sent to Moore, with a request that he would "take his choice." Moore chose the original dedication, which was accordingly prefixed to the First Edition. The alternative ran as follows:—

"January 7th, 1814.

MY DEAR MOORE,

I had written to you a long letter of dedication, which I suppress, because, though it contained something relating to you, which every one had been glad to hear, yet there was too much about politics and poesy, and all things whatsoever, ending with that topic on which most men are fluent, and none very amusing,—*one's self*. It might have been re-written; but to what purpose? My praise could add nothing to your well-earned and firmly established fame; and with my most hearty admiration of your talents, and delight in your conversation, you are already acquainted. In availing myself of your friendly permission to inscribe this poem to you, I can only wish the offering were as worthy your acceptance, as your regard is dear to

Yours, most affectionately and faithfully,

Byron."]

^[195] {224} [After the words, "Scott alone," Byron had inserted, in a parenthesis, "He will excuse the 'Mr.'—we do not say *Mr. Cæsar*."]

^[196] {225} ["It is difficult to say whether we are to receive this passage as an admission or a denial of the opinion to which it refers; but Lord Byron certainly did the public injustice, if he supposed it imputed to him the criminal actions with which many of his heroes were stained. Men no more expected to meet in Lord Byron the Corsair, who 'knew himself a villain,' than they looked for the hypocrisy of Kehama on the shores of the Derwent Water; yet even in the features of Conrad, those who had looked on Lord Byron will recognize the likeness—

""To the sight

No giant frame sets forth his common height;

Sun-burnt his cheek, his forehead high and pale
The sable curls in wild profusion veil...."

Canto I. stanza ix.

—Sir Walter Scott, *Quart. Rev.*, No. xxxi. October, 1816.]

[197] {227} The time in this poem may seem too short for the occurrences, but the whole of the Ægean isles are within a few hours' sail of the continent, and the reader must be kind enough to take the *wind* as I have often found it.

[198] [Compare—"Survey the region, and confess her home." *Windsor Forest*, by A. Pope, line 256.]

[hk] {228} *Protract to age his painful doting day.*—[MS. erased.]

[hl] {230} *Her nation—flag—how tells the telescope.*—[MS.]

[199] [Compare *The Isle of Palms*, by John Wilson, Canto I. (1812, p. 8)—

"She sailed amid the loveliness
Like a thing with heart and mind."]

[hm] {231} *Till creaks her keel upon the shallow sand.*—[MS.]

[hn] {234} *The haughtier thought his bosom ill conceals.*—[MS.]

[ho]

*He had the skill when prying souls would seek,
To watch his words and trace his pensive cheek.*—[MS.]
His was the skill when prying, etc.—[Revise.]

[200] {235} That Conrad is a character not altogether out of nature, I shall attempt to prove by some historical coincidences which I have met with since writing *The Corsair*.

"Eccelin, prisonnier," dit Rolandini, "s'enfermoit dans un silence menaçant; il fixoit sur la terre son visage féroce, et ne donnoit point d'essor à sa profonde indignation. De toutes parts cependant les soldats et les peuples accouroient; ils vouloient voir cet homme, jadis si puissant ... et la joie universelle éclatoit de toutes parts.... Eccelino étoit d'une petite taille; mais tout l'aspect de sa personne, tous ses mouvemens, indiquoient un soldat. Son langage étoit amer, son déportement superbe, et par son seul regard, il faisoit trembler les plus hardis."—Simonde de Sismondi, *Histoire des Républiques Italiennes du Moyen Age*, 1809, iii. 219.

Again, "Gizericus [Genseric, king of the Vandals, the conqueror of both Carthage and Rome] ... staturâ mediocris, et equi casu claudicans, animo profundus, sermone ratus, luxuriæ contemptor, irâ turbidus, habendi cupidus, ad sollicitandas gentes providentissimus," etc., etc.—Jornandes, *De Getarum Origine* ("De Rebus Geticis"), cap. 33, ed. 1597, p. 92.

I beg leave to quote those gloomy realities to keep in countenance my Giaour and Corsair.
—[Added to the Ninth Edition.]

[201] [Stanza x. was an after-thought. It is included in a sixth revise, in which lines 244-246 have been erased, and the present reading superscribed. A seventh revise gives the text as above.]

[hp] {236}

Released but to convulse or freeze or glow!
Fire in the veins, or damps upon the brow.—[MS.]

[hq]

Behold his soul once seen not soon forgot!
All that there burns its hour away—but sears
The scathed Remembrance of long coming years.—[MS.]

[202] {237} [Lines 277-280 are not in the MS. They were inserted on a detached printed sheet, with a view to publication in the Seventh Edition.]

[hr] {238} *Not Guilt itself could quench this earliest one.*—[MS. erased.]

[hs] {239}

Now to Francesca.—[MS.]
Now to Ginevra.—[Revise of January 6, 1814.]
Now to Medora.—[Revise of January 15, 1814.]

[ht] *Yet heed my prayer—my latest accents hear.*—[MS.]

[203] [Compare—

"He gave to Misery all he had, a tear,
He gained from Heaven ('twas all he wished) a friend."

Gray's *Elegy in a Country Churchyard*.]

[204] {243} [For Bireno's desertion of Olympia, see] *Orlando Funoso*, Canto X. [stanzas 1-27].

[hu] {244}

*Oh! he could bear no more—but madly grasped
Her form—and trembling there his own unclasped.*—[MS.]

[205] {247} By night, particularly in a warm latitude, every stroke of the oar, every motion of the boat or ship, is followed by a slight flash like sheet lightning from the water.

[206] {248} [Cape Gallo is at least eight miles to the south of Corone; but Point Lividia, the promontory on which part of the town is built, can hardly be described as a "jutting cape," or as (see line 1623) a "giant shape."]

[207] {249} [Coron, or Corone, the ancient Colonides, is situated a little to the north of a promontory, Point Lividia, on the western shore of the Gulf of Kalamata, or Coron, or Messenia.

Antoine Louis Castellan (1772-1838), with whose larger work on Turkey Byron professed himself familiar (Letter to Moore, August 28, 1813), gives a vivid description of Coron and the bey's palace in his *Lettres sur la Morée, etc.* (first published, Paris, 1808), 3 vols., 1820. Whether Byron had or had not consulted the "Letters," the following passages may help to illustrate the scene:—

"La chaîne caverneuse du Taygete s'élève en face de Coron, à l'autre extrémité du golfe" (iii. 181).

"Nous avons aussi été faire une visite au bey, qui nous a permis de parcourir la citadelle" (p. 187).

"Le bey fait a exécuter en notre présence une danse singulière, qu'on peut nommer danse pantomime" (p. 189; see line 642).

"La maison est assez bien distribuée et proprement meublée à la manière des Turcs. La principale pièce est grande, ornée d'une boiserie ciselée sur les dessins arabesques, et même marquetée. Les fenêtres donnent sur le jardin ... les volets sont ordinairement fermés, dans le milieu de la journée, et le jour ne pénètre alors qu'a travers des ouvertures pratiquées, au dessus des fenêtres et garnis de vitraux colorés" (p. 200).

Castellan saw the palace and bay illuminated (p. 203).]

[208] {250} Coffee.

[209] "Chibouque" [chibûk], pipe.

[210] {251} Dancing girls. [Compare *The Waltz*, line 127, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 492, note 1.]

[211] It has been observed, that Conrad's entering disguised as a spy is out of nature. Perhaps so. I find something not unlike it in history.—"Anxious to explore with his own eyes the state of the Vandals, Majorian ventured, after disguising the colour of his hair, to visit Carthage in the character of his own ambassador; and Genseric was afterwards mortified by the discovery, that he had entertained and dismissed the Emperor of the Romans. Such an anecdote may be rejected as an improbable fiction; but it is a fiction which would not have been imagined unless in the life of a hero."—See Gibbon's *Decline and Fall* [1854, iv. 272.]

[212] {252} [On the coast of Asia Minor, twenty-one miles south of Smyrna.]

[213] [A Levantine bark—"a kind of ketch without top-gallant sail, or mizzen-top sail."]

[214] {254} [Compare the *Giaour*, [line 343, note 2](#); *vide ante*, p. 102.]

[215] The Dervises [Dervish, Persian *darvesh*, poor] are in colleges, and of different orders, as the monks.

[216] {255} "Zatanai," Satan. [Probably a phonetic rendering of σατανά(ς). The Turkish form would be *sheytan*. Compare letter to Moore, April 9, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 66, note 1.]

[217] {256} A common and not very novel effect of Mussulman anger. See Prince Eugene's *Mémoires*, 1811, p. 6, "The Seraskier received a wound in the thigh; he plucked up his beard by the roots, because he was obliged to quit the field." ["Le séraskier est blessé a la cuisse; il s'arrache la barbe, parce qu'il est obligé de fuir." A contemporary translation (Sherwood, Neely, and Jones, 1811), renders "il s'arrache la barbe" *he tore out the arrow*.]

[218] {257} Gulnare, a female name; it means, literally, the flower of the pomegranate.

[219] {259} [The word "to" had been left out by the printer, and in a late revise Byron supplies the omission, and writes—

"To Mr. Murray or Mr. Davison.
Do not omit words—it is quite enough to alter or mis-spell them.
BN."

In the MS. the line ran—

"To send his soul—he scarcely cared to Heaven."

"Asked" is written over in pencil, but "cared" has not been erased.]

[220] {261} [Compare—"One *anarchy*, one *chaos* of the *mind*." *The Wanderer*, by Richard Savage, Canto V. (1761, p. 86).]

[221] {262} [Compare—"That hideous sight, a *naked* human heart." *Night Thoughts*, by Edward Young (Night III.) (Anderson's *British Poets*, x. 71).]

[222] {263} [Compare—

"When half the world lay wrapt in sleepless night,
A jarring sound the startled hero wakes.

He hears a step draw near—in beauty's pride
A female comes—wide floats her glistening gown—
Her hand sustains a lamp...."

Wieland's *Oberon*, translated by W. Sotheby, Canto XII. stanza xxxi., *et seq.*]

[223] {265} In Sir Thomas More, for instance, on the scaffold, and Anne Boleyn, in the Tower, when, grasping her neck, she remarked, that it "was too slender to trouble the headsman much." During one part of the French Revolution, it became a fashion to leave some "*mot*" as a legacy; and the quantity of facetious last words spoken during that period would form a melancholy jest-book of a considerable size.

[hv] {268}

*I breathe but in the hope—his altered breast
May seek another—and have mine at rest.
Or if unwonted fondness now I feign.[*]—[MS.]*

[*] [The alteration was sent to the publishers on a separate quarto sheet, with a memorandum, "In Canto *first*—nearly the end," etc.—a rare instance of inaccuracy on the part of the author.]

[224] {270} The opening lines, as far as section ii., have, perhaps, little business here, and were annexed to an unpublished (though printed) poem [*The Curse of Minerva*]; but they were written on the spot, in the Spring of 1811, and—I scarce know why—the reader must excuse their appearance here—if he can. [See letter to Murray, October 23, 1812.]

[225] [See *Curse of Minerva*, line 7, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 457. For Hydra, see A. L. Castellan's *Lettres sur la Morée*, 1820, i. 155-176. He gives (p. 174) a striking description of a *sunrise* off the Cape of Sunium.]

[226] {271} Socrates drank the hemlock a short time before sunset (the hour of execution), notwithstanding the entreaties of his disciples to wait till the sun went down.

[227] The twilight in Greece is much shorter than in our own country: the days in winter are longer, but in summer of shorter duration.

[228] {272} The Kiosk is a Turkish summer house: the palm is without the present walls of Athens, not far from the temple of Theseus, between which and the tree, the wall intervenes.—Cephisus' stream is indeed scanty, and Ilissus has no stream at all.

[E. Dodwell (*Classical Tour*, 1819, i. 371) speaks of "a magnificent palm tree, which shoots among the ruins of the Ptolemaion," a short distance to the east of the Theseion. There is an illustration in its honour. The Theseion—which was "within five minutes' walk" of Byron's lodgings (*Travels in Albania*, 1858, i. 259)—contains the remains of the scholar, John Tweddell, died 1793, "over which a stone was placed, owing to the exertions of Lord Byron" (Clarke's *Travels*, Part II. sect. i. p. 534). When Byron died, Colonel Stanhope proposed, and the chief Odysseus decreed, that he should be buried in the same spot.—*Life*, p. 640.]

[229] {273} [After the battle of Salamis, B.C. 480, Paros fell under the dominion of Athens.]

[hw] {274}

They gather round and each his aid supplies.—[MS.]

[hx] {275}

Within that cave Debate waxed warm and strange.—[MS.]

Loud in the cave Debate waxed warm and strange.—

[January 6, 1814.]

In that dark Council words waxed warm and strange.—

[January 13, 1814.]

[230] [Lines 1299-1375 were written after the completion of the poem. They were forwarded to the publisher in time for insertion in a revise dated January 6, 1814.]

[231] The comboloio, or Mahometan rosary; the beads are in number ninety-nine. [*Vide ante*, p. 181, *The Bride of Abydos*, Canto II. line 554.]

[hy] {276}

*Methinks a short release by ransom wrought
Of all his treasures not too cheaply bought.*—[MS. erased.]
Methinks a short release for ransom—gold.—[MS.]

[hz] {277}

Of thine adds certainty to all I heard.—[MS.]

[ia] {278}

When every coming hour might view him dead.—[MS.]

[232] ["By the way—I have a charge against you. As the great Mr. Dennis roared out on a similar occasion—'By G-d, *that is my thunder!*' so do I exclaim, '*This is my lightning!*' I allude to a speech of Ivan's, in the scene with Petrowna and the Empress, where the thought and almost expression are similar to Conrad's in the 3d canto of *The Corsair*. I, however, do not say this to accuse you, but to exempt myself from suspicion, as there is a priority of six months' publication, on my part, between the appearance of that composition and of your tragedies" (Letter to W. Sotheby, September 25, 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 219). The following are the lines in question:—

"And I have leapt
In transport from my flinty couch, to welcome
The thunder as it burst upon my roof,
And beckon'd to the lightning, as it flash'd
And sparkled on these fetters."

Act iv. sc. 3 (*Ivan*, 1816, p. 64).

According to Moore, this passage in *The Corsair*, as Byron seemed to fear, was included by "some scribblers"—i.e. the "lumbering Goth" (see John Bull's Letter), A. A. Watts, in the *Literary Gazette*, February and March, 1821—among his supposed plagiarisms. Sotheby informed Moore that his lines had been written, though not published, before the appearance of the *Corsair*. The *Confession*, and *Orestes*, reappeared with three hitherto

unpublished tragedies, *Ivan*, *The Death of Darnley*, and *Zamorin and Zama*, under the general title, *Five Unpublished Tragedies*, in 1814.

The story of the critic John Dennis (1657-1734) and the "thunder" is related in Cibber's *Lives*, iv. 234. Dennis was, or feigned to be, the inventor of a new method of producing stage-thunder, by troughs of wood and stops. Shortly after a play (*Appius and Virginia*) which he had put upon the stage had been withdrawn, he was present at a performance of *Macbeth*, at which the new "thunder" was inaugurated. "That is my thunder, by God!" exclaimed Dennis. "The villains will play my thunder, but not my plays."—*Dict. Nat. Biog.*, art. "Dennis."]

[ib] {282}

*But speak not now—on thine and on my head
O'erhangs the sabre——.*—[MS.]

[ic] {284}

Night wears apace—and I have need of rest.—[MS.]

[id] {286} A variant of lines 1596, 1597 first appeared in MS. in a revise numbering 1780 lines—

*Blood he had viewed, could view unmoved—but then
It reddened on the scarfs and swords of men.*

In a later revise line 1597 was altered to—

It flowed a token of the deeds of men.

[ie] {287} *His silent thoughts the present, past review.*—[MS. erased.]

[if] *Fell quenched in tears of more than misery.*—[MS.]

[ig] {288} *They count the Dragon-teeth around her tier.*—[MS.]

[233] ["Tier" must stand for "hold." The "cable-tier" is the place in the hold where the cable is stowed.]

[ih] {289} *Whom blood appalled not, their rude eyes perplex.*—[MS. erased.]

[234] [Compare—

"And I the cause—for whom were given
Her peace on earth, her hopes in heaven."

[ii] {290}

"Gulnare"—she answered not again—"Gulnare"
She raised her glance—her sole reply was there.—[M.S.]

[ij]

That sought from form so fair no more than this
That kiss—the first that Frailty wrung from Faith
That last—on lips so warm with rosy breath.—[MS. erased.]

[ik] As he had fanned them with his rosy wing.—[MS.]

[il] {291}

Oh! none so prophesy the joys of home
As they who hail it from the Ocean-foam.—[MS.]
Oh—what can sanctify the joys of home
Like the first glance from Ocean's troubled foam.—[Revise.]

[235] {292} In the Levant it is the custom to strew flowers on the bodies of the dead, and in the hands of young persons to place a nosegay.

[Compare—"There shut it inside the sweet cold hand." *Evelyn Hope*, by Robert Browning.]

[236] {293} [Compare—"And—but for that sad shrouded eye," etc. and the whole of the famous passage in the *Giaour* (line 68, sq., *vide ante*, [p. 88](#)), beginning—"He who hath bent him o'er the dead."]

[im] Escaped the idle braid that could not bind.—[MS.]

[in] By the first glance on that cold soulless brow.—[MS.]

[io] {294} And the night cometh—'tis the same to him.—[M.S.]

[237] [Stanza xxiii. is not in the MS. It was forwarded on a separate sheet, with the following directions:— (1814, January 10, 11.) "Let the following lines be sent immediately, and form the *last section* (number it) *but one* of the 3rd (last) Canto."]

[238] {295} [Byron had, perhaps, explored the famous stalactite cavern in the island of Anti-Paros, which is described by Tournefort, Clarke, Choiseul-Gouffier, and other travellers.]

[239] {296} That the point of honour which is represented in one instance of Conrad's character has not been carried beyond the bounds of probability, may perhaps be in some degree confirmed by the following anecdote of a brother buccaneer in the year 1814:—"Our readers have all seen the account of the enterprise against the pirates of Barataria; but few, we believe, were informed of the situation, history, or nature of that establishment. For the information of such as were unacquainted with it, we have procured from a friend the following interesting narrative of the main facts, of which he has personal knowledge, and which cannot fail to interest some of our readers:—Barataria is a bayou, or a narrow arm of the Gulf of Mexico; it runs through a rich but very flat country, until it reaches within a mile of the Mississippi river, fifteen miles below the city of New Orleans. This bayou has branches almost innumerable, in which persons can lie concealed from the severest scrutiny. It communicates with three lakes which lie on the south-west side, and these, with the lake of the same name, and which lies contiguous to the sea, where there is an island formed by the two arms of this lake and the sea. The east and west points of this island were fortified, in the year 1811, by a band of pirates, under the command of one Monsieur La Fitte. A large majority of these outlaws are of that class of the population of the state of Louisiana who fled from the island of St. Domingo during the troubles there, and took refuge in the island of Cuba; and when the last war between France and Spain commenced, they were compelled to leave that island with the short notice of a few days. Without ceremony they entered the United States, the most of them the state of Louisiana, with all the negroes they had possessed in Cuba. They were notified by the Governor of that State of the clause in the constitution which forbade the importation of slaves; but, at the same time, received the assurance of the Governor that he would obtain, if possible, the approbation of the General Government for their retaining this property.—The island of Barataria is situated about lat. 29 deg. 15 min., lon. 92. 30.; and is as remarkable for its health as for the superior scale and shell fish with which its waters abound. The chief of this horde, like Charles de Moor, had, mixed with his many vices, some transcendant virtues. In the year 1813, this party had, from its turpitude and boldness, claimed the attention of the Governor of Louisiana; and to break up the establishment he thought proper to strike at the head. He therefore, offered a reward of 500 dollars for the head of Monsieur La Fitte, who was well known to the inhabitants of the city of New Orleans, from his immediate connection, and his once having been a fencing-master in that city of great reputation, which art he learnt in Buonaparte's army, where he was a captain. The reward which was offered by the Governor for the head of La Fitte was answered by the offer of a reward from the latter of 15,000 for the head of the Governor. The Governor ordered out a company to march from the city to La Fitte's island, and to burn and destroy all the property, and to bring to the city of New Orleans all his banditti. This company, under the command of a man who had

been the intimate associate of this bold Captain, approached very near to the fortified island, before he saw a man, or heard a sound, until he heard a whistle, not unlike a boatswain's call. Then it was he found himself surrounded by armed men who had emerged from the secret avenues which led to this bayou. Here it was that this modern Charles de Moor developed his few noble traits; for to this man, who had come to destroy his life and all that was dear to him, he not only spared his life, but offered him that which would have made the honest soldier easy for the remainder of his days, which was indignantly refused. He then, with the approbation of his captor, returned to the city. This circumstance, and some concomitant events, proved that this band of pirates was not to be taken by land. Our naval force having always been small in that quarter, exertions for the destruction of this illicit establishment could not be expected from them until augmented; for an officer of the navy, with most of the gun-boats on that station, had to retreat from an overwhelming force of La Fitte's. So soon as the augmentation of the navy authorised an attack, one was made; the overthrow of this banditti has been the result: and now this almost invulnerable point and key to New Orleans is clear of an enemy, it is to be hoped the government will hold it by a strong military force."—American Newspaper.

[The story of the "Pirates of Barataria," which an American print, the *National Intelligencer*, was the first to make public, is quoted *in extenso* by the *Weekly Messenger* (published at Boston) of November 4, 1814. It is remarkable that a tale which was destined to pass into the domain of historical romance should have been instantly seized upon and turned to account by Byron, whilst it was as yet half-told, while the legend was still in the making. Jean Lafitte, the Franco-American Conrad, was born either at Bayonne or Bordeaux, circ. 1780, emigrated with his elder brother Pierre, and settled at New Orleans, in 1809, as a blacksmith. Legitimate trade was flat, but the delta of the Mississippi, with its labyrinth of creeks and islands and *bayous*, teemed with pirates or merchant-smugglers. Accordingly, under the nominal sanction of letters of marque from the Republic of Cartagena, and as belligerents of Spain, the brothers, who had taken up their quarters on Grande Terre, an island to the east of the "Grand Pass," or channel of the Bay of Barataria, swept the Gulph of Mexico with an organised flotilla of privateers, and acquired vast booty in the way of specie and living cargoes of slaves. Hence the proclamation of the Governor of Louisiana, W. C. C. Claiborne, in which (November 24, 1813) he offered a sum of \$500 for the capture of Jean Lafitte. For the sequel of this first act of the drama the "American newspaper" is the sole authority. The facts, however, if facts they be, which are pieced together by Charles Étienne Arthur Gayarré, in the *History of Louisiana* (1885, iv. 301, sq.), and in two articles contributed to the *American Magazine of History*, October and November, 1883, are as curious and romantic as the legend. It would appear that early in September, 1814, a British officer, Colonel E.

Nicholls, made overtures to Jean Lafitte, offering him the rank of captain in the British army, a grant of lands, and a sum of \$30,000 if he would join forces with the British squadron then engaged in an attack on the coast of Louisiana. Lafitte begged for time to consider Colonel Nicholls's proposal, but immediately put himself in communication with Claiborne, offering, on condition of immunity for past offences, to place his resources at the disposal of the United States. Claiborne's reply to this patriotic offer seems to have been to despatch a strong naval force, under Commander Daniel Patterson, with orders to exterminate the pirates, and seize their fort on Grande Terre; and, on this occasion, though the brothers escaped, the authorities were successful. A proclamation was issued by General Andrew Jackson, in which the pirates were denounced as "hellish banditti," and, to all appearances, their career was at an end. But circumstances were in their favour, and a few weeks later Jackson not only went back on his own mandate, but accepted the alliance and services of the brothers Lafitte and their captains at the siege of New Orleans, January 8, 1815. Finally, when peace with Great Britain was concluded, President Madison publicly acknowledged the "unequivocal traits of courage and fidelity" which had been displayed by the brothers Lafitte, and the once proscribed band of outlaws. Thenceforth Pierre Lafitte disappears from history; but Jean is believed to have settled first at Galveston, in Texas, and afterwards, in 1820, on the coast of Yucatan, whence "he continued his depredations on Spanish commerce." He died game, a pirate to the last, in 1826. See, for what purports to be documentary evidence of the correspondence between Colonel E. Nicholls and Jean Lafitte, *Historical Memoirs of the War in West Florida and Louisiana*, by Major A. La Carrière Latour, 1816, Appendix III. pp. vii.-xv. See, too, *Fernando de Lemos* (an historical novel), by Charles Gayarré, 1872, pp. 347-361.]

In [the Rev. Mark] Noble's continuation of "Granger's *Biographical History*" [*of England*, 1806, iii. 68], there is a singular passage in his account of Archbishop Blackbourne [1658-1743]; and as in some measure connected with the profession of the hero of the foregoing poem, I cannot resist the temptation of extracting it.—"There is something mysterious in the history and character of Dr. Blackbourne. The former is but imperfectly known; and report has even asserted he was a buccaneer; and that one of his brethren in that profession having asked, on his arrival in England, what had become of his old chum, Blackbourne, was answered, he is Archbishop of York. We are informed, that Blackbourne was installed sub-dean of Exeter in 1694, which office he resigned in 1702; but after his successor Lewis Barnett's death, in 1704, he regained it. In the following year he became dean; and in 1714 held with it the archdeanery [i.e. archdeaconry] of Cornwall. He was consecrated Bishop of Exeter, February 24, 1716; and translated to York, November 28, 1724, as a reward, according to court scandal, for uniting George I. to the Duchess of Munster. This, however, appears to have been an unfounded calumny. As archbishop he

behaved with great prudence, and was equally respectable as the guardian of the revenues of the see. Rumour whispered he retained the vices of his youth, and that a passion for the fair sex formed an item in the list of his weaknesses; but so far from being convicted by seventy witnesses, he does not appear to have been directly criminated by one. In short, I look upon these aspersions as the effects of mere malice. How is it possible a buccaneer should have been so good a scholar as Blackbourne certainly was? He who had so perfect a knowledge of the classics (particularly of the Greek tragedians), as to be able to read them with the same ease as he could Shakespeare, must have taken great pains to acquire the learned languages; and have had both leisure and good masters. But he was undoubtedly educated at Christ-church College, Oxford. He is allowed to have been a pleasant man; this, however, was turned against him, by its being said, 'he gained more hearts than souls.'"

[Walpole, in his *Memoirs of the Reign of King George II.*, 1847, i. 87, who makes himself the mouthpiece of these calumnies, says that Hayter, Bishop of Norwich, was "a natural son of Blackbourne, the jolly old Archbishop of York, who had all the manners of a man of quality, though he had been a Buccaneer, and was a clergyman; but he retained nothing of his first profession except his seraglio."]

"The only voice that could soothe the passions of the savage (Alphonso III.) was that of an amiable and virtuous wife, the sole object of his love; the voice of Donna Isabella, the daughter of the Duke of Savoy, and the grand-daughter of Philip II. King of Spain. Her dying words sunk deep into his memory [A.D. 1626, August 22]; his fierce spirit melted into tears; and, after the last embrace, Alphonso retired into his chamber to bewail his irreparable loss, and to meditate on the vanity of human life."—Gibbon's *Miscellaneous Works* [1837, p. 831].

[This final note was added to the Tenth Edition.]

ODE TO NAPOLEON BUONAPARTE. [\[240\]](#)

"Expende Annibalem:—quot libras in duce summo Invenies?"

JUVENAL, [Lib. iv.] *Sat.* x. line 147. [\[241\]](#)

"The Emperor Nepos was acknowledged by the *Senate*, by the *Italians*, and by the Provincials of *Gaul*; his moral virtues, and military talents, were loudly celebrated; and those who derived any private benefit from his government announced in prophetic strains the restoration of the public felicity. * * By this shameful abdication, he protracted his life about five years, in a very ambiguous state, between an Emperor and an Exile, till!!!"—Gibbon's *Decline and Fall*, two vols. notes by Milman, i. 979. [\[242\]](#)

INTRODUCTION TO THE *ODE TO* *NAPOLEON BUONAPARTE*.



THE dedication of the *Corsair*, dated January 2, 1814, contains one of Byron's periodical announcements that he is about, for a time, to have done with authorship—some years are to elapse before he will again "trespass on public patience."

Three months later he was, or believed himself to be, in the same mind. In a letter to Moore, dated April 9, 1814 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 64), he writes, "No more rhyme for—or rather, *from*—me. I have taken my leave of that stage, and henceforth will mountebank it no longer." He had already—*Journal*, April 8 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 408)—heard a rumour "that his poor little pagod, Napoleon" was "pushed off his pedestal," and before or after he began his letter to Moore he must have read an announcement in the *Gazette Extraordinary* (April 9, 1814—the abdication was signed April 11) that Napoleon had abdicated the "throne of the world," and declined upon the kingdom of Elba. On the next day, April 10, he wrote two notes to Murray, to inform him that he had written an "ode on the fall of Napoleon," that Murray could print it or not as he pleased; but that if it appeared by itself, it was to be published anonymously. A first edition consisting of fifteen stanzas, and numbering fourteen pages, was issued on the 16th of April, 1814. A second edition followed immediately, but as publications of

less than a sheet were liable to the stamp tax on newspapers, at Murray's request, another stanza, the fifth, was inserted in a later (between the second and the twelfth) edition, and, by this means, the pamphlet was extended to seventeen pages. The concluding stanzas xvii., xviii., xix., which Moore gives in a note (*Life*, p. 249), were not printed in Byron's lifetime, but were first included, in a separate poem, in Murray's edition of 1831, and first appended to the Ode in the seventeen-volume edition of 1832.

Although he had stipulated that the *Ode* should be published anonymously, Byron had no objection to "its being said to be mine." There was, in short, no secret about it, and notices on the whole favourable appeared in the *Morning Chronicle*, April 21, in the *Examiner*, April 24 (in which Leigh Hunt combated Byron's condemnation of Buonaparte for not "dying as honour dies"), and in the *Anti-Jacobin* for May, 1814 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 73, note 3).

Byron's repeated resolutions and promises to cease writing and publishing, which sound as if they were only made to be broken, are somewhat exasperating, and if, as he pleaded in his own behalf, the occasion (of Napoleon's abdication) was *physically* irresistible, it is to be regretted that he did not *swerve* from his self-denying ordinance to better purpose. The note of disillusionment and disappointment in the *Ode* is but an echo of the sentiments of the "general." Napoleon on his own "fall" is more original and more interesting: "Il céda," writes Léonard Gallois (*Histoire de Napoléon d'après lui-même*, 1825, pp. 546, 547), "non sans de grands combats intérieurs, et la dicta en ces termes.

'Les puissances alliées ayant proclamé que l'empereur Napoléon était le seul obstacle au rétablissement, de la paix en Europe, l'empereur Napoléon fidèle à son serment, déclare qu'il renonce, pour lui et ses héritiers, aux trônes de France

et d'Italie, parce qu'il n'est aucun sacrifice personnel, même celui de la vie, qu'il ne soit prêt à faire à l'intérêt de la France.

NAPOLÉON."

ODE TO NAPOLEON BUONAPARTE.

I.

done—but yesterday a King!
and armed with Kings to strive—
now thou art a nameless thing:
O abject—yet alive!
is the man of thousand thrones,
O strewed our earth with hostile bones,
and can he thus survive?^[243]
O he, miscalled the Morning Star,^[244]
man nor fiend hath fallen so far.

II.^[245]

Wounded man! why scourge thy kind
Who bowed so low the knee?
Gazing on thyself grown blind,
Thou taught'st the rest to see.
O might unquestioned,—power to save,—
The only gift hath been the grave
O those that worshipped thee;
till thy fall could mortals guess
O man's less than littleness!

III.

nks for that lesson—it will teach
o after-warriors more
n high Philosophy can preach,
nd vainly preached before.
t spell upon the minds of men^[246]
aks never to unite again,
hat led them to adore
se Pagod things of sabre-sway,
n fronts of brass, and feet of clay.

IV.

triumph, and the vanity,
he rapture of the strife—^[247]
earthquake-voice of Victory,
o thee the breath of life;
sword, the sceptre, and that sway
ch man seemed made but to obey,
/herewith renown was rife—
quelled!—Dark Spirit! what must be
madness of thy memory!

V.^[248]

Desolator desolate!^[249]
he Victor overthrown!
Arbiter of others' fate
. Suppliant for his own!
some yet imperial hope
t with such change can calmly cope?
r dread of death alone?
lie a Prince—or live a slave—
choice is most ignobly brave!

VI.

who of old would rend the oak,
reamed not of the rebound;^[250]
ined by the trunk he vainly broke—
lone—how looked he round?
u, in the sternness of thy strength,
equal deed hast done at length.
nd darker fate hast found:
ell, the forest prowlers' prey;
thou must eat thy heart away!

VII.

Roman,^[251] when his burning heart
was slaked with blood of Rome,
saw down the dagger—dared depart,
in savage grandeur, home.—
lared depart in utter scorn
men that such a yoke had borne,
yet left him such a doom!
only glory was that hour
elf-upheld abandoned power.

VIII.

Spaniard, when the lust of sway
had lost its quickening spell,^[252]
crowns for rosaries away,
an empire for a cell;
rict accountant of his beads,
btle disputant on creeds,
his dotage trifled well.^[253]

better had he neither known
got's shrine, nor despot's throne.

IX.

thou—from thy reluctant hand
he thunderbolt is wrung—
late thou leav'st the high command
o which thy weakness clung;
Evil Spirit as thou art,
enough to grieve the heart
o see thine own unstrung;
hink that God's fair world hath been
footstool of a thing so mean;

X.

. Earth hath spilt her blood for him,
/ho thus can hoard his own!
. Monarchs bowed the trembling limb,
nd thanked him for a throne!
Freedom! we may hold thee dear,
en thus thy mightiest foes their fear
i humblest guise have shown.
ne'er may tyrant leave behind
ighter name to lure mankind!

XI.

ie evil deeds are writ in gore,
or written thus in vain—
triumphs tell of fame no more,
r deepen every stain:
ou hadst died as Honour dies,

ie new Napoleon might arise,
o shame the world again—
who would soar the solar height,
et in such a starless night?^[ip]

XII.

gh'd in the balance, hero dust
vile as vulgar clay;^[iq]
scales, Mortality! are just
o all that pass away:
yet methought the living great
ie higher sparks should animate,
o dazzle and dismay:
deem'd Contempt could thus make mirth
hese, the Conquerors of the earth.

XIII.^[254]

she, proud Austria's mournful flower,
hy still imperial bride;
v bears her breast the torturing hour?
till clings she to thy side?
t she too bend, must she too share
late repentance, long despair,
hou throneless Homicide?
ill she loves thee, hoard that gem,—
worth thy vanished diadem!^[255]

XIV.

n haste thee to thy sullen Isle,
nd gaze upon the sea;^[ir]

that element may meet thy smile—
ne'er was ruled by thee!
race with thine all idle hand^[is]
biting mood upon the sand
that Earth is now as free!
that Corinth's pedagogue^[256] hath now
transferred his by-word to thy brow.

XV.

Oh Timour! in his captive's cage^{[257][it]}
What thoughts will there be thine,
while brooding in thy prisoned rage?
But one—"The world *was* mine!"
Oss, like he of Babylon,^[258]
Whose sense is with thy sceptre gone,^[259]
Whom life will not long confine
That spirit poured so widely forth—
Whom long obeyed—so little worth!

XVI.

Like the thief of fire from heaven,^[260]
Wilt thou withstand the shock?
Thou shalt share with him, the unforgiven,
The eagle and his rock!
Thou art doomed by God—by man accurst,^[iu]
Thou art that last act, though not thy worst,
The very Fiend's arch mock;^[261]
In his fall preserved his pride,
Or, if a mortal, had as proudly died!^{[iv][262]}

XVII.

re was a day—there was an hour,
hile earth was Gaul's—Gaul thine—^[iw]
en that immeasurable power
nsated to resign
been an act of purer fame
n gathers round Marengo's name
nd gilded thy decline,
ough the long twilight of all time,
pite some passing clouds of crime.

XVIII.

thou forsooth must be a King
nd don the purple vest,
f that foolish robe could wring
emembrance from thy breast.
re is that faded garment? where^[ix]
gewgaws thou wert fond to wear,
he star, the string, the crest?^{[iy][263]}
froward child of Empire! say,
all thy playthings snatched away?

XIX.

re may the wearied eye repose^[iz]
hen gazing on the Great;
re neither guilty glory glows,
or despicable state?
—One—the first—the last—the best—
Cincinnatus of the West,
Whom Envy dared not hate,

ueathed the name of Washington,
nake man blush there was but one!^{[ja][264]}

FOOTNOTES:

[240] {301}

[ODE TO NAPOLEON BUONAPARTE.

By

London: Printed for J. Murray, Albemarle Street, By W. Bulmer and Co. Cleveland-Row, St. James's, 1814.—*First Proof, title-page.*]

[241] [The quotation from Juvenal was added in Second Proof.

"Produce the urn that Hannibal contains,
And weigh the mighty dust which yet remains;
AND IS THIS ALL!"

"I know not that this was ever done in the old world; at least with regard to Hannibal: but in the statistical account of Scotland, I find that Sir John Paterson had the curiosity to collect and weigh the ashes of a person discovered a few years since in the parish of Eccles.... Wonderful to relate, he found the whole did not exceed in weight one ounce and a half! AND IS THIS ALL? Alas! the *quot libras* itself is a satirical exaggeration."—Gifford's *Translation of Juvenal* (ed. 1817), ii. 26, 27.

The motto, "Expende—Quot Libras In Duce Summo Invenies," was inscribed on one side of the silver urn presented by Byron to Walter Scott in April, 1815. (See *Letters*, 1899, iii. 414, Appendix IV.)]

[242] ["I send you ... an additional motto from Gibbon, which you will find *singularly appropriate*."—Letter to Murray, April 12, 1814, *ibid.*, p. 68.]

[243] {305} ["I don't know—but I think *I*, even *I* (an insect compared with this creature), have set my life on casts not a millionth part of this man's. But, after all, a crown may not be worth dying for. Yet, to outlive *Lodi* for this!!! Oh that Juvenal or Johnson could rise from the dead! 'Expende—quot libras in duce summo invenies?' I knew they were light in

the balance of mortality; but I thought their living dust weighed more *carats*. Alas! this imperial diamond hath a flaw in it, and is now hardly fit to stick in a glazier's pencil;—the pen of the historian won't rate it worth a ducat. Psha! 'something too much of this.' But I won't give him up even now; though all his admirers have, 'like the thanes, fallen from him.'"—*Journal*, April 9, 1814, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 409.]

[244] [Compare "How art thou fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son of the morning!"—*Isaiah* xiv. 12.]

[245] {306} [Stanzas ii. and iii. were added in Proof iv.]

[246] [A "spell" may be broken, but it is difficult to understand how, like the two halves of a seal or amulet, a broken spell can "unite again."]

[247] "*Certaminis gaudia*"—the expression of Attila in his harangue to his army, previous to the battle of Chalons, given in Cassiodorus. ["Nisi ad certaminis hujus gaudia præparasset."—*Attilæ Oratio ad Hunnos*, caput xxxix., *Appendix ad Opera Cassiodori*, Migne, lxix. 1279.]

[248] {307} [Added in Proof v.]

[249] [The first four lines of stanza v. were quoted by "Mr. Miller in the House of Representatives of the United States," in a debate on the Militia Draft Bill (*Weekly Messenger*, Boston, February 10, 1815). "Take warning," he went on to say, "by this example. Bonaparte split on this rock of conscription," etc. This would have pleased Byron, who confided to his *Journal*, December 3, 1813 (*Letters*, 1898, ii. 360), that the statement that "my rhymes are very popular in the United States," was "the first tidings that have ever sounded like *Fame* to my ears."]

[250] ["Like Milo, he would rend the oak; but it closed again, wedged his hands, and now the beasts—lion, bear, down to the dirtiest jackal—may all tear him."—*Journal*, April 8, 1814, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 408. For the story of Milo and the Oak, see Valerius Maximus, *Factorum, Dictorumque Memorabilium*, lib. ix. cap. xii. Part II. example 9.]

[251] {308} Sylla. [We find the germ of this stanza in the Diary of the evening before it was written: "I mark this day! Napoleon Buonaparte has abdicated the throne of the world. 'Excellent well.' Methinks Sylla did better; for he revenged, and resigned in the height of his sway, red with the slaughter of his foes—the finest instance of glorious contempt of the rascals upon record. Dioclesian did well too—Amurath not amiss, had he become aught except a dervise—Charles the Fifth but so so; but Napoleon worst of all."—*Journal*, April 9, 1814, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 409.]

[252] ["Alter '*potent* spell' to '*quicken*ing spell:' the first (as Polonius says) 'is a vile phrase,' and means nothing, besides being commonplace and Rosa-Matildaish."—Letter to Murray, April 11, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 68.]

[253] {309} [Charles V. resigned the kingdom to his son Philip, circ. October, 1555, and the imperial crown to his brother Ferdinand, August 27, 1556, and entered the Jeronymite Monastery of St. Justus at Placencia in Estremadura. Before his death (September 21, 1558) he dressed himself in his shroud, was laid in his coffin, "joined in the prayers which were offered up for the rest of his soul, mingling his tears with those which his attendants shed, as if they had been celebrating a real funeral."—Robertson's *Charles V.*, 1798, iv. 180, 205, 254.]

[ip] {310}

*But who would rise in brightest day
To set without one parting ray?*—[MS.]

[iq] ——*common clay*.—[First Proof.]

[254] [Added in Proof v.]

[255] {311} [Count Albert Adam de Neipperg, born 1774, an officer in the Austrian Army, and, 1811, Austrian envoy to the Court of Stockholm, was presented to Marie Louise a few days after Napoleon's abdication, became her chamberlain; and, according to the *Nouvelle Biographie Universelle*, "plus tard il l'épousa." The count, who is said to have been remarkably plain (he had lost an eye in a scrimmage with the French), died April 12, 1829.]

[ir]

*And look along the sea;
That element may meet thy smile,
For Albion kept it free.
But gaze not on the land for there
Walks crownless Power with temples bare
And shakes the head at thee
And Corinth's Pedagogue hath now.*—[Proof ii.]

[is]

*Or sit thee down upon the sand
And trace with thine all idle hand.*—
[A final correction made in Proof ii.]

[256] ["Dionysius at Corinth was yet a king to this."—*Diary*, April 9. Dionysius the Younger, on being for the second time banished from Syracuse, retired to Corinth (B.C. 344), where "he is said to have opened a school for teaching boys to read" (see Plut., *Timal.*, c. 14), but not, apparently, with a view to making a living by pedagogy.—Grote's *Hist. of Greece*, 1872, ix. 152.]

[257] {312} The cage of Bajazet, by order of Tamerlane.

[The story of the cage is said to be a fable. After the battle of Angora, July 20, 1402, Bajazet, whose escape from prison had been planned by one of his sons, was chained during the night, and placed in a kafes (*kâfess*), a Turkish word, which signifies either a cage or a grated room or bed. Hence the legend.—*Hist. de l'Empire Othoman*, par J. von Hammer-Purgstall, 1836, ii. 97.]

[it] *There Timour in his captive cage.*—[First Proof.]

[258] [Presumably another instance of "careless and negligent ease."]

[259] ["Have you heard that Bertrand has returned to Paris with the account of Napoleon's having lost his senses? It is a *report*; but, if true, I must, like Mr. Fitzgerald and Jeremiah (of lamentable memory), lay claim to prophecy."—Letter to Murray, June 14, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 95.]

[260] Prometheus.

[iu]

*He suffered for kind acts to men
Who have not seen his like again,
At least of kingly stock
Since he was good, and thou but great
Thou canst not quarrel with thy fate.*—[First Proof, stanza x.]

[261] {313}

"O! 'tis the spite of hell, the fiend's arch-mock,
To lip a wanton in a secure couch,
And to suppose her chaste!"

Othello, act iv. sc. 1, lines 69-71.

[We believe there is no doubt of the truth of the anecdote here alluded to—of Napoleon's having found leisure for an unworthy amour, the very evening of his arrival at Fontainebleau.—*Note to Edition* 1832.]

A consultation of numerous lives and memoirs of Napoleon has not revealed the particulars of this "unworthy amour." It is possible that Murray may have discovered the source of Byron's allusion among the papers "in the possession of one of Napoleon's generals, a friend of Miss Waldie," which were offered him "for purchase and publication," in 1815.—See *Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 279.]

[iv] *And—were he mortal had as proudly died,—*[Alteration in First Proof.]

[262] [Of Prometheus—

"Unlike the offence, though like would be the fate—
His to give life, but *thine* to desolate;
He stole from Heaven the flame for which he fell,
Whilst *thine* be stolen from thy native Hell."

—Attached to Proof v., April 25.]

[iw] *While earth was Gallia's, Gallia thine.*—[MS.]

[ix] {314} *Where is that tattered——.*—[MS.]

[iy] *——the laurel-circled crest.*—[MS.]

[263] [Byron had recently become possessed of a "fine print" (by Raphael Morghen, after Gérard) of Napoleon in his imperial robes, which (see *Journal*, March 6, 1814, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 393, note 2) became him "as if he had been hatched in them." According to the catalogue of Morghen's works, the engraving represents "the head nearly full-face, looking to the right, crowned with laurel. He wears an enormous velvet robe embroidered with bees—hanging over it the collar and jewel of the Legion of Honour." It was no doubt this "fine print" which suggested "the star, the string [i.e. the chain of enamelled eagles], the crest."]

[iz] *Where may the eye of man repose.*—[MS.]

[ja] *Alas! and must there be but one!*—[MS.]

[264] ["The two stanzas which I now send you were, by some mistake, omitted in the copies of Lord Byron's spirited and poetical 'Ode to Napoleon Buonaparte,' already published. One of 'the devils' in Mr. Davison's employ procured a copy of this for me, and I give you the chance of first discovering them to the world.

Your obedient servant,

J. R."

"Yes! better to have stood the storm,

A Monarch to the last!
Although that heartless fireless form
Had crumbled in the blast:
Than stoop to drag out Life's last years,
The nights of terror, days of tears
For all the splendour past;
Then,—after ages would have read
Thy awful death with more than dread.

"A lion in the conquering hour!
In wild defeat a hare!
Thy mind hath vanished with thy power,
For Danger brought despair.
The dreams of sceptres now depart,
And leave thy desolated heart
The Capitol of care!
Dark Corsican, 'tis strange to trace
Thy long deceit and last disgrace."

Morning Chronicle, April 27, 1814.]

LARA: A TALE.

INTRODUCTION TO *LARA*



THE MS. of *Lara* is dated May 14, 1814. The opening lines, which were not prefixed to the published poem, and were first printed in *Murray's Magazine* (January, 1887), are of the nature of a Dedication. They were probably written a few days after the well-known song, "I speak not, I trace not, I breathe not thy name," which was enclosed to Moore in a letter dated May 4, 1814. There can be little doubt that both song and dedication were addressed to Lady Frances Wedderburn Webster, and that *Lara*, like the *Corsair* and the *Bride of Abydos*, was written *con amore*, and because the poet was "eating his heart away."

By the 14th of June Byron was able to announce to Moore that "*Lara* was finished, and that he had begun copying." It was written, owing to the length of the London season, "amidst balls and fooleries, and after coming home from masquerades and routs, in the summer of the sovereigns" (Letter to Moore, June 8, 1822, *Life*, p. 561).

By way of keeping his engagement—already broken by the publication of the *Ode to Napoleon Buonaparte*—not to "trespass on public patience," Byron began by protesting (June 14) that *Lara* was not to be published separately, but "might be included in a third volume now collecting." A fortnight later (June 27) an interchange of unpublished poems between himself and Rogers, "two cantos of darkness and dismay" in return for a

privately printed copy of *Jacqueline*, who is "all grace and softness and poetry" (Letter to Rogers, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 101), suggested another and happier solution of the difficulty, a coalescing with Rogers, and, if possible, Moore (*Life*, 1892, p. 257, note 2), "into a joint invasion of the public" (Letter to Moore, July 8, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 102). But Rogers hesitated, and Moore refused to embark on so doubtful a venture, with the result that, as late as the 3rd of August, Byron thought fit to remonstrate with Murray for "advertising *Lara and Jacqueline*," and confessed to Moore that he was "still demurring and delaying and in a fuss" (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 115, 119). Murray knew his man, and, though he waited for Byron's formal and ostensibly reluctant word of command, "Out with *Lara*, since it must be" (August 5, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 122), he admitted (August 6, *Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 230) that he had "anticipated his consent," and "had done everything but actually deliver the copies of *Lara*." "The moment," he adds, "I received your letter, for for it I waited, I cut the last cord of my aerial work, and at this instant 6000 copies are sold." *Lara, a Tale; Jacqueline, a Tale*, was published on Saturday, August 6, 1814.

Jacqueline is a somewhat insipid pastoral, betraying the influence of the Lake School, more especially Coleridge, on a belated and irresponsible disciple, and wholly out of place as contrast or foil to the melodramatic *Lara*.

No sooner had the "lady," as Byron was pleased to call her, played her part as decoy, than she was discharged as *emerita*. A week after publication (August 12, 1814, *Letters*, iii. 125) Byron told Moore that "Murray talks of divorcing Larry and Jacky—a bad sign for the authors, who will, I suppose, be divorced too.... Seriously, I don't care a cigar about it." The divorce was

soon pronounced, and, contrary to Byron's advice (September 2, 1814, *Letters*, iii. 131), at least four separate editions of *Lara* were published during the autumn of 1814.

The "advertisement" to *Lara and Jacqueline* contains the plain statement that "the reader ... may probably regard it [*Lara*] as a sequel to the *Corsair*"—an admission on the author's part which forestalls and renders nugatory any prolonged discussion on the subject. It is evident that *Lara* is Conrad, and that Kaled, the "darkly delicate" and mysterious page, whose "hand is femininely white," is Gulnare in a transparent and temporary disguise.

If the facts which the "English Gentleman in the Greek Military Service" (*Life, Writings, etc., of Lord Byron*, 1825, i. 191-201) gives in detail with regard to the sources of the *Corsair* are not wholly imaginary, it is possible that the original Conrad's determination to "quit so horrible a mode of life" and return to civilization may have suggested to Byron the possible adventures and fate of a *grand seigneur* who had played the pirate in his time, and resumed his ancestral dignities only to be detected and exposed by some rival or victim of his wild and lawless youth.

Lara was reviewed together with the *Corsair*, by George Agar Ellis in the *Quarterly Review* for July, 1814, vol. xi. p. 428; and in the *Portfolio*, vol. xiv. p. 33.

LARA.^[jb]

CANTO THE FIRST.^[265]

I.

Serfs^[266] are glad through Lara's wide domain,^[267]
Slavery half forgets her feudal chain;
their unhop'd, but unforgotten lord,
long self-exil'd Chieftain, is restored:
re be bright faces in the busy hall,
r/s on the board, and banners on the wall;
checkering o'er the pictured window, plays
unwonted faggot's hospitable blaze;
gay retainers gather round the hearth,
1 tongues all loudness, and with eyes all mirth. 10

II.

Chief of Lara is returned again:
why had Lara crossed the bounding main?
by his Sire, too young such loss to know,^[268]
l of himself,—that heritage of woe,
t fearful empire which the human breast

holds to rob the heart within of rest!—
none to check, and few to point in time
thousand paths that slope the way to crime;
n, when he most required commandment, then
Lara's daring boyhood governed men.^[jc] 20
ills not, boots not step by step to trace
youth through all the mazes of its race;
rt was the course his restlessness had run,^[jd]
long enough to leave him half undone.

III.

Lara left in youth his father-land;
from the hour he waved his parting hand
a trace waxed fainter of his course, till all
nearly ceased his memory to recall.
sire was dust, his vassals could declare,
as all they knew, that Lara was not there; 30
sent, nor came he, till conjecture grew
l in the many, anxious in the few.
hall scarce echoes with his wonted name,
portrait darkens in its fading frame,
ther chief consoled his destined bride,^[je]
young forgot him, and the old had died;^[jf]
doth he live!" exclaims the impatient heir,
sighs for sables which he must not wear.^[jg]
hundred scutcheons deck with gloomy grace
Laras' last and longest dwelling-place; 40
one is absent from the mouldering file,
t now were welcome in that Gothic pile.^[jh]

IV.

comes at last in sudden loneliness,
whence they know not, why they need not guess;
y more might marvel, when the greeting's o'er
that he came, but came not long before:
rain is his beyond a single page,
oreign aspect, and of tender age.
s had rolled on, and fast they speed away
hose that wander as to those that stay; 50
lack of tidings from another clime
lent a flagging wing to weary Time.
y see, they recognise, yet almost deem
present dubious, or the past a dream.

ives, nor yet is past his Manhood's prime,
ugh seared by toil, and something touched by Time;
faults, whate'er they were, if scarce forgot,
ht be untaught him by his varied lot;
good nor ill of late were known, his name
ht yet uphold his patrimonial fame: 60
soul in youth was haughty, but his sins^[269]
nore than pleasure from the stripling wins;
such, if not yet hardened in their course,
ht be redeemed, nor ask a long remorse.

V.

they indeed were changed—'tis quickly seen,
ate'er he be, 'twas not what he had been:
t brow in furrowed lines had fixed at last,
spake of passions, but of passion past:
pride, but not the fire, of early days,
lness of mien, and carelessness of praise; 70

gh demeanour, and a glance that took
ir thoughts from others by a single look;
that sarcastic levity of tongue,
stinging of a heart the world hath stung,
t darts in seeming playfulness around,
makes those feel that will not own the wound;
these seemed his, and something more beneath
n glance could well reveal, or accent breathe.
dition, Glory, Love, the common aim,
t some can conquer, and that all would claim, 80
in his breast appeared no more to strive,
seemed as lately they had been alive;
some deep feeling it were vain to trace
moments lightened o'er his livid face.

VI.

much he loved long question of the past,
told of wondrous wilds, and deserts vast,
those far lands where he had wandered lone,
—as himself would have it seem—unknown:
these in vain his eye could scarcely scan,
glean experience from his fellow man; 90
what he had beheld he shunned to show,
hardly worth a stranger's care to know;
ill more prying such inquiry grew,
brow fell darker, and his words more few.

VII.

unrejoiced to see him once again,
m was his welcome to the haunts of men;
n of high lineage, linked in high command,

mingled with the Magnates of his land;
ed the carousals of the great and gay,
saw them smile or sigh their hours away; 100
still he only saw, and did not share,
common pleasure or the general care;
did not follow what they all pursued
n hope still baffled still to be renewed;
shadowy Honour, nor substantial Gain,
Beauty's preference, and the rival's pain:
und him some mysterious circle thrown
elled approach, and showed him still alone;
n his eye sat something of reproof,
t kept at least Frivolity aloof; 110
things more timid that beheld him near
lence gazed, or whispered mutual fear;
they the wiser, friendlier few confessed
y deemed him better than his air expressed.

VIII.

s strange—in youth all action and all life,
ning for pleasure, not averse from strife;
nan—the Field—the Ocean, all that gave
nise of gladness, peril of a grave,
rn he tried—he ransacked all below,
found his recompense in joy or woe, 120
ame, trite medium; for his feelings sought
at intenseness an escape from thought:^[j]
Tempest of his Heart in scorn had gazed
hat the feeblér Elements hath raised;
Rapture of his Heart had looked on high,
asked if greater dwelt beyond the sky:

ined to excess, the slave of each extreme,
/ woke he from the wildness of that dream!
s! he told not—but he did awake
urse the withered heart that would not break. 130

IX.

ks, for his volume heretofore was Man,
n eye more curious he appeared to scan,
oft in sudden mood, for many a day,
n all communion he would start away:
then, his rarely called attendants said,
ough night's long hours would sound his hurried tread
the dark gallery, where his fathers frowned
ide but antique portraiture around:
y heard, but whispered—"that must not be known—
sound of words less earthly than his own."^[jj] 140
they who chose might smile, but some had seen
y scarce knew what, but more than should have been.
/ gazed he so upon the ghastly head^[270]
ch hands profane had gathered from the dead,
t still beside his opened volume lay,
f to startle all save him away?
/ slept he not when others were at rest?
/ heard no music, and received no guest?
was not well, they deemed—but where the wrong?^[271]
ie knew perchance—but 'twere a tale too long; 150
such besides were too discreetly wise,
nore than hint their knowledge in surmise;
if they would—they could"—around the board
s Lara's vassals prattled of their lord.

X.

as the night—and Lara's glassy stream
 stars are studding, each with imaged beam;
 calm, the waters scarcely seem to stray,
 yet they glide like Happiness away;^[272]
 reflecting far and fairy-like from high
 immortal lights that live along the sky: 160
 banks are fringed with many a goodly tree,
 flowers the fairest that may feast the bee;
 in her chaplet infant Dian wove,
 Innocence would offer to her love.
 These deck the shore; the waves their channel make
 windings bright and mazy like the snake.
 The sea was so still, so soft in earth and air,
 scarce would start to meet a spirit there;
 were that nought of evil could delight
 to walk in such a scene, on such a night! 170
 as a moment only for the good:
 Lara deemed, nor longer there he stood,
 turned in silence to his castle-gate;
 in scene his soul no more could contemplate:
 in scene reminded him of other days,
 skies more cloudless, moons of purer blaze,
 nights more soft and frequent, hearts that now—
 —no—the storm may beat upon his brow,
 felt, unsparing—but a night like this,
 light of Beauty, mocked such breast as his. 180

XI.

turned within his solitary hall,
 his high shadow shot along the wall:

re were the painted forms of other times,^[273]
as all they left of virtues or of crimes,
e vague tradition; and the gloomy vaults
t hid their dust, their foibles, and their faults;
. half a column of the pompous page,
t speeds the specious tale from age to age;
ere History's pen its praise or blame supplies,
. lies like Truth, and still most truly lies. 190
andering mused, and as the moonbeam shone
ough the dim lattice, o'er the floor of stone,
. the high fretted roof, and saints, that there
Gothic windows knelt in pictured prayer,^[jk]
ected in fantastic figures grew,
e life, but not like mortal life, to view;
bristling locks of sable, brow of gloom,
. the wide waving of his shaken plume,
nced like a spectre's attributes—and gave
aspect all that terror gives the grave.^[jl] 200

XII.

as midnight—all was slumber; the lone light
med in the lamp, as both to break the night.
κ! there be murmurs heard in Lara's hall—
und—a voice—a shriek—a fearful call!
ng, loud shriek—and silence—did they hear
t frantic echo burst the sleeping ear?
y heard and rose, and, tremulously brave,
h where the sound invoked their aid to save;
y come with half-lit tapers in their hands,
. snatched in startled haste unbelted brands. 210

XIII.

l as the marble where his length was laid,
as the beam that o'er his features played,
Lara stretched; his half-drawn sabre near,
pped it should seem in more than Nature's fear;
he was firm, or had been firm till now,
still Defiance knit his gathered brow;
ugh mixed with terror, senseless as he lay,
re lived upon his lip the wish to slay;
ie half formed threat in utterance there had died,
ie imprecation of despairing Pride; 220
eye was almost sealed, but not forsook,
n in its trance, the gladiator's look,
t oft awake his aspect could disclose,
now was fixed in horrible repose.
y raise him—bear him;—hush! he breathes, he speaks,
swarthy blush recolours in his cheeks,
lip resumes its red, his eye, though dim,
s wide and wild, each slowly quivering limb
alls its function, but his words are strung
rms that seem not of his native tongue; 230
inct but strange, enough they understand
leem them accents of another land;
such they were, and meant to meet an ear
t hears him not—alas! that cannot hear!

XIV.

page approached, and he alone appeared
now the import of the words they heard;
, by the changes of his cheek and brow,
y were not such as Lara should avow,

he interpret,—yet with less surprise
n those around their Chieftain's state he eyes, 240
Lara's prostrate form he bent beside,
in that tongue which seemed his own replied;
Lara heeds those tones that gently seem
oothe away the horrors of his dream—
eam it were, that thus could overthrow
east that needed not ideal woe.

XV.

ate'er his frenzy dreamed or eye beheld,—
t remembered ne'er to be revealed,—
s at his heart: the custom'd morning came,
breathed new vigour in his shaken frame; 250
solace sought he none from priest nor leech,
soon the same in movement and in speech,
eretofore he filled the passing hours,
less he smiles, nor more his forehead lowers,
n these were wont; and if the coming night
eared less welcome now to Lara's sight,
o his marvelling vassals showed it not,
ose shuddering proved *their* fear was less forgot.
embling pairs (alone they dared not) crawl^[jm]
astonished slaves, and shun the fated hall; 260
waving banner, and the clapping door,
rustling tapestry, and the echoing floor;
long dim shadows of surrounding trees,
flapping bat, the night song of the breeze;
ht they behold or hear their thought appals,
evening saddens o'er the dark grey walls.

XVI.

that thought! that hour of ne'er unravelled gloom
ne not again, or Lara could assume
seeming of forgetfulness, that made
vassals more amazed nor less afraid. 270

Memory vanished then with sense restored?
The word, nor look, nor gesture of their lord
expressed a feeling that recalled to these
that fevered moment of his mind's disease.

Was it a dream? was his the voice that spoke
these strange wild accents; his the cry that broke
his slumber? his the oppressed, o'erlaboured heart
that ceased to beat, the look that made them start?
Would he who thus had suffered so forget,
when such as saw that suffering shudder yet? 280
Would that silence prove his memory fixed
deep for words, indelible, unmixed
with that corroding secrecy which gnaws
the heart to show the effect, but not the cause?
So in him; his breast had buried both,
common gazers could discern the growth
of thoughts that mortal lips must leave half told;
they choke the feeble words that would unfold.

XVII.

His inexplicably mixed appeared
wished to be loved and hated, sought and feared; 290
his vision varying o'er his hidden lot,^[jn]
neither praise nor railing ne'er his name forgot:
silence formed a theme for others' prate—
they guessed—they gazed—they fain would know his fate.
What had he been? what was he, thus unknown,

o walked their world, his lineage only known?
ter of his kind? yet some would say,
n them he could seem gay amidst the gay;^[10]
owned that smile, if oft observed and near,
ied in its mirth, and withered to a sneer; 300
t smile might reach his lip, but passed not by,
e'er could trace its laughter to his eye:
there was softness too in his regard,
imes, a heart as not by nature hard,
once perceived, his Spirit seemed to chide
n weakness, as unworthy of its pride,
steemed itself, as scorning to redeem
doubt from others' half withheld esteem;
elf-inflicted penance of a breast
ch Tenderness might once have wrung from Rest; 310
igilance of Grief that would compel
soul to hate for having loved too well.^[274]

XVIII.

re was in him a vital scorn of all:^[11]
f the worst had fallen which could befall,
stood a stranger in this breathing world,
erring Spirit from another hurled;
ing of dark imaginings, that shaped
hoice the perils he by chance escaped;
'scaped in vain, for in their memory yet
mind would half exult and half regret: 320
n more capacity for love than Earth
ows on most of mortal mould and birth.
early dreams of good outstripped the truth,^[275]
troubled Manhood followed baffled Youth;

1 thought of years in phantom chase misspent,
wasted powers for better purpose lent;
fiery passions that had poured their wrath
hurried desolation o'er his path,
left the better feelings all at strife^[jq]
wild reflection o'er his stormy life; 330
haughty still, and loth himself to blame,
called on Nature's self to share the shame,
charged all faults upon the fleshly form
gave to clog the soul, and feast the worm:
he at last confounded good and ill,
half mistook for fate the acts of will:^{[jr][276]}
high for common selfishness, he could
times resign his own for others' good,
not in pity—not because he ought,
in some strange perversity of thought, 340
that swayed him onward with a secret pride
to what few or none would do beside;
this same impulse would, in tempting time,
lead his spirit equally to crime;
much he soared beyond, or sunk beneath,
men with whom he felt condemned to breathe,
longed by good or ill to separate
himself from all who shared his mortal state;
mind abhorring this had fixed her throne
from the world, in regions of her own: 350
so coldly passing all that passed below,
blood in temperate seeming now would flow:
happier if it ne'er with guilt had glowed,
ever in that icy smoothness flowed!
true, with other men their path he walked,

. like the rest in seeming did and talked,
outraged Reason's rules by flaw nor start,
Madness was not of the head, but heart;
. rarely wandered in his speech, or drew
thoughts so forth as to offend the view. 360

XIX.

. all that chilling mystery of mien,
. seeming gladness to remain unseen,
had (if 'twere not nature's boon) an art
fixing memory on another's heart:
as not love perchance—nor hate—nor aught
t words can image to express the thought;
they who saw him did not see in vain,
. once beheld—would ask of him again:
. those to whom he spake remembered well,
. on the words, however light, would dwell: 370
e knew, nor how, nor why, but he entwined
self perforce around the hearer's mind;^[js]
re he was stamped, in liking, or in hate,
reeted once; however brief the date
t friendship, pity, or aversion knew,^[jt]
there within the inmost thought he grew.
could not penetrate his soul, but found,
pite your wonder, to your own he wound;
presence haunted still; and from the breast^[ju]
forced an all unwilling interest: 380
i was the struggle in that mental net—
Spirit seemed to dare you to forget!

XX.

re is a festival, where knights and dames,
ought that wealth or lofty lineage claims,
ear—a high-born and a welcome guest
tho's hall came Lara with the rest.
long carousal shakes the illumined hall,
l speeds alike the banquet and the ball;
the gay dance of bounding Beauty's train
s grace and harmony in happiest chain: 390
t are the early hearts and gentle hands
t mingle there in well according bands;
a sight the careful brow might smooth,
make Age smile, and dream itself to youth,
Youth forget such hour was past on earth,
prings the exulting bosom to that mirth!^[iv]

XXI.

. Lara gazed on these, sedately glad,
brow belied him if his soul was sad;
his glance followed fast each fluttering fair,
se steps of lightness woke no echo there: 400
eaned against the lofty pillar nigh,
n folded arms and long attentive eye,
marked a glance so sternly fixed on his—
rooked high Lara scrutiny like this:
ength he caught it—'tis a face unknown,
seems as searching his, and his alone;
ng and dark, a stranger's by his mien,
o still till now had gazed on him unseen:
ength encountering meets the mutual gaze
een enquiry, and of mute amaze; 410
Lara's glance emotion gathering grew,

f distrusting that the stranger threw;
ng the stranger's aspect, fixed and stern,
hed more than thence the vulgar eye could learn.

XXII.

; he!" the stranger cried, and those that heard
echoed fast and far the whispered word.
; he!"—"Tis who?" they question far and near,
louder accents rung on Lara's ear;
videly spread, few bosoms well could brook
general marvel, or that single look: 420
Lara stirred not, changed not, the surprise
t sprung at first to his arrested eyes
ned now subsided—neither sunk nor raised
nced his eye round, though still the stranger gazed;
drawing nigh, exclaimed, with haughty sneer,
; he!—how came he thence?—what doth he here?"

XXIII.

ere too much for Lara to pass by
n questions, so repeated fierce and high;^[jw]
n look collected, but with accent cold,
e mildly firm than petulantly bold, 430
urned, and met the inquisitorial tone—
r name is Lara—when thine own is known,
bt not my fitting answer to requite
unlooked for courtesy of such a knight.
Lara!—further wouldst thou mark or ask?
in no question, and I wear no mask."

ou *shunn'st* no question! Ponder—is there none

heart must answer, though thine ear would shun?
deem'st thou me unknown too? Gaze again!
eas'thy memory was not given in vain. 440
never canst thou cancel half her debt—
nity forbids thee to forget."
n slow and searching glance upon his face
w Lara's eyes, but nothing there could trace
y knew, or chose to know—with dubious look
leigned no answer, but his head he shook,
half contemptuous turned to pass away;
the stern stranger motioned him to stay.

word!—I charge thee stay, and answer here
me, who, wert thou noble, were thy peer, 450
as thou wast and art—nay, frown not, Lord,
lse, 'tis easy to disprove the word—
as thou wast and art, on thee looks down,
rusts thy smiles, but shakes not at thy frown.
thou not he? whose deeds——"[\[jx\]](#)

"Whate'er I be,
ds wild as these, accusers like to thee,
t no further; those with whom they weigh
r hear the rest, nor venture to gainsay
wondrous tale no doubt thy tongue can tell,
ch thus begins so courteously and well. 460
Otho cherish here his polished guest,
im my thanks and thoughts shall be expressed."
here their wondering host hath interposed—
ate'er there be between you undisclosed,
is no time nor fitting place to mar
mirthful meeting with a wordy war.
ou, Sir Ezzelin, hast aught to show

ch it befits Count Lara's ear to know,
narrow, here, or elsewhere, as may best
æem your mutual judgment, speak the rest; 470
udge myself for thee, as not unknown,
ugh, like Count Lara, now returned alone
n other lands, almost a stranger grown;
if from Lara's blood and gentle birth
gur right of courage and of worth,
will not that untainted line belie,
aught that Knighthood may accord, deny."

·morrow be it," Ezzelin replied,
d here our several worth and truth be tried;
ge my life, my falchion to attest 480
words, so may I mingle with the blest!"
at answers Lara? to its centre shrunk
soul, in deep abstraction sudden sunk;
words of many, and the eyes of all
t there were gathered, seemed on him to fall;
his were silent, his appeared to stray
ir forgetfulness away—away—
s! that heedlessness of all around
poke remembrance only too profound.

XXIV.

·morrow!—aye, to-morrow!" further word^[jyl] 490
n those repeated none from Lara heard;
n his brow no outward passion spoke;
n his large eye no flashing anger broke;
there was something fixed in that low tone,
ch showed resolve, determined, though unknown.

seized his cloak—his head he slightly bowed,
passing Ezzelin, he left the crowd;
as he passed him, smiling met the frown
in which that Chieftain's brow would bear him down:
as nor smile of mirth, nor struggling pride 500
t curbs to scorn the wrath it cannot hide;
that of one in his own heart secure
all that he would do, or could endure.
Would this mean peace? the calmness of the good?
guilt grown old in desperate hardihood?
So! too like in confidence are each,
man to trust to mortal look or speech;
in deeds, and deeds alone, may he discern
those which it wrings the unpractised heart to learn.

XXV.

Lara called his page, and went his way— 510
I could that stripling word or sign obey:
only follower from those climes afar,
where the Soul glows beneath a brighter star:
Lara left the shore from whence he sprung,
dutiful patient, and sedate though young;
not as him he served, his faith appears
above his station, and beyond his years.
Though not unknown the tongue of Lara's land,
much from him he rarely heard command;
fleet his step, and clear his tones would come, 520
when Lara's lip breathed forth the words of home:
these accents, as his native mountains dear,
like their absent echoes in his ear,^[jz]
sounded—kindred's—parents'—wonted voice recall,

✓ lost, abjured, for one—his friend, his all:
him earth now disclosed no other guide;
at marvel then he rarely left his side?

XXVI.

it was his form, and darkly delicate
t brow whereon his native sun had sate,
had not marred, though in his beams he grew, 530
cheek where oft the unbidden blush shone through;
not such blush as mounts when health would show
the heart's hue in that delighted glow;
'twas a hectic tint of secret care
t for a burning moment fevered there;
the wild sparkle of his eye seemed caught
n high, and lightened with electric thought,^[ka]
ugh its black orb those long low lashes' fringe
tempered with a melancholy tinge;
less of sorrow than of pride was there, 540
if 'twere grief, a grief that none should share:
pleased not him the sports that please his age,
tricks of Youth, the frolics of the Page;
hours on Lara he would fix his glance,
ill-forgotten in that watchful trance;
from his chief withdrawn, he wandered lone,
f were his answers, and his questions none;
walk the wood, his sport some foreign book;
resting-place the bank that curbs the brook:
seemed, like him he served, to live apart 550
n all that lures the eye, and fills the heart;
now no brotherhood, and take from earth
gift beyond that bitter boon—our birth.

XXVII.

ight he loved, 'twas Lara; but was shown
 faith in reverence and in deeds alone;
 ute attention; and his care, which guessed
 1 wish, fulfilled it ere the tongue expressed.
 there was haughtiness in all he did,
 irit deep that brooked not to be chid;
 zeal, though more than that of servile hands, ^[kb] 560
 ct alone obeys, his air commands;
 f 'twas Lara's less than *his* desire
 t thus he served, but surely not for hire.
 ht were the tasks enjoined him by his Lord,
 old the stirrup, or to bear the sword;
 une his lute, or, if he willed it more, ^[kc]
 omes of other times and tongues to pore;
 ne'er to mingle with the menial train,
 whom he showed nor deference nor disdain,
 that well-worn reserve which proved he knew 570
 sympathy with that familiar crew:
 soul, whate'er his station or his stem,
 ld bow to Lara, not descend to them.
 igher birth he seemed, and better days,
 mark of vulgar toil that hand betrays,
 emininely white it might bespeak
 ther sex, when matched with that smooth cheek,
 for his garb, and something in his gaze,
 e wild and high than Woman's eye betrays;
 tent fierceness that far more became 580
 fiery climate than his tender frame:
 e, in his words it broke not from his breast,
 from his aspect might be more than guessed. ^[kd]

ed his name, though rumour said he bore
ther ere he left his mountain-shore;
sometimes he would hear, however nigh,
t name repeated loud without reply,
nfamiliar—or, if roused again,
t to the sound, as but remembered then;
ess 'twas Lara's wonted voice that spake, 590
then—ear—eyes—and heart would all awake.

XXVIII.

ad looked down upon the festive hall,
mark'd that sudden strife so marked of all:
when the crowd around and near him told^[ke]
ir wonder at the calmness of the bold,
ir marvel how the high-born Lara bore
n insult from a stranger, doubly sore,
colour of young Kaled went and came,
lip of ashes, and the cheek of flame;
o'er his brow the dampening heart-drops threw 600
sickening iciness of that cold dew,
t rises as the busy bosom sinks
n heavy thoughts from which Reflection shrinks.
—there be things which we must dream and dare,
execute ere thought be half aware:^[277]
ate'er might Kaled's be, it was enow
eal his lip, but agonise his brow.
gazed on Ezzelin till Lara cast
t sidelong smile upon the knight he past;
en Kaled saw that smile his visage fell, 610
f on something recognised right well:
memory read in such a meaning more

n Lara's aspect unto others wore:
ward he sprung—a moment, both were gone,
all within that hall seemed left alone;
n had so fixed his eye on Lara's mien,
had so mixed their feelings with that scene,
t when his long dark shadow through the porch
more relieves the glare of yon high torch,
n pulse beats quicker, and all bosoms seem 620
ound as doubting from too black a dream,
n as we know is false, yet dread in sooth,
ause the worst is ever nearest truth.
they are gone—but Ezzelin is there,
n thoughtful visage and imperious air;
long remained not; ere an hour expired
aved his hand to Otho, and retired.

XXIX.

crowd are gone, the revellers at rest;
courteous host, and all-approving guest,
in to that accustomed couch must creep 630
ere Joy subsides, and Sorrow sighs to sleep,
Man, o'erlaboured with his Being's strife,
nks to that sweet forgetfulness of life:
re lie Love's feverish hope, and Cunning's guile,^[kf]
e's working brain, and lulled Ambition's wile;
each vain eye Oblivion's pinions wave,
quenched Existence crouches in a grave.^[kg]
at better name may Slumber's bed become?
it's sepulchre, the universal home,
ere Weakness—Strength—Vice—Virtue—sunk supine, 640
e in naked helplessness recline;

l for a while to heave unconscious breath,
wake to wrestle with the dread of Death,
shun—though Day but dawn on ills increased—
t sleep,—the loveliest, since it dreams the least.

CANTO THE SECOND.



I.

HT wanes—the vapours round the mountains curled^[278]
t into morn, and Light awakes the world,
i has another day to swell the past,
lead him near to little, but his last;
mighty Nature bounds as from her birth, 650
Sun is in the heavens, and Life on earth,^[279]
vers in the valley, splendour in the beam,
lth on the gale, and freshness in the stream.
ortal Man! behold her glories shine,
cry, exulting inly, "They are thine!"
e on, while yet thy gladdened eye may see:
orrow comes when they are not for thee:
grieve what may above thy senseless bier,
earth nor sky will yield a single tear;
cloud shall gather more, nor leaf shall fall, 660
gale breathe forth one sigh for thee, for all;^[280]
creeping things shall revel in their spoil,
fit thy clay to fertilise the soil.

II.

morn—'tis noon—assembled in the hall,
gathered Chieftains come to Otho's call;
now the promised hour, that must proclaim
life or death of Lara's future fame;
Ezzelin his charge may here unfold, ^[kh]
whatsoe'er the tale, it must be told.
faith was pledged, and Lara's promise given, 670
neet it in the eye of Man and Heaven.
comes he not? Such truths to be divulged,
hinks the accuser's rest is long indulged.

III.

hour is past, and Lara too is there,
self-confiding, coldly patient air;
comes not Ezzelin? The hour is past,
murmurs rise, and Otho's brow's o'ercast.
now my friend! his faith I cannot fear,
t he be on earth, expect him here;
roof that held him in the valley stands 680
ween my own and noble Lara's lands;
halls from such a guest had honour gained,
had Sir Ezzelin his host disdained,
that some previous proof forbade his stay,
urged him to prepare against to-day;
word I pledged for his I pledge again,
vill myself redeem his knighthood's stain."
ceased—and Lara answered, "I am here
end at thy demand a listening ear
ales of evil from a stranger's tongue, 690
se words already might my heart have wrung,
that I deemed him scarcely less than mad,

at the worst, a foe ignobly bad.
ow him not—but me it seems he knew
inds where—but I must not trifle too:
lucé this babbler—or redeem the pledge;
e in thy hold, and with thy falchion's edge."^[ki]

id Otho on the instant, reddening, threw
glove on earth, and forth his sabre flew.
e last alternative befits me best, 700
thus I answer for mine absent guest."

1 cheek unchanging from its sallow gloom,
ever near his own or other's tomb;
1 hand, whose almost careless coolness spoke
rasp well-used to deal the sabre-stroke;
1 eye, though calm, determined not to spare,
Lara too his willing weapon bare.
ain the circling Chieftains round them closed,
Otho's frenzy would not be opposed;
from his lip those words of insult fell— 710
sword is good who can maintain them well.

IV.

rt was the conflict; furious, blindly rash,
1 Otho gave his bosom to the gash:
bled, and fell; but not with deadly wound,
tched by a dextrous sleight along the ground.
mand thy life!" He answered not: and then
n that red floor he ne'er had risen again,
Lara's brow upon the moment grew
lost to blackness in its demon hue;^[281]
fiercer shook his angry falchion now 720

n when his foe's was levelled at his brow;
n all was stern collectedness and art,
v rose the unleavened hatred of his heart;
ittle sparing to the foe he felled, [kj]
t when the approaching crowd his arm withheld,
almost turned the thirsty point on those
o thus for mercy dared to interpose;
to a moment's thought that purpose bent;
looked he on him still with eye intent,
f he loathed the ineffectual strife 730
t left a foe, howe'er o'erthrown, with life;
f to search how far the wound he gave
sent its victim onward to his grave.

V.

y raised the bleeding Otho, and the Leech
made all present question, sign, and speech;
others met within a neighbouring hall,
he, incensed, and heedless of them all, [kk]
cause and conqueror in this sudden fray,
aughty silence slowly strode away;
acked his steed, his homeward path he took, 740
cast on Otho's towers a single look.

VI.

where was he? that meteor of a night,
o menaced but to disappear with light.
ere was this Ezzelin? who came and went,
eave no other trace of his intent.
eft the dome of Otho long ere morn,
arkness, yet so well the path was worn

could not miss it: near his dwelling lay;
there he was not, and with coming day
the fast inquiry, which unfolded nought, 750
except the absence of the Chief it sought.
The chamber tenantless, a steed at rest,
the host alarmed, his murmuring squires distressed:
his search extends along, around the path,
read to meet the marks of prowlers' wrath:
none are there, and not a brake hath borne
gout of blood, nor shred of mantle torn;
fall nor struggle hath defaced the grass,
which still retains a mark where Murder was;
dabbling fingers left to tell the tale, 760
the bitter print of each convulsive nail,
the agonised hands that cease to guard,
and in that pang the smoothness of the sword.
The such had been, if here a life was reft,
these were not; and doubting Hope is left;
The strange Suspicion, whispering Lara's name,
And daily mutters o'er his blackened fame;
He is sudden silent when his form appeared,
And hints the absence of the thing it feared
in its wonted wondering to renew, 770
The dye conjecture with a darker hue.

VII.

As rolls along, and Otho's wounds are healed,
not his pride; and hate no more concealed:
Was a man of power, and Lara's foe,
friend of all who sought to work him woe,
From his country's justice now demands

ount of Ezzelin at Lara's hands.
 ould else than Lara could have cause to fear
 presence? who had made him disappear,
 at the man on whom his menaced charge 780
 sate too deeply were he left at large?
 general rumour ignorantly loud,
 mystery dearest to the curious crowd;
 seeming friendliness of him who strove
 win no confidence, and wake no love;
 sweeping fierceness which his soul betrayed,
 skill with which he wielded his keen blade;
 ere had his arm unwarlike caught that art?
 ere had that fierceness grown upon his heart?
 it was not the blind capricious rage^[kl] 790
 ord can kindle and a word assuage;
 the deep working of a soul unmixed
 1 aught of pity where its wrath had fixed;
 1 as long power and overgorged success
 concentrates into all that's merciless:
 se, linked with that desire which ever sways
 ikind, the rather to condemn than praise,
 nst Lara gathering raised at length a storm,
 1 as himself might fear, and foes would form,
 he must answer for the absent head 800
 ne that haunts him still, alive or dead.

VIII.

ain that land was many a malcontent,
 ould cursed the tyranny to which he bent;
 t soil full many a wringing despot saw,
 ould worked his wantonness in form of law;

g war without and frequent broil within
made a path for blood and giant sin,
t waited but a signal to begin
havoc, such as civil discord blends,
ch knows no neuter, owns but foes or friends; 810
d in his feudal fortress each was lord,
word and deed obeyed, in soul abhorred.
s Lara had inherited his lands,
with them pining hearts and sluggish hands;
that long absence from his native clime
left him stainless of Oppression's crime,
now, diverted by his milder sway,^[kn]
dread by slow degrees had worn away.
menials felt their usual awe alone,
more for him than them that fear was grown; 820
y deemed him now unhappy, though at first
ir evil judgment augured of the worst,
each long restless night, and silent mood,
traced to sickness, fed by solitude:
though his lonely habits threw of late
om o'er his chamber, cheerful was his gate;^[kn]
thence the wretched ne'er unsoothed withdrew,
them, at least, his soul compassion knew.
l to the great, contemptuous to the high,
humble passed not his unheeding eye; 830
h he would speak not, but beneath his roof
y found asylum oft, and ne'er reproof.
they who watched might mark that, day by day,
ie new retainers gathered to his sway;
most of late, since Ezzelin was lost,
played the courteous lord and bounteous host:

chance his strife with Otho made him dread
the snare prepared for his obnoxious head;
ate'er his view, his favour more obtains
in these, the people, than his fellow thanes. 840
his were policy, so far 'twas sound,
a million judged but of him as they found;
on him by sterner chiefs to exile driven
yet but required a shelter, and 'twas given.
him no peasant mourned his rifled cot,
nor scarce the Serf could murmur o'er his lot;
on him old Avarice found its hoard secure,
on him contempt forbore to mock the poor;
with present cheer and promised recompense
gained, till all too late to part from thence: 850
late he offered, with the coming change,
a deep reversion of delayed revenge;
Love, long baffled by the unequal match,
his well-won charms success was sure to snatch.^[ko]
now was ripe, he waits but to proclaim
that slavery nothing which was still a name.
the moment came, the hour when Otho thought
he at last the vengeance which he sought:
summons found the destined criminal
girt by thousands in his swarming hall; 860
h from their feudal fetters newly riven,
lying earth, and confident of heaven.
that morning he had freed the soil-bound slaves,
to dig no land for tyrants but their graves!
on is their cry—some watchword for the fight
to vindicate the wrong, and warp the right;
glory—Freedom—Vengeance—what you will,

ord's enough to raise Mankind to kill;^[kp]
ie factious phrase by cunning caught and spread,
t Guilt may reign-and wolves and worms be fed! 870

IX.

oughout that clime the feudal Chiefs had gained
n sway, their infant monarch hardly reigned;
v was the hour for Faction's rebel growth,
Serfs contemned the one, and hated both:
y waited but a leader, and they found
to their cause inseparably bound;
circumstance compelled to plunge again,
elf-defence, amidst the strife of men.
off by some mysterious fate from those
om Birth and Nature meant not for his foes, 880
Lara from that night, to him accurst,
ared to meet, but not alone, the worst:
ie reason urged, whate'er it was, to shun
irry into deeds at distance done;
ningling with his own the cause of all,
if he failed, he still delayed his fall.
sullen calm that long his bosom kept,
storm that once had spent itself and slept,
sed by events that seemed foredoomed to urge
gloomy fortunes to their utmost verge, 890
st forth, and made him all he once had been,
is again; he only changed the scene.
it care had he for life, and less for fame,
not less fitted for the desperate game:
leemed himself marked out for others' hate,
mocked at Ruin so they shared his fate.

· cared he for the freedom of the crowd?
· raised the humble but to bend the proud.
· had hoped quiet in his sullen lair,
Man and Destiny beset him there: 900
· ed to hunters, he was found at bay;
· they must kill, they cannot snare the prey.
n, unambitious, silent, he had been
ceforth a calm spectator of Life's scene;
dragged again upon the arena, stood
ader not unequal to the feud;
oice—mien—gesture—savage nature spoke,
· from his eye the gladiator broke.

X.

at boots the oft-repeated tale of strife,
feast of vultures, and the waste of life? 910
varying fortune of each separate field,
fierce that vanquish, and the faint that yield?
smoking ruin, and the crumbled wall?
his the struggle was the same with all;
e that distempered passions lent their force
itterness that banished all remorse.
e sued, for Mercy knew her cry was vain,
captive died upon the battle-plain.^[kq]
ither cause, one rage alone possessed
empire of the alternate victor's breast; 920
· they that smote for freedom or for sway,
med few were slain, while more remained to slay.
as too late to check the wasting brand,
· Desolation reaped the famished land;
torch was lighted, and the flame was spread,

. Carnage smiled upon her daily dead.

XI.

h with the nerve the new-born impulse strung,
first success to Lara's numbers clung:
that vain victory hath ruined all;
y form no longer to their leader's call: 930
blind confusion on the foe they press,
. think to snatch is to secure success.
lust of booty, and the thirst of hate,
e on the broken brigands to their fate:
ain he doth whate'er a chief may do,
heck the headlong fury of that crew;
ain their stubborn ardour he would tame,
hand that kindles cannot quench the flame;
wary foe alone hath turned their mood,
. shown their rashness to that erring brood: 940
feigned retreat, the nightly ambuscade,
daily harass, and the fight delayed,
long privation of the hoped supply,
tentless rest beneath the humid sky,
stubborn wall that mocks the leaguer's art,
. palls the patience of his baffled art,
hese they had not deemed: the battle-day
y could encounter as a veteran may;
more preferred the fury of the strife,^[kr]
. present death, to hourly suffering life: 950
. Famine wrings, and Fever sweeps away
numbers melting fast from their array;
mperate triumph fades to discontent,
. Lara's soul alone seems still unbent;

few remain to aid his voice and hand,
thousands dwindled to a scanty band:
perate, though few, the last and best remained
nourn the discipline they late disdained.
hope survives, the frontier is not far,
thence they may escape from native war: 960
bear within them to the neighbouring state
exile's sorrows, or an outlaw's hate:
d is the task their father-land to quit,
harder still to perish or submit.

XII.

resolved—they march—consenting Night
des with her star their dim and torchless flight;
ady they perceive its tranquil beam
p on the surface of the barrier stream;
ady they descry—Is yon the bank?
y! 'tis lined with many a hostile rank. 970
urn or fly!—What glitters in the rear?
Otho's banner—the pursuer's spear!
those the shepherds' fires upon the height?
s! they blaze too widely for the flight:
off from hope, and compassed in the toil,
s blood perchance hath bought a richer spoil!

XIII.

oment's pause—'tis but to breathe their band,
hall they onward press, or here withstand?
atters little—if they charge the foes
o by their border-stream their march oppose, 980
ie few, perchance, may break and pass the line,

never linked to baffle such design.
The charge be ours! to wait for their assault
The fate well worthy of a coward's halt."
He flies each sabre, reined is every steed,
The next word shall scarce outstrip the deed:
The next tone of Lara's gathering breath
And many shall but hear the voice of Death!

XIV.

His blade is bared,—in him there is an air
Deep, but far too tranquil for despair; 990
Something of indifference more than then
Comes the bravest, if they feel for men—
He turned his eye on Kaled, ever near,
Still too faithful to betray one fear;
Chance 'twas but the moon's dim twilight threw
O'er his aspect an unwonted hue
Sorrowful paleness, whose deep tint expressed
Truth, and not the terror of his breast.
Lara marked, and laid his hand on his:
He bled not in such an hour as this; 1000
His lip was silent, scarcely beat his heart,
His eye alone proclaimed, "We will not part!
Our band may perish, or thy friends may flee,
I'll well to Life—but not Adieu to thee!"

His word hath passed his lips, and onward driven,
He rurs the linked band through ranks asunder riven:
He has each steed obeyed the arméd heel,
He flashes the scimitars, and rings the steel;
He numbered, not outbraved, they still oppose
He pair to daring, and a front to foes; 1010

blood is mingled with the dashing stream,
which runs all redly till the morning beam.^[ks]

XV.^[282]

commanding—aiding—animating all,^[283]
where foe appeared to press, or friend to fall,
hears Lara's voice, and waves or strikes his steel,
inspiring hope, himself had ceased to feel.
He fled, for well they knew that flight were vain;
those that waver turn to smite again,
while yet they find the firmest of the foe
in oil before their leader's look and blow: 1020
He girt with numbers, now almost alone,
revivifies their ranks, or re-unites his own;
himself he spared not—once they seemed to fly—
He was the time, he waved his hand on high,
He shook—Why sudden droops that pluméd crest?
The shaft is sped—the arrow's in his breast!
That fatal gesture left the unguarded side,
He. Death has stricken down yon arm of pride.
The word of triumph fainted from his tongue;
That hand, so raised, how droopingly it hung! 1030
Yet the sword instinctively retains,
though from its fellow shrink the falling reins;
These Kaled snatches: dizzy with the blow,
He senseless bending o'er his saddle-bow,
Perceives not Lara that his anxious page
Revivifies his charger from the combat's rage:
In time his followers charge, and charge again;
He mixed the slayers now to heed the slain!

XVI.

glimmers on the dying and the dead,
cloven cuirass, and the helmless head; 1040
war-horse masterless is on the earth, [kt][284]
that last gasp hath burst his bloody girth;
near, yet quivering with what life remained,
heel that urged him and the hand that reined;
some too near that rolling torrent lie, [ku]
those waters mock the lip of those that die;
that panting thirst which scorches in the breath
hose that die the soldier's fiery death,
pain impels the burning mouth to crave
a drop—the last—to cool it for the grave; 1050
in feeble and convulsive effort swept,
their limbs along the crimsoned turf have crept;
faint remains of life such struggles waste,
yet they reach the stream, and bend to taste:
they feel its freshness, and almost partake—
a pause? No further thirst have they to slake—
unquenched, and yet they feel it not;
as an agony—but now forgot!

XVII.

Death a lime, remoter from the scene,
were but for him that strife had never been, 1060
breathing but devoted warrior lay:
as Lara bleeding fast from life away.
fellow once, and now his only guide,
stands Kaled watchful o'er his welling side,
with his scarf would staunch the tides that rush,
in each convulsion, in a blacker gush;
then, as his faint breathing waxes low,

weebler, not less fatal tricklings flow:
scarce can speak, but motions him 'tis vain,
merely adds another throb to pain. 1070
clasps the hand that pang which would assuage,
sadly smiles his thanks to that dark page,
nothing fears—nor feels—nor heeds—nor sees—
that damp brow which rests upon his knees;
that pale aspect, where the eye, though dim,
held all the light that shone on earth for him.

XVIII.

the foe arrives, who long had searched the field,
in triumph nought till Lara too should yield:
they would remove him, but they see 'twere vain,
he regards them with a calm disdain, 1080
that rose to reconcile him with his fate,
that escape to death from living hate:
Otho comes, and leaping from his steed,
looks on the bleeding foe that made him bleed,
questions of his state; he answers not,
their glances on him as on one forgot,
he turns to Kaled:—each remaining word
they understood not, if distinctly heard;
dying tones are in that other tongue,
in which some strange remembrance wildly clung. 1090
they spake of other scenes, but what—is known
to Kaled, whom their meaning reached alone;
he replied, though faintly, to their sound,
he gazed the rest in dumb amazement round:
they seemed even then—that twain—unto the last
half forget the present in the past;

hare between themselves some separate fate,
ose darkness none beside should penetrate.

XIX.^[285]

ir words though faint were many—from the tone
ir import those who heard could judge alone; 1100
n this, you might have deemed young Kaled's death
e near than Lara's by his voice and breath,
ad—so deep—and hesitating broke
accents his scarce-moving pale lips spoke;^[kv]
Lara's voice, though low, at first was clear
calm, till murmuring Death gasped hoarsely near;
from his visage little could we guess,
inrepentant—dark—and passionless,^[kw]
e that when struggling nearer to his last,
n that page his eye was kindly cast; 1110
once, as Kaled's answering accents ceased,
e Lara's hand, and pointed to the East:
ether (as then the breaking Sun from high
ed back the clouds) the morrow caught his eye,
hat 'twas chance—or some remembered scene,
t raised his arm to point where such had been,
ce Kaled seemed to know, but turned away,
f his heart abhorred that coming day,
shrunk his glance before that morning light,
ook on Lara's brow—where all grew night. 1120
sense seemed left, though better were its loss;
when one near displayed the absolving Cross,
proffered to his touch the holy bead,
vhich his parting soul might own the need,
ooked upon it with an eye profane,

. smiled—Heaven pardon! if 'twere with disdain:
. Kaled, though he spoke not, nor withdrew
n Lara's face his fixed despairing view,
n brow repulsive, and with gesture swift,
ig back the hand which held the sacred gift, 1130
f such but disturbed the expiring man,
seemed to know his life but *then* began—
t Life of Immortality, secure^[kx]
one, save them whose faith in Christ is sure.

XX.

gasping heaved the breath that Lara drew,^[ky]
. dull the film along his dim eye grew;
limbs stretched fluttering, and his head drooped o'er
weak yet still untiring knee that bore;
pressed the hand he held upon his heart—
ats no more, but Kaled will not part 1140
n the cold grasp, but feels, and feels in vain,
that faint throb which answers not again.
eats!"—Away, thou dreamer! he is gone—
ice was Lara which thou look'st upon.

XXI.

gazed, as if not yet had passed away^[kz]
haughty spirit of that humbled clay;
. those around have roused him from his trance,
cannot tear from thence his fixed glance;
. when, in raising him from where he bore
in his arms the form that felt no more, 1150
saw the head his breast would still sustain,
. down like earth to earth upon the plain;

lid not dash himself thereby, nor tear
glossy tendrils of his raven hair,
strove to stand and gaze, but reeled and fell,
ce breathing more than that he loved so well.
n that *he* loved! Oh! never yet beneath
breast of *man* such trusty love may breathe!
t trying moment hath at once revealed
secret long and yet but half concealed; 1160
aring to revive that lifeless breast,
rief seemed ended, but the sex confessed;
life returned, and Kaled felt no shame—
at now to her was Womanhood or Fame?

XXII.

. Lara sleeps not where his fathers sleep,
where he died his grave was dug as deep;
is his mortal slumber less profound,
ugh priest nor blessed nor marble decked the mound,
he was mourned by one whose quiet grief,
s loud, outlasts a people's for their Chief. 1170
i was all question asked her of the past,
vain e'en menace—silent to the last;
told nor whence, nor why she left behind
all for one who seemed but little kind.
7 did she love him? Curious fool!—be still—
man love the growth of human will?
ier he might be gentleness; the stern
e deeper thoughts than your dull eyes discern,
when they love, your smilers guess not how
ts the strong heart, though less the lips avow. 1180
y were not common links, that formed the chain

t bound to Lara Kaled's heart and brain;
that wild tale she brooked not to unfold,
sealed is now each lip that could have told.

XXIII.

y laid him in the earth, and on his breast,
ides the wound that sent his soul to rest,
y found the scattered dints of many a scar,
ch were not planted there in recent war;
ere'er had passed his summer years of life,
ems they vanished in a land of strife; 1190
all unknown his Glory or his Guilt,^[1a]
se only told that somewhere blood was spilt,
Ezzelin, who might have spoke the past,
irned no more—that night appeared his last.

XXIV.

n that night (a peasant's is the tale)
erf that crossed the intervening vale,^[286]
en Cynthia's light almost gave way to morn,
nearly veiled in mist her waning horn;
erf, that rose betimes to thread the wood,
hew the bough that bought his children's food, 1200
ed by the river that divides the plain
Dtho's lands and Lara's broad domain:
eard a tramp—a horse and horseman broke
n out the wood—before him was a cloak
pt round some burthen at his saddle-bow,
t was his head, and hidden was his brow.
sed by the sudden sight at such a time,
some foreboding that it might be crime,

self unheeded watched the stranger's course,
reached the river, bounded from his horse, 1210
lifting thence the burthen which he bore,
ved up the bank, and dashed it from the shore,
n paused—and looked—and turned—and seemed to watch,
still another hurried glance would snatch,
follow with his step the stream that flowed,
f even yet too much its surface showed;
nce he started—stooped—around him strown
winter floods had scattered heaps of stone:
hese the heaviest thence he gathered there,
slung them with a more than common care. 1220
ntime the Serf had crept to where unseen
self might safely mark what this might mean;
caught a glimpse, as of a floating breast,
something glittered starlike on the vest;
ere he well could mark the buoyant trunk,
assy fragment smote it, and it sunk:^[lb]
se again, but indistinct to view,
left the waters of a purple hue,
n deeply disappeared: the horseman gazed
ebbed the latest eddy it had raised; 1230
n turning, vaulted on his pawing steed,
instant spurred him into panting speed.
face was masked—the features of the dead,
ad it were, escaped the observer's dread;
if in sooth a Star its bosom bore,
n is the badge that Knighthood ever wore,
such 'tis known Sir Ezzelin had worn
n the night that led to such a morn.
us he perished, Heaven receive his soul!
undiscovered limbs to ocean roll; 1240

. charity upon the hope would dwell
as not Lara's hand by which he fell.^[1c]

XXV.

. Kaled—Lara—Ezzelin, are gone,
e without their monumental stone!
first, all efforts vainly strove to wean
n lingering where her Chieftain's blood had been:
f had so tamed a spirit once too proud,
tears were few, her wailing never loud;
furious would you tear her from the spot
ere yet she scarce believed that he was not, 1250
eye shot forth with all the living fire
t haunts the tigress in her whelpless ire;
left to waste her weary moments there,
talked all idly unto shapes of air,
n as the busy brain of Sorrow paints,
woos to listen to her fond complaints:
she would sit beneath the very tree
ere lay his drooping head upon her knee;
in that posture where she saw him fall,
words, his looks, his dying grasp recall; 1260
she had shorn, but saved her raven hair,
oft would snatch it from her bosom there,
fold, and press it gently to the ground,
f she staunched anew some phantom's wound.^[1d]
self would question, and for him reply;
n rising, start, and beckon him to fly
n some imagined Spectre in pursuit;
n seat her down upon some linden's root,
hide her visage with her meagre hand,

race strange characters along the sand— 1270
; could not last—she lies by him she loved;
tale untold—her truth too dearly proved.

FOOTNOTES:

[jb] {323} *Lara the sequel of "the Corsair."*—[MS. erased.]

[265] [A revised version of the following "Advertisement" was prefixed to the First Edition (Printed for J. Murray, Albemarle Street, By T. Davison, Whitefriars, 1814), which was accompanied by *Jacqueline*:—

"The Reader—if the tale of *Lara* has the fortune to meet with one—may probably regard it as a sequel to the *Corsair*;—the colouring is of a similar cast, and although the situations of the characters are changed, the stories are in some measure connected. The countenance is nearly the same—but with a different expression. To the readers' conjecture are left the name of the writer and the failure or success of his attempt—the latter are the only points upon which the author or his judges can feel interested.

"The Poem of *Jaqueline* is the production of a different author and is added at the request of the writer of the former tale, whose wish and entreaty it was that it should occupy the first pages of the following volume, and he regrets that the tenacious courtesy of his friend would not permit him to place it where the judgement of the reader concurring with his own will suggest its more appropriate station."]

[266] The reader is apprised, that the name of *Lara* being Spanish, and no circumstance of local and natural description fixing the scene or hero of the poem to any country or age, the word "Serf," which could not be correctly applied to the lower classes in Spain, who were never vassals of the soil, has nevertheless been employed to designate the followers of our fictitious chieftain.

[Byron, writing to Murray, July 14, 1814, says, "The name only is Spanish; the country is not Spain, but the Moon" (not "Morea," as hitherto printed).—*Letters*, 1899, iii. 110. The MS. is dated May 15, 1814.]

[267] {324} [For the opening lines to *Lara*, see *Murray's Magazine*, January, 1887, vol. i. p. 3.]

[268] [Compare *Childish Recollections*, lines 221-224—

"Can Rank, or e'en a Guardian's name supply
The love, which glistens in a Father's eye?
For this, can Wealth, or Title's sound atone,
Made, by a Parent's early loss, my own?"

Compare, too, *English Bards, etc.*, lines 689-694, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 95, 352.]

[jc] *First in each folly—nor the last in vice.*—[MS. erased]

[jd] {325} *Short was the course the beardless wanderer run.*—[MS.]

[je] *Another chief had won*——.—[MS. erased.]

[jf] *His friends forgot him—and his dog had died.*—[MS.]

[jg] *Without one rumour to relieve his care.*—[MS. erased.]

[jh] *That most might decorate that gloomy pile.*—[MS. erased.]

[269] {326} [The construction is harsh and obscure, but the meaning is, perhaps, that, though *Lara's* soul was haughty, his sins were due to nothing worse than pleasure, that they were the natural sins of youth.]

[ji] {328} *Their refuge in intensity of thought.*—[MS.]

[jj] {329} *The sound of other voices than his own.*—[MS.]

[270] ["The circumstance of his having at this time [1808-9] among the ornaments of his study, a number of skulls highly polished, and placed on light stands round the room, would seem to indicate that he rather courted than shunned such gloomy associations."—*Life*, p. 87.]

[271] [Compare—

"His train but deemed the favourite page
Was left behind to spare his age,
Or other if they deemed, none dared
To mutter what he thought or heard."

Marmion, Canto III. stanza xv. lines 19-22.]

[272] [Compare—

"Sweetly shining on the eye,
A rivulet gliding smoothly by;
Which shows with what an easy tide
The moments of the happy glide."

Dyer's *Country Walk* (*Poetical Works of Armstrong, Dyer, and Green*, 1858, p. 221).]

[273] {331} ["He used, at first, though offered a bed at Annesley, to return every night to Newstead, to sleep; alleging as a reason that he was afraid of the family pictures of the Chaworths."—*Life*, p. 27.]

[jk] ———*knelt in painted prayer.*—[MS.]

[jl] *His aspect all that best becomes the grave.*—[MS.]

[jm] {333} ———*along the gallery crawl.*—[MS.]

[jn] {334}

*Opinion various as his varying eye
In praise or railing—never passed him by.*—[MS.]

[jo] {335} ———*gayest of the gay.*—[MS.]

[274] [The MS. omits lines 313-382. Stanza xviii. is written on a loose sheet belonging to the Murray MSS.; stanza xix. on a sheet inserted in the MS. Both stanzas must have been composed after the first draft of the poem was completed.]

[jp] ———*an inward scorn of all.*—[MS.]

[275] {336} [Compare Coleridge's *Lines to a Gentleman* [William Wordsworth] (written in 1807, but not published till 1817), lines 69, 70—

"Sense of past youth, and manhood come in vain,
And genius given, and knowledge won in vain."]

[jq]

*And left Reflection: loth himself to blame,
He called on Nature's self to share the shame.*—[MS.]

[jr] *And half mistook for fate his wayward will.*—[MS.]

[276] [For Byron's belief or half-persuasion that he was predestined to evil, compare *Childe Harold*, Canto I. stanza lxxxiii. lines 8, 9, and note. Compare, too, Canto III.

stanza lxx. lines 8 and 9; and Canto IV. stanza xxxiv. line 6: *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii, 74, 260, 354.]

[js] {337}

—around another's mind;
There he was fixed——.—[MS.]

[jt] {338}

That friendship, interest, aversion knew
But there within your inmost——.—[MS.]

[ju]

Yes you might hate abhor, but from the breast
He wrung an all unwilling interest—
Vain was the struggle, in that sightless net.—[MS.]

[jv] So springs the exulting spirit——.—[MS.]

[jw] {339} That question thus repeated—Thrice and high.—[MS.]

[jx] {340}

Art thou not he who——"
"Whatso'er I be.—[MS.]

[jy] {342}

"Tomorrow!—aye—tomorrow" these were all
The words from Lara's answering lip that fall.—[MS.]

[jz] {343} That brought their native echoes to his ear.—[MS.]

[ka] From high and quickened into life and thought.—[MS.]

[kb] {344}

Though no reluctance checked his willing hand,
He still obeyed as others would command.—[MS.]

[kc]

To tune his lute and, if none else were there,
To fill the cup in which himself might share.—[MS.]

[kd] {345} *Yet still existed there though still suppress.*—[ms]

[ke] *And when the slaves and pages round him told.*—[ms]

[277] {346} [Compare—

"Strange things I have in head, that will to hand,
Which must be acted, ere they may be scanned."

Macbeth, act iii. sc. 4, lines 139, 140.]

[kf] {347} *There lie the lover's hope—the watcher's toil.*—[MS.]

[kg] *And half-Existence melts within a grave.*—[MS.]

[278] {348} [Compare—

"Now slowly melting into day,
Vapour and mist dissolved away."

Sotheby's *Constance de Castile*, Canto III. stanza v. lines 17, 18.]

[279] [Compare the last lines of Pippa's song in Browning's *Pippa Passes*—"God's in His Heaven, all's right with the world!"]

[280] [Mr. Alexander Dyce points out the resemblance between these lines and a passage in one of Pope's letters to Steele (July 15, 1712, *Works*, 1754, viii. 226): "The morning after my exit the sun will rise as bright as ever, the flowers smell as sweet, the plants spring as green."]

[kh] {349} *When Ezzelin——.*—[Ed. 1831.]

[ki] *Here in thy hall——.*—[MS.]

[281] {351} [Compare *Mysteries of Udolpho*, by Mrs. Ann Radcliffe, 1794, ii. 279: "The Count then fell back into the arms of his servants, while Montoni held his sword over him and bade him ask his life ... his complexion changed almost to blackness as he looked upon his fallen adversary."]

[kj] *And turned to smite a foe already felled.*—[MS.]

[kk] *And he less calm—yet calmer than them all.*—[MS.]

[kl] {353} *——the blind and headlong rage.*—[MS.]

[km] {354}

*The first impressions with his milder sway
Of dread——.—[MS.]*

[\[kn\]](#) *Mysterious gloom around his hall and state.—[MS.]*

[\[ko\]](#) {355} *The Beauty—which the first success would snatch.—[MS.]*

[\[kp\]](#) {356}

*A word's enough to rouse mankind to kill
Some factions phrase by cunning raised and spread.—[MS.]*

[\[kq\]](#) {357} *——upon the battle slain.—[Ed. 1831.]*

[\[kr\]](#) {358} *But not endure the long protracted strife.—[MS. erased.]*

[\[ks\]](#) {360} *And raged the combat till——.—[MS.]*

[\[282\]](#) {361} [Stanza XV. was added after the completion of the first draft of the poem.]

[\[283\]](#) [Compare—

"Il s'excite, il s'empresse, il inspire aux soldats
Cet espoir généreux que lui-même il n'a pas."

Voltaire, *Henriade*, Chant. viii. lines 127, 128,
Oeuvres Complètes, Paris, 1837, ii. 325.]

[\[kt\]](#) {362} *The stiffening steed is on the dinted earth.—[MS.]*

[\[284\]](#) [Compare—

"There lay a horse, another through the field
Ran masterless."

Tasso's *Jerusalem* (translated by Edward Fairfax),
Bk. VII. stanza cvi. lines 3, 4.]

[\[ku\]](#) *——that glassy river lie.—[MS.]*

[\[285\]](#) {364} [Stanza xix. was added after the completion of the poem. The MS. is extant.]

[\[kv\]](#) *——white lips spoke.—[MS.]*

[\[kw\]](#) *——pale—and passionless.—[MS.]*

[\[kx\]](#) {365}

That Life—immortal—infinite secure

To All for whom that Cross hath made it sure.—

[MS. First ed. 1814.]

or,

That life immortal, infinite and sure

To all whose faith the eternal boon secure.—[MS.]

[ky] *But faint the dying Lara's accents grew.—*[MS.]

[kz]

He gazed as doubtful that the thing he saw

Had something more to ask from Lone or awe.—[MS.]

[la] {367}

But all unknown the blood he lost or spilt

These only told his Glory or his Guilt.—[MS.]

[286] The event in this section was suggested by the description of the death or rather burial of the Duke of Gandia. "The most interesting and particular account of it is given by Burchard, and is in substance as follows:—'On the eighth day of June, the Cardinal of Valenza and the Duke of Gandia, sons of the pope, supped with their mother, Vanozza, near the church of *S. Pietro ad vincula*: several other persons being present at the entertainment. A late hour approaching, and the cardinal having reminded his brother that it was time to return to the apostolic palace, they mounted their horses or mules, with only a few attendants, and proceeded together as far as the palace of Cardinal Ascanio Sforza, when the duke informed the cardinal that, before he returned home, he had to pay a visit of pleasure. Dismissing therefore all his attendants, excepting his *staffiero*, or footman, and a person in a mask, who had paid him a visit whilst at supper, and who, during the space of a month or thereabouts, previous to this time, had called upon him almost daily at the apostolic palace, he took this person behind him on his mule, and proceeded to the street of the Jews, where he quitted his servant, directing him to remain there until a certain hour; when, if he did not return, he might repair to the palace. The duke then seated the person in the mask behind him, and rode I know not whither; but in that night he was assassinated, and thrown into the river. The servant, after having been dismissed, was also assaulted and mortally wounded; and although he was attended with great care, yet such was his situation, that he could give no intelligible account of what had befallen his master. In the morning, the duke not having returned to the palace, his servants began to be alarmed; and one of them informed the pontiff of the evening excursion of his sons, and that the duke had not yet made his appearance. This gave the pope no small anxiety; but he conjectured that the duke had been attracted by some courtesan to pass the night

with her, and, not choosing to quit the house in open day, had waited till the following evening to return home. When, however, the evening arrived, and he found himself disappointed in his expectations, he became deeply afflicted, and began to make inquiries from different persons, whom he ordered to attend him for that purpose. Amongst these was a man named Giorgio Schiavoni, who, having discharged some timber from a bark in the river, had remained on board the vessel to watch it; and being interrogated whether he had seen any one thrown into the river on the night preceding, he replied, that he saw two men on foot, who came down the street, and looked diligently about to observe whether any person was passing. That seeing no one, they returned, and a short time afterwards two others came, and looked around in the same manner as the former: no person still appearing, they gave a sign to their companions, when a man came, mounted on a white horse, having behind him a dead body, the head and arms of which hung on one side, and the feet on the other side of the horse; the two persons on foot supporting the body, to prevent its falling. They thus proceeded towards that part where the filth of the city is usually discharged into the river, and turning the horse, with his tail towards the water, the two persons took the dead body by the arms and feet, and with all their strength flung it into the river. The person on horseback then asked if they had thrown it in; to which they replied, *Signor, si* (yes, Sir). He then looked towards the river, and seeing a mantle floating on the stream, he enquired what it was that appeared black, to which they answered, it was a mantle; and one of them threw stones upon it, in consequence of which it sunk. The attendants of the pontiff then enquired from Giorgio, why he had not revealed this to the governor of the city; to which he replied, that he had seen in his time a hundred dead bodies thrown into the river at the same place, without any inquiry being made respecting them; and that he had not, therefore, considered it as a matter of any importance. The fishermen and seamen were then collected, and ordered to search the river, where, on the following evening, they found the body of the duke, with his habit entire, and thirty ducats in his purse. He was pierced with nine wounds, one of which was in his throat, the others in his head, body, and limbs. No sooner was the pontiff informed of the death of his son, and that he had been thrown, like filth, into the river, than, giving way to his grief, he shut himself up in a chamber, and wept bitterly. The Cardinal of Segovia, and other attendants on the pope, went to the door, and after many hours spent in persuasions and exhortations, prevailed upon him to admit them. From the evening of Wednesday till the following Saturday the pope took no food; nor did he sleep from Thursday morning till the same hour on the ensuing day. At length, however, giving way to the entreaties of his attendants, he began to restrain his sorrow, and to consider the injury which his own health might sustain by the further indulgence of his grief."—Roscoe's *Life and Pontificate of Leo Tenth*, 1805, i. 265. [See, too, for the original in

Burchard Diar, in Gordon's *Life of Alex. VI.*, *Append.*, "De Cæde Ducis Gandiæ," *Append.* No. xlviii., *ib.*, pp. 90, 91.]

[[lb](#)] {370} *A mighty pebble*——.—[MS.]

[[lc](#)] *That not unarmed in combat fair he fell.*—[MS. erased.]

[[ld](#)] {371} ——*some phantom wound.*—[MS.]

HEBREW MELODIES

INTRODUCTION TO *HEBREW MELODIES*



ACCORDING to the "Advertisement" prefixed to Murray's First Edition of the *Hebrew Melodies*, London, 1815 (the date, January, 1815, was appended in 1832), the "poems were written at the request of the author's friend, the Hon. D. Kinnaird, for a selection of Hebrew Melodies, and have been published, with the music, arranged by Mr. Braham and Mr. Nathan."

Byron's engagement to Miss Milbanke took place in September, 1814, and the remainder of the year was passed in London, at his chambers in the Albany. The so-called *Hebrew Melodies* were, probably, begun in the late autumn of that year, and were certainly finished at Seaham, after his marriage had taken place, in January-February, 1815. It is a natural and pardonable conjecture that Byron took to writing sacred or, at any rate, scriptural verses by way of giving pleasure and doing honour to his future wife, "the girl who gave to song What gold could never buy." They were, so to speak, the first-fruits of a seemlier muse.

It is probable that the greater number of these poems were in MS. before it occurred to Byron's friend and banker, the Honble. Douglas James William Kinnaird (1788-1830), to make him known to Isaac Nathan (1792-1864), a youthful composer of "musical farces and operatic works," who had been destined by his parents for the Hebrew priesthood, but had broken

away, and, after some struggles, succeeded in qualifying himself as a musician.

Byron took a fancy to Nathan, and presented him with the copyright of his "poetical effusions," on the understanding that they were to be set to music and sung in public by John Braham. "Professional occupations" prevented Braham from fulfilling his part of the engagement, but a guinea folio (Part. I.) ("*Selections of Hebrew Melodies, Ancient and Modern*, with appropriate symphonies and accompaniments, by I. Braham and I. Nathan, the poetry written expressly for the work by the Right Honourable Lord Byron")—with an ornamental title-page designed by the architect Edward Blore (1789-1879), and dedicated to the Princess Charlotte of Wales—was published in April, 1815. A second part was issued in 1816.

The preface, part of which was reprinted (p. vi.) by Nathan, in his *Fugitive Pieces and Reminiscences of Lord Byron*, London, 1829, is not without interest—

"The Hebrew Melodies are a selection from the favourite airs which are still sung in the religious ceremonies of the Jews. Some of these have, in common with all their Sacred airs, been preserved by memory and tradition alone, without the assistance of written characters. Their age and originality, therefore, must be left to conjecture. But the latitude given to the taste and genius of their performers has been the means of engrafting on the original Melodies a certain wildness and pathos, which have at length become the chief characteristics of the sacred songs of the Jews....

"Of the poetry it is necessary to speak, in order thus publicly to acknowledge the kindness with which Lord Byron has condescended to furnish the most valuable part of the work. It has been our endeavour to select such melodies as would best suit the style and sentiment of the poetry."

Moore, for whose benefit the Melodies had been rehearsed, was by no means impressed by their "wildness and pathos," and seems to have twitted Byron on the subject, or, as he puts it (*Life*, p. 276), to have taken the liberty of "laughing a little at the manner in which some of the Hebrew Melodies had been set to music." The author of *Sacred Songs* (1814) set to airs by Beethoven, Mozart, Haydn, etc., was a critic not to be gainsaid, but from the half-comical petulance with which he "curses" and "sun-burns" (Letters to Moore, February 22, March 8, 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 179, 183) Nathan, and his "vile Ebrew nasalities," it is evident that Byron winced under Moore's "chaff."

Apart from the merits or demerits of the setting, the title *Hebrew Melodies* is somewhat misleading. Three love-songs, "She walks in Beauty like the Night," "Oh! snatched away in Beauty's Bloom," and "I saw thee weep," still form part of the collection; and, in Nathan's folio (which does not contain "A spirit passed before me"), two fragments, "It is the hour when from the boughs" and "Francesca walks in the shadow of night," which were afterwards incorporated in *Parisina*, were included. The *Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, retain the fragments from *Parisina*, and add the following hitherto unpublished poems: "I speak not, I trace not," etc., "They say that Hope is Happiness," and the genuine but rejected Hebrew Melody "In the valley of waters we wept on the day."

It is uncertain when Murray's first edition appeared. Byron wrote to Nathan with regard to the copyright in January, 1815 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 167), but it is unlikely that the volume was put on the market before Nathan's folio, which was advertised for the first time in the *Morning Chronicle*, April 6, 1815; and it is possible that the first public

announcement of the *Hebrew Melodies*, as a separate issue, was made in the *Courier*, June 22, 1815.

The *Hebrew Melodies* were reviewed in the *Christian Observer*, August, 1815, vol. xiv. p. 542; in the *Analectic Magazine*, October, 1815, vol. vi. p. 292; and were noticed by Jeffrey [The *Hebrew Melodies*, though "obviously inferior" to Lord Byron's other works, "display a skill in versification and a mastery in diction which would have raised an inferior artist to the very summit of distinction"] in the *Edinburgh Review*, December, 1816, vol. xxvii. p. 291.

ADVERTISEMENT

The subsequent poems were written at the request of my friend, the Hon. Douglas Kinnaird, for a Selection of Hebrew Melodies, and have been published, with the music, arranged by Mr. Braham and Mr. Nathan.

January, 1815.

HEBREW MELODIES



SHE WALKS IN BEAUTY. ^[287]

I.

walks in Beauty, like the night
f cloudless climes and starry skies;
all that's best of dark and bright
leet in her aspect and her eyes:
s mellowed to that tender light
hich Heaven to gaudy day denies.

II.

shade the more, one ray the less,
ad half impaired the nameless grace
ch waves in every raven tress,
r softly lightens o'er her face;
re thoughts serenely sweet express,
ow pure, how dear their dwelling-place.

III.

on that cheek, and o'er that brow,
o soft, so calm, yet eloquent,

smiles that win, the tints that glow,
ut tell of days in goodness spent,
ind at peace with all below,
. heart whose love is innocent!

June 12, 1814.

THE HARP THE MONARCH MINSTREL SWEPT.

I.

HE Harp the Monarch Minstrel swept,^[1e]
The King of men, the loved of Heaven!
Whose Music hallowed while she wept
O'er tones her heart of hearts had given—
Doubled be her tears, its chords are riven!
Softened men of iron mould,
It gave them virtues not their own;
No ear so dull, no soul so cold,
That felt not—fired not to the tone,
David's Lyre grew mightier than his Throne!

II.

told the triumphs of our King,^[1f]
It wafted glory to our God;
Made our gladdened valleys ring,
The cedars bow, the mountains nod;
Sound aspired to Heaven and there abode!^[288]
Since then, though heard on earth no more,^[1g]
Devotion and her daughter Love
Still bid the bursting spirit soar
To sounds that seem as from above,
Beams that day's broad light can not remove.

IF THAT HIGH WORLD.

I.

That high world,^[289] which lies beyond
Our own, surviving Love endears;
Where the cherished heart be fond,

he eye the same, except in tears—
✓ welcome those untrodden spheres!
ow sweet this very hour to die!
oar from earth and find all fears
ost in thy light—Eternity!

II.

ust be so: 'tis not for self
hat we so tremble on the brink;
striving to o'erleap the gulf,
et cling to Being's severing link.^[1h]
in that future let us think
o hold each heart the heart that shares,
n them the immortal waters drink,
nd soul in soul grow deathless theirs!

THE WILD GAZELLE.

I.

wild gazelle on Judah's hills
xulting yet may bound,
drink from all the living rills
hat gush on holy ground;
iry step and glorious eye^[290]
✓ glance in tameless transport by:—

II.

ep as fleet, an eye more bright,
ath Judah witnessed there;
o'er her scenes of lost delight

inhabitants more fair.
cedars wave on Lebanon,
Judah's statelier maids are gone!

III.

we blest each palm that shades those plains
than Israel's scattered race;
taking root, it there remains
in solitary grace:
will not quit its place of birth,
will not live in other earth.

IV.

we must wander witheringly,
in other lands to die;
where our fathers' ashes be,
our own may never lie:
temple hath not left a stone,
Mockery sits on Salem's throne.

OH! WEEP FOR THOSE.

I.

weep for those that wept by Babel's stream,
whose shrines are desolate, whose land a dream;
weep for the harp of Judah's broken shell;
Horn—where their God hath dwelt the godless dwell!

II.

where shall Israel lave her bleeding feet?
when shall Zion's songs again seem sweet?
Judah's melody once more rejoice
hearts that leaped before its heavenly voice?

III.

es of the wandering foot and weary breast,
shall ye flee away and be at rest!
wild-dove hath her nest, the fox his cave,
kind their country—Israel but the grave!

ON JORDAN'S BANKS.

I.

Jordan's banks the Arab's camels stray,
Sion's hill the False One's votaries pray,
Baal-adorer bows on Sinai's steep—
there—even there—Oh God! thy thunders sleep:

II.

re—where thy finger scorched the tablet stone!
re—where thy shadow to thy people shone!
glory shrouded in its garb of fire:
self—none living see and not expire!

III.

in the lightning let thy glance appear;
ep from his shivered hand the oppressor's spear!
long by tyrants shall thy land be trod?

long thy temple worshipless, Oh God?

JEPHTHA'S DAUGHTER. ^[291]

I.

DE our Country, our God—Oh, my Sire!
and that thy Daughter expire;
e thy triumph was bought by thy vow—
e the bosom that's bared for thee now!

II.

the voice of my mourning is o'er,
the mountains behold me no more:
e hand that I love lay me low,
re cannot be pain in the blow!

III.

of this, oh, my Father! be sure—
t the blood of thy child is as pure
he blessing I beg ere it flow,
the last thought that soothes me below.

IV.

ugh the virgins of Salem lament,
he judge and the hero unbent!
ve won the great battle for thee,
my Father and Country are free!

V.

en this blood of thy giving hath gushed,
en the voice that thou lovest is hushed,
my memory still be thy pride,
forget not I smiled as I died!

OH! SNATCHED AWAY IN BEAUTY'S BLOOM. ^[292]

I.

H! snatched away in beauty's bloom,
n thee shall press no ponderous tomb;
But on thy turf shall roses rear
Their leaves, the earliest of the year;
the wild cypress wave in tender gloom: ^[li]

II.

nd oft by yon blue gushing stream
Shall Sorrow lean her drooping head, ^[lj]
nd feed deep thought with many a dream,
And lingering pause and lightly tread;
d wretch! as if her step disturbed the dead!

III.

y! we know that tears are vain,
hat Death nor heeds nor hears distress:
this unteach us to complain?
r make one mourner weep the less?
thou—who tell'st me to forget, ^[lk]
looks are wan, thine eyes are wet. ^{[ll][293]}

MY SOUL IS DARK.

I.

soul is dark—Oh! quickly string^[294]
he harp I yet can brook to hear;
let thy gentle fingers fling
s melting murmurs o'er mine ear.
this heart a hope be dear,
hat sound shall charm it forth again:
these eyes there lurk a tear,
'will flow, and cease to burn my brain.

II.

bid the strain be wild and deep,
or let thy notes of joy be first:
I thee, minstrel, I must weep,
r else this heavy heart will burst;
it hath been by sorrow nursed,
nd ached in sleepless silence long;
now 'tis doomed to know the worst,
nd break at once—or yield to song.^[295]

I SAW THEE WEEP.

I.

w thee weep—the big bright tear
ame o'er that eye of blue;^[296]
then methought it did appear
violet dropping dew:

As the smile—the sapphire's blaze
Beside thee ceased to shine;
Could not match the living rays
That filled that glance of thine.

II.

Clouds from yonder sun receive
A deep and mellow dye,
Which scarce the shade of coming eve
Can banish from the sky,
These smiles unto the moodiest mind
Their own pure joy impart;
Their sunshine leaves a glow behind
That lightens o'er the heart.

THY DAYS ARE DONE.

I.

Thy days are done, thy fame begun;
Thy country's strains record
Triumphs of her chosen Son,
The slaughters of his sword!
Deeds he did, the fields he won,
The freedom he restored!

II.

Though thou art fall'n, while we are free
Thou shalt not taste of death!
The generous blood that flowed from thee
Is dained to sink beneath:

in our veins its currents be,
thy spirit on our breath!

III.

name, our charging hosts along,
shall be the battle-word!
fall, the theme of choral song
from virgin voices poured!
weep would do thy glory wrong:
thou shalt not be deplored.

SAUL.

I.

THOU whose spell can raise the dead,
Bid the Prophet's form appear.
"Samuel, raise thy buried head!
King, behold the phantom Seer!"
He yawned; he stood the centre of a cloud:
It changed its hue, retiring from his shroud.^[1m]
He stood all glassy in his fixed eye;
His hand was withered, and his veins were dry;
His foot, in bony whiteness, glittered there,
His sinews and sinewless, and ghastly bare;
His lips that moved not and unbreathing frame,
The caverned winds, the hollow accents came.
He saw, and fell to earth, as falls the oak,
Once, and blasted by the thunder-stroke.^[1n]

II.

"Why is my sleep disquieted?
Who is he that calls the dead?
Is it thou, O King? Behold,
Bloodless are these limbs, and cold:^[lo]
Such are mine; and such shall be
Thine to-morrow, when with me:
Ere the coming day is done,
Such shalt thou be—such thy Son.
Fare thee well, but for a day,
Then we mix our mouldering clay.
Thou—thy race, lie pale and low,
Pierced by shafts of many a bow;
And the falchion by thy side
To thy heart thy hand shall guide:
Crownless—breathless—headless fall,
Son and Sire—the house of Saul!"^[297]

Seaham, *Feb.*, 1815.

SONG OF SAUL BEFORE HIS LAST BATTLE.

I.

WARRIORS and chiefs! should the shaft or the sword
ce me in leading the host of the Lord,
d not the corse, though a King's, in your path.^[lp]
y your steel in the bosoms of Gath!

II.

u who art bearing my buckler and bow,^[lq]
uld the soldiers of Saul look away from the foe,

teach me that moment in blood at thy feet!
I be the doom which they dared not to meet.

III.

Well to others, but never we part,
I to my Royalty—Son of my heart!^[1r]
Thou art the diadem, boundless the sway,
Facing singly the death, which awaits us to-day!

Seaham, 1815.

"ALL IS VANITY, SAITH THE PREACHER."

I.

FAME, Wisdom, Love, and Power were mine,
And Health and Youth possessed me;
My goblets blushed from every vine,
And lovely forms caressed me;
I sunned my heart in Beauty's eyes,
And felt my soul grow tender;
All Earth can give, or mortal prize,
Was mine of regal splendour.

II.

I strive to number o'er what days^[1s]
Remembrance can discover,
Which all that Life or Earth displays
Would lure me to live over.
There rose no day, there rolled no hour
Of pleasure unembittered;^[298]

And not a trapping decked my Power
That galled not while it glittered.

III. ^[lt]

The serpent of the field, by art
And spells, is won from harming;
But that which coils around the heart,
Oh! who hath power of charming?
It will not list to Wisdom's lore,
Nor Music's voice can lure it;
But there it stings for evermore
The soul that must endure it.

Seaham, 1815.

WHEN COLDNESS WRAPS THIS SUFFERING CLAY.

I.

EN coldness wraps this suffering clay, ^[lu]
h! whither strays the immortal mind?
nnot die, it cannot stay,
ut leaves its darkened dust behind.
n, unembodied, doth it trace
y steps each planet's heavenly way? ^[lv]
ill at once the realms of space,
. thing of eyes, that all survey?

II.

nal—boundless,—undecayed,
. thought unseen, but seeing all,

all in earth, or skies displayed,^[lw]
shall it survey, shall it recall:
a fainter trace that Memory holds
so darkly of departed years,
one broad glance the Soul beholds,
and all, that was, at once appears.

III.

More Creation peopled earth,
his eye shall roll through chaos back;
where the farthest heaven had birth,
the Spirit trace its rising track.
where the future mars or makes,
his glance dilate o'er all to be,
the Sun is quenched—or System breaks,
fixed in its own Eternity.

IV.

Love or Love—Hope—Hate—or Fear,
lives all passionless and pure:
age shall fleet like earthly year;
so years as moments shall endure.
fly—away—without a wing,
'er all—through all—its thought shall fly,
timeless and eternal thing,
forgetting what it was to die.

Seaham, 1815.

VISION OF BELSHAZZAR.^[299]

I.

King was on his throne,
he Satraps thronged the hall.^[lx]
ousand bright lamps shone
'er that high festival.
ousand cups of gold,
i Judah deemed divine—^[ly]
ovah's vessels hold
he godless Heathen's wine!

II.

at same hour and hall,
he fingers of a hand
ie forth against the wall,
nd wrote as if on sand:
fingers of a man;—
solitary hand
ng the letters ran,
nd traced them like a wand.

III.

monarch saw, and shook,
nd bade no more rejoice;
bloodless waxed his look,
nd tremulous his voice.
the men of lore appear,
he wisest of the earth,
expound the words of fear,
hich mar our royal mirth."

IV.

Idea's seers are good,
but here they have no skill;
the unknown letters stood
untold and awful still.
Babel's men of age
were wise and deep in lore;
now they were not sage,
they saw—but knew no more.

V.

captive in the land,
a stranger and a youth,^[300]
heard the King's command,
he saw that writing's truth.
Lamps around were bright,
the prophecy in view;
read it on that night,—
the morrow proved it true.

VI.

Ishtar's grave is made,^[12]
his kingdom passed away.
In the balance weighed,
light and worthless clay;
shroud, his robe of state,
his canopy the stone;
Mede is at his gate!
The Persian on his throne!"

SUN OF THE SLEEPLESS!

of the sleepless! melancholy star!
whose tearful beam glows tremulously far,
that show'st the darkness thou canst not dispel,
how like art thou to Joy remembered well!
gleams the past, the light of other days,
which shines, but warms not with its powerless rays:
bright-beam Sorrow watcheth to behold,
instruct, but distant—clear—but, oh how cold!

WERE MY BOSOM AS FALSE AS THOU
DEEM'ST IT TO BE.

I.

Were my bosom as false as thou deem'st it to be,
I had not have wandered from far Galilee;
as but abjuring my creed to efface
the curse which, thou say'st, is the crime of my race.

II.

Thou hadst never triumph, then God is with thee!
Thou slave only sin—thou art spotless and free!
Thou Exile on earth is an Outcast on high,
I live on in thy faith—but in mine I will die.

III.

I have lost for that faith more than thou canst bestow,
The God who permits thee to prosper doth know;
His hand is my heart and my hope—and in thine
land and the life which for him I resign.

HEROD'S LAMENT FOR MARIAMNE. ^[301]

I.

Mariamne! now for thee
he heart for which thou bled'st is bleeding;
enge is lost in Agony^[ma]
nd wild Remorse to rage succeeding.^[mb]
Mariamne! where art thou?
hou canst not hear my bitter pleading:^[mc]
could'st thou—thou would'st pardon now,
hough Heaven were to my prayer unheeding.

II.

. is she dead?—and did they dare
bey my Frenzy's jealous raving?^[md]
Wrath but doomed my own despair:
he sword that smote her 's o'er me waving.—
thou art cold, my murdered Love!
nd this dark heart is vainly craving^[me]
he who soars alone above,
nd leaves my soul unworthy saving.

III.

s gone, who shared my diadem;
he sunk, with her my joys entombing;
ept that flower from Judah's stem,
hose leaves for me alone were blooming;

mine's the guilt, and mine the hell,
his bosom's desolation dooming;
I have earned those tortures well,^[mf]
Which unconsumed are still consuming!

Jan. 15, 1815.

ON THE DAY OF THE DESTRUCTION OF JERUSALEM BY TITUS.

I.

From the last hill that looks on thy once holy dome,^[mg]
I held thee, oh Sion! when rendered to Rome:^[mh]
As thy last sun went down, and the flames of thy fall
I held back on the last glance I gave to thy wall.

II.

I looked for thy temple—I looked for my home,
I forgot for a moment my bondage to come;^[mi]
I held but the death-fire that fed on thy fane,
I the fast-fettered hands that made vengeance in vain.

III.

Many an eve, the high spot whence I gazed
I reflected the last beam of day as it blazed;
When I stood on the height, and beheld the decline
The rays from the mountain that shone on thy shrine.

IV.

. now on that mountain I stood on that day,
I marked not the twilight beam melting away;
would that the lightning had glared in its stead,
. the thunderbolt burst on the Conqueror's head!^[mj]

V.

the Gods of the Pagan shall never profane
shrine where Jehovah disdained not to reign;
. scattered and scorned as thy people may be,
worship, oh Father! is only for thee.

1815.

BY THE RIVERS OF BABYLON WE SAT
DOWN AND WEPT.^[302]

I.

sate down and wept by the waters^[303]
f Babel, and thought of the day
en our foe, in the hue of his slaughters,
lade Salem's high places his prey;
. Ye, oh her desolate daughters!
ere scattered all weeping away.

II.

le sadly we gazed on the river
hich rolled on in freedom below,
y demanded the song; but, oh never
hat triumph the Stranger shall know!^[mk]

⁂ this right hand be withered for ever,
re it string our high harp for the foe!

III.

he willow that harp is suspended,
h Salem! its sound should be free;^[ml]
the hour when thy glories were ended
ut left me that token of thee:
ne'er shall its soft tones be blended
⁂ith the voice of the Spoiler by me!

Jan. 15, 1813.

"BY THE WATERS OF BABYLON."

I.

ne valley of waters we wept on the day
en the host of the Stranger made Salem his prey;
our heads on our bosoms all droopingly lay,
our hearts were so full of the land far away!

II.

song they demanded in vain—it lay still
ur souls as the wind that hath died on the hill—
y called for the harp—but our blood they shall spill
our right hands shall teach them one tone of their skill.

III.

stringlessly hung in the willow's sad tree,
lead as her dead-leaf, those mute harps must be:

hands may be fettered—our tears still are free
our God—and our Glory—and Sion, Oh *Thee*!

1815.

THE DESTRUCTION OF SENNACHERIB.

I.

Assyrian came down like the wolf on the fold,
his cohorts were gleaming in purple and gold;
the sheen of their spears was like stars on the sea,
on the blue wave rolls nightly on deep Galilee.

II.

the leaves of the forest when Summer is green,
the host with their banners at sunset were seen:
the leaves of the forest when Autumn hath blown,^[304]
the host on the morrow lay withered and strown.

III.

the Angel of Death spread his wings on the blast,
breathed in the face of the foe as he passed;
the eyes of the sleepers waxed deadly and chill,
their hearts but once heaved—and for ever grew still!

IV.

there lay the steed with his nostril all wide,
through it there rolled not the breath of his pride;
the foam of his gasping lay white on the turf,^[mm]
cold as the spray of the rock-beating surf.^[mn]

V.

there lay the rider distorted and pale,
the dew on his brow, and the rust on his mail:^[mo]
the tents were all silent—the banners alone—
lances unlifted—the trumpet unblown.

VI.

the widows of Ashur are loud in their wail,^[mp]
the idols are broke in the temple of Baal;
the might of the Gentile, unsmote by the sword,^[mq]
melted like snow in the glance of the Lord!

Seaham, Feb. 17, 1815.

A SPIRIT PASSED BEFORE ME.

FROM JOB.

I.

SPIRIT passed before me: I beheld
face of Immortality unveiled—
p Sleep came down on every eye save mine—
there it stood,—all formless—but divine:
ing my bones the creeping flesh did quake;
as my damp hair stiffened, thus it spake:

II.

man more just than God? Is man more pure
than he who deems even Seraphs insecure?
creatures of clay—vain dwellers in the dust!

moth survives you, and are ye more just?
ings of a day! you wither ere the night,
dless and blind to Wisdom's wasted light!"

FOOTNOTES:

[287] {381} [In a manuscript note to a letter of Byron's, dated June 11, 1814, Wedderburn Webster writes, "I *did* take him to Lady Sitwell's party.... He there for the first time saw his cousin, the beautiful Mrs. Wilmot [who had appeared in mourning with numerous spangles in her dress]. When we returned to ... the Albany, he ... desired Fletcher to give him a *tumbler of brandy*, which he drank at once to Mrs. Wilmot's health.... The next day he wrote some charming lines upon her, 'She walks in beauty,' etc."—*Letters*, 1899, iii. 92, note 1.

Anne Beatrix, daughter and co-heiress of Eusebius Horton, of Catton Hall, Derbyshire, married Byron's second cousin, Robert John Wilmot (1784-1841), son of Sir Robert Wilmot of Osmaston, by Juliana, second daughter of the Hon. John Byron, and widow of the Hon. William Byron. She died February 4, 1871.

Nathan (*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, pp. 2, 3) has a note to the effect that Byron, while arranging the first edition of the *Melodies*, used to ask for this song, and would not unfrequently join in its execution.]

[le] {382}

*The Harp the Minstrel Monarch swept,
The first of men, the loved of Heaven,
Which Music cherished while she wept.*—[MS. M.]

[lf] {383} *It told the Triumph*——.—[MS. M.]

[288] ["When Lord Byron put the copy into my hand, it terminated with this line. This, however, did not complete the verse, and I asked him to help out the melody. He replied, 'Why, I have sent you to Heaven—it would be difficult to go further!' My attention for a few moments was called to some other person, and his Lordship, whom I had hardly missed, exclaimed, 'Here, Nathan, I have brought you down again;' and immediately presented me the beautiful and sublime lines which conclude the melody."—*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, p. 33.]

[lg]

*It there abode, and there it rings,
But ne'er on earth its sound shall be;
The prophets' race hath passed away;
And all the hallowed minstrelsy—
From earth the sound and soul are fled,
And shall we never hear again?—*[MS. M. erased.]

[289] [According to Nathan, the monosyllable "if" at the beginning of the first line led to "numerous attacks on the noble author's religion, and in some an inference of atheism was drawn."

Needless to add, "in a subsequent conversation," Byron repels this charge, and delivers himself of some admirable if commonplace sentiments on the "grand perhaps."-*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, pp. 5, 6.]

[lh] {384} ——*breaking link.*—[Nathan, 1815, 1829.]

[290] [Compare *To Ianthe*, stanza iv. lines 1, 2—

"Oh! let that eye, which, wild as the Gazelle's,
Now brightly bold or beautifully shy."

Compare, too, *The Giaour*, lines 473, 474—

"Her eye's dark charm 'twere vain to tell,
But gaze on that of the Gazelle."

Poetical Works, 1899, ii. 13; *et ante*, p. 108.]

[291] {387} [Nathan (*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, pp. 11, 12) seems to have tried to draw Byron into a discussion on the actual fate of Jephtha's daughter—death at her father's hand, or "perpetual seclusion"—and that Byron had no opinion to offer. "Whatever may be the absolute state of the case, I am innocent of her blood; she has been killed to my hands;" and again, "Well, my hands are not imbrued in her blood!"]

[292] {388} ["In submitting the melody to his Lordship's judgment, I once inquired in what manner they might refer to any scriptural subject: he appeared for a moment affected—at last replied, 'Every mind must make its own references; there is scarcely one of us who could not imagine that the affliction belongs to himself, to me it certainly belongs.' 'She is no more, and perhaps the only vestige of her existence is the feeling I sometimes fondly indulge.'"—*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, p. 30. It has been surmised that the lines contain a final reminiscence of the mysterious Thyrsa.]

[li] ——in gentle gloom.—[MS. M.]

[lj]

*Shall Sorrow on the waters gaze,
And lost in deep remembrance dream,
As if her footsteps could disturb the dead.*—[MS. M.]

[lk] {389} *Even thou*——.—[MS. M.]

[ll]

IV.

*Nor need I write to tell the tale,
My pen were doubly weak;
Oh what can idle words avail,
Unless my heart could speak?*

V.

*By day or night, in weal or woe,
That heart no longer free
Must bear the love it cannot show,
And silent turn for thee.*—[MS. M.]

[293] [Compare "Nay, now, pry'thee weep no more! you know, ... that 'tis sinful to murmur at ... Providence."—"And should not that reflection check your own, my Blanche?"—"Why are your cheeks so wet? Fie! fie, my child!"—*Romantic Tales*, by M. G. Lewis, 1808, i. 53.]

[294] [Compare "My soul is dark."—Ossian, "Oina-Morul," *The Works of Ossian*, 1765, ii. 279.]

[295] {390} ["It was generally conceived that Lord Byron's reported singularities approached on some occasions to derangement; and at one period, indeed, it was very currently asserted that his intellects were actually impaired. The report only served to amuse his Lordship. He referred to the circumstance, and declared that he would try how a *Madman* could write: seizing the pen with eagerness, he for a moment fixed his eyes in majestic wildness on vacancy; when, like a flash of inspiration, without erasing a single word, the above verses were the result."—*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, p. 37.]

[296] [Compare the first *Sonnet to Genevra* (addressed to Lady Frances Wedderburn Webster), "Thine eye's blue tenderness."]

[lm] {392}

*He stands amidst an earthly cloud,
And the mist mantled o'er his floating shroud.*—[MS. erased.]

[ln] *At once and scorched beneath*——.—[MS. Copy (1, 2).]

[lo] *Bloodless are these bones*——.—[MS.]

[297] ["Since we have spoken of witches," said Lord Byron at Cephalonia, in 1823, "what think you of the witch of Endor? I have always thought this the finest and most finished witch-scene that ever was written or conceived; and you will be of my opinion, if you consider all the circumstances and the actors in the case, together with the gravity, simplicity, and dignity of the language."—*Conversations on Religion with Lord Byron*, by James Kennedy, M.D., London, 1830, p. 154.]

[lp] {393} *Heed not the carcase that lies in your path.*—[MS. Copy (1).]

[lq]

——*my shield and my bow,
Should the ranks of your king look away from the foe.*—[MS.]

[lr] {394}

Heir to my monarchy——.—[MS.]
Note to *Heir*—Jonathan.—[Copy.]

[ls]

*My father was the shepherd's son,
Ah were my lot as lowly
My earthly course had softly run.*—[MS.]

[298] {395} [Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto I. stanza lxxxii. lines 8, 9—

"Full from the fount of Joy's delicious springs
Some bitter o'er the flowers its bubbling venom flings."

Poetical Works, 1899, ii. 73, and note 16, p. 93.]

[lt]

*Ah! what hath been but what shall be,
The same dull scene renewing?
And all our fathers were are we
In erring and undoing.*—[MS.]

[lu] *When this corroding clay is gone.*—[MS. erased.]

[lv] *The stars in their eternal way.*—[MS. L. erased.]

[lw] {396} *A conscious light that can pervade.*—[MS. erased.]

[299] {397} [Compare the lines entitled "Belshazzar" (*vide post*, [p. 421](#)), and *Don Juan*, Canto III. stanza lxv.]

[lx] *——in the hall.*—[Copy.]

[ly] *In Israel——.*—[Copy.]

[300] {398} [It was not in his youth, but in extreme old age, that Daniel interpreted the "writing on the wall."]

[lz] *Oh king thy grave——.*—[Copy erased.]

[301] {400} [Mariamne, the wife of Herod the Great, falling under the suspicion of infidelity, was put to death by his order. Ever after, Herod was haunted by the image of the murdered Mariamne, until disorder of the mind brought on disorder of body, which led to temporary derangement. See *History of the Jews*, by H. H. Milman, 1878, pp. 236, 237. See, too, Voltaire's drama, *Mariamne*, *passim*.

Nathan, wishing "to be favoured with so many lines pathetic, some playful, others martial, etc.... one evening ... unfortunately (while absorbed for a moment in worldly affairs) requested so many *dull* lines—meaning *plaintive*." Byron instantly caught at the expression, and exclaimed, "Well, Nathan! you have at length set me an easy task," and before parting presented him with "these beautifully pathetic lines, saying, 'Here, Nathan, I think you will find these *dull* enough.'"—*Fugitive Pieces*, 1829, p. 51.]

[ma]

And what was rage is agony.—[MS. erased.]

Revenge is turned——.—[MS.]

[mb] *And deep Remorse——.*—[MS.]

[mc] *And what am I thy tyrant pleading.*—[MS. erased.]

[md]

Thou art not dead—they could not dare

Obey my jealous Frenzy's raving.—[MS.]

[me] *But yet in death my soul enslaving.*—[MS. erased.]

[mf] {401} *Oh I have earned——.*—[MS.]

[mg] *——that looks o'er thy once holy dome.*—[MS.]

[mh]

——o'er thy once holy wall

I beheld thee O Sion the day of thy fall.—[MS. erased.]

[mi] *And forgot in their ruin——.*—[MS. erased.]

[mj] {402}

And the red bolt——.—[MS. erased.]

And the thunderbolt crashed——.—[MS.]

[302] [The following note, in Byron's handwriting, is prefixed to the copy in Lady Byron's handwriting:—

"Dear Kinnaid,—Take only *one* of these marked 1 and 2 [i.e. 'By the Rivers,' etc.; and 'By the waters,' vide [p. 404](#)], as both are but different versions of the *same thought*—leave the choice to any important person you like.

Yours,

B."]

[303] [Landon, in his "Dialogue between Southey and Porson" (*Works*, 1846, i. 69), attempted to throw ridicule on the opening lines of this "Melody."

"A prey in 'the hue of his slaughters'! This is very pathetic; but not more so than the thought it suggested to me, which is plainer—

'We sat down and wept by the waters

Of Camus, and thought of the day

When damsels would show their red garters

In their hurry to scamper away.'"]

[mk] {403}

Our mute harps were hung on the willow

That grew by the stream of our foe,

And in sadness we gazed on each billow

That rolled on in freedom below.—[MS, erased.]

[[m](#)]

*On the willow that harp still hangs mutely
Oh Salem its sound was for thee.*—[MS. erased.]

[[304](#)] {405} [Compare—"As leaves in autumn, so the bodies fell." *The Barons' Wars*, by Michael Drayton, Bk. II. stanza lvii.; Anderson's *British Poets*, iii. 38.]

[[mm](#)] *And the foam of his bridle lay cold on the earth.*—[MS.]

[[mn](#)] *—of the cliff-beating surf.*—[MS.]

[[mo](#)] *With the crow on his breast—.*—[MS.]

[[mp](#)] *And the widows of Babel—.*—[MS. erased.]

[[mq](#)] *And the voices of Israel are joyous and high.*—[MS. erased.]

POEMS 1814-1816.

POEMS 1814-1816.



FAREWELL! IF EVER FONDEST PRAYER.

1.

EWELL! if ever fondest prayer
or other's weal availed on high,
e will not all be lost in air,
ut waft thy name beyond the sky.
re vain to speak—to weep—to sigh:
h! more than tears of blood can tell,
en wrung from Guilt's expiring eye,^[305]
re in that word—Farewell!—Farewell!

2.

se lips are mute, these eyes are dry;
ut in my breast and in my brain,
ike the pangs that pass not by,
he thought that ne'er shall sleep again.
soul nor deigns nor dares complain,
hough Grief and Passion there rebel:
ly know we loved in vain—
only feel—Farewell!—Farewell!

WHEN WE TWO PARTED.

1.

When we two parted
In silence and tears,
Half broken-hearted
To sever for years,
Cold grew thy cheek and cold,
And older thy kiss;
Better that hour foretold^[mr]
Than sorrow to this.

2.

Dark dew of the morning^[ms]
Fell chill on my brow—
It like the warning
Of what I feel now.
Thy vows are all broken,^[mt]
And light is thy fame:
For thy name spoken,
I share in its shame.

3.^[mu]

Thy name thee before me,
A knell to mine ear;
A sadder comes o'er me—
Why wert thou so dear?
They know not I knew thee,

Who knew thee too well:—
g, long shall I rue thee,
so deeply to tell.

4.

Secret we met—
In silence I grieve.
That thy heart could forget,
Thy spirit deceive.
How should I meet thee^[mv]
After long years,
Nor should I greet thee?—
With silence and tears.

[First published, *Poems*, 1816.]

[LOVE AND GOLD.^[306]]

1.

Do not talk of Love to thee,
Though thou art young and free and fair!
There is a spell thou dost not see,
That bids a genuine love despair.

2.

Yet that spell invites each youth,
Or thee to sigh, or seem to sigh;
Where falsehood wear the garb of truth,
And Truth itself appear a lie.

3.

Never Doubt a place possess
In woman's heart, 'twere wise in thine:
Put not Love into thy breast,
Doubt others' love, nor trust in mine.

4.

Perchance 'tis feigned, perchance sincere,
But false or true thou canst not tell;
Much hast thou from all to fear,
In that unconquerable spell.

5.

All the herd that throng around,
By simpering or thy sighing train,
Can tell me who to thee is bound
By Love's or Plutus' heavier chain.

6.

Some 'tis Nature, some 'tis Art
That bids them worship at thy shrine;
Thou deserv'st a better heart,
Than they or I can give for thine.

7.

Thee, and such as thee, behold,
O Fortune painted truly—blind!
O doomed thee to be bought or sold,
As proved too bounteous to be kind.

8.

One day some tempter's crafty suit
Would woo thee to a loveless bed:
He thee to the altar's foot
A decorated victim led.

9.

Oh, dear maid! I must not speak
Whatever my secret thoughts may be;
Though thou art all that man can reckon
I dare not talk of Love to *thee*.

STANZAS FOR MUSIC. ^[307]

1.

Speak not, I trace not, I breathe not thy name, ^[mw]
There is grief in the sound, there is guilt in the fame:
The tear which now burns on my cheek may impart
Deep thoughts that dwell in that silence of heart.

2. ^[mx]

Brief for our passion, too long for our peace,
Are those hours—can their joy or their bitterness cease?
Repent, we abjure, we will break from our chain,—
We will part, we will fly to—unite it again!

3.

Thine be the gladness, and mine be the guilt! ^[my]

give me, adored one!—forsake, if thou wilt;—
the heart which is thine shall expire undebased^[mz]
man shall not break it—whatever *thou* mayst.^[na]

4.

stern to the haughty, but humble to thee,
soul, in its bitterest blackness, shall be:^[nb]
our days seem as swift, and our moments more sweet,
than thee by my side, than with worlds at our feet.

5.^[nc]

sigh of thy sorrow, one look of thy love,^[nd]
shall turn me or fix, shall reward or reprove;
the heartless may wonder at all I resign—
my lip shall reply, not to them, but to *mine*.

May 4, 1814.

[First published, *Letters and Journals*, 1830, i. 554.]

ADDRESS INTENDED TO BE RECITED AT THE CALEDONIAN MEETING.^[308]

It hath not glowed above the page where Fame
has fixed high Caledon's unconquered name;
the mountain-land which spurned the Roman chain,
has baffled back the fiery-crested Dane,
the brave bright claymore and hardihood of hand
no foe could tame—no tyrant could command?
The race is gone—but still their children breathe,
and Glory crowns them with redoubled wreath:

Gael and Saxon mingling banners shine,
, England! add their stubborn strength to thine.
blood which flowed with Wallace flows as free,
now 'tis only shed for Fame and thee!
pass not by the northern veteran's claim,
give support—the world hath given him fame!

humbler ranks, the lowly brave, who bled
le cheerly following where the Mighty led—^[309]
o sleep beneath the undistinguished sod
re happier comrades in their triumph trod,
is bequeath—'tis all their fate allows—
sireless offspring and the lonely spouse:
on high Albyn's dusky hills may raise
tearful eye in melancholy gaze,
iew, while shadowy auguries disclose
Highland Seer's anticipated woes,
bleeding phantom of each martial form
in the cloud, or darkling in the storm;^[310]
le sad, she chaunts the solitary song,
soft lament for him who tarries long—
him, whose distant relics vainly crave
Coronach's wild requiem to the brave!

Heaven—not man—must charm away the woe,
ch bursts when Nature's feelings newly flow;
Tenderness and Time may rob the tear
ialf its bitterness for one so dear;
ation's gratitude perchance may spread
ornless pillow for the widowed head;
r lighten well her heart's maternal care,
wean from Penury the soldier's heir;

leem to living war-worn Valour just^[311]
n wounded remnant—Albion's cherished trust—
m his decline with those endearing rays,
ose bounteous sunshine yet may gild his days—
hall that Country—while he sinks to rest—
hand hath fought for—by his heart be blest!

May, 1814.

[First published, *Letters and Journals*, 1830, i. 559.]

ELEGIAC STANZAS ON THE DEATH OF
SIR PETER PARKER, BART.^[312]

I.

RE is a tear for all that die,^[313]
mourner o'er the humblest grave;
nations swell the funeral cry,
nd Triumph weeps above the brave.

2.

them is Sorrow's purest sigh
'er Ocean's heaving bosom sent:
ain their bones unburied lie,
ll earth becomes their monument!

3.

mb is theirs on every page,
n epitaph on every tongue:
present hours, the future age,
or them bewail, to them belong.

4.

them the voice of festal mirth
rows hushed, *their name* the only sound;
le deep Remembrance pours to Worth
he goblet's tributary round.

5.

eme to crowds that knew them not,
amented by admiring foes,
o would not share their glorious lot?
/ho would not die the death they chose?

6.

, gallant Parker! thus enshrined
hy life, thy fall, thy fame shall be;
early valour, glowing, find
model in thy memory.

7.

there are breasts that bleed with thee
i woe, that glory cannot quell;
shuddering hear of victory,
/here one so dear, so dauntless, fell.

8.

re shall they turn to mourn thee less?
/hen cease to hear thy cherished name?
e cannot teach forgetfulness,
/hile Grief's full heart is fed by Fame.

9.

! for them, though not for thee,
hey cannot choose but weep the more;
p for the dead the grief must be,
/ho ne'er gave cause to mourn before.

October 7, 1814.

[First published, *Morning Chronicle*, October 7, 1814.]

JULIAN [A FRAGMENT]. ^[314]

1.

Night came on the Waters—all was rest
Earth—but Rage on Ocean's troubled Heart.
Waves arose and rolled beneath the blast;
Sailors gazed upon their shivered Mast.
At dark Hour a long loud gathered cry
From out the billows pierced the sable sky,
And borne o'er breakers reached the craggy shore—
Sea roars on—that Cry is heard no more.

2.

There is no vestige, in the Dawning light,
Of those that shrieked thro' shadows of the Night.
Bark—the Crew—the very Wreck is gone,
And red—mutilated—traceless—all save one.
And him there still is Life, the Wave that dashed
Against the shore the plank to which his form was lashed,
And turned unheeding of its helpless Prey—
The lone survivor of that Yesterday—

one of Many whom the withering Gale
left unpunished to record their Tale.
who shall hear it? on that barren Sand
e comes to stretch the hospitable hand.
t shore reveals no print of human foot,
e'en the pawing of the wilder Brute;
niggard vegetation will not smile,
unless on that solitary Isle.

3.

naked Stranger rose, and wrung his hair,
that first moment passed in silent prayer.
s! the sound—he sunk into Despair—
was on Earth—but what was Earth to him,
seless and homeless—bare both breast and limb?
off from all but Memory he curst
fate—his folly—but himself the worst.
it was his hope? he looked upon the Wave—
pite—of all—it still may be his Grave!

4.

rose and with a feeble effort shaped
course unto the billows—late escaped:
weakness conquered—swam his dizzy glance,
down to Earth he sunk in silent trance.
v long his senses bore its chilling chain,
knew not—but, recalled to Life again,
ranger stood beside his shivering form—
what was he? had he too scaped the storm?

5.

raised young Julian. "Is thy Cup so full
bitterness—thy Hope—thy heart so dull
that thou shouldst from Thee dash the Draught of Life,
that have escaped the elemental strife!
—tho' these shores few aids to Life supply,
look upon me, and know thou shalt not die.
If thou gazest in mute wonder—more may be
thy marvel when thou knowest mine and me.
I come—The bark that bears us hence shall find
Haven, soon, despite the warning Wind."

6.

raised young Julian from the sand, and such
wondrous power of healing dwelt within the touch,
that his weak limbs grew light with freshened Power,
that he had slept not fainted in that hour,
that he woke from Slumber—as the Birds awake,
that he called at morning from the branched brake,
that on the day's promise heralds early Spring,
that Heaven unfolded woos their soaring wing:
Julian felt, and gazed upon his Guide,
in honest Wonder what might next betide.

Dec. 12, 1814.

TO BELSHAZZAR.

1. ^[ne]

BELSHAZZAR! from the banquet turn,
or in thy sensual fulness fall;
hold! while yet before thee burn

he graven words, the glowing wall,^[nf]
y a despot men miscall
rowned and anointed from on high;
thou, the weakest, worst of all—
it not written, thou must die?^[ng]

2.

dash the roses from thy brow—
rey hairs but poorly wreath with them;
th's garlands misbecome thee now,
lore than thy very diadem,^[nh]
ere thou hast tarnished every gem:—
hen throw the worthless bauble by,
ch, worn by thee, ev'n slaves condemn;
nd learn like better men to die!

3.

early in the balance weighed,
nd ever light of word and worth,
ose soul expired ere youth decayed,
nd left thee but a mass of earth.
ee thee moves the scorner's mirth:
ut tears in Hope's averted eye
ient that even thou hadst birth—
nfit to govern, live, or die.

February 12, 1815.
[First published, 1831.]

STANZAS FOR MUSIC.^[315]

"O Lachrymarum fons, tenero sacros
Ducentium ortus ex animo: quater
Felix! in imo qui scatentem
Pectore te, pia Nympha, sensit."

GRAY'S *Poemata*.

[Motto to "The Tear," *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 49.]

1.

RE'S not a joy the world can give like that it takes away,
en the glow of early thought declines in Feeling's dull decay;
not on Youth's smooth cheek the blush alone, which fades so fast,^[ni]
the tender bloom of heart is gone, ere Youth itself be past.

2.

n the few whose spirits float above the wreck of happiness
driven o'er the shoals of guilt or ocean of excess:
magnet of their course is gone, or only points in vain
shore to which their shivered sail shall never stretch again.

3.

n the mortal coldness of the soul like Death itself comes down;
nnot feel for others' woes, it dare not dream its own;
t heavy chill has frozen o'er the fountain of our tears,
though the eye may sparkle still, 'tis where the ice appears.

4.

ugh wit may flash from fluent lips, and mirth distract the breast,
ough midnight hours that yield no more their former hope of rest;
but as ivy-leaves around the ruined turret wreath^{[nj][316]}
green and wildly fresh without, but worn and grey beneath.

5.

could I feel as I have felt,—or be what I have been,
weep as I could once have wept, o'er many a vanished scene;
springs in deserts found seem sweet, all brackish though they be,
midst the withered waste of life, those tears would flow to me.

March, 1815.
[First published, *Poems*, 1816.]

ON THE DEATH OF THE DUKE OF DORSET. ^[317]

1.

ARD thy fate without a tear,
thy loss with scarce a sigh;
yet thou wast surpassing dear,
so loved of all to die.
How not what hath seared my eye—
its tears refuse to start;
every drop, it bids me dry,
all dreary on my heart.

2.

dull and heavy, one by one,
they sink and turn to care,
ravenned waters wear the stone,
yet dropping harden there:
they cannot petrify more fast,
than feelings sunk remain,
which coldly fixed regard the past,
but never melt again.

STANZAS FOR MUSIC.

1.

IGHT be the place of thy soul!
o lovelier spirit than thine
burst from its mortal control,
the orbs of the blessed to shine.
earth thou wert all but divine,
s thy soul shall immortally be,^[nk]
our sorrow may cease to repine
hen we know that thy God is with thee.

2.

it be the turf of thy tomb!^{[nl][318]}
lay its verdure like emeralds be!^[nm]
re should not be the shadow of gloom
ought that reminds us of thee.
ng flowers and an evergreen tree^[nn]
lay spring from the spot of thy rest:
nor cypress nor yew let us see;
or why should we mourn for the blest?

[First published, *Examiner*, June 4, 1815.]

NAPOLEON'S FAREWELL.^[319]

[FROM THE FRENCH.]

1.

EWELL to the Land, where the gloom of my Glory
se and o'ershadowed the earth with her name—
abandons me now—but the page of her story,
brightest or blackest, is filled with my fame.^[no]
ve warred with a World which vanquished me only
en the meteor of conquest allured me too far;
ve coped with the nations which dread me thus lonely,
last single Captive to millions in war.

2.

Well to thee, France! when thy diadem crowned me,
ide thee the gem and the wonder of earth,—
thy weakness decrees I should leave as I found thee,^[np]
ayed in thy glory, and sunk in thy worth.
for the veteran hearts that were wasted
rife with the storm, when their battles were won—
n the Eagle, whose gaze in that moment was blasted
still soared with eyes fixed on Victory's sun!^[nq]

3.

Well to thee, France!—but when Liberty rallies
e more in thy regions, remember me then,—
Violet still grows in the depth of thy valleys;
ugh withered, thy tear will unfold it again—
yet, I may baffle the hosts that surround us,
yet may thy heart leap awake to my voice—
re are links which must break in the chain that has bound us,
n turn thee and call on the Chief of thy choice!

July 25, 1815. London.

FROM THE FRENCH. ^[320]

I.

ST thou go, my glorious Chief,
evered from thy faithful few?
o can tell thy warrior's grief,
laddening o'er that long adieu?^[nr]
nan's love, and Friendship's zeal,
ear as both have been to me—^[ns]
at are they to all I feel,
/ith a soldier's faith for thee?^[nt]

II.

of the soldier's soul!
irst in fight, but mightiest now;^[nu]
y could a world control;
hee alone no doom can bow.
hy side for years I dared
eath; and envied those who fell,
en their dying shout was heard,
lessing him they served so well.^[321]

III.

ild that I were cold with those,
ince this hour I live to see;
en the doubts of coward foes^[nv]
carce dare trust a man with thee,

adding each should set thee free!
Oh! although in dungeons pent,
their chains were light to me,
azing on thy soul unbent.

IV.

ould the sycophants of him
ow so deaf to duty's prayer,^[nw]
e his borrowed glories dim,
his native darkness share?
e that world this hour his own,
ll thou calmly dost resign,
ld he purchase with that throne
earts like those which still are thine?^[nx]

V.

Chief, my King, my Friend, adieu!
ever did I droop before;
er to my Sovereign sue,
s his foes I now implore:
I ask is to divide
very peril he must brave;
ing by the hero's side
is fall—his exile—and his grave.^[ny]

[First published, *Poems*, 1816,]

ODE FROM THE FRENCH.^[322]

I.

do not curse thee, Waterloo!
ugh Freedom's blood thy plain bedew;
re 'twas shed, but is not sunk—
ng from each gory trunk,
e the water-spout from ocean,
n a strong and growing motion—
ars, and mingles in the air,
n that of lost La Bédoyère—^[323]
n that of him whose honoured grave
tains the "bravest of the brave."
imson cloud it spreads and glows,
shall return to whence it rose;
en 'tis full 'twill burst asunder—
er yet was heard such thunder
hen shall shake the world with wonder—
er yet was seen such lightning
o'er heaven shall then be bright'ning!
e the Wormwood Star foretold
y the sainted Seer of old,
w'ring down a fiery flood,
ning rivers into blood.^[324]

II.

Chief has fallen, but not by you,
quishers of Waterloo!
en the soldier citizen
yed not o'er his fellow-men—
e in deeds that led them on
re Glory smiled on Freedom's son—
o, of all the despots banded,
/ith that youthful chief competed?

Who could boast o'er France defeated,
lone Tyranny commanded?
goaded by Ambition's sting,
Hero sunk into the King?
On he fell:—so perish all,
Should men by man enthrall!

III.

Thou, too, of the snow-white plume!
Whose realm refused thee ev'n a tomb;^[325]
Ever hadst thou still been leading
Ice o'er hosts of hirelings bleeding,
Who sold thyself to death and shame
A meanly royal name;
Not as he of Naples wears,
Who thy blood-bought title bears.
He didst thou deem, when dashing
On thy war-horse through the ranks.
Like a stream which burst its banks,
The helmets cleft, and sabres clashing,
He and shivered fast around thee—
The fate at last which found thee:
That haughty plume laid low
By a slave's dishonest blow?
He—as the Moon sways o'er the tide,
Llled in air, the warrior's guide;
Through the smoke-created night
The black and sulphurous fight,
The soldier raised his seeking eye
To catch that crest's ascendancy,—
As it onward rolling rose,

noved his heart upon our foes.
re, where death's brief pang was quickest,
the battle's wreck lay thickest,
wed beneath the advancing banner
f the eagle's burning crest—
re with thunder-clouds to fan her,
Who could then her wing arrest—
ictory beaming from her breast?)
le the broken line enlarging
ell, or fled along the plain;
re be sure was Murat charging!
here he ne'er shall charge again!

IV.

glories gone the invaders march,
ps Triumph o'er each levelled arch—
let Freedom rejoice,
n her heart in her voice;
her hand on her sword,
bly shall she be adored;
ice hath twice too well been taught
"moral lesson"^[326] dearly bought—
safety sits not on a throne,
n Capet or Napoleon!
in equal rights and laws,
rts and hands in one great cause—
dom, such as God hath given
o all beneath his heaven,
n their breath, and from their birth,
ugh guilt would sweep it from the earth;
n a fierce and lavish hand

tering nations' wealth like sand;
ring nations' blood like water,
nperial seas of slaughter!

V.

the heart and the mind,
the voice of mankind,
l arise in communion—
who shall resist that proud union?
time is past when swords subdued—
i may die—the soul's renewed:
n in this low world of care
dom ne'er shall want an heir;
ions breathe but to inherit
for ever bounding spirit—
en once more her hosts assemble,
nts shall believe and tremble—
le they at this idle threat?
nson tears will follow yet.^[327]

[First published, *Morning Chronicle*, March 15, 1816.]

STANZAS FOR MUSIC.

1.

RE be none of Beauty's daughters
/ith a magic like thee;
like music on the waters
thy sweet voice to me:
en, as if its sound were causing
charméd Ocean's pausing,

waves lie still and gleaming,
the lulled winds seem dreaming:

2.

the midnight Moon is weaving
er bright chain o'er the deep;
ose breast is gently heaving,
s an infant's asleep:
he spirit bows before thee,
isten and adore thee;
n a full but soft emotion,
e the swell of Summer's ocean.

March 28 [1816].
[First published, *Poems*, 1816.]

ON THE STAR OF "THE LEGION OF HONOUR."^[328]

[FROM THE FRENCH.]

1.

R of the brave!—whose beam hath shed
n glory o'er the quick and dead—
u radiant and adored deceit!
ch millions rushed in arms to greet,—
l meteor of immortal birth!
rise in Heaven to set on Earth?

2.

ls of slain heroes formed thy rays;
nity flashed through thy blaze;

music of thy martial sphere
fame on high and honour here;
thy light broke on human eyes,
a Volcano of the skies.

3.

lava rolled thy stream of blood,
swept down empires with its flood;
h rocked beneath thee to her base,
thou didst lighten through all space;
the shorn Sun grew dim in air,
set while thou wert dwelling there.

4.

ore thee rose, and with thee grew,
inbow of the loveliest hue
three bright colours,^[329] each divine,
fit for that celestial sign;
Freedom's hand had blended them,
tints in an immortal gem.

5.

tint was of the sunbeam's dyes;
, the blue depth of Seraph's eyes;
, the pure Spirit's veil of white
robed in radiance of its light:
three so mingled did beseem
texture of a heavenly dream.

6.

of the brave! thy ray is pale,
darkness must again prevail!
oh thou Rainbow of the free!
tears and blood must flow for thee.
When thy bright promise fades away,
life is but a load of clay.

7.

Freedom hallows with her tread
silent cities of the dead;
beautiful in death are they
who proudly fall in her array;
soon, oh, Goddess! may we be
evermore with them or thee!

[First published, *Examiner*, April 7, 1816.]

STANZAS FOR MUSIC.

I.

They say that Hope is happiness;
but genuine Love must prize the past,
Memory wakes the thoughts that bless:
they rose the first—they set the last;

II.

all that Memory loves the most
was once our only Hope to be,
all that Hope adored and lost
at last melted into Memory.

III.

is! it is delusion all:
the future cheats us from afar,
can we be what we recall,
or dare we think on what we are.

[First published, *Fugitive Pieces*, 1829.]

FOOTNOTES:

[\[305\]](#) {409} [Compare *The Corsair*, Canto I. stanza xv. lines 480-490.]

[\[mr\]](#) {410}

*Never may I behold
Moment like this.*—[MS.]

[\[ms\]](#)

*The damp of the morning
Clung chill on my brow.*—[MS. erased.]

[\[mt\]](#) *Thy vow hath been broken.*—[MS.]

[\[mu\]](#)

——*lies hidden*
*Our secret of sorrow—
And deep in my soul—
But deed more forbidden,
Our secret lies hidden,
But never forgot.*—[Erasures, stanza 3, MS.]

[\[mv\]](#) {411}

*If one should meet thee
How should we greet thee?
In silence and tears.*—[MS.]

[306] [From an autograph MS. in the possession of Mr. Murray, now for the first time printed.]

The water-mark of the paper on which a much-tortured rough copy of these lines has been scrawled, is 1809, but, with this exception, there is no hint as to the date of composition. An entry in the *Diary* for November 30, 1813, in which Annabella (Miss Milbanke) is described "as an heiress, a girl of twenty, a peeress that is to be," etc., and a letter (Byron to Miss Milbanke) dated November 29, 1813 (see *Letters*, 1898, ii. 357, and 1899, iii. 407), in which there is more than one allusion to her would-be suitors, "your thousand and one pretendants," etc., suggest the idea that the lines were addressed to his future wife, when he first made her acquaintance in 1812 or 1813.]

[307] {413} ["Thou hast asked me for a song, and I enclose you an experiment, which has cost me something more than trouble, and is, therefore, less likely to be worth your taking any in your proposed setting. Now, if it be so, throw it into the fire without *phrase*."—Letter to Moore, May 4, 1814, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 80.]

[mw] *I speak not—I breathe not—I write not that name.*—[MS. erased.]

[mx] {414}

*We have loved—and oh, still, my adored one we love!
Oh the moment is past, when that Passion might cease.—*
[MS. erased.]

[my] *The thought may be madness—the wish may be—guilt.*—[MS. erased.]

[mz]

{ *But I cannot repent what we ne'er can recall.
But the heart which is thine would disdain to recall*
[MS. erased.]

[na] *—though I feel that thou mayst.*—[MS. L. erased.]

[nb]

*This soul in its bitterest moments shall be,
And our days run as swift—and our moments more sweet,
With thee at my side, than the world at my feet.*—[MS.]

[nc] {415}

And thine is that love which I will never forego

Though the price which I pay be Eternity's woe.—[MS. erased]

[[nd](#)] *One tear of thy sorrow, one smile*——.—[MS. erased]

[[308](#)] [The "Caledonian Meeting," at which these lines were, or were intended to be, recited (see *Life*, p. 254), was a meeting of subscribers to the Highland Society, held annually in London, in support of the [Royal] *Caledonian Asylum* "for educating and supporting children of soldiers, sailors, and marines, natives of Scotland." "To soothe," says the compiler of the *Report* for 1814, p. 4, "by the assurance that their offspring will be reared in virtue and comfort, the minds of those brave men, through whose exposure to hardship and danger the independence of the Empire has been preserved, is no less an act of sound policy than of gratitude."]

[[309](#)] {416} [As an instance of Scottish gallantry in the Peninsular War it is sufficient to cite the following list of "casualties" at the battle of Vittoria, June 21, 1813: "The battalion [the seventy-first Highland Light Infantry] suffered very severely, having had 1 field officer, 1 captain, 2 lieutenants, 6 sergeants, 1 bugler, and 78 rank and file killed; 1 field officer, 3 captains, 7 lieutenants, 13 sergeants, 2 buglers, and 255 rank and file were wounded."—*Historical Record of the 71st Highland Light Infantry*, by Lieut. Henry J. T. Hildyard, 1876, p. 91.]

[[310](#)] [Compare *Temora*, bk. vii., "The king took his deathful spear, and struck the deeply-sounding shield.... Ghosts fled on every side, and rolled their gathered forms on the wind. —Thrice from the winding vale arose the voices of death."—*Works of Ossian*, 1765, ii. 160.]

[[311](#)] {417} [The last six lines are printed from the MS.]

[[312](#)] [Sir P. Parker fell in August, 1814, in his twenty-ninth year, whilst leading a party from his ship, the *Menelaus*, at the storming of the American camp near Baltimore. He was Byron's first cousin (his father, Christopher Parker (1761-1804), married Charlotte Augusta, daughter of Admiral the Hon. John Byron); but they had never met since boyhood. (See letter to Moore, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 150; see too *Letters*, i. 6, note 1.) The stanzas were included in *Hebrew Melodies*, 1815, and in the Ninth Edition of *Childe Harold*, 1818.]

[[313](#)] [Compare Tasso's sonnet—"Questa Tomba non è, ehe non è morto," etc. *Rime Eroiche*, Parte Seconda, No. 38, *Opere di Torquato Tasso*, Venice, 1736, vi. 169.]

[[314](#)] {419} [From an autograph MS. in the possession of Mr. Murray, now for the first time printed.]

[[ne](#)] {421}

1.

*The red light glows, the wassail flows,
Around the royal hall;
And who, on earth, dare mar the mirth
Of that high festival?
The prophet dares—before thee glows—
Belshazzar rise, nor dare despise
The writing on the wall!*

2

*Thy vice might raise th' avenging steel,
Thy meanness shield thee from the blow—
And they who loathe thee proudly feel.—[MS.]*

[nf] {422}

*The words of God along the wall.—[MS. erased.]
The word of God—the graven wall.—[MS.]*

[ng] *Behold it written——.—[MS.]*

[nh] *——thy sullied diadem.—[MS.]*

[315] {423} [Byron gave these verses to Moore for Mr. Power of the Strand, who published them, with music by Sir John Stevenson. "I feel merry enough," he wrote, March 2, "to send you a sad song." And again, March 8, 1815, "An event—the death of poor Dorset—and the recollection of what I once felt, and ought to have felt now, but could not—set me pondering, and finally into the train of thought which you have in your hands." A year later, in another letter to Moore, he says, "I pique myself on these lines as being the *truest*, though the most melancholy, I ever wrote." (March 8, 1816.)—*Letters*, 1899, iii. 181, 183, 274.]

[ni] *'Tis not the blush alone that fades from Beauty's cheek.—[MS.]*

[nj] {424} *As ivy o'er the mouldering wall that heavily hath crept.—[MS.]*

[316] [Compare—

*"And oft we see gay ivy's wreath
The tree with brilliant bloom o'erspread,
When, part its leaves and gaze beneath,
We find the hidden tree is dead."*

*"To Anna," The Warrior's Return, etc.,
by Mrs. Opie, 1808, p. 144.]*

[317] {425} [From an autograph MS. in the possession of Mr. Murray, now for the first time printed. The MS. is headed, in pencil, "Lines written on the Death of the Duke of Dorset, a College Friend of Lord Byron's, who was killed by a fall from his horse while hunting." It is endorsed, "Bought of Markham Thorpe, August 29, 1844." (For Duke of Dorset, see *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 194, note 2; and *Letters*, 1899, in. 181, note 1.)]

[nk] {426} ——*shall eternally be.*—[MS. erased.]

[nl] *Green be the turf*——.—[MS.]

[318] [Compare "O lay me, ye that see the light, near some rock of my hills: let the thick hazels be around, let the rustling oaks be near. Green be the place of my rest."—"The War of Inis-Thona," *Works of Ossin*, 1765, i. 156.]

[nm] *May its verdure be sweetest to see.*—[MS.]

[nn] {427}

*Young flowers and a far-spreading tree
May wave on the spot of thy rest;
But nor cypress nor yew let it be.*—[MS.]

[319] ["We need scarcely remind our readers that there are points in these spirited lines, with which our opinions do not accord; and, indeed, the author himself has told us that he rather adapted them to what he considered the speaker's feelings than his own."—*Examiner*, July 30, 1815.]

[no] *The brightest and blackest are due to my fame.*—[MS.]

[np] *But thy destiny wills*——.—[MS.]

[nq] {428}

*Oh for the thousands of Those who have perished
By elements blasted, unvanquished by man—
Then the hope which till now I have fearlessly cherished,
Had waved o'er thine eagles in Victory's van.*—[MS.]

[320] ["All wept, but particularly Savary, and a Polish officer who had been exalted from the ranks by Buonaparte. He clung to his master's knees; wrote a letter to Lord Keith, entreating permission to accompany him, even in the most menial capacity, which could not be admitted."—*Private Letter from Brussels.*]

[nr] {429} ——*that mute adieu.*—[MS.]

[[ns](#)] *Dear as they have seemed to me.*—[MS.]

[[nt](#)] *In the faith I pledged to thee.*—[MS.]

[[nu](#)]

Glory lightened from thy soul.

Never did I grieve till now.—[MS.]

[[321](#)] ["At Waterloo one man was seen, whose left arm was shattered by a cannon-ball, to wrench it off with the other, and, throwing it up in the air, exclaimed to his comrades, 'Vive l'Empereur, jusqu'à la mort!' There were many other instances of the like: this you may, however, depend on as true."—*Private Letter from Brussels.*]

[[nv](#)] *When the hearts of coward foes.*—[MS.]

[[nw](#)] {430} ———*to Friendship's prayer.*—[MS.]

[[nx](#)]

'Twould not gather round his throne

Half the hearts that still are thine.—[MS.]

[[ny](#)]

Let me but partake his doom,

Be it exile or the grave.

or, *All I ask is to abide*

All the perils he must brave,

All my hope was to divide.—[MS.]

or, *Let me still partake his gloom,*

Late his soldier, now his slave—

Grant me but to share the gloom

Of his exile or his grave.—[MS.]

[[322](#)] {431} [These lines "are said to have been done into English verse by R. S. ——— P. L. P. R., Master of the Royal Spanish Inqn., etc., etc."—*Morning Chronicle*, March 15, 1816. "The French have their *Poems* and *Odes* on the famous Battle of Waterloo, as well as ourselves. Nay, they seem to glory in the battle as the source of great events to come. We have received the following poetical version of a poem, the original of which is circulating in Paris, and which is ascribed (we know not with what justice) to the Muse of M. de Chateaubriand. If so, it may be inferred that in the poet's eye a new change is at hand, and he wishes to prove his secret indulgence of old principles by reference to this effusion."—Note, *ibid.*]

[323] [Charles Angélique François Huchet, Comte de La Bédoyère, born 1786, was in the retreat from Moscow, and in 1813 distinguished himself at the battles of Lutzen and Bautzen. On the return of Napoleon from Elba he was the first to bring him a regiment. He was promoted, and raised to the peerage, but being found in Paris after its occupation by the Allied army, he was tried by a court-martial, and suffered death August 15, 1815.]

[324] {432} See Rev. Chap. viii. V. 7, etc., "The first angel sounded, and there followed hail and fire mingled with blood," etc. V. 8, "And the second angel sounded, and as it were a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea: and the third part of the sea became blood," etc. V. 10, "And the third angel sounded, and there fell a great star from heaven, burning as it were a lamp, and it fell upon the third part of the rivers, and upon the fountains of waters." V. 11, "And the name of the star is called *Wormwood*: and the third part of the waters became *wormwood*; and many men died of the waters, because they were made bitter."

[325] Murat's remains are said to have been torn from the grave and burnt. ["Poor dear Murat, what an end ...! His white plume used to be a rallying point in battle, like Henry the Fourth's. He refused a confessor and a bandage; so would neither suffer his soul or body to be bandaged."—Letter to Moore, November 4. 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 245. See, too, for Joachim Murat (born 1771), proclaimed King of Naples and the Two Sicilies, August, 1808, *ibid.*, note 1.]

[326] {434} ["Write, Britain, write the moral lesson down." Scott's *Field of Waterloo*, Conclusion, stanza vi. line 3.]

[327] {435} ["Talking of politics, as Caleb Quotem says, pray look at the conclusion of my 'Ode on Waterloo,' written in the year 1815, and comparing it with the Duke de Berri's catastrophe in 1820, tell me if I have not as good a right to the character of 'Vates,' in both senses of the word, as Fitzgerald and Coleridge?—

'Crimson tears will follow yet;'

and have not they?"—Letter to Murray, April 24, 1820.

In the Preface to *The Tyrant's Downfall*, etc., 1814, W. L. Fitzgerald (see *English Bards*, etc., line 1, *Poetical Works*, 1898, i. 297, note 3) "begs leave to refer his reader to the dates of his Napoleonics ... to prove his legitimate title to the prophetic meaning of *Vates*" (*Cent. Mag.*, July, 1814, vol. lxxxiv. p. 58). Coleridge claimed to have foretold the restoration of the Bourbons (see *Biographia Literaria*, cap. x.).]

[328] {436} ["The Friend who favoured us with the following lines, the poetical spirit of which wants no trumpet of ours, is aware that they imply more than an impartial observer

of the late period might feel, and are written rather as by Frenchman than Englishman;— but certainly, neither he nor any lover of liberty can help feeling and regretting that in the latter time, at any rate, the symbol he speaks of was once more comparatively identified with the cause of Freedom."—*Examiner*. April 7, 1816.]

[\[329\]](#) {437} The tricolor.

THE SIEGE OF CORINTH

"Guns, Trumpets, Blunderbusses, Drums and Thunder."

Pope, *Sat.* i. 26.^[330]

INTRODUCTION TO *THE SIEGE OF* *CORINTH.*



In a note to the "Advertisement" to the *Siege of Corinth* (*vide post*, [p. 447](#)), Byron puts it on record that during the years 1809-10 he had crossed the Isthmus of Corinth eight times, and in a letter to his mother, dated Patras, July 30, 1810, he alludes to a recent visit to the town of Corinth, in company with his friend Lord Sligo. (See, too, his letter to Coleridge, dated October 27, 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 228.) It is probable that he revisited Corinth more than once in the autumn of 1810; and we may infer that, just as the place and its surroundings—the temple with its "two or three columns" (line 497), and the view across the bay from Acro-Corinth—are sketched from memory, so the story of the siege which took place in 1715 is based upon tales and legends which were preserved and repeated by the grandchildren of the besieged, and were taken down from their lips. There is point and meaning in the apparently insignificant line (stanza xxiv. line 765), "We have heard the hearers say" (see *variant* i. p. 483), which is slipped into the description of the final catastrophe. It bears witness to the fact that the *Siege of Corinth* is not a poetical expansion of a chapter in history, but a heightened reminiscence of local tradition.

History has, indeed, very little to say on the subject. The anonymous *Compleat History of the Turks* (London, 1719), which Byron quotes as an

authority, is meagre and inaccurate. Hammer-Purgstall (*Histoire de l'Empire Ottoman*, 1839, xiii. 269), who gives as his authorities Girolamo Ferrari and Raschid, dismisses the siege in a few lines; and it was not till the publication of Finlay's *History of Greece* (vol. v., A.D. 1453-1821), in 1856, that the facts were known or reported. Finlay's newly discovered authority was a then unpublished MS. of a journal kept by Benjamin Brue, a connection of Voltaire's, who accompanied the Grand Vizier, Ali Cumurgi, as his interpreter, on the expedition into the Morea. According to Brue (*Journal de la Campagne ... en 1715 ...* Paris, 1870, p. 18), the siege began on June 28, 1715. A peremptory demand on the part of the Grand Vizier to surrender at discretion was answered by the Venetian proveditor-general, Giacomo Minetto, with calm but assured defiance ("Your menaces are useless, for we are prepared to resist all your attacks, and, with confidence in the assistance of God, we will preserve this fortress to the most serene Republic. God is with us"). Nevertheless, the Turks made good their threat, and on the 2nd of July the fortress capitulated. On the following day at noon, whilst a party of Janissaries, contrary to order, were looting and pillaging in all directions, the fortress was seen to be enveloped in smoke. How or why the explosion happened was never discovered, but the result was that some of the pillaging Janissaries perished, and that others, to avenge their death, which they attributed to Venetian treachery, put the garrison to the sword. It was believed at the time that Minetto was among the slain; but, as Brue afterwards discovered, he was secretly conveyed to Smyrna, and ultimately ransomed by the Dutch Consul.

The late Professor Kölbing (*Siege of Corinth*, 1893, p. xxvii.), in commenting on the sources of the poem, suggests, under reserve, that Byron may have derived the incident of Minetto's self-immolation from an historic source—the siege of Zsigetvar, in 1566, when a multitude of Turks

perished from the explosion of a powder magazine which had been fired at the cost of his own life by the Hungarian commander Zrini.

It is, at least, equally probable that local patriotism was, in the first instance, responsible for the poetic colouring, and that Byron supplemented the meagre and uninteresting historic details which were at his disposal by "intimate knowledge" of the Corinthian version of the siege. (See *Memoirs of the Life and Writings of the Right Hon. Lord Byron*, London, 1822, p. 222; and *Memoirs of the Life and Writings of Lord Byron*, by George Clinton, London, 1825, p. 284.)

It has been generally held that the *Siege of Corinth* was written in the second half of 1815 (Kölbing's *Siege of Corinth*, p. vii.). "It appears," says John Wright (*Works*, 1832, x. 100), "by the original MS., to have been begun in July, 1815;" and Moore (*Life*, p. 307), who probably relied on the same authority, speaks of "both the *Siege of Corinth* and *Parisina* having been produced but a short time before the Separation" (i.e. spring, 1816). Some words which Medwin (*Conversations*, 1824, p. 55) puts into Byron's mouth point to the same conclusion. Byron's own testimony, which is completely borne out by the MS. itself (dated J^y [i.e. January, not July] 31, 1815), is in direct conflict with these statements. In a note to stanza xix. lines 521-532 (*vide post*, pp. [471](#)-473) he affirms that it "was not till after these lines were written" that he heard "that wild and singularly original and beautiful poem [*Christabel*] recited;" and in a letter to S. T. Coleridge, dated October 27, 1815 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 228), he is careful to explain that "the enclosed extract from an unpublished poem (i.e. stanza xix. lines 521-532) ... was written before (not seeing your *Christabelle* [sic], for that you know I never did till this day), but before I heard Mr. S[cott] repeat it, which he did in June last, and this thing was begun in January, and more than half

written before the Summer." The question of plagiarism will be discussed in an addendum to Byron's note on the lines in question; but, subject to the correction that it was, probably, at the end of May (see Lockhart's *Memoir of the Life of Sir W. Scott*, 1871, pp. 311-313), not in June, that Scott recited *Christabel* for Byron's benefit, the date of the composition of the poem must be determined by the evidence of the author himself.

The copy of the MS. of the *Siege of Corinth* was sent to Murray at the beginning (probably on the 2nd, the date of the copy) of November, and was placed in Gifford's hands about the same time (see letter to Murray, November 4, 1815, *Letters*, 1899, iii. 245; and Murray's undated letter on Gifford's "great delight" in the poem, and his "three critical remarks," *Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 356). As with *Lara*, Byron began by insisting that the *Siege* should not be published separately, but slipped into a fourth volume of the collected works, and once again (possibly when he had at last made up his mind to accept a thousand guineas for his own requirements, and not for other beneficiaries—Godwin, Coleridge, or Maturin) yielded to his publisher's wishes and representations. At any rate, the *Siege of Corinth* and *Parisina*, which, says Moore, "during the month of January and part of February were in the hands of the printers" (*Life*, p. 300), were published in a single volume on February 7, 1816. The greater reviews were silent, but notices appeared in numerous periodicals; e.g. the *Monthly Review*, February, 1816, vol. lxxix. p. 196; the *Eclectic Review*, March, 1816, N.S. vol. v. p. 269; the *European*, May, 1816, vol. lxxix. p. 427; the *Literary Panorama*, June, 1816, N.S. vol. iv. p. 418; etc. Many of these reviews took occasion to pick out and hold up to ridicule the illogical sentences, the grammatical solecisms, and general imperfections of *technique* which marked and disfigured the *Siege of Corinth*. A passage in a letter which John Murray wrote to his brother-publisher, William

Blackwood (*Annals of a Publishing House*, 1897, i. 53), refers to these cavillings, and suggests both an apology and a retaliation—

"Many who by 'numbers judge a poet's song' are so stupid as not to see the powerful effect of the poems, which is the great object of poetry, because they can pick out fifty careless or even bad lines. The words may be carelessly put together; but this is secondary. Many can write polished lines who will never reach the name of poet. You see it is all poetically conceived in Lord B.'s mind."

In such wise did Murray bear testimony to Byron's "splendid and imperishable excellence, which covers all his offences and outweighs all his defects—the excellence of sincerity and strength."

TO

JOHN HOBHOUSE, ESQ.,

THIS POEM IS INSCRIBED,

BY HIS

FRIEND.

January 22nd, 1816.

ADVERTISEMENT



"THE grand army of the Turks (in 1715), under the Prime Vizier, to open to themselves a way into the heart of the Morea, and to form the siege of Napoli di Romania, the most considerable place in all that country,^[331] thought it best in the first place to attack Corinth, upon which they made several storms. The garrison being weakened, and the governor seeing it was impossible to hold out such a place against so mighty a force, thought it fit to beat a parley: but while they were treating about the articles, one of the magazines in the Turkish camp, wherein they had six hundred barrels of powder, blew up by accident, whereby six or seven hundred men were killed; which so enraged the infidels, that they would not grant any capitulation, but stormed the place with so much fury, that they took it, and put most of the garrison, with Signior Minotti, the governor, to the sword. The rest, with Signior or Antonio Bembo, Proveditor Extraordinary, were made prisoners of war."—*A Compleat History of the Turks* [London, 1719], iii. 151.

NOTE ON THE MS. OF *THE SIEGE OF CORINTH*.

The original MS. of the *Siege of Corinth* (now in the possession of Lord Glenesk) consists of sixteen folio and nine quarto sheets, and numbers fifty pages. Sheets 1-4 are folios, sheets 5-10 are quartos, sheets 11-22 are folios, and sheets 23-25 are quartos.

To judge from the occasional and disconnected pagination, this MS. consists of portions of two or more fair copies of a number of detached

scraps written at different times, together with two or three of the original scraps which had not been transcribed.

The water-mark of the folios is, with one exception (No. 8, 1815), 1813; and of the quartos, with one exception (No. 8, 1814), 1812.

Lord Glenesk's MS. is dated January 31, 1815. Lady Byron's transcript, from which the *Siege of Corinth* was printed, and which is in Mr. Murray's possession, is dated November 2, 1815.

THE SIEGE OF CORINTH

ne year since Jesus died for men,^[332]
teen hundred years and ten,^[333]
were a gallant company,
ng o'er land, and sailing o'er sea.
but we went merrily!^[334]
forded the river, and clomb the high hill,
er our steeds for a day stood still;
ether we lay in the cave or the shed,
sleep fell soft on the hardest bed;
ether we couched in our rough capote,^[335] 10
he rougher plank of our gliding boat,
tretched on the beach, or our saddles spread,
pillow beneath the resting head,
h we woke upon the morrow:
ll our thoughts and words had scope,
e had health, and we had hope,
and travel, but no sorrow.
were of all tongues and creeds;—
ie were those who counted beads,
ie of mosque, and some of church, 20
nd some, or I mis-say, of neither;
through the wide world might ye search,
or find a motlier crew nor blither.

some are dead, and some are gone,
some are scattered and alone,
some are rebels on the hills^[336]
that look along Epirus' valleys,
where Freedom still at moments rallies,
pays in blood Oppression's ills;
and some are in a far countree, 30
some all restlessly at home;
but never more, oh! never, we
shall meet to revel and to roam.
those hardy days flew cheerily!^[nz]
when they now fall drearily,
thoughts, like swallows, skim the main,^[337]
bear my spirit back again
o'er the earth, and through the air,
wild bird and a wanderer.
this that ever wakes my strain, 40
so oft, too oft, implores again
few who may endure my lay,^[oa]
follow me so far away.
Nearer, wilt thou follow now,
sit with me on Acro-Corinth's brow?

I.^[338]

by a vanished year and age,^[ob]
Tempest's breath, and Battle's rage,
she swept o'er Corinth; yet she stands,
fortress formed to Freedom's hands.^[oc]
Whirlwind's wrath, the Earthquake's shock, 50
she left untouched her hoary rock,
keystone of a land, which still,

ugh fall'n, looks proudly on that hill,
landmark to the double tide
t purpling rolls on either side,
f their waters chafed to meet,
pause and crouch beneath her feet.
could the blood before her shed
e first Timoleon's brother bled,^[339]
affled Persia's despot fled, 60
e from out the Earth which drank
stream of Slaughter as it sank,
t sanguine Ocean would o'erflow
isthmus idly spread below:
ould the bones of all the slain,^[od]
o perished there, be piled again,
t rival pyramid would rise
e mountain-like, through those clear skies^[oe]
n yon tower-capp'd Acropolis,
ch seems the very clouds to kiss. 70

II.

lun Cithæron's ridge appears
gleam of twice ten thousand spears;
downward to the Isthmian plain,
n shore to shore of either main,^[of]
tent is pitched, the Crescent shines
ng the Moslem's leaguering lines;
the dusk Spahi's bands^[340] advance
eath each bearded Pacha's glance;
far and wide as eye can reach^[og]
turbaned cohorts throng the beach; 80
there the Arab's camel kneels,

there his steed the Tartar wheels;
Turcoman hath left his herd,^[341]
sabre round his loins to gird;
there the volleying thunders pour,
waves grow smoother to the roar.
trench is dug, the cannon's breath
gs the far hissing globe of death;^[342]
whirl the fragments from the wall,
ch crumbles with the ponderous ball; 90
from that wall the foe replies,
dusty plain and smoky skies,
1 fares that answer fast and well
summons of the Infidel.

III.

near and nearest to the wall
hose who wish and work its fall,
1 deeper skill in War's black art,
n Othman's sons, and high of heart
my Chief that ever stood
mphant in the fields of blood; 100
n post to post, and deed to deed,
spurring on his reeking steed,
re sallying ranks the trench assail,
make the foremost Moslem quail;
where the battery, guarded well,
rains as yet impregnable,
ghting cheerly to inspire
soldier slackening in his fire;
first and freshest of the host
ch Stamboul's Sultan there can boast, 110

guide the follower o'er the field,
point the tube, the lance to wield,
whirl around the bickering blade;—
Alp, the Adrian renegade!^[343]

IV.

in Venice—once a race of worth
gentle Sires—he drew his birth;
late an exile from her shore,^[oh]
inst his countrymen he bore
arms they taught to bear; and now
turban girt his shaven brow. 120
ough many a change had Corinth passed
n Greece to Venice' rule at last;
here, before her walls, with those
Greece and Venice equal foes,
stood a foe, with all the zeal
ch young and fiery converts feel,
in whose heated bosom throngs
memory of a thousand wrongs.
him had Venice ceased to be
ancient civic boast—"the Free;" 130
in the palace of St. Mark
amed accusers in the dark
in the "Lion's mouth" had placed
large against him uneffaced:^[344]
led in time, and saved his life,
vaste his future years in strife,^[oi]
t taught his land how great her loss
him who triumphed o'er the Cross,
nst which he reared the Crescent high,

. battled to avenge or die. 140

V.

mourgi^[345]—he whose closing scene
rned the triumph of Eugene,
en on Carlowitz' bloody plain,
last and mightiest of the slain,
ank, regretting not to die,
cursed the Christian's victory—
mourgi—can his glory cease,
t latest conqueror of Greece,
Christian hands to Greece restore
freedom Venice gave of yore? 150
ndred years have rolled away
e he refixed the Moslem's sway;
now he led the Mussulman,
gave the guidance of the van
lp, who well repaid the trust
ities levelled with the dust;
proved, by many a deed of death,
v firm his heart in novel faith.

VI.

walls grew weak; and fast and hot
inst them poured the ceaseless shot, 160
n unabating fury sent
n battery to battlement;
thunder-like the pealing din^[oj]
e from each heated culverin;
here and there some crackling dome
fired before the exploding bomb;

as the fabric sank beneath
shattering shell's volcanic breath,
and wreathing columns flashed
flame, as loud the ruin crashed, 170
into countless meteors driven,
earth-stars melted into heaven;^[ok]
those clouds that day grew doubly dun,
oblivious to the hidden sun,
a volumed smoke that slowly grew^[ol]
the wide sky of sulphurous hue.

VII.

not for vengeance, long delayed,
he, did Alp, the renegade,
Moslem warriors sternly teach
skill to pierce the promised breach: 180
within these walls a Maid was pent
hope would win, without consent
that inexorable Sire,
whose heart refused him in its ire,
an Alp, beneath his Christian name,
a virgin hand aspired to claim.
a happier mood, and earlier time,
he unimpeached for traitorous crime,
rest in Gondola or Hall,
glittered through the Carnival; 190
he tuned the softest serenade
that e'er on Adria's waters played
at midnight to Italian maid.^[om]

VIII.

. many deemed her heart was won;
sought by numbers, given to none,
young Francesca's hand remained
by the Church's bonds unchained:
. when the Adriatic bore
ciotto to the Paynim shore,
wonted smiles were seen to fail, 200
. pensive waxed the maid and pale;
e constant at confessional,
e rare at masque and festival;
een at such, with downcast eyes,
ch conquered hearts they ceased to prize:
1 listless look she seems to gaze:
1 humbler care her form arrays;
voice less lively in the song;
step, though light, less fleet among
pairs, on whom the Morning's glance 210
aks, yet unsated with the dance.

IX.

. by the State to guard the land,
rich, wrested from the Moslem's hand, ^[346]
le Sobieski tamed his pride
Buda's wall and Danube's side, ^[on]
chiefs of Venice wrung away
n Patra to Euboea's bay,) ^[oo]
otti held in Corinth's towers ^[oo]
Doge's delegated powers,
le yet the pitying eye of Peace 220
led o'er her long forgotten Greece:
. ere that faithless truce was broke

ch freed her from the unchristian yoke,
n him his gentle daughter came;
there, since Menelaus' dame
ook her lord and land, to prove
at woes await on lawless love,
fairer form adorned the shore
n she, the matchless stranger, bore.^[op]

X.

wall is rent, the ruins yawn; 230
, with to-morrow's earliest dawn,
the disjointed mass shall vault
foremost of the fierce assault.
bands are ranked—the chosen van
artar and of Mussulman,
full of hope, misnamed "forlorn,"^[347]
o hold the thought of death in scorn,
win their way with falchion's force,
ave the path with many a corse,
which the following brave may rise, 240
ir stepping-stone—the last who dies!^[oq]

XI.

midnight: on the mountains brown^[348]
cold, round moon shines deeply down;
e roll the waters, blue the sky
ads like an ocean hung on high,
pangled with those isles of light,^{[or][349]}
vildly, spiritually bright;
o ever gazed upon them shining

. turned to earth without repining,
wished for wings to flee away, 250
mix with their eternal ray?
waves on either shore lay there
n, clear, and azure as the air;
scarce their foam the pebbles shook,
murmured meekly as the brook.
winds were pillowed on the waves;
banners drooped along their staves,
, as they fell around them furling,
ve them shone the crescent curling;
that deep silence was unbroke, 260
e where the watch his signal spoke,
e where the steed neighed oft and shrill,
echo answered from the hill,
the wide hum of that wild host
tled like leaves from coast to coast,
ose the Muezzin's voice in air
idnight call to wonted prayer;
se, that chanted mournful strain,
e some lone Spirit's o'er the plain:
as musical, but sadly sweet, 270
n as when winds and harp-strings meet,
take a long unmeasured tone,
nortal minstrelsy unknown.^[os]
emed to those within the wall
y prophetic of their fall:
ruck even the besieger's ear
n something ominous and drear,^[350]
undefined and sudden thrill,
ch makes the heart a moment still,

n beat with quicker pulse, ashamed 280
hat strange sense its silence framed;
n as a sudden passing-bell
es, though but for a stranger's knell.^[ot]

XII.

tent of Alp was on the shore;
sound was hushed, the prayer was o'er;
watch was set, the night-round made,
mandates issued and obeyed:
but another anxious night,
pains the morrow may requite
n all Revenge and Love can pay, 290
uerdon for their long delay.
' hours remain, and he hath need
est, to nerve for many a deed
laughter; but within his soul
thoughts like troubled waters roll.^[ou]
stood alone among the host;
his the loud fanatic boast
lant the Crescent o'er the Cross,
isk a life with little loss,
re in paradise to be 300
Houris loved immortally:
his, what burning patriots feel,
stern exaltedness of zeal,
use of blood, untired in toil,
en battling on the parent soil.
stood alone—a renegade
inst the country he betrayed;
stood alone amidst his band,

out a trusted heart or hand:
 y followed him, for he was brave, 310
 great the spoil he got and gave;
 y crouched to him, for he had skill
 varp and wield the vulgar will:^[ov]
 still his Christian origin
 n them was little less than sin.
 y envied even the faithless fame
 earned beneath a Moslem name;
 e he, their mightiest chief, had been
 outh a bitter Nazarene.
 y did not know how Pride can stoop, 320
 en baffled feelings withering droop;
 y did not know how Hate can burn
 earts once changed from soft to stern;
 all the false and fatal zeal
 convert of Revenge can feel.
 uled them—man may rule the worst,
 ever daring to be first:
 ions o'er the jackals sway;
 jackal points, he fells the prey,^{[ow][351]}
 n on the vulgar, yelling, press, 330
 orge the relics of success.

XIII.

head grows fevered, and his pulse
 quick successive throbs convulse;
 ain from side to side he throws
 form, in courtship of repose,^[ox]
 f he dozed, a sound, a start
 ke him with a sunken heart.

turban on his hot brow pressed,
mail weighed lead-like on his breast,
ugh oft and long beneath its weight 340
n his eyes had slumber sate,
out or couch or canopy,
ept a rougher field and sky^[oy]
n now might yield a warrior's bed,
n now along the heaven was spread.
could not rest, he could not stay
in his tent to wait for day,^[oz]
walked him forth along the sand,
ere thousand sleepers strewed the strand.
at pillowed them? and why should he 350
e wakeful than the humblest be,
e more their peril, worse their toil?
yet they fearless dream of spoil;
le he alone, where thousands passed
ght of sleep, perchance their last,
ckly vigil wandered on,
envied all he gazed upon.

XIV.

felt his soul become more light
eath the freshness of the night.
I was the silent sky, though calm, 360
bathed his brow with airy balm:
ind, the camp—before him lay,
iany a winding creek and bay,
anto's gulf; and, on the brow
Delphi's hill, unshaken snow,^[pa]
n and eternal, such as shone

ough thousand summers brightly gone,
ag the gulf, the mount, the clime;
ill not melt, like man, to time:
int and slave are swept away, 370
; formed to wear before the ray;
that white veil, the lightest, frailest, [352]
ch on the mighty mount thou hailest,
le tower and tree are torn and rent,
ies o'er its craggy battlement;
orm a peak, in height a cloud,
ixture like a hovering shroud,
s high by parting Freedom spread,
rom her fond abode she fled,
lingered on the spot, where long 380
prophet spirit spake in song. [pb]
still her step at moments falters
withered fields, and ruined altars,
fain would wake, in souls too broken,
ointing to each glorious token:
vain her voice, till better days
n in those yet remembered rays,
ch shone upon the Persian flying,
saw the Spartan smile in dying.

XV.

mindless of these mighty times 390
Alp, despite his flight and crimes;
through this night, as on he wandered, [pc]
o'er the past and present pondered,
thought upon the glorious dead
there in better cause had bled,

felt how faint and feebly dim^[pd]
fame that could accrue to him,
cheered the band, and waved the sword,^[pe]
ator in a turbaned horde;
led them to the lawless siege, 400
se best success were sacrilege.
so had those his fancy numbered,^[353]
chiefs whose dust around him slumbered;
ir phalanx marshalled on the plain,
se bulwarks were not then in vain.
y fell devoted, but undying;
very gale their names seemed sighing;
waters murmured of their name;
woods were peopled with their fame;
silent pillar, lone and grey, 410
med kindred with their sacred clay;
ir spirits wrapped the dusky mountain,
ir memory sparkled o'er the fountain;^[pf]
meanest rill, the mightiest river
ed mingling with their fame for ever.
pite of every yoke she bears,
t land is Glory's still and theirs!^[pg]
still a watch-word to the earth:
en man would do a deed of worth
oints to Greece, and turns to tread, 420
anctioned, on the tyrant's head:
ooks to her, and rushes on
ere life is lost, or Freedom won.^[ph]

XVI.

by the shore Alp mutely mused,

wooded the freshness Night diffused.
re shrinks no ebb in that tideless sea,^[354]
ch changeless rolls eternally;
hat wildest of waves, in their angriest mood,^[pi]
ce break on the bounds of the land for a rood;
the powerless moon beholds them flow, 430
dless if she come or go:
n or high, in main or bay,
heir course she hath no sway.
rock unworn its base doth bare,
looks o'er the surf, but it comes not there;
the fringe of the foam may be seen below,
he line that it left long ages ago:
nooth short space of yellow sand^{[pi][355]}
ween it and the greener land.

wandered on along the beach, 440
within the range of a carbine's reach
he leaguered wall; but they saw him not,
ow could he 'scape from the hostile shot?^[pk]
traitors lurk in the Christians' hold?
e their hands grown stiff, or their hearts waxed cold?
ow not, in sooth; but from yonder wall^[pl]
re flashed no fire, and there hissed no ball,
ugh he stood beneath the bastion's frown,
t flanked the seaward gate of the town;
ugh he heard the sound, and could almost tell 450
sullen words of the sentinel,
his measured step on the stone below
iked, as he paced it to and fro;
he saw the lean dogs beneath the wall

l o'er the dead their Carnival,^[356]
 ging and growling o'er carcass and limb;
 y were too busy to bark at him!
 n a Tartar's skull they had stripped the flesh,
 re peel the fig when its fruit is fresh;
 . their white tusks crunched o'er the whiter skull,^[357] 460
 t slipped through their jaws, when their edge grew dull,
 hey lazily mumbled the bones of the dead,
 en they scarce could rise from the spot where they fed;
 vell had they broken a lingering fast
 n those who had fallen for that night's repast.
 . Alp knew, by the turbans that rolled on the sand,
 foremost of these were the best of his band:
 nson and green were the shawls of their wear,
 . each scalp had a single long tuft of hair,^[358]
 he rest was shaven and bare. 470
 scalps were in the wild dog's maw,
 hair was tangled round his jaw:
 close by the shore, on the edge of the gulf,
 re sat a vulture flapping a wolf,
 o had stolen from the hills, but kept away,
 ed by the dogs, from the human prey;
 he seized on his share of a steed that lay,
 ed by the birds, on the sands of the bay.

XVII.

turned him from the sickening sight:
 er had shaken his nerves in fight; 480
 he better could brook to behold the dying,
 p in the tide of their warm blood lying,^{[pm][359]}
 ched with the death-thirst, and writhing in vain,

n the perishing dead who are past all pain.^{[pn][360]}
re is something of pride in the perilous hour,
ate'er be the shape in which Death may lower;
Fame is there to say who bleeds,
. Honour's eye on daring deeds!^[361]
when all is past, it is humbling to tread^[po]
the weltering field of the tombless dead,^[362] 490
. see worms of the earth, and fowls of the air,
sts of the forest, all gathering there;
regarding man as their prey,
rejoicing in his decay.^[pp]

XVIII.

re is a temple in ruin stands,
tioned by long forgotten hands;
or three columns, and many a stone,
ble and granite, with grass o'ergrown!
upon Time! it will leave no more
he things to come than the things before!^{[pq][363]} 500
upon Time! who for ever will leave
enough of the past for the future to grieve
that which hath been, and o'er that which must be:
at we have seen, our sons shall see;
nants of things that have passed away,
gments of stone, reared by creatures of clay!^[pr]

XIX.

ate him down at a pillar's base,^[364]
. passed his hand athwart his face;
one in dreary musing mood,

lining was his attitude; 510
head was drooping on his breast,
ered, throbbing, and oppressed;
o'er his brow, so downward bent,
his beating fingers went,
riedly, as you may see
r own run over the ivory key,
the measured tone is taken
he chords you would awaken.
re he sate all heavily,
ie heard the night-wind sigh. 520
it the wind through some hollow stone,^[ps]
: that soft and tender moan?^[365]
ifted his head, and he looked on the sea,
it was unrippled as glass may be;
ooked on the long grass—it waved not a blade;
r was that gentle sound conveyed?
ooked to the banners—each flag lay still,
lid the leaves on Cithæron's hill,
he felt not a breath come over his cheek;
it did that sudden sound bespeak? 530
urned to the left—is he sure of sight?
re sate a lady, youthful and bright!^{[pt][366]}

XX.

started up with more of fear
n if an arméd foe were near.
d of my fathers! what is here?
o art thou? and wherefore sent
ear a hostile armament?"
trembling hands refused to sign

cross he deemed no more divine:
had resumed it in that hour,^[pu] 540
Conscience wrung away the power.
gazed, he saw; he knew the face
beauty, and the form of grace;
as Francesca by his side,
maid who might have been his bride!^[pv]

rose was yet upon her cheek,
mellowed with a tenderer streak:
ere was the play of her soft lips fled?
e was the smile that enlivened their red.
Ocean's calm within their view,^[pw] 550
ide her eye had less of blue;
like that cold wave it stood still,
its glance, though clear, was chill.^[367]
und her form a thin robe twining,
ght concealed her bosom shining;
ough the parting of her hair,
iting darkly downward there,
rounded arm showed white and bare:
ere yet she made reply,
e she raised her hand on high; 560
as so wan, and transparent of hue,
might have seen the moon shine through.

XXI.

ome from my rest to him I love best,
t I may be happy, and he may be blessed.
ve passed the guards, the gate, the wall;
ght thee in safety through foes and all.

said the lion will turn and flee^[368]
n a maid in the pride of her purity;
the Power on high, that can shield the good
s from the tyrant of the wood, 570
n extended its mercy to guard me as well
n the hands of the leaguering Infidel.
me—and if I come in vain,
er, oh never, we meet again!
u hast done a fearful deed
illing away from thy fathers' creed:
dash that turban to earth, and sign
sign of the cross, and for ever be mine;
ng the black drop from thy heart,
to-morrow unites us no more to part." 580

d where should our bridal couch be spread?
ie midst of the dying and the dead?
to-morrow we give to the slaughter and flame
sons and the shrines of the Christian name.
e, save thou and thine, I've sworn,
l be left upon the morn:
thee will I bear to a lovely spot,
ere our hands shall be joined, and our sorrow forgot.
re thou yet shall be my bride,
en once again I've quelled the pride 590
 Venice; and her hated race
e felt the arm they would debase
urge, with a whip of scorpions, those
om Vice and Envy made my foes."

n his hand she laid her own—
it was the touch, but it thrilled to the bone,

shot a chillness to his heart,^[px]
which fixed him beyond the power to start.
Though slight was that grasp so mortal cold,
It could not loose him from its hold; 600
Never did clasp of one so dear
Lie on the pulse with such feeling of fear,
Those thin fingers, long and white,
Were through his blood by their touch that night.
The feverish glow of his brow was gone,
His heart sank so still that it felt like stone,
He looked on the face, and beheld its hue,^[py]
Deeply changed from what he knew:
But faint—without the ray
Of mind, that made each feature play 610
Like sparkling waves on a sunny day;
Her motionless lips lay still as death,
Her words came forth without her breath,
There rose not a heave o'er her bosom's swell,^[pz]
There seemed not a pulse in her veins to dwell.
Though her eye shone out, yet the lids were fixed,^[369]
The glance that it gave was wild and unmixed
With aught of change, as the eyes may seem
On the restless who walk in a troubled dream;
Like the figures on arras, that gloomily glare, 620
Shed by the breath of the wintry air^[qa]
Lit by the dying lamp's fitful light,^[qb]
Lifeless, but life-like, and awful to sight;
They seem, through the dimness, about to come down
On the shadowy wall where their images frown;
Fully flitting to and fro,
The gusts on the tapestry come and go.^[370]

not for love of me be given
so much, then, for the love of Heaven,—
when I say—that turban tear 630
run off thy faithless brow, and swear
to the injured country's sons to spare,
thou art lost; and never shalt see—
earth—that's past—but Heaven or me.
If thou dost accord, albeit
heavy doom 'tis thine to meet,
that doom shall half absolve thy sin,
If Mercy's gate may receive thee within:[371]
pause one moment more, and take
the curse of Him thou didst forsake; 640
If look once more to Heaven, and see
love for ever shut from thee.
There is a light cloud by the moon—[372]
passing, and will pass full soon—
by the time its vapoury sail
has ceased her shaded orb to veil,
If heart within thee is not changed,
when God and man are both avenged;
If will thy doom be, darker still
the immortality of ill." 650

He looked to heaven, and saw on high
a sign she spake of in the sky;
his heart was swollen, and turned aside,
deep interminable pride.[373]
his first false passion of his breast
run ed like a torrent o'er the rest.
He sue for mercy! *He* dismayed
wild words of a timid maid!

wronged by Venice, vow to save
sons, devoted to the grave! 660
—though that cloud were thunder's worst,
charged to crush him—let it burst!

looked upon it earnestly,
out an accent of reply;
watched it passing; it is flown:
on his eye the clear moon shone,
thus he spake—"Whate'er my fate,
no changeling—'tis too late:
reed in storms may bow and quiver,
n rise again; the tree must shiver. 670
at Venice made me, I must be,
foe in all, save love to thee:
thou art safe: oh, fly with me!"
urned, but she is gone!
ning is there but the column stone.
n she sunk in the earth, or melted in air?
saw not—he knew not—but nothing is there.

XXII.

night is past, and shines the sun
f that morn were a jocund one. [373]
tly and brightly breaks away 680
Morning from her mantle grey, [374]
the Noon will look on a sultry day. [375]
to the trump, and the drum,
the mournful sound of the barbarous horn,
the flap of the banners, that flit as they're borne,
the neigh of the steed, and the multitude's hum,

the clash, and the shout, "They come! they come!"
horsetails^[376] are plucked from the ground, and the sword
in its sheath; and they form, and but wait for the word.
Ar, and Spahi, and Turcoman, 690
Leave your tents, and throng to the van;
Mount ye, spur ye, skirr the plain,^[377]
That the fugitive may flee in vain,
When he breaks from the town; and none escape,
Old or young, in the Christian shape;
Leave your fellows on foot, in a fiery mass,
To sustain the breach through which they pass.^[378]
Horses are all bridled, and snort to the rein;
Riveted is each neck, and flowing each mane;
White is the foam of their champ on the bit; 700
Spears are uplifted; the matches are lit;
Cannon are pointed, and ready to roar,
To crush the wall they have crumbled before:^[379]
Stand in his phalanx each Janizar;
At their head; his right arm is bare,
And the blade of his scimitar;
Khan and the Pachas are all at their post;
Vizier himself at the head of the host.
When the culverin's signal is fired, then on;
We are not in Corinth a living one— 710
Priest at her altars, a chief in her halls,
Earth in her mansions, a stone on her walls.
And the prophet—Alla Hu!^[380]
Go to the skies with that wild halloo!
Where the breach lies for passage, the ladder to scale;
Put your hands on your sabres, and how should ye fail?
Who first downs with the red cross may crave^[381]

heart's dearest wish; let him ask it, and have!"
s uttered Coumourgi, the dauntless Vizier;^[382]
reply was the brandish of sabre and spear, 720
the shout of fierce thousands in joyous ire:—
nce—hark to the signal—fire!

XXIII.

he wolves, that headlong go
he stately buffalo,
ugh with fiery eyes, and angry roar,
hoofs that stamp, and horns that gore,
ramples on earth, or tosses on high
foremost, who rush on his strength but to die
s against the wall they went,
s the first were backward bent;^[383] 730
y a bosom, sheathed in brass,
wed the earth like broken glass,^[qd]
ered by the shot, that tore
ground whereon they moved no more:
n as they fell, in files they lay,
e the mower's grass at the close of day,^[qe]
en his work is done on the levelled plain;
n was the fall of the foremost slain.^[384]

XXIV.

he spring-tides, with heavy splash,
n the cliffs invading dash 740
e fragments, sapped by the ceaseless flow,
white and thundering down they go,
e the avalanche's snow

he Alpine vales below;
 s at length, outbreathed and worn,
 nth's sons were downward borne
 he long and oft renewed
 rge of the Moslem multitude.
 rmness they stood, and in masses they fell,
 ped by the host of the Infidel, 750
 d to hand, and foot to foot:
 aing there, save Death, was mute;^[385]
 ke, and thrust, and flash, and cry
 quarter, or for victory,
 gle there with the volleying thunder,
 ch makes the distant cities wonder
 7 the sounding battle goes,
 ith them, or for their foes;
 ey must mourn, or may rejoice
 at annihilating voice, 760
 ch pierces the deep hills through and through
 1 an echo dread and new:
 might have heard it, on that day,
 Salamis and Megara;
 have heard the hearers say,)^[qf]
 n unto Piræus' bay.

XXV.

n the point of encountering blades to the hilt,
 res and swords with blood were gilt;^[386]
 the rampart is won, and the spoil begun,
 . all but the after carnage done. 770
 ller shrieks now mingling come
 n within the plundered dome:

to the haste of flying feet,
t splash in the blood of the slippery street;
here and there, where 'vantage ground
inst the foe may still be found,
perate groups, of twelve or ten,
re a pause, and turn again—
n banded backs against the wall,
cely stand, or fighting fall. 780

re stood an old man^[387]—his hairs were white,
his veteran arm was full of might:
gallantly bore he the brunt of the fray,
dead before him, on that day,
semicircle lay;
he combated unwounded,
ugh retreating, unsurrounded.
ly a scar of former fight
ced^[388] beneath his corslet bright;
of every wound his body bore, 790
n and all had been ta'en before:
ugh agéd, he was so iron of limb,
of our youth could cope with him,
the foes, whom he singly kept at bay,
numbered his thin hairs^[389] of silver grey.
n right to left his sabre swept:
ly an Othman mother wept
s that were unborn, when dipped^[390]
weapon first in Moslem gore,
his years could count a score. 800
ll he might have been the sire^[391]
o fell that day beneath his ire:
sonless left long years ago,

wrath made many a childless foe;
since the day, when in the strait^[392]
only boy had met his fate,
parent's iron hand did doom
e than a human hecatomb.^[393]
ades by carnage be appeased,
oclus' spirit less was pleased 810
n his, Minotti's son, who died
re Asia's bounds and ours divide.
ed he lay, where thousands before
thousands of years were inhumed on the shore;
at of them is left, to tell
re they lie, and how they fell?
a stone on their turf, nor a bone in their graves;
they live in the verse that immortally saves.^[394]

XXVI.

κ to the Allah shout!^[395] a band
he Mussulman bravest and best is at hand; 820
ir leader's nervous arm is bare,
fter to smite, and never to spare—
lothed to the shoulder it waves them on;
s in the fight is he ever known:
ers a gaudier garb may show,
empt the spoil of the greedy foe;
y a hand's on a richer hilt,
none on a steel more ruddily gilt;
y a loftier turban may wear,—
is but known by the white arm bare; 830
k through the thick of the fight, 'tis there!
re is not a standard on that shore

vell advanced the ranks before;
re is not a banner in Moslem war
lure the Delhis half so far;
ances like a falling star!
ere'er that mighty arm is seen,
bravest be, or late have been;^[396]
re the craven cries for quarter
ily to the vengeful Tartar; 840
he hero, silent lying,
ns to yield a groan in dying;
stering his last feeble blow
nst the nearest levelled foe,
ugh faint beneath the mutual wound,
opling on the gory ground.

XXVII.

the old man stood erect.
Alp's career a moment checked.
ld thee, Minotti; quarter take,
thine own, thy daughter's sake." 850

ver, Renegado, never!
ugh the life of thy gift would last for ever."^[qg]

ncesca!—Oh, my promised bride!^[qh]
it she too perish by thy pride!"

e is safe."—"Where? where?"—"In Heaven;
n whence thy traitor soul is driven—
from thee, and undefiled."
nly then Minotti smiled,
ie saw Alp staggering bow

ore his words, as with a blow. 860

God! when died she?"—"Yesternight—
weep I for her spirit's flight:
e of my pure race shall be
res to Mahomet and thee—
ie on!"—That challenge is in vain—
s already with the slain!
le Minotti's words were wreaking
e revenge in bitter speaking
n his falchion's point had found,
the time allowed to wound, 870
n within the neighbouring porch
long defended church,
ere the last and desperate few
ld the failing fight renew,
sharp shot dashed Alp to the ground;
an eye could view the wound
t crashed through the brain of the infidel,
nd he spun, and down he fell;
ash like fire within his eyes
ed, as he bent no more to rise, 880
then eternal darkness sunk
ough all the palpitating trunk;^[qi]
ght of life left, save a quivering
ere his limbs were slightly shivering:
y turned him on his back; his breast
brow were stained with gore and dust,
through his lips the life-blood oozed,
n its deep veins lately loosed;
in his pulse there was no throb,
on his lips one dying sob; 890

l, nor word, nor struggling breath^[qj]
alded his way to death:
his very thought could pray,
neled he passed away,
out a hope from Mercy's aid,—
he last a Renegade.^[397]

XXVIII.

fully the yell arose
his followers, and his foes;
se in joy, in fury those.^[qk]
n again in conflict mixing,^[ql] 900
hing swords, and spears transfixing,
rchanged the blow and thrust,
ling warriors in the dust.
et by street, and foot by foot,
Minotti dares dispute
latest portion of the land
beneath his high command;
n him, aiding heart and hand,
remnant of his gallant band.
the church is tenable, 910
hence issued late the fated ball
hat half avenged the city's fall,
n Alp, her fierce assailant, fell:
her bending sternly back,
y leave before a bloody track;
, with their faces to the foe,
ling wounds with every blow,^[398]
chief, and his retreating train,
to those within the fane;

re they yet may breathe awhile, 920
ltered by the massy pile.

XXIX.

f breathing-time! the turbaned host,
n added ranks and raging boast,
s onwards with such strength and heat,
ir numbers balk their own retreat;
narrow the way that led to the spot
re still the Christians yielded not;
the foremost, if fearful, may vainly try
ough the massy column to turn and fly;
y perforce must do or die. 930
y die; but ere their eyes could close,
ngers o'er their bodies rose;
h and furious, fast they fill
ranks unthinned, though slaughtered still;
faint the weary Christians wax
ore the still renewed attacks:
now the Othmans gain the gate;
resists its iron weight,
still, all deadly aimed and hot,
n every crevice comes the shot; 940
n every shattered window pour
volleys of the sulphurous shower:
the portal wavering grows and weak—
iron yields, the hinges creak—
nds—it falls—and all is o'er;
Corinth may resist no more!

XXX.

clly, sternly, and all alone,
otti stood o'er the altar stone:
lonna's face upon him shone,^[399]
ited in heavenly hues above, 950
n eyes of light and looks of love;
placed upon that holy shrine
ix our thoughts on things divine,
en pictured there, we kneeling see
and the boy-God on her knee,
ling sweetly on each prayer
leaven, as if to waft it there.
she smiled; even now she smiles,
ugh slaughter streams along her aisles:
otti lifted his agéd eye, 960
made the sign of a cross with a sigh,
n seized a torch which blazed thereby;
still he stood, while with steel and flame,
ard and onward the Mussulman came.

XXXI.

vaults beneath the mosaic stone^[qm]
tained the dead of ages gone;
ir names were on the graven floor,
now illegible with gore;^[qn]
carvéd crests, and curious hues
varied marble's veins diffuse, 970
e smeared, and slippery—stained, and strown
n broken swords, and helms o'erthrown:
re were dead above, and the dead below
cold in many a confined row;
might see them piled in sable state,

a pale light through a gloomy grate;
War had entered their dark caves,^[qo]
stored along the vaulted graves
sulphurous treasures, thickly spread
masses by the fleshless dead: 980
and, throughout the siege, had been
Christians' chiefest magazine;
these a late formed train now led,
Cott's last and stern resource
against the foe's o'erwhelming force.

XXXII.

The foe came on, and few remain
to strive, and those must strive in vain:
lack of further lives, to slake
thirst of vengeance now awake,
and barbarous blows they gash the dead, 990
to lop the already lifeless head,
to fell the statues from their niche,
to spoil the shrines of offerings rich,
to from each other's rude hands wrest
silver vessels Saints had blessed.
The high altar on they go;
but it made a glorious show!^[400]
Its table still behold
a cup of consecrated gold;
deep and deep, a glittering prize, 1000
brightly it sparkles to plunderers' eyes:
The morn it held the holy wine,^[qp]
consecrated by Christ to his blood so divine,
which his worshippers drank at the break of day,^[qq]

hrive their souls ere they joined in the fray.
a few drops within it lay;
round the sacred table glow
lve lofty lamps, in splendid row,
n the purest metal cast;
oil—the richest, and the last. 1010

XXXIII.

ear they came, the nearest stretched
grasp the spoil he almost reached
hen old Minotti's hand
ched with the torch the train—
 'Tis fired!^[401]
e, vaults, the shrine, the spoil, the slain,
he turbaned victors, the Christian band,
that of living or dead remain,
led on high with the shivered fane,
one wild roar expired!^[402] 1020
shattered town—the walls thrown down—
waves a moment backward bent—
hills that shake, although unrent,^[qr]
s if an Earthquake passed—
thousand shapeless things all driven
loud and flame athwart the heaven,
y that tremendous blast—
laimed the desperate conflict o'er
hat too long afflicted shore:^[403]
o the sky like rockets go 1030
that mingled there below:
y a tall and goodly man,
ched and shrivelled to a span,

en he fell to earth again
e a cinder strewed the plain:
rn the ashes shower like rain;
ie fell in the gulf, which received the sprinkles
n a thousand circling wrinkles;
ie fell on the shore, but, far away,
tered o'er the isthmus lay; 1040
istian or Moslem, which be they?
their mothers see and say!^[qs]
en in cradled rest they lay,
. each nursing mother smiled
he sweet sleep of her child,
e deemed she such a day
ild rend those tender limbs away.^[404]
the matrons that them bore
ld discern their offspring more;^[405]
t one moment left no trace 1050
e of human form or face
e a scattered scalp or bone:
. down came blazing rafters, strown
und, and many a falling stone,^[qt]
ply dinted in the clay,
blackened there and reeking lay.
the living things that heard
deadly earth-shock disappeared:
wild birds flew; the wild dogs fled,
. howling left the unburied dead;^{[qu][406]} 1060
camels from their keepers broke;
distant steer forsook the yoke—
nearer steed plunged o'er the plain,
. burst his girth, and tore his rein;

bull-frog's note, from out the marsh,
 p-mouthed arose, and doubly harsh;^[407]
 wolves yelled on the caverned hill
 ere Echo rolled in thunder still;^[qv]
 jackal's troop, in gathered cry,^{[qw][408]}
 ed from afar complainingly, 1070
 n a mixed and mournful sound,^[qx]
 e crying babe, and beaten hound:^[409]
 n sudden wing, and ruffled breast,
 eagle left his rocky nest,
 . mounted nearer to the sun,
 clouds beneath him seemed so dun;
 ir smoke assailed his startled beak,
 . made him higher soar and shriek—
 hus was Corinth lost and won!^[410]

FOOTNOTES:

^[330] "With Gun, Drum, Trumpet, Blunderbuss, and Thunder."

^[331] {447} Napoli di Romania is not now the most considerable place in the Morea, but Tripolitza, where the Pacha resides, and maintains his government. Napoli is near Argos. I visited all three in 1810-11; and, in the course of journeying through the country from my first arrival in 1809, I crossed the Isthmus eight times in my way from Attica to the Morea, over the mountains; or in the other direction, when passing from the Gulf of Athens to that of Lepanto. Both the routes are picturesque and beautiful, though very different: that by sea has more sameness; but the voyage, being always within sight of land, and often very near it, presents many attractive views of the islands Salamis, Ægina, Poros, etc., and the coast of the Continent.

["Independently of the suitableness of such an event to the power of Lord Byron's genius, the Fall of Corinth afforded local attractions, by the intimate knowledge which the poet had of the place and surrounding objects.... Thus furnished with that topographical

information which could not be well obtained from books and maps, he was admirably qualified to depict the various operations and progress of the siege."—*Memoir of the Life and Writings of the Right Honourable Lord Byron*, London, 1822, p. 222.]

[332] {449} [The introductory lines, 1-45, are not included in the copy of the poem in Lady Byron's handwriting, nor were they published in the First Edition. On Christmas Day, 1815, Byron, enclosing this fragment to Murray, says, "I send some lines written some time ago, and intended as an opening to the *Siege of Corinth*. I had forgotten them, and am not sure that they had not better be left out now;—on that you and your Synod can determine." They are headed in the MS., "The Stranger's Tale," October 23rd. First published in *Letters and Journals*, 1830, i. 638, they were included among the *Occasional Poems* in the edition of 1831, and first prefixed to the poem in the edition of 1832.]

[333] [The metrical rendering of the date (miscalculated from the death instead of the birth of Christ) may be traced to the opening lines of an old ballad (Kölbing's *Siege of Corinth*, p. 53)—

"Upon the sixteen hunder year
Of God, and fifty-three,
From Christ was born, that bought us dear,
As writings testifie," etc.

See "The Life and Age of Man" (*Burns' Selected Poems*, ed. by J. L. Robertson, 1889, p. 191).]

[334] [Compare letter to Hodgson, July 16, 1809: "How merrily we lives that travellers be!"—*Letters*, 1898, i. 233.]

[335] {450} [For "capote," compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza lii. line 7, and Byron's note (24.B.), *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 132, 181. Compare, too, letter to Mrs. Byron, November 12, 1809 (*Letters*, 1899, i. 253): "Two days ago I was nearly lost in a Turkish ship of war.... I wrapped myself up in my Albanian capote (an immense cloak), and lay down on deck to wait the worst."]

[336] The last tidings recently heard of Dervish (one of the Arnauts who followed me) state him to be in revolt upon the mountains, at the head of some of the bands common in that country in times of trouble.

[nz] {451} *But those winged days*——.—[MS.]

[337] [Compare Kingsley's *Last Buccaneer*—

"If I might but be a sea-dove, I'd fly across the main—

To the pleasant isle of Aves, to look at it once again."]

[[oa](#)] *The kindly few who love my lay.*—[MS.]

[[338](#)] [The MS. is dated J^y (January) 31, 1815. Lady Byron's copy is dated November 2, 1815.]

[[ob](#)] *Many a year, and many an age.*—[MS. G. Copy.]

[[oc](#)] *A marvel from her Moslem bands.*—[MS. G.]

[[339](#)] {452} [Timoleon, who had saved the life of his brother Timophanes in battle, afterwards put him to death for aiming at the supreme power in Corinth. Warton says that Pope once intended to write an epic poem on the story, and that Akenside had the same design (*Works of Alexander Pope, Esq.*, 1806, ii. 83).]

[[od](#)] *Or could the dead be raised again.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[[oe](#)]

—through yon clear skies

Than tower-capt Acropolis.—[MS. G.]

[[of](#)] *Stretched on the edge*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[[340](#)] [Turkish holders of military fiefs.]

[[og](#)]

The turbaned crowd of dusky hue

Whose march Morea's fields may rue.—[MS. G. erased.]

[[341](#)] {453} The life of the Turcomans is wandering and patriarchal: they dwell in tents.

[[342](#)] [Compare *The Giaour*, line 639 (*vide ante*, [p. 116](#))—"The deathshot hissing from afar."]

[[343](#)] {454} [Professor Kolbing admits that he is unable to say how "Byron met with the name of Alp." I am indebted to my cousin, Miss Edith Coleridge, for the suggestion that the name is derived from Mohammed (Lhaz-ed-Dyn-Abou-Choudja), surnamed Alp-Arslan (Arsslan), or "Brave Lion," the second of the Seljuk dynasty, in the eleventh century. "He conquered Armenia and Georgia ... but was assassinated by Yussuf Cothuol, Governor of Berzem, and was buried at Merw, in Khorassan." His epitaph moralizes his fate: "O vous qui avez vu la grandeur d'Alparslan élevée jusqu'au ciel, regardez! le voici maintenant en poussière."—Hammer-Purgstall, *Histoire de l'Empire Othoman*, i. 13-15.]

[oh] *But now an exile——.*—[MS. G.]

[344] {455} ["The *Lions' Mouths*, under the arcade at the summit of the Giants' Stairs, which gaped widely to receive anonymous charges, were no doubt far more often employed as vehicles of private malice than of zeal for the public welfare."—*Sketches from Venetian History*, 1832, ii. 380.]

[oi] *To waste its future——.*—[MS. G.]

[345] Ali Coumourgi [Damad Ali or Ali Cumurgi (i.e. son of the charcoal-burner)], the favourite of three sultans, and Grand Vizier to Achmet III., after recovering Peloponnesus from the Venetians in one campaign, was mortally wounded in the next, against the Germans, at the battle of Peterwaradin (in the plain of Carlowitz), in Hungary, endeavouring to rally his guards. He died of his wounds next day [August 16, 1716]. His last order was the decapitation of General Breuner, and some other German prisoners, and his last words, "Oh that I could thus serve all the Christian dogs!" a speech and act not unlike one of Caligula. He was a young man of great ambition and unbounded presumption: on being told that Prince Eugene, then opposed to him, "was a great general," he said, "I shall become a greater, and at his expense."

[For his letter to Prince Eugene, "Eh bien! la guerre va décider entre nous," etc., and for an account of his death, see Hammer-Purgstall, *Historie de l'Empire Othoman*, xiii. 300, 312.]

[oj] {456} *And death-like rolled——.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[ok] *Like comets in convulsion riven.*—[MS. G. Copy erased.]

[ol]

*Impervious to the powerless sun,
Through sulphurous smoke whose blackness grew.—*
[MS. G. erased.]

[om] {457} *In midnight courtship to Italian maid.*—[MS. G.]

[346] {458} [The siege of Vienna was raised by John Sobieski, King of Poland (1629-1696), September 12, 1683. Buda was retaken from the Turks by Charles VII., Duke of Lorraine, Sobieski's ally and former rival for the kingdom of Poland, September 2, 1686. The conquest of the Morea was begun by the Venetians in 1685, and completed in 1699.]

[on] *By Buda's wall to Danube's side.*—[MS. G.]

[oo] *Pisani held——.*—[MS. G.]

[op] *Than she, the beauteous stranger, bore.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[347] {459} [For Byron's use of the phrase, "Forlorn Hope," as an equivalent of the Turkish Delhis, or Delis, see *Childe Harold*, Canto II. ("The Albanian War-Song"), *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 149, note 1.]

[oq] *By stepping o'er*——.—[MS. G.]

[348] ["Brown" is Byron's usual epithet for landscape seen by moonlight. Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza xxii. line 6, etc., *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 113, note 3.]

[or] *Bespangled with her isles*——.—[MS. G.]

[349] ["Stars" are likened to "isles" by Campbell, in *The Pleasures of Hope*, Part II.—

"The seraph eye shall count the starry train,
Like distant isles embosomed on the main."

And "isles" to "stars" by Byron, in *The Island*, Canto II. stanza xi. lines 14, 15—

"The studded archipelago,
O'er whose blue bosom rose the starry isles."

For other "star-similes," see *Childe Harold*, Canto III. stanza lxxxviii. line 9, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 270, note 2.]

[os]

And take a dark unmeasured tone.—[MS. G.]
And make a melancholy moan,
To mortal voice and ear unknown.—[MS. G. erased.]

[350] {461} [Compare Scott's *Marmion*, III. xvi. 4—

"And that strange Palmer's boding say,
That fell so ominous and drear."]

[ot]

——*by fancy framed,*
Which rings a deep, internal knell,
A visionary passing-bell.—[MS. G. erased.]

[ou] *The thoughts tumultuously roll.*—[MS. G.]

[ov] {462} *To triumph o'er*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[ow]

They but provide, he fells the prey.—[MS. G.]
As lions o'er the jackal sway
By springing dauntless on the prey;
They follow on, and yelling press
To gorge the fragments of success.—[MS. G. erased.]

[351] [Lines 329-331 are inserted in the copy. They are in Byron's handwriting. Compare *Don Juan*, Canto IX. stanza xxvii. line 1, *seq.*—"That's an appropriate simile, *that jackal.*"]

[ox] {463}

He vainly turned from side to side,
And each reposing posture tried.—[MS. G. erased.]

[oy] *Beyond a rougher*——.—[MS. G.]

[oz] ——*to sigh for day.*—[MS. G.]

[pa] {464}

Of Liakura—his unmelting snow
Bright and eternal——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[352] [Compare *The Giaour*, line 566 (*vide ante*, [p. 113](#))—

"For where is he that hath beheld
The peak of Liakura unveiled?"

The reference is to the almost perpetual "cap" of mist on Parnassus (Mount Likéri or Liakura), which lies some thirty miles to the north-west of Corinth.]

[pb] {465} *Her spirit spoke in deathless song.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[pc] *And in this night*——.—[MS. G.]

[pd] *He felt how little and how dim.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[pe] *Who led the band*——.—[MS. G.]

[353] [Compare *The Giaour*, lines 103, *seq.* (*vide ante*, [p. 91](#))—"Clime of the unforgotten brave!" etc.]

[pf] {466} *Their memory hallowed every fountain.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[pg] Here follows, in the MS.—

Immortal—boundless—undecayed—

Their souls the very soil pervade.—

[*In the Copy the lines are erased.*]

[ph] *Where Freedom loveliest may be won.—*[MS. G. erased.]

[354] The reader need hardly be reminded that there are no perceptible tides in the Mediterranean.

[pi] *So that fiercest of waves——.—*[MS. G.]

[pj] {467} *A little space of light grey sand.—*[MS. G. erased.]

[355] [Compare *The Island*, Canto IV. sect. ii. lines 11, 12—

"A narrow segment of the yellow sand

On one side forms the outline of a strand."]

[pk]

Or would not waste on a single head

The ball on numbers better sped.—[MS. G. erased]

[pl] *I know not in faith——.—*[MS. G.]

[356] [Gifford has drawn his pen through lines 456-478. If, as the editor of *The Works of Lord Byron*, 1832 (x. 100), maintains, "Lord Byron gave Mr. Gifford *carte blanche* to strike out or alter anything at his pleasure in this poem as it was passing through the press," it is somewhat remarkable that he does not appear to have paid any attention whatever to the august "reader's" suggestions and strictures. The sheets on which Gifford's corrections are scrawled are not proof-sheets, but pages torn out of the first edition; and it is probable that they were made after the poem was published, and with a view to the inclusion of an emended edition in the collected works. See letter to Murray, January 2, 1817.]

[357] {468} This spectacle I have seen, such as described, beneath the wall of the Seraglio at Constantinople, in the little cavities worn by the Bosphorus in the rock, a narrow terrace of which projects between the wall and the water. I think the fact is also mentioned in Hobhouse's *Travels [in Albania]*, 1855, ii. 215]. The bodies were probably those of some refractory Janizaries.

[358] This tuft, or long lock, is left from a superstition that Mahomet will draw them into Paradise by it.

[pm] {469} *Deep in the tide of their lost blood lying.*—[MS. G. Copy.]

[359] ["Than the mangled corpse in its own blood lying."—GIFFORD.]

[pn] *Than the rotting dead*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[360] [Strike out—

"Scorch'd with the death-thirst, and writhing in vain,
Than the perishing dead who are past all pain."

What is a "perishing dead"?—GIFFORD.]

[361] [Lines 487, 488 are inserted in the copy in Byron's handwriting.]

[po] *And when all*——.—[MS. G.]

[362] ["O'er the weltering *limbs* of the tombless dead."—GIFFORD.]

[pp]

*All that liveth on man will prey,
All rejoicing in his decay,
or, Nature rejoicing in his decay.
All that can kindle dismay and disgust
Follow his frame from the bier to the dust.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[pq] {470}

——*it hath left no more
Of the mightiest things that have gone before.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[363] [Omit this couplet.—GIFFORD.]

[pr] After this follows in the MS. erased—

*Monuments that the coming age
Leaves to the spoil of the season's rage—
Till Ruin makes the relics scarce,
Then Learning acts her solemn farce,
And, roaming through the marble waste,
Prates of beauty, art, and taste.*

XIX.

That Temple was more in the midst of the plain—

or, *What of that shrine did yet remain*
Lay to his left more in midst of the plain.—[MS. G.]

[364] [From this all is beautiful to—"He saw not—he knew not—but nothing is there."—GIFFORD. For "pillar's base," compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza x. line 2, *Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 105.]

[ps] {471}

Is it the wind that through the stone.
or, —o'er the heavy stone.—[MS. G. erased.]

[365] I must here acknowledge a close, though unintentional, resemblance in these twelve lines to a passage in an unpublished poem of Mr. Coleridge, called "Christabel." It was not till after these lines were written that I heard that wild and singularly original and beautiful poem recited; and the MS. of that production I never saw till very recently, by the kindness of Mr. Coleridge himself, who, I hope, is convinced that I have not been a wilful plagiarist. The original idea undoubtedly pertains to Mr. Coleridge, whose poem has been composed above fourteen years. Let me conclude by a hope that he will not longer delay the publication of a production, of which I can only add my mite of approbation to the applause of far more competent judges.

[The lines in *Christabel*, Part the First, 43-52, 57, 58, are these—

"The night is chill; the forest bare;
Is it the wind that moaneth bleak?
There is not wind enough in the air
To move away the ringlet curl
From the lovely lady's cheek—
There is not wind enough to twirl
The one red leaf, the last of its clan,
That dances as often as dance it can,
Hanging so light, and hanging so high,
On the topmost twig that looks up at the sky."
" ... What sees she there?
There she sees a damsel bright,
Drest in a silken robe of white."

Byron (*vide ante*, [p. 443](#)), in a letter to Coleridge, dated October 27, 1815, had already expressly guarded himself against a charge of plagiarism, by explaining that lines 521-532 of stanza xix. were written before he heard Walter Scott repeat *Christabel* in the preceding June. Now, as Byron himself perceived, perhaps for the first time, when he had the MS. of *Christabel* before him, the coincidence in language and style between the two passages is

unquestionable; and, as he hoped and expected that Coleridge's fragment, when completed, would issue from the press, he was anxious to avoid even the semblance of pilfering, and went so far as to suggest that the passage should be cancelled. Neither in the private letter nor the published note does Byron attempt to deny or explain away the coincidence, but pleads that his lines were written before he had heard Coleridge's poem recited, and that he had not been guilty of a "wilful plagiarism." There is no difficulty in accepting his statement. Long before the summer of 1815 *Christabel* "had a pretty general circulation in the literary world" (Medwin, *Conversations*, 1824, p. 261), and he may have heard without heeding this and other passages quoted by privileged readers; or, though never a line of *Christabel* had sounded in his ears, he may (as Kölbing points out) have caught its lilt at second hand from the published works of Southey, or of Scott himself.

Compare *Thalaba the Destroyer*, v. 20 (1838, iv. 187)—

"What sound is borne on the wind?
Is it the storm that shakes
The thousand oaks of the forest?

Is it the river's roar
Dashed down some rocky descent?" etc.

Or compare *The Lay of the Last Minstrel*, I. xii. 5. *seq.* (1812, p. 24)—

"And now she sits in secret bower
In old Lord David's western tower,
And listens to a heavy sound,
That moans the mossy turrets round.
Is it the roar of Teviot's tide,
That chafes against the scaur's red side?
Is it the wind that swings the oaks?
Is it the echo from the rocks?" etc.

Certain lines of Coleridge's did, no doubt, "find themselves" in the *Siege of Corinth*, having found their way to the younger poet's ear and fancy before the Lady of the vision was directly and formally introduced to his notice.]

[pt] {473} *There sate a lady young and bright.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[366] [Contemporary critics fell foul of these lines for various reasons. The *Critical Review* (February, 1816, vol. iii. p. 151) remarks that "the following couplet [i.e. lines 531, 532] reminds us of the *persiflage* of Lewis or the pathos of a vulgar ballad;" while the *Dublin Examiner* (May, 1816, vol. i. p. 19) directs a double charge against the

founders of the schism and their proselyte: "If the Cumberland *Lakers* were not well known to be personages of the most pious and saintly temperament, we would really have serious apprehensions lest our noble Poet should come to any harm in consequence of the envy which the two following lines and a great many others through the poems, might excite by their successful rivalry of some of the finest effects of babyism that these Gentlemen can boast."]

[pu] *He would have made it*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[pv] *She who would*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[pw] {474} *The ocean spread before their view.*—[Copy.]

[367] ["And its *thrilling* glance, etc."—GIFFORD.]

[368] [Warton (*Observations en the Fairy Queen*, 1807, ii. 131), commenting on Spenser's famous description of "Una and the Lion" (*Faëry Queene*, Book I. canto iii. stanzas 5, 6, 7), quotes the following passage from *Seven Champions of Christendom*: "Now, Sabra, I have by this sufficiently proved thy true virginity: for it is the nature of a lion, be he never so furious, not to harme the unspotted virgin, but humbly to lay his bristled head upon a maiden's lap."

Byron, according to Leigh Hunt (*Lord Byron and some of his Contemporaries*, 1828, i. 77), could not "see anything" in Spenser, and was not familiar with the *Fairy Queen*; but he may have had in mind Scott's allusion to Spenser's Una—

"Harpers have sung and poets told
That he, in fury uncontrolled,
The shaggy monarch of the wood,
Before a virgin, fair and good,
Hath pacified his savage mood."

Marmion, Canto II. stanza vii. line 3, *seq.*

(See Kölbing's note to *Siege of Corinth*, 1893, pp. 110-112.)]

[px] {476}

*She laid her fingers on his hand,
Its coldness thrilled through every bone.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[py] *As he looked on her face*——.—[MS. G.]

[pz] ——*on her bosom's swell.*—[MS. G. erased. Copy.]

[369] [Compare Shakespeare, *Macbeth*, act v. sc. 1, line 30—

"You see, her eyes are open,
Aye, but their sense is shut."

Compare, too, *Christabel*, Conclusion to Part the First (lines 292, 293)—

"With open eyes (ah, woe is me!)
Asleep, and dreaming fearfully."

[qa] {477}

*Like a picture, that magic had charmed from its frame,
Lifeless but life-like, and ever the same.*
or, *Like a picture come forth from its canvas and frame.—*
[MS. G. erased.]

[qb]

And seen——.—[MS. G.]
——its fleecy mail.—[MS. G. erased.]

[370] [In the summer of 1803, Byron, then turned fifteen, though offered a bed at Annesley, used at first to return every night to Newstead; alleging that he was afraid of the family pictures of the Chaworths, which he fancied "had taken a grudge to him on account of the duel, and would come down from their frames to haunt him." Moore thinks this passage may have been suggested by the recollection (*Life*, p. 27). Compare *Lara*, Canto I. stanza xi. line 1, seq. (*vide ante*, [p. 331](#), [note 1](#)).]

[371] [Compare Southey's *Roderick*, Canto XXI. (ed. 1838, ix. 195)—

" ... and till the grave
Open, the gate of mercy is not closed."]

[372] {478} I have been told that the idea expressed in this and the five following lines has been admired by those whose approbation is valuable. I am glad of it; but it is not original—at least not mine; it may be found much better expressed in pages 182-3-4 of the English version of "Vathek" (I forget the precise page of the French), a work to which I have before referred; and never recur to, or read, without a renewal of gratification.—
[The following is the passage: "'Deluded prince!' said the Genius, addressing the Caliph ... 'This moment is the last, of grace, allowed thee: ... give back Nouronihar to her father, who still retains a few sparks of life: destroy thy tower, with all its abominations: drive Carathis from thy councils: be just to thy subjects: respect the ministers of the Prophet:

compensate for thy impieties by an exemplary life; and, instead of squandering thy days in voluptuous indulgence, lament thy crimes on the sepulchres of thy ancestors. Thou beholdest the clouds that obscure the sun: at the instant he recovers his splendour, if thy heart be not changed, the time of mercy assigned thee will be past for ever."

"Vathek, depressed with fear, was on the point of prostrating himself at the feet of the shepherd ... but, his pride prevailing ... he said, 'Whoever thou art, withhold thy useless admonitions.... If what I have done be so criminal ... there remains not for me a moment of grace. I have traversed a sea of blood to acquire a power which will make thy equals tremble; deem not that I shall retire when in view of the port; or that I will relinquish her who is dearer to me than either my life or thy mercy. Let the sun appear! let him illumine my career! it matters not where it may end!' On uttering these words ... Vathek ... commanded that his horses should be forced back to the road.

"There was no difficulty in obeying these orders; for the attraction had ceased; the sun shone forth in all his glory, and the shepherd vanished with a lamentable scream" (ed. 1786, pp. 183-185).]

[[qc](#)] {479} *By rooted and unhallowed pride.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[[373](#)] [Leave out this couplet.—GIFFORD.]

[[374](#)] {480} [Compare—"While the still morn went out with sandals grey." *Lycidas*, line 187.]

[[375](#)] [Strike out—"And the Noon will look on a sultry day."—GIFFORD.]

[[376](#)] The horsetails, fixed upon a lance, a pacha's standard.

["When the vizir appears in public, three *thoughts*, or horse-tails, fastened to a long staff, with a large gold ball at top, is borne before him."—*Moeurs des Ottomans*, par A. L. Castellan (Translated, 1821), iv. 7.

Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II., "Albanian War-Song," stanza 10, line 2; and *Bride of Abydos*, line 714 (*vide ante*, [p. 189](#)).]

[[377](#)] [Compare—"Send out moe horses, skirr the country round." *Macbeth*, act v. sc. 3, line 35.]

[[378](#)] [Omit—

"While your fellows on foot, in a fiery mass,
Bloodstain the breach through which they pass."

—GIFFORD.]

[379] ["And crush the wall they have *shaken* before."—GIFFORD.]

[380] [Compare *The Giaour*, line 734 (*vide ante*, [p. 120](#))—"At solemn sound of 'Alla Hu!'" And *Don Juan*, Canto VIII. stanza viii.]

[381] ["He who first *downs* with the red cross may crave," etc. What vulgarism is this!—"He who *lowers*,—or *plucks down*," etc.—GIFFORD.]

[382] [The historian, George Finlay, who met and frequently conversed with Byron at Mesalonghi, with a view to illustrating "Lord Byron's *Siege of Corinth*," subjoins in a note the full text of "the summons sent by the grand vizier, and the answer." (See Finlay's *Greece under Othoman and Venetian Domination*, 1856, p. 266, note 1; and, for the original authority, see Brue's *Journal de la Campagne, ... en 1715*, Paris, 1871, p. 18.)]

[383] {482}

["Thus against the wall they *bent*,
Thus the first were backward *sent*."

—GIFFORD.]

[qd] *With such volley yields like glass.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[qe] *Like the mowers ridge*——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[384] ["Such was the fall of the foremost train."—GIFFORD.]

[385] {483} [Compare *The Deformed Transformed*, Part I. sc. 2 ("Song of the Soldiers")

—

"Our shout shall grow gladder,
And death only be mute."]

[qf] *I have heard*——.—[MS. G.]

[386] [Compare *Macbeth*, act ii. sc. 2, line 55—

"If he do bleed,
I'll gild the faces of the grooms withal."]

[387] {484} ["There stood a man," etc.—GIFFORD.]

[388] ["*Lurked*"—a bad word—say "*was hid*."—GIFFORD.]

[389] ["Outnumbered his hairs," etc.—GIFFORD.]

[390] ["Sons that were unborn, when *he* dipped."—GIFFORD.]

[391] {485} [Bravo!—this is better than King Priam's fifty sons.—GIFFORD.]

[392] In the naval battle at the mouth of the Dardanelles, between the Venetians and Turks.

[393] [There can be no such thing; but the whole of this is poor, and spun out.—GIFFORD. The solecism, if such it be, was repeated in *Marino Faliero*, act iii. sc. I, line 38.]

[394] [Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto II. stanza xxix. lines 5-8 (*Poetical Works*, 1899, ii. 125)—

"Dark Sappho! could not Verse immortal save?...
If life eternal may await the lyre."]

[395] ["Hark to the Alia Hu!" etc.—GIFFORD.]

[396] {486} [Gifford has erased lines 839-847.]

[qg] *Though the life of thy giving would last for ever.*—[MS. G. Copy.]

[qh] *Where's Francesca?—my promised bride!*—[MS. G. Copy.]

[qi] {488} Here follows in MS. G.—

*Twice and once he roll'd a space,
Then lead-like lay upon his face.*

[qj] *Sigh, nor sign, nor parting word.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[397] [The Spanish "renegado" and the Anglicized "renegade" were favourite terms of reprobation with politicians and others at the beginning of the century. When Southey's *Wat Tyler* was reprinted in 1817, William Smith, the Member for Norwich, denounced the Laureate as a "renegado," an attack which Coleridge did his best to parry by contributing articles to the *Courier* on "Apostasy and Renegadoism" (Letter to Murray, March 26, 1817, *Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 306). Byron himself, in *Don Juan* ("Dedication," stanza i. line 5), hails Southey as "My Epic Renegade!" Compare, too, stanza xiv. of "*Lines addressed to a Noble Lord* (His Lordship will know why), By one of the small Fry of the Lakes" (i.e. Miss Barker, the "Bhow Begum" of Southey's *Doctor*)—

"And our Ponds shall better please thee,
Than those now dishonoured seas,
With their shores and Cyclades
Stocked with Pachas, Seraskiers,

is, no doubt, an archaism, but Byron might have quoted Dryden as an authority, "The ponderous ball expires."]

[qr] *The hills as by an earthquake bent.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[403] {494} [Strike out from "Up to the sky," etc., to "All blackened there and reeking lay." Despicable stuff.—GIFFORD.]

[qs] *Who can see or who shall say?*—[MS. G. erased.]

[404] [Lines 1043-1047 are not in the Copy or MS. G., but were included in the text of the First Edition.]

[405] [Compare *Don Juan*, Canto II. stanza cii. line 1, *seq.*—

"Famine, despair, cold, thirst, and heat, had done
Their work on them by turns, and thinned them to
Such things a mother had not known her son
Amidst the skeletons of that gaunt crew."

Compare, too, *The Island*, Canto I. section ix. lines 13, 14.]

[qt] {495} *And crashed each mass of stone.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[qu]

And left their food the unburied dead.—[Copy.]

And left their food the untasted dead.—[MS. G.]

And howling left——.—[MS. G. erased.]

[406] [Omit the next six lines.—GIFFORD.]

[407] ["I have heard hyænas and jackalls in the ruins of Asia; and bull-frogs in the marshes; besides wolves and angry Mussulmans."—*Journal*, November 23, 1813, *Letters*, 1898, ii. 340.]

[qv] *Where Echo rolled in horror still.*—[MS. G.]

[qw] *The frightened jackal's shrill sharp cry.*—[MS. G. erased.]

[408] I believe I have taken a poetical licence to transplant the jackal from Asia. In Greece I never saw nor heard these animals; but among the ruins of Ephesus I have heard them by hundreds. They haunt ruins, and follow armies. [Compare *Childe Harold*, Canto IV. stanza cliii. line 6; and *Don Juan*, Canto IX. stanza xxvii. line 2.]

[qx] *Mixed and mournful as the sound.*—[MS. G.]

[409] [Leave out this couplet.—GIFFORD.]

[410] [With lines 1058-1079, compare Southey's *Roderick* (Canto XVIII., ed. 1838, ix. 169)—

"Far and wide the thundering shout,
Rolling among reduplicating rocks,
Pealed o'er the hills, and up the mountain vales.
The wild ass starting in the forest glade
Ran to the covert; the affrighted wolf
Skulked through the thicket to a closer brake;
The sluggish bear, awakened in his den,
Roused up and answered with a sullen growl,
Low-breathed and long; and at the uproar scared,
The brooding eagle from her nest took wing."

A sentence in a letter to Moore, dated January 10, 1815 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 168), "*I have tried the rascals (i.e. the public) with my Harrys and Larrys, Pilgrims and Pirates. Nobody but S....y has done any thing worth a slice of bookseller's pudding, and he has not luck enough to be found out in doing a good thing,*" implies that Byron had read and admired Southey's *Roderick*—an inference which is curiously confirmed by a memorandum in Murray's handwriting: "When Southey's poem, *Don Roderick* (*sic*), was published, Lord Byron sent in the middle of the night to ask John Murray if he had heard any opinion of it, for he thought it one of the finest poems he had ever read." The resemblance between the two passages, which is pointed out by Professor Kölbing, is too close to be wholly unconscious, but Byron's expansion of Southey's lines hardly amounts to a plagiarism.]

PARISINA.

INTRODUCTION TO *PARISINA*.



PARISINA, which had been begun before the *Siege of Corinth*, was transcribed by Lady Byron, and sent to the publisher at the beginning of December, 1815. Murray confessed that he had been alarmed by some hints which Byron had dropped as to the plot of the narrative, but was reassured when he traced "the delicate hand that transcribed it." He could not say enough of this "Pearl" of great price. "It is very interesting, pathetic, beautiful—do you know I would almost say moral" (*Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 353). Ward, to whom the MS. of *Parisina* was shown, and Isaac D'Israeli, who heard it read aloud by Murray, were enthusiastic as to its merits; and Gifford, who had mingled censure with praise in his critical appreciation of the *Siege*, declared that the author "had never surpassed *Parisina*."

The last and shortest of the six narrative poems composed and published in the four years (the first years of manhood and of fame, the only years of manhood passed at home in England) which elapsed between the appearance of the first two cantos of *Childe Harold* and the third, *Parisina* has, perhaps, never yet received its due. At the time of its appearance it shared the odium which was provoked by the publication of *Fare Thee Well* and *A Sketch*, and before there was time to reconsider the new volume on its own merits, the new canto of *Childe Harold*, followed almost immediately by the *Prisoner of Chillon* and its brilliant and noticeable companion

poems, usurped the attention of friend and foe. Contemporary critics (with the exception of the *Monthly* and *Critical* Reviews) fell foul of the subject-matter of the poem—the guilty passion of a bastard son for his father's wife. "It was too disgusting to be rendered pleasing by any display of genius" (*European Magazine*); "The story of *Parisina* includes adultery not to be named" (*Literary Panorama*); while the *Eclectic*, on grounds of taste rather than of morals, gave judgment that "the subject of the tale was purely unpleasing"—"the impression left simply painful."

Byron, no doubt, for better or worse, was in advance of his age, in the pursuit of art for art's sake, and in his indifference, not to morality—the *dénouement* of the story is severely moral—but to the moral edification of his readers. The tale was chosen because it is a tale of love and guilt and woe, and the poet, unconcerned with any other issue, sets the tale to an enchanting melody. It does not occur to him to condone or to reprobate the loves of Hugo and Parisina, and in detailing the issue leaves the actors to their fate. It was this aloofness from ethical considerations which perturbed and irritated the "canters," as Byron called them—the children and champions of the anti-revolution. The modern reader, without being attracted or repelled by the *motif* of the story, will take pleasure in the sustained energy and sure beauty of the poetic strain. Byron may have gone to the "nakedness of history" for his facts, but he clothed them in singing robes of a delicate and shining texture.

TO

SCROPE BERDMORE DAVIES, ESQ.

THE FOLLOWING POEM
IS INSCRIBED,
BY ONE WHO HAS LONG ADMIRER HIS TALENTS
AND VALUED HIS FRIENDSHIP.

January 22, 1816.

ADVERTISEMENT.

The following poem is grounded on a circumstance mentioned in Gibbon's "Antiquities of the House of Brunswick." I am aware, that in modern times, the delicacy or fastidiousness of the reader may deem such subjects unfit for the purposes of poetry. The Greek dramatists, and some of the best of our old English writers, were of a different opinion: as Alfieri and Schiller have also been, more recently, upon the Continent. The following extract will explain the facts on which the story is founded. The name of *Azo* is substituted for Nicholas, as more metrical.—[B.]

"Under the reign of Nicholas III. [A.D. 1425] Ferrara was polluted with a domestic tragedy. By the testimony of a maid, and his own observation, the Marquis of Este discovered the incestuous loves of his wife Parisina, and Hugo his bastard son, a beautiful and valiant youth. They were beheaded in the castle by the sentence of a father and husband, who published his shame, and survived their execution.^[411] He was unfortunate,

if they were guilty: if they were innocent, he was still more unfortunate; nor is there any possible situation in which I can sincerely approve the last act of the justice of a parent."—GIBBON'S *Miscellaneous Works*, vol. iii. p. 470. —[Ed. 1837, p. 830.]

PARISINA. ^[412]

I.

is the hour when from the boughs^[413]
the nightingale's high note is heard;
the hour when lovers' vows
seem sweet in every whispered word;
the gentle winds, and waters near,
are music to the lonely ear.
On flower the dews have lightly wet,
in the sky the stars are met,
on the wave is deeper blue,
on the leaf a browner hue, 10
in the heaven that clear obscure,
softly dark, and darkly pure,
which follows the decline of day,
the twilight melts beneath the moon away.^[414]

II.

it is not to list to the waterfall^[415]
that Parisina leaves her hall,
it is not to gaze on the heavenly light
that the Lady walks in the shadow of night;
if she sits in Este's bower,

not for the sake of its full-blown flower; 20
listens—but not for the nightingale—
ugh her ear expects as soft a tale.
re glides a step through the foliage thick, [qz]
her cheek grows pale, and her heart beats quick.
re whispers a voice through the rustling leaves,
her blush returns, and her bosom heaves:
oment more—and they shall meet—
past—her Lover's at her feet.

III.

what unto them is the world beside,
n all its change of time and tide? 30
iving things—its earth and sky—
nothing to their mind and eye.
heedless as the dead are they
ught around, above, beneath;
f all else had passed away,
y only for each other breathe;
ir very sighs are full of joy
leep, that did it not decay,
t happy madness would destroy
hearts which feel its fiery sway: 40
guilt, of peril, do they deem
at tumultuous tender dream?
o that have felt that passion's power,
aused, or feared in such an hour?
hought how brief such moments last?
yet—they are already past!
s! we must awake before
know such vision comes no more.

IV.

1 many a lingering look they leave
he spot of guilty gladness past: 50
though they hope, and vow, they grieve,
s if that parting were the last.
frequent sigh—the long embrace—
he lip that there would cling for ever,
le gleams on Parisina's face
he Heaven she fears will not forgive her,
f each calmly conscious star
eld her frailty from afar—
frequent sigh, the long embrace,
binds them to their trysting-place. 60
it must come, and they must part
earful heaviness of heart,
1 all the deep and shuddering chill
ch follows fast the deeds of ill.

V.

1 Hugo is gone to his lonely bed,
o covet there another's bride;
she must lay her conscious head
husband's trusting heart beside.
fevered in her sleep she seems,
red her cheek with troubled dreams, 70
nd mutters she in her unrest
ime she dare not breathe by day,^[415]
nd clasps her Lord unto the breast
ch pants for one away:
he to that embrace awakes,
, happy in the thought, mistakes

t dreaming sigh, and warm caress,
such as he was wont to bless;
could in very fondness weep
her who loves him even in sleep. 80

VI.

clasped her sleeping to his heart,
and listened to each broken word:
ears—Why doth Prince Azo start,
as if the Archangel's voice he heard?
well he may—a deeper doom
had scarcely thunder o'er his tomb,
when he shall wake to sleep no more,
stand the eternal throne before.
well he may—his earthly peace
in that sound is doomed to cease. 90
that sleeping whisper of a name
speaks her guilt and Azo's shame.
whose that name? that o'er his pillow
sounds fearful as the breaking billow,
which rolls the plank upon the shore,
and dashes on the pointed rock
the wretch who sinks to rise no more,—
so came upon his soul the shock.
whose that name?—'tis Hugo's,—his—
both he had not deemed of this!— 100
Hugo's,—he, the child of one
loved—his own all-evil son—
offspring of his wayward youth,
when he betrayed Bianca's truth,^{[ra][416]}
the maid whose folly could confide

him who made her not his bride.

VII.

He plucked his poniard in its sheath,
But sheathed it ere the point was bare;
He'er unworthy now to breathe,
He could not slay a thing so fair— 110
At least, not smiling—sleeping—there—
No more:—he did not wake her then,
But gazed upon her with a glance
Which, had she roused her from her trance,
Frozen her sense to sleep again;
O'er his brow the burning lamp
Shed on the dew-drops big and damp.
He spake no more—but still she slumbered—
And he, in his thought, her days are numbered.

VIII.

And with the morn he sought and found, 120
Many a tale from those around,
Proof of all he feared to know,
His present guilt—his future woe;
Long-conniving damsels seek
To save themselves, and would transfer
The guilt—the shame—the doom—to her:
No concealment is no more—they speak
The circumstance which may compel
Credence to the tale they tell:
And Azo's tortured heart and ear 130
He felt nothing more to feel or hear.

IX.

was not one who brooked delay:
Within the chamber of his state,
Chief of Este's ancient sway
Upon his throne of judgement sate;
Nobles and his guards are there,—
Before him is the sinful pair;
One young,—and *one* how passing fair!
One swordless belt, and fettered hand,
Christ! that thus a son should stand 140
Before a father's face!
Thus must Hugo meet his sire,
To hear the sentence of his ire,
The tale of his disgrace!
Yet he seems not overcome,
Though, as yet, his voice be dumb.

X.

Still,—and pale—and silently
Did Parisina wait her doom;
Nor changed since last her speaking eye
Flashed gladness round the glittering room, 150
Where high-born men were proud to wait—
Where Beauty watched to imitate
Her gentle voice—her lovely mien—
To gather from her air and gait
The graces of its Queen:
None,—had her eye in sorrow wept,
Thousand warriors forth had leapt,
Thousand swords had sheathless shone,
To make her quarrel all their own. ^[417]

7,—what is she? and what are they? 160
 she command, or these obey?
 silent and unheeding now,
 1 downcast eyes and knitting brow,
 . folded arms, and freezing air,
 . lips that scarce their scorn forbear,
 knights, her dames, her court—is there:
 . he—the chosen one, whose lance
 yet been couched before her glance,
 3—were his arm a moment free—
 died or gained her liberty; 170
 minion of his father's bride,—
 too, is fettered by her side;
 sees her swoln and full eye swim
 5 for her own despair than him:
 se lids—o'er which the violet vein
 idering, leaves a tender stain,
 ing through the smoothest white
 t e'er did softest kiss invite—
 7 seemed with hot and livid glow
 ress, not shade, the orbs below; 180
 ch glance so heavily, and fill,
 ear on tear grows gathering still^{[rb][418]}

XI.

. he for her had also wept,
 ut for the eyes that on him gazed:
 sorrow, if he felt it, slept;
 tern and erect his brow was raised.
 ate'er the grief his soul avowed,
 ould not shrink before the crowd;

yet he dared not look on her;
remembrance of the hours that were— 190
guilt—his love—his present state—
father's wrath, all good men's hate—
earthly, his eternal fate—
hers,—oh, hers! he dared not throw
look upon that death-like brow!
had his rising heart betrayed
horse for all the wreck it made.

XII.

Azo spake:—"But yesterday
gloried in a wife and son;
that dream this morning passed away; 200
the day declines, I shall have none.
life must linger on alone;
I,—let that pass,—there breathes not one
who would not do as I have done:
these ties are broken—not by me;
let that too pass;—the doom's prepared!
O, the priest awaits on thee,
and then—thy crime's reward!
Ay! address thy prayers to Heaven.
Before its evening stars are met, 210
in if thou there canst be forgiven:
His mercy may absolve thee yet.
Here, upon the earth beneath,
there is no spot where thou and I
either for an hour could breathe:
farewell! I will not see thee die—
thou, frail thing! shall view his head—

way! I cannot speak the rest:
o! woman of the wanton breast;
I, but thou his blood dost shed: 220
if that sight thou canst outlive,
joy thee in the life I give."

XIII.

here stern Azo hid his face—
or on his brow the swelling vein
hrobbed as if back upon his brain
he hot blood ebbd and flowd again;
therefore bowed he for a space,
nd passed his shaking hand along
is eye, to veil it from the throng;
le Hugo raised his chainéd hands, 230
for a brief delay demands
father's ear: the silent sire
oids not what his words require.
it is not that I dread the death—
thou hast seen me by thy side
redly through the battle ride,
that—not once a useless brand—
slaves have wrested from my hand
n shed more blood in cause of thine,
n e'er can stain the axe of mine:^[419] 240
hou gav'st, and may'st resume my breath,
ft for which I thank thee not;
are my mother's wrongs forgot,
slighted love and ruined name,
offspring's heritage of shame;
she is in the grave, where he,

son—thy rival—soon shall be.
broken heart—my severed head—
I witness for thee from the dead
v trusty and how tender were 250
youthful love—paternal care.
true that I have done thee wrong—
ut wrong for wrong:—this,—deemed thy bride,
he other victim of thy pride,—
u know'st for me was destined long;
u saw'st, and coveted'st her charms;
nd with thy very crime—my birth,—
hou taunted'st me—as little worth;
atch ignoble for her arms;
ause, forsooth, I could not claim 260
lawful heirship of thy name,
sit on Este's lineal throne;
et, were a few short summers mine,
ly name should more than Este's shine
n honours all my own.
d a sword—and have a breast
t should have won as haught^[420] a crest
ver waved along the line
ll these sovereign sires of thine.
always knightly spurs are worn 270
brightest by the better born;
mine have lanced my courser's flank
ore proud chiefs of princely rank,
en charging to the cheering cry
Este and of Victory!
ll not plead the cause of crime,
sue thee to redeem from time
w brief hours or days that must

length roll o'er my reckless dust;—
in maddening moments as my past, 280
they could not, and they did not, last;—
neither my birth and name be base,
nor thy nobility of race
lained to deck a thing like me—
yet in my lineaments they trace
some features of my father's face,
nor in my spirit—all of thee.
In thee this tamelessness of heart—
in thee—nay, wherefore dost thou start?—
in thee in all their vigour came 290
arm of strength, my soul of flame—
thou didst not give me life alone,
all that made me more thine own.
What thy guilty love hath done!
aid thee with too like a son!
I no bastard in my soul,
that, like thine, abhorred control;
nor for my breath, that hasty boon
thou gav'st and wilt resume so soon,
lued it no more than thou, 300
when rose thy casque above thy brow,
nor we, all side by side, have striven,
nor o'er the dead our coursers driven:
past is nothing—and at last
future can but be the past;^[421]
would I that I then had died:
nor though thou work'dst my mother's ill,
nor made thy own my destined bride,
feel thou art my father still:
nor harsh as sounds thy hard decree, 310

not unjust, although from thee.
ot in sin, to die in shame,
life begun and ends the same:
rrered the sire, so erred the son,
thou must punish both in one.
crime seems worst to human view,
God must judge between us too!"^[422]

XIV.

ceased—and stood with folded arms,
n which the circling fetters sounded;
nd not an ear but felt as wounded, 320
f all the chiefs that there were ranked,
en those dull chains in meeting clanked:
Parisina's fatal charms^[423]
in attracted every eye—
ld she thus hear him doomed to die!
stood, I said, all pale and still,
living cause of Hugo's ill:
eyes unmoved, but full and wide,
once had turned to either side—
once did those sweet eyelids close, 330
hade the glance o'er which they rose,
round their orbs of deepest blue
circling white dilated grew—
there with glassy gaze she stood
ce were in her curdled blood;
every now and then a tear^[424]
o large and slowly gathered slid
rom the long dark fringe of that fair lid,
as a thing to see, not hear!"^[425]

. those who saw, it did surprise, 340
n drops could fall from human eyes.
peak she thought—the imperfect note
 choked within her swelling throat,
seemed in that low hollow groan
 whole heart gushing in the tone.
ased—again she thought to speak,
n burst her voice in one long shriek,
 to the earth she fell like stone
tatie from its base o'erthrown,
e like a thing that ne'er had life,— 350
onument of Azo's wife,—
n her, that living guilty thing,
ose every passion was a sting,
ch urged to guilt, but could not bear
t guilt's detection and despair.
yet she lived—and all too soon
overed from that death-like swoon—
scarce to reason—every sense
 been o'erstrung by pangs intense;
 each frail fibre of her brain 360
bowstrings, when relaxed by rain,
 erring arrow launch aside)
: forth her thoughts all wild and wide—
 past a blank, the future black,
n glimpses of a dreary track,
: lightning on the desert path,
en midnight storms are mustering wrath.
feared—she felt that something ill
 on her soul, so deep and chill;
t there was sin and shame she knew, 370
t some one was to die—but who?

had forgotten:—did she breathe?
Id this be still the earth beneath,
sky above, and men around;
were they fiends who now so frowned
one, before whose eyes each eye
then had smiled in sympathy?
was confused and undefined
her all-jarred and wandering mind;
chaos of wild hopes and fears: 380
now in laughter, now in tears,
madly still in each extreme,
strove with that convulsive dream;
so it seemed on her to break:
vainly must she strive to wake!

XV.

Convent bells are ringing,
but mournfully and slow;
the grey square turret swinging,
with a deep sound, to and fro.
Heavily to the heart they go! 390
And the hymn is singing—
the song for the dead below,
for the living who shortly shall be so!
A departed being's soul^[rc]
The death-hymn peals and the hollow bells knoll:^[426]
So near his mortal goal;
Listening at the Friar's knee,
to hear, and piteous to see—
Listening on the bare cold ground.
In the block before and the guards around; 400

the headsman with his bare arm ready,
t the blow may be both swift and steady,
s if the axe be sharp and true
e he set its edge anew:^[427]
le the crowd in a speechless circle gather
ee the Son fall by the doom of the Father!

XVI.

a lovely hour as yet
ore the summer sun shall set,
ch rose upon that heavy day,
mock'd it with his steadiest ray; 410
his evening beams are shed
on Hugo's fated head,
his last confession pouring
he monk, his doom deploring
enitential holiness,
ends to hear his accents bless
n absolution such as may
e our mortal stains away.
t high sun on his head did glisten
ie there did bow and listen, 420
the rings of chestnut hair
ed half down his neck so bare;
brighter still the beam was thrown
n the axe which near him shone
n a clear and ghastly glitter——
that parting hour was bitter!
n the stern stood chilled with awe:
k the crime, and just the law—
they shuddered as they saw.

XVII.

parting prayers are said and over 430
that false son, and daring lover!
beads and sins are all recounted, ^[rd]
hours to their last minute mounted;
mantling cloak before was stripped,
bright brown locks must now be clipped;
done—all closely are they shorn;
vest which till this moment worn—
scarf which Parisina gave—
it not adorn him to the grave.
on that must now be thrown aside, 440
o'er his eyes the kerchief tied;
no—that last indignity
shall ne'er approach his haughty eye.
feelings seemingly subdued,
deep disdain were half renewed,
when headsman's hands prepared to bind
those eyes which would not brook such blind,
if they dared not look on death.
—yours my forfeit blood and breath;
these hands are chained, but let me die 450
at least with an unshackled eye—
“see!”—and as the word he said,
on the block he bowed his head;
these the last accents Hugo spoke:
“like!”—and flashing fell the stroke—
fell the head—and, gushing, sunk
back the stained and heaving trunk,
in the dust, which each deep vein
was red with its ensanguined rain;

eyes and lips a moment quiver, 460
vulsed and quick—then fix for ever.

lied, as erring man should die,
/ithout display, without parade;
leekly had he bowed and prayed,
s not disdaining priestly aid,
desperate of all hope on high.
while before the Prior kneeling,
heart was weaned from earthly feeling;
wrathful Sire—his Paramour—
it were they in such an hour? 470
nore reproach,—no more despair,—
hought but Heaven,—no word but prayer—
e the few which from him broke,
en, bared to meet the headsman's stroke,
laimed to die with eyes unbound,
sole adieu to those around.

XVIII.

as the lips that closed in death,
n gazer's bosom held his breath:
yet, afar, from man to man,
ld electric^[428] shiver ran, 480
lown the deadly blow descended
im whose life and love thus ended;
, with a hushing sound compressed,
gh shrunk back on every breast;
no more thrilling noise rose there,^[re]
eyond the blow that to the block
ierced through with forced and sullen shock,

one:—what cleaves the silent air
sadly shrill, so passing wild?
t, as a mother's o'er her child, 490
e to death by sudden blow,
he sky these accents go,
e a soul's in endless woe.
ough Azo's palace-lattice driven,
t horrid voice ascends to heaven,
every eye is turned thereon;
sound and sight alike are gone!
as a woman's shriek—and ne'er
adlier accents rose despair;
those who heard it, as it past, 500
mercy wished it were the last.

XIX.

o is fallen; and, from that hour,
nore in palace, hall, or bower,
Parisina heard or seen:
name—as if she ne'er had been—
banished from each lip and ear,
e words of wantonness or fear;
from Prince Azo's voice, by none
mention heard of wife or son;
omb—no memory had they; 510
irs was unconsecrated clay—
east the Knight's who died that day.
Parisina's fate lies hid
e dust beneath the coffin lid:
ether in convent she abode,
won to heaven her dreary road,

olighted and remorseful years
courage, and fast, and sleepless tears;
f she fell by bowl or steel,
that dark love she dared to feel: 520
f, upon the moment smote,
died by tortures less remote,
him she saw upon the block
a heart that shared the headsman's shock,
quickened brokenness that came,
ity o'er her shattered frame,
e knew—and none can ever know:
whatsoever its end below,
life began and closed in woe!

XX.

. Azo found another bride, 530
. goodly sons grew by his side;
none so lovely and so brave
him who withered in the grave;^[429]
f they were—on his cold eye
ir growth but glanced unheeded by,
noticed with a smothered sigh.
never tear his cheek descended,
. never smile his brow unbended;
. o'er that fair broad brow were wrought
intersected lines of thought; 540
se furrows which the burning share
orrow ploughs untimely there;
s of the lacerating mind
ch the Soul's war doth leave behind.^[430]
was past all mirth or woe:

ning more remained below
sleepless nights and heavy days,
ind all dead to scorn or praise,
part which shunned itself—and yet
t would not yield, nor could forget, 550
ch, when it least appeared to melt,
nsely thought—intensely felt:
deepest ice which ever froze
only o'er the surface close;
living stream lies quick below,
flows, and cannot cease to flow.^[431]
was his sealed-up bosom haunted^[rf]
houghts which Nature hath implanted;
deeply rooted thence to vanish,
ve'er our stifled tears we banish; 560
en struggling as they rise to start,
check those waters of the heart,
y are not dried—those tears unshed
flow back to the fountain head,
resting in their spring more pure,
ever in its depth endure,
een—unwept—but uncongealed,
cherished most where least revealed.
n inward starts of feeling left,
hrob o'er those of life bereft, 570
out the power to fill again
desert gap which made his pain;
out the hope to meet them where
ed souls shall gladness share;
n all the consciousness that he
only passed a just decree;^[rg]

t they had wrought their doom of ill;
Azo's age was wretched still.
tainted branches of the tree,
lopped with care, a strength may give, 580
y which the rest shall bloom and live
greenly fresh and wildly free:
if the lightning, in its wrath,
waving boughs with fury scathe,
massy trunk the ruin feels,
never more a leaf reveals.

FOOTNOTES:

[411] {503} ["Ferrara is much decayed and depopulated; but the castle still exists entire; and I saw the court where Parisina and Hugo were beheaded, according to the annal of Gibbon."—*Vide Advertisement to Lament of Tasso.*]

[412] {505} "This turned out a calamitous year for the people of Ferrara, for there occurred a very tragical event in the court of their sovereign. Our annals, both printed and in manuscript, with the exception of the unpolished and negligent work of Sardi, and one other, have given the following relation of it,—from which, however, are rejected many details, and especially the narrative of Bandelli, who wrote a century afterwards, and who does not accord with the contemporary historians.

"By the above-mentioned Stella dell' Assassino, the Marquis, in the year 1405, had a son called Ugo, a beautiful and ingenuous youth. Parisina Malatesta, second wife of Niccolo, like the generality of step-mothers, treated him with little kindness, to the infinite regret of the Marquis, who regarded him with fond partiality. One day she asked leave of her husband to undertake a certain journey, to which he consented, but upon condition that Ugo should bear her company; for he hoped by these means to induce her, in the end, to lay aside the obstinate aversion which she had conceived against him. And indeed his intent was accomplished but too well, since, during the journey, she not only divested herself of all her hatred, but fell into the opposite extreme. After their return, the Marquis had no longer any occasion to renew his former reproofs. It happened one day that a servant of the Marquis, named Zoese, or, as some call him, Giorgio, passing before the

apartments of Parisina, saw going out from them one of her chamber-maids, all terrified and in tears. Asking the reason, she told him that her mistress, for some slight offence, had been beating her; and, giving vent to her rage, she added, that she could easily be revenged, if she chose to make known the criminal familiarity which subsisted between Parisina and her step-son. The servant took note of the words, and related them to his master. He was astounded thereat, but, scarcely believing his ears, he assured himself of the fact, alas! too clearly, on the 18th of May, by looking through a hole made in the ceiling of his wife's chamber. Instantly he broke into a furious rage, and arrested both of them, together with Aldobrandino Rangoni, of Modena, her gentleman, and also, as some say, two of the women of her chamber, as abettors of this sinful act. He ordered them to be brought to a hasty trial, desiring the judges to pronounce sentence, in the accustomed forms, upon the culprits. This sentence was death. Some there were that bestirred themselves in favour of the delinquents, and, amongst others, Ugoccion Contrario, who was all-powerful with Niccolo, and also his aged and much deserving minister Alberto dal Sale. Both of these, their tears flowing down their cheeks, and upon their knees, implored him for mercy; adducing whatever reasons they could suggest for sparing the offenders, besides those motives of honour and decency which might persuade him to conceal from the public so scandalous a deed. But his rage made him inflexible, and, on the instant, he commanded that the sentence should be put in execution.

"It was, then, in the prisons of the castle, and exactly in those frightful dungeons which are seen at this day beneath the chamber called the Aurora, at the foot of the Lion's tower, at the top of the street Giovecca, that on the night of the 21st of May were beheaded, first, Ugo, and afterwards Parisina. Zoese, he that accused her, conducted the latter under his arm to the place of punishment. She, all along, fancied that she was to be thrown into a pit, and asked at every step, whether she was yet come to the spot? She was told that her punishment was the axe. She enquired what was become of Ugo, and received for answer, that he was already dead; at which, sighing grievously, she exclaimed, 'Now, then, I wish not myself to live;' and, being come to the block, she stripped herself, with her own hands, of all her ornaments, and, wrapping a cloth round her head, submitted to the fatal stroke, which terminated the cruel scene. The same was done with Rangoni, who, together with the others, according to two calendars in the library of St. Francesco, was buried in the cemetery of that convent. Nothing else is known respecting the women.

"The Marquis kept watch the whole of that dreadful night, and, as he was walking backwards and forwards, enquired of the captain of the castle if Ugo was dead yet? who answered him, Yes. He then gave himself up to the most desperate lamentations, exclaiming, 'Oh! that I too were dead, since I have been hurried on to resolve thus against my own Ugo!' And then gnawing with his teeth a cane which he had in his hand, he

passed the rest of the night in sighs and in tears, calling frequently upon his own dear Ugo. On the following day, calling to mind that it would be necessary to make public his justification, seeing that the transaction could not be kept secret, he ordered the narrative to be drawn out upon paper, and sent it to all the courts of Italy.

"On receiving this advice, the Doge of Venice, Francesco Foscari, gave orders, but without publishing his reasons, that stop should be put to the preparations for a tournament, which, under the auspices of the Marquis, and at the expense of the city of Padua, was about to take place, in the square of St. Mark, in order to celebrate his advancement to the ducal chair.

"The Marquis, in addition to what he had already done, from some unaccountable burst of vengeance, commanded that as many of the married women as were well known to him to be faithless, like his Parisina, should, like her, be beheaded. Amongst others, Barberina, or, as some call her, Laodamia Romei, wife of the court judge, underwent this sentence, at the usual place of execution; that is to say, in the quarter of St. Giacomo, opposite the present fortress, beyond St. Paul's. It cannot be told how strange appeared this proceeding in a prince, who, considering his own disposition, should, as it seemed, have been in such cases most indulgent. Some, however, there were who did not fail to commend him." [Memorie per la Storia di Ferrara, Raccolte da Antonio Frizzi, 1793, iii. 408-410. See, too, *Celebri Famiglie Italiane*, by Conte Pompeo Litta, 1832, Fasc. xxvi. Part III. vol. ii.]

[413] {507} [The revise of *Parisina* is endorsed in Murray's handwriting, "Given to me by Lord Byron at his house, Saturday, January 13, 1816."]

[414] The lines contained in this section were printed as set to music some time since, but belonged to the poem where they now appear; the greater part of which was composed prior to *Lara*, and other compositions since published. [Note to *Siege, etc.*, First Edition, 1816.]

[qy]

*Francisca walks in the shadow of night,
But it is not to gaze on the heavenly light—
But if she sits in her garden bower,
'Tis not for the sake of its blowing flower.—*

[Nathan, 1815, 1829.]

[qz] {508} *There winds a step——.—*[Nathan, 1815, 1829.]

[415] {509} [Leigh Hunt, in his *Autobiography* (1860, p. 252), says, "I had the pleasure of supplying my friendly critic, Lord Byron, with a point for his *Parisina* (the incident of the

heroine talking in her sleep)."

Putting Lady Macbeth out of the question, the situation may be traced to a passage in Henry Mackenzie's *Julia de Roubigné* (1777, ii. 101: "Montauban to Segarva," Letter xxxv.):—

"I was last night abroad at supper; Julia was a-bed before my return. I found her lute lying on the table, and a music-book open by it. I could perceive the marks of tears shed on the paper, and the air was such as might encourage their falling. Sleep, however, had overcome her sadness, and she did not awake when I opened the curtain to look on her. When I had stood some moments, I heard her sigh strongly through her sleep, and presently she muttered some words, I know not of what import. I had sometimes heard her do so before, without regarding it much; but there was something that roused my attention now. I listened; she sighed again, and again spoke a few broken words. At last I heard her plainly pronounce the name Savillon two or three times, and each time it was accompanied with sighs so deep that her heart seemed bursting as it heaved then."]

[ra] {511} ——*Medora's*——.—[Copy erased.]

[416] [Compare *Christabel*, Part II. lines 408, 409—

"Alas! they had been friends in youth;
But whispering tongues can poison truth."]

[417] {513} [Compare the famous eulogy of Marie Antoinette, in Burke's *Reflections on the Revolution in France*, in a Letter intended to have been sent to a Gentleman in Paris, London, 1790, pp. 112, 113—

"It is now sixteen or seventeen years since I saw the Queen of France, then the dauphiness, at Versailles.... Little did I dream ... that I should have lived to see such disasters fall upon her in a nation of gallant men, in a nation of men of honour and of cavaliers. I thought ten thousand swords must have leaped from their scabbards to avenge even a look that threatened her with insult."]

[rb] {514} *As tear by tear rose gathering still*.—[Revise.]

[418] [Lines 175-182, which are in Byron's handwriting, were added to the Copy.]

[419] {516} [The meaning is plain, but the construction is involved. The contrast is between the blood of foes, which Hugo has shed for Azo, and Hugo's own blood, which Azo is about to shed on the scaffold. But this is one of Byron's incurious infelicities.]

[420] {517} Haught—haughty. "Away, *haught* man, thou art insulting me."—SHAKESPEARE [*Richard II.*, act iv. sc. i, line 254—"No lord of thine, thou haught insulting man."]

[421] {518} [Lines 304, 305, and lines 310-317 are not in the Copy. They were inserted by Byron in the Revise.]

[422] [A writer in the *Critical Review* (February, 1816, vol. iii. p. 151) holds this couplet up to derision. "Too" is a weak ending, and, orally at least, ambiguous.]

[423] ["I sent for *Marmion*, ... because it occurred to me there might be a resemblance between part of *Parisina* and a similar scene in Canto 2d. of *Marmion*. I fear there is, though I never thought of it before, and could hardly wish to imitate that which is inimitable.... I had completed the story on the passage from Gibbon, which, in fact, leads to a like scene naturally, without a thought of the kind; but it comes upon me not very comfortably."—Letter to Murray, February 3, 1816 (*Letters*, 1899, iii. 260). The scene in *Marmion* is the one where Constance de Beverley appears before the conclave—

"Her look composed, and steady eye,
Bespoke a matchless constancy;
And there she stood so calm and pale,
That, but her breathing did not fail,
And motion slight of eye and head,
And of her bosom, warranted
That neither sense nor pulse she lacks,
You must have thought a form of wax,
Wrought to the very life, was there—
So still she was, so pale, so fair."

Canto II. stanza xxi. lines 5-14.]

[424] {519} ["I admire the fabrication of the 'big Tear,' which is very fine—much larger, by the way, than Shakespeare's."—Letter of John Murray to Lord Byron (*Memoir of John Murray*, 1891, i. 354).]

[425] [Compare *Christabel*, Part I. line 253—"A sight to dream of, not to tell!"]

[rc] {521} *For a departing beings soul.*—[Copy.]

[426] [For the peculiar use of "knoll" as a verb, compare *Childe Harold*, Canto III. stanza xcvi. line 5; and *Werner*, act iii. sc. 3.]

[427] {522} [Lines 401-404, which are in Byron's handwriting, were added to the Copy.]

[rd] {523} *His latest beads and sins are counted.*—[Copy.]

[428] {524} [For the use of "electric" as a metaphor, compare Coleridge's *Songs of the Pixies*, v. lines 59, 60—

"The electric flash, that from the melting eye
Darts the fond question and the soft reply."]

[re] *But no more thrilling voice rose there.*—[Copy.]

[429] {526} [Here, again, Byron is *super grammaticam*. The comparison is between Hugo and "goodly sons," not between Hugo and "bride" in the preceding line.]

[430] [Lines 539-544 are not in the Copy, but were inserted in the Revise.]

[431] {527} [Lines 551-556 are not in the Copy, but were inserted in the Revise.]

[rf] *Ah, still unwelcomely was haunted.*—[Copy.]

[rg] *Had only sealed a just decree.*—[Copy.]

POEMS OF THE SEPARATION.

INTRODUCTION TO *POEMS OF THE SEPARATION.*



The two poems, *Fare Thee Well* (March 17) and *A Sketch* (March 29, 1816), which have hitherto been entitled *Domestic Pieces*, or *Poems on His Own Circumstances*, I have ventured to rename *Poems of the Separation*. Of secondary importance as poems or works of art, they stand out by themselves as marking and helping to make the critical epoch in the life and reputation of the poet. It is to be observed that there was an interval of twelve days between the date of *Fare Thee Well* and *A Sketch*; that the composition of the latter belongs to a later episode in the separation drama; and that for some reasons connected with the proceedings between the parties, a pathetic if not uncritical resignation had given place to the extremity of exasperation—to hatred and fury and revenge. It follows that either poem, in respect of composition and of publication, must be judged on its own merits. Contemporary critics, while they were all but unanimous in holding up *A Sketch* to unqualified reprobation, were divided with regard to the good taste and good faith of *Fare Thee Well*. Moore intimates that at first, and, indeed, for some years after the separation, he was strongly inclined to condemn the *Fare Thee Well* as a histrionic performance—"a showy effusion of sentiment;" but that on reading the account of all the circumstances in Byron's *Memoranda*, he was impressed by the reality of

the "swell of tender recollections, under the influence of which, as he sat one night musing in his study, these stanzas were produced—the tears, as he said, falling fast over the paper as he wrote them" (*Life*, p. 302).

With whatever purpose, or under whatever emotion the lines were written, Byron did not keep them to himself. They were shown to Murray, and copies were sent to "the initiated." "I have just received," writes Murray, "the enclosed letter from Mrs. Maria Graham [1785-1842, *née* Dundas, authoress and traveller, afterwards Lady Callcott], to whom I had sent the verses. It will show you that you are thought of in the remotest corners, and furnishes me with an excuse for repeating that I shall not forget you. God bless your Lordship. Fare *Thee* Well" [MSS. M.].

But it does not appear that they were printed in their final shape (the proof of a first draft, consisting of thirteen stanzas, is dated March 18, 1816) till the second copy of verses were set up in type with a view to private distribution (see *Letters*, 1899, iii. 279). Even then there was no thought of publication on the part of Byron or of Murray, and, as a matter of fact, though *Fare Thee Well* was included in the "Poems" of 1816, it was not till both poems had appeared in over twenty pirated editions that *A Sketch* was allowed to appear in vol. iii. of the Collected Works of 1819. Unquestionably Byron intended that the "initiated," whether foes or sympathizers, should know that he had not taken his dismissal in silence; but it is far from certain that he connived at the appearance of either copy of verses in the public press. It is impossible to acquit him of the charge of appealing to a limited circle of specially chosen witnesses and advocates in a matter which lay between himself and his wife, but the aggravated offence of rushing into print may well be attributed to "the injudicious zeal of a friend," or the "malice prepense" of an enemy. If he had hoped that the

verses would slip into a newspaper, as it were, *malgré lui*, he would surely have taken care that the seed fell on good ground under the favouring influence of Perry of the *Morning Chronicle*, or Leigh Hunt of the *Examiner*. As it turned out, the first paper which possessed or ventured to publish a copy of the "domestic pieces" was the *Champion*, a Tory paper, then under the editorship of John Scott (1783-1821), a man of talent and of probity, but, as Mr. Lang puts it (*Life and Letters* of John Gibson Lockhart, 1897, i. 256), "Scotch, and a professed moralist." The date of publication was Sunday, April 14, and it is to be noted that the *Ode from the French* ("We do not curse thee, Waterloo") had been published in the *Morning Chronicle* on March 15, and that on the preceding Sunday, April 7, the brilliant but unpatriotic apostrophe to the *Star of the Legion of Honour* had appeared in the *Examiner*. "We notice it [this strain of his Lordship's harp]," writes the editor, "because we think it would not be doing justice to the merits of such political tenets, if they were not coupled with their corresponding practice in regard to moral and domestic obligations. There is generally a due proportion kept in 'the music of men's lives.' ... Of many of the *facts* of this distressing case we are not ignorant; but God knows they are not for a newspaper. Fortunately they fall within very general knowledge, in London at least; if they had not they would never have found their way to us. But there is a respect due to certain wrongs and sufferings that would be outraged by uncovering them." It was all very mysterious, very terrible; but what wonder that the laureate of the ex-emperor, the contemner of the Bourbons, the pæanist of the "star of the brave," "the rainbow of the free," should make good his political heresy by personal depravity—by unmanly vice, unmanly whining, unmanly vituperation?

Wordsworth, to whom Scott forwarded the *Champion* of April 14, "outdid" the journalist in virtuous fury: "Let me say only one word of Lord

B. The man is insane. The verses on his private affairs excite in me less indignation than pity. The latter copy is the Billingsgate of Bedlam. ... You yourself seem to labour under some delusion as to the merits of Lord B.'s poetry, and treat the wretched verses, the *Fare Well*, with far too much respect. They are disgusting in sentiment, and in execution contemptible. 'Though my many faults deface me,' etc. Can worse doggerel than such a stanza be written? One verse is commendable: 'All my madness none can know.'" The criticism, as criticism, confutes itself, and is worth quoting solely because it displays the feeling of a sane and honourable man towards a member of the "opposition," who had tripped and fallen, and now lay within reach of his lash (see *Life of William Wordsworth*, 1889, ii. 267, etc.).

It was not only, as Macaulay put it, that Byron was "singled out as an expiatory sacrifice" by the British public in a periodical fit of morality, but, as the extent and the limitations of the attack reveal, occasion was taken by political adversaries to inflict punishment for an outrage on popular sentiment.

The *Champion* had been the first to give tongue, and the other journals, on the plea that the mischief was out, one after the other took up the cry. On Monday, April 15, the *Sun* printed *Fare Thee Well*, and on Tuesday, April 16, followed with *A Sketch*. On the same day the *Morning Chronicle*, protesting that "the poems were not written for the public eye, but as having been inserted in a Sunday paper," printed both sets of verses; the *Morning Post*, with an ugly hint that "the noble Lord gives us verses, when he dare not give us circumstances," restricted itself to *Fare Thee Well*; while the *Times*, in a leading paragraph, feigned to regard "the two extraordinary copies of verses ... the whining stanzas of *Fare Thee Well*, and the low malignity and miserable doggerel of the companion *Sketch*," as "an

injurious fabrication." On Thursday, the 18th, the *Courier*, though declining to insert *A Sketch*, deals temperately and sympathetically with the *Fare Thee Well*, and quotes the testimony of a "fair correspondent" (? Madame de Staël), that if "her husband had bade her such a farewell she could not have avoided running into his arms, and being reconciled immediately—'Je n'aurois pu m'y tenir un instant';" and on the same day the *Times*, having learnt to its "extreme astonishment and regret," that both poems were indeed Lord Byron's, maintained that the noble author had "degraded literature, and abused the privileges of rank, by converting them into weapons of vengeance against an inferior and a female." On Friday, the 19th, the *Star* printed both poems, and the *Morning Post* inserted a criticism, which had already appeared in the *Courier* of the preceding day. On Saturday, the 20th, the *Courier* found itself compelled, in the interests of its readers, to print both poems. On Sunday, the 21st, the octave of the original issue, the *Examiner* devoted a long article to an apology for Byron, and a fierce rejoinder to the *Champion*; and on the same day the *Independent Whig* and the *Sunday News*, which favoured the "opposition," printed both poems, with prefatory notices more or less favourable to the writer; whereas the Tory *Antigallican Monitor*, which also printed both poems, added the significant remark that "if everything said of Lord Byron be true, it would appear that the Whigs were not altogether so immaculate as they themselves would wish the world to suppose."

The testimony of the press is instructive from two points of view. In the first place, it tends to show that the controversy was conducted on party lines; and, secondly, that the editor of the *Champion* was in some degree responsible for the wide diffusion and lasting publicity of the scandal. The separation of Lord and Lady Byron must, in any case, have been more than a nine days' wonder, but if the circulation of the "pamphlet" had been

strictly confined to the "initiated," the excitement and interest of the general public would have smouldered and died out for lack of material.

In his second letter on Bowles, dated March 25, 1821 (*Observations upon Observations, Life*, 1892, p. 705), Byron alludes to the publication of these poems in the *Champion*, and comments on the behaviour of the editor, who had recently (February 16, 1821) been killed in a duel. He does not minimize the wrong, but he pays a fine and generous tribute to the courage and worth of his assailant. "Poor Scott is now no more ...he died like a brave man, and he lived an able one," etc. It may be added that Byron was an anonymous subscriber to a fund raised by Sir James Mackintosh, Murray, and others, for "the helpless family of a man of virtue and ability" (*London Magazine*, April, 1821, vol. iii. p. 359).

For chronological reasons, and in accordance with the precedent of the edition of 1832, a third poem, *Stanzas to Augusta*, has been included in this group.

POEMS OF THE SEPARATION



FARE THEE WELL.^[432]

"Alas! they had been friends in youth;
But whispering tongues can poison truth:
And Constancy lives in realms above;
And Life is thorny; and youth is vain:
And to be wroth with one we love,
Doth work like madness in the brain;

But never either found another
To free the hollow heart from paining—
They stood aloof, the scars remaining,
Like cliffs which had been rent asunder;
A dreary sea now flows between,
But neither heat, nor frost, nor thunder,
Shall wholly do away, I ween,
The marks of that which once hath been."

COLERIDGE'S Christabel.^[rh]

E thee well! and if for ever,
till for ever, fare *thee well*:
n though unforgiving, never
ainst thee shall my heart rebel.
ld that breast were bared before thee^[ri]
/here thy head so oft hath lain,

le that placid sleep came o'er thee^[rj]
Which thou ne'er canst know again:
Ild that breast, by thee glanced over,
Very inmost thought could show!
If thou would'st at last discover
'twas not well to spurn it so.
Praise the world for this commend thee—^[433]
Though it smile upon the blow,
If its praises must offend thee,
Bounded on another's woe:
Praise my many faults defaced me,
Could no other arm be found,
If the one which once embraced me,
Should inflict a cureless wound?
Nay yet, thyself deceive not—
Love may sink by slow decay,
By sudden wrench, believe not
Hearts can thus be torn away:
Thine own its life retaineth—
Till must mine, though bleeding, beat;^[rk]
The undying thought which paineth^[rl]
—that we no more may meet.
These are words of deeper sorrow^[rm]
Than the wail above the dead;
I shall live—but every morrow^[rn]
Take us from a widowed bed.
When thou would'st solace gather—
When our child's first accents flow—
Thou teach her to say "Father!"
Though his care she must forego?
When her little hands shall press thee—

When her lip to thine is pressed—
Think of him whose prayer shall bless thee—
Think of him thy love *had* blessed!
Would her lineaments resemble
Hose thou never more may'st see,
In thy heart will softly tremble^[ro]
With a pulse yet true to me.
My faults perchance thou knowest—
All my madness—none can know;^[rp]
My hopes—where'er thou goest—
Wither—yet with *thee* they go.
My feeling hath been shaken;
Pride—which not a world could bow—^[rq]
Is to thee—by thee forsaken,^[rr]
Even my soul forsakes me now.
'Tis done—all words are idle—
Words from me are vainer still;^[rs]
The thoughts we cannot bridle
Force their way without the will.
Fare thee well! thus disunited—^[rt]
Torn from every nearer tie—
Wounded in heart—and lone—and blighted—
More than this I scarce can die.

[First draft, *March* 18, 1816.
First printed as published, April 4, 1816.]

A SKETCH.^{[ru][434]}

"Honest—honest Iago!
If that thou be'st a devil, I cannot kill thee."

SHAKESPEARE.

IN the garret, in the kitchen bred,
noted thence to deck her mistress' head;^[rv]
t—for some gracious service unexpressed,
from its wages only to be guessed—
ed from the toilet to the table,—where
wondering betters wait behind her chair.
n eye unmoved, and forehead unabashed,
dines from off the plate she lately washed.
ck with the tale, and ready with the lie,
genial confidante, and general spy— 10
o could, ye gods! her next employment guess—
only infant's earliest governess!^[rw]
taught the child to read, and taught so well,
t she herself, by teaching, learned to spell.
adept next in penmanship she grows,
nany a nameless slander deftly shows:
at she had made the pupil of her art,
e know—but that high Soul secured the heart,^[rx]
panted for the truth it could not hear,
n longing breast and undeluded ear. 20
ed was perversion by that youthful mind,^[ry]
ch Flattery fooled not, Baseness could not blind,
eit infect not, near Contagion soil,
ilgence weaken, nor Example spoil,^[rz]
mastered Science tempt her to look down
numbler talents with a pitying frown,
Genius swell, nor Beauty render vain,
Envy ruffle to retaliate pain,^[sa]
Fortune change, Pride raise, nor Passion bow,
Virtue teach austerity—till now. 30
nely purest of her sex that live,^[sb]

wanting one sweet weakness—to forgive;
shocked at faults her soul can never know,
deems that all could be like her below:
to all vice, yet hardly Virtue's friend,
Virtue pardons those she would amend.

to the theme, now laid aside too long,
baleful burthen of this honest song,^[sc]
though all her former functions are no more,
rules the circle which she served before. 40
others—none know why—before her quake;
daughters dread her for the mothers' sake;
silly habits—those false links, which bind
times the loftiest to the meanest mind—^[sd]
she given her power too deeply to instil
the angry essence of her deadly will;^[se]
like a snake she steal within your walls,
the black slime betray her as she crawls;
like a viper to the heart she wind,
she leave the venom there she did not find; 50
it marvel that this hag of hatred works^[sf]
her evil latent as she lurks,
like a Pandemonium where she dwells,
she reign the Hecate of domestic hells?
led by a touch to deepen Scandal's tints
in all the kind mendacity of hints,
she mingle truth with falsehood—sneers with smiles—
she read of candour with a web of wiles,^[sg]
she ain blunt show of briefly-spoken seeming,
hide her bloodless heart's soul-hardened scheming; 60
she of lies; a face formed to conceal,

, without feeling, mock at all who feel:
1 a vile mask the Gorgon would disown,—
reek of parchment, and an eye of stone.^[sh]
k, how the channels of her yellow blood
e to her skin, and stagnate there to mud,
ed like the centipede in saffron mail,
larker greenness of the scorpion's scale—^[si]
drawn from reptiles only may we trace
genial colours in that soul or face)— 70
k on her features! and behold her mind^[sj]
n a mirror of itself defined:
k on the picture! deem it not o'ercharged—
re is no trait which might not be enlarged:
true to "Nature's journeymen,"^[435] who made
; monster when their mistress left off trade—
; female dog-star of her little sky,
ere all beneath her influence droop or die.^[sk]

wretch without a tear—without a thought,
e joy above the ruin thou hast wrought— 80
time shall come, nor long remote, when thou
t feel far more than thou inflicttest now;
for thy vile self-loving self in vain,
turn thee howling in unpitied pain.
the strong curse of crushed affections light^[436]
k on thy bosom with reflected blight!
make thee in thy leprosy of mind
oathsome to thyself as to mankind!
all thy self-thoughts curdle into hate,
k—as thy will or others would create: 90
thy hard heart be calcined into dust,

thy soul welter in its hideous crust.
 may thy grave be sleepless as the bed,
 widowed couch of fire, that thou hast spread!
 n, when thou fain wouldst weary Heaven with prayer,
 k on thine earthly victims—and despair!
 rn to the dust!—and, as thou rott'st away,
 n worms shall perish on thy poisonous clay.^[sl]
 for the love I bore, and still must bear,
 er thy malice from all ties would tear— 100
 name—thy human name—to every eye
 climax of all scorn should hang on high,
 lted o'er thy less abhorred compeers—
 festering^[437] in the infamy of years.^[sm]

[First draft, *March* 29, 1816.
 First printed as published, April 4, 1816.]

STANZAS TO AUGUSTA.^[438]

EN all around grew drear and dark,^[sn]
 nd reason half withheld her ray—
 . Hope but shed a dying spark
 /hich more misled my lonely way;
 at deep midnight of the mind,
 nd that internal strife of heart,
 en dreading to be deemed too kind,
 he weak despair—the cold depart;
 en Fortune changed—and Love fled far,^[so]
 nd Hatred's shafts flew thick and fast,
 u wert the solitary star^[sp]
 /hich rose and set not to the last.^[sq]
 blest be thine unbroken light!

hat watched me as a Seraph's eye,
stood between me and the night,
or ever shining sweetly nigh.
when the cloud upon us came,^[sr]
Which strove to blacken o'er thy ray—^[ss]
n purer spread its gentle flame,^[st]
nd dashed the darkness all away.
may thy Spirit dwell on mine,^[su]
nd teach it what to brave or brook—
re's more in one soft word of thine
han in the world's defied rebuke.
u stood'st, as stands a lovely tree,^[sv]
hat still unbroke, though gently bent,
waves with fond fidelity
s boughs above a monument.
winds might rend—the skies might pour,
ut there thou wert—and still wouldst be
oted in the stormiest hour
o shed thy weeping leaves o'er me.
thou and thine shall know no blight,
Whatever fate on me may fall;
Heaven in sunshine will requite
he kind—and thee the most of all.
n let the ties of baffled love
e broken—thine will never break;
heart can feel—but will not move;
hy soul, though soft, will never shake.
these, when all was lost beside,
ere found and still are fixed in thee:—
bearing still a breast so tried,
arth is no desert—ev'n to me.

[First published, *Poems*, 1816.]

FOOTNOTES:

[432] {537} ["He there (Byron, in his *Memoranda*) described, and in a manner whose sincerity there was no doubting, the swell of tender recollections, under the influence of which, as he sat one night musing in the study, these stanzas were produced,—the tears, as he said, falling fast over the paper as he wrote them."—*Life*, p. 302.]

It must have been a fair and *complete* copy that Moore saw (see *Life*, p. 302, note 3). There are no tear-marks on this (the first draft, sold at Sotheby's, April 11, 1885) draft, which must be the *first*, for it is incomplete, and every line (almost) tortured with alterations.

"Fare Thee Well!" was printed in Leigh Hunt's *Examiner*, April 21, 1816, at the end of an article (by L. H.) entitled "Distressing Circumstances in High Life." The text there has two readings different from that of the pamphlet, viz.—

Examiner: "Than the soft one which embraced me."

Pamphlet: "Than the one which once embraced me."

Examiner: "Yet the thoughts we cannot bridle."

Pamphlet: "But," etc.

—*MS. Notes taken by the late J. Dykes Campbell at Sotheby's, April 18, 1890, and re-transcribed for Mr. Murray, June 15, 1894.*

A final proof, dated April 7, 1816, was endorsed by Murray, "Correct 50 copies as early as you can to-morrow."]

[rh] The motto was prefixed in *Poems*, 1816.

[ri] {538} *Thou my breast laid bare before thee.*—[MS. erased.]

[rj] *Not a thought is pondering on thee.*—[MS, erased.]

[433] [Lines 13-20 do not appear in an early copy dated March 18, 1816. They were added on the margin of a proof dated April 4, 1816.]

[rk] {539} Net result of many alterations.

[rl] *And the lasting thought—.*—[MS. erased.]

[rm] *—of deadlier sorrow.*—[MS. erased.]

[rn] *Every future night and morrow.*—[MS. erased.]

[ro] *Still thy heart—.*—[MS. erased.]

[rp] *All my follies——.*—[MS. erased.]

[rq] *——which not the world could bow.*—[MS.]

[rr] *Falls at once——.*—[MS. erased.]

[rs] {540} *Tears and sighs are idler still.*—[MS. erased.]

[rt] *Fare thee well—thus lone and blighted.*—[MS. erased.]

[ru] *A Sketch from Life.*—[MS. M.]

[434] ["I send you my last night's dream, and request to have 50 copies (for private distribution) struck off. I wish Mr. Gifford to look at them; they are from life."—Letter to Murray, March 30, 1816.

"The original MS. of Lord Byron's Satire, 'A Sketch from Private Life,' written by his Lordship, 30th March, 1816. Given by his Lordship to me on going abroad after his separation from Lady Byron, John Hanson. To be carefully preserved." (This MS. omits lines 19-20, 35-36, 55-56, 65-70, 77-78, 85-92.)

A copy entitled, "A sketch from private Life," dated March 30, 1816, is in Mrs. Leigh's handwriting. The corrections and additions are in Byron's handwriting.

A proof dated April 2, 1816, is endorsed by Murray, "Correct with most particular care and print off 50 copies, and keep standing."

[rv] *Promoted thence to comb——*—[MS. M. erased.]

[rw] *——early governess.*—[MS. M.]

[rx] *——but that pure spirit saved her heart.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[ry] *Vain was each effort——.*—[MS. M.]

[rz]

*Much Learning madden—when with scarce a peer
She soared through science with a bright career—
Nor talents swell——.*—[MS. M.]

[sa] *——bigotry prevoke.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[sb] *Serenely purest of the things that live.*—[MS. M.]

[sc] {542} *The trusty burthen of my honest song.*—[MS. M.]

[sd] *At times the highest*——.—[MS. M.]

[se] ——*of her evil will.*—[MS. M.]

[sf]

What marvel that this mistress demon works

Eternal evil { *wheresoe'er she lurks.*—[MS. M.]
when she latent works.—[Copy.]

[sg] *A gloss of candour of a web of wiles.*—[MS. M.]

[sh] {543} Lines 65-68 were added April 2, 1816.

[si] The parenthesis was added April 2, 1816.

[sj] *Look on her body*——.—[MS. M.]

[435] [See *Hamlet*, act iii. sc. 2, line 31.]

[sk] *Where all that gaze upon her droop or die.*—[MS. altered April 2, 1816.]

[436] Lines 85-91 were added April 2, 1816, on a page endorsed, "Quick—quick—quick—quick."

[sl] {544} ——*in thy poisoned clay.*—[MS. M. erased.]

[437] ["I doubt about 'weltering' but the dictionary should decide—look at it. We say 'weltering in blood'—but do they not also use 'weltering in the wind' 'weltering on a gibbet'?—there is no dictionary, so look or ask. In the meantime, I have put 'festering,' which perhaps in any case is the best word of the two.—P.S. Be quick. Shakespeare has it often and I do not think it too strong for the figure in this thing."—Letter to Murray, April 2.]

[sm] *And weltering in the infamy of years.*—[MS. M.]

[438] [His sister, the Honourable Mrs. Leigh.—These stanzas—the parting tribute to her whose tenderness had been his sole consolation in the crisis of domestic misery—were, we believe, the last verses written by Lord Byron in England. In a note to Mr. Rogers, dated April 16 [1816], he says, "My sister is now with me, and leaves town to-morrow; we shall not meet again for some time at all events—*if ever!* and under these circumstances I trust to stand excused to you and Mr. Sheridan, for being unable to wait upon him this evening."—Note to Edition of 1832, x. 193.]

A fair copy, broken up into stanzas, is endorsed by Murray, "Given to me (and I believe composed by Ld. B.), Friday, April 12, 1816."

[[sn](#)] ———*grew waste and dark.*—[MS. M.]

[[so](#)] {545} *When Friendship shook*———.—[MS. M.]

[[sp](#)] *Thine was the solitary star.*—[MS. M.]

[[sq](#)] *Which rose above me to the last.*—[MS. M.]

[[sr](#)]

And when the cloud between us came.—[MS. M.]

And when the cloud upon me came.—[Copy C. H.]

[[ss](#)] *Which would have closed on that last ray.*—[MS. M.]

[[st](#)] *Then stiller stood the gentle Flame.*—[MS. M.]

[[su](#)] *Still may thy Spirit sit on mine.*—[MS. M.]

[[sy](#)] {546}

And thou wast as a lovely Tree

Whose branch unbroke but gently bent

Still waved with fond Fidelity.—[Copy C. H.]

END OF VOL. III.

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